Future Founder & Leader

CURRICULUM HANDBOOK

56 quarterly projects · 248 lessons · ages 9–14

Compiled verbatim from the validated curriculum content. Interactive version: **athlon1987.github.io/fullstack-nanodegree-vm**

How this curriculum works

Each age band runs four **pillars** in parallel — Think, Communicate, Build, and Create Wealth — with one quarterly **project** per pillar. Every project ends in a real, tangible **artifact**, and every lesson follows the same six-step loop:

1. **Concept** — learn the idea
2. **Real example** — see it in the world
3. **Apply it** — advance the project artifact
4. **Reflect** — think about what happened
5. **Get feedback** — improve it
6. **Teach it back** — teach someone else (the retention step)

Every lesson also carries an **AI judgment note**: when to reach for AI and — more important — when not to. Projects and lessons unlock in order via prerequisites; success criteria are observable things a parent can verify.

AGE BAND	STATUS
9–10	Complete — 16 projects, 4 per pillar
11–12	Complete — 16 projects, 4 per pillar
13–14	Complete — 16 projects, 4 per pillar
15–16	In progress — 8 of 16 projects

Contents

- Communicate Q1: Publish Something Worth Reading
- Communicate Q2: Reach Out and Interview
- Communicate Q3: Show Your Work
- Communicate Q4: Launch Loud
- Build Q1: Build Something People Keep Using
- Build Q2: Automate the Boring Part
- Build Q3: Make It Run Without You
- Build Q4: Build the Delivery Machine
- Create Wealth Q1: Ship a Real Micro-Offer
- Create Wealth Q2: Know Your Numbers
- Create Wealth Q3: Customers on Repeat
- Create Wealth Q4: Run the Venture Month

AGES 15-16

- Think Q1: Choose Your Problem
- Think Q2: Don't Fool Yourself
- Communicate Q1: Own the Room
- Communicate Q2: The Professional Voice
- Build Q1: Go Deep on a Craft
- Build Q2: Build With Others
- Create Wealth Q1: From Hours to Assets
- Create Wealth Q2: Money That Works

Ages 9-10

THINK · Q1

The Noticing Game

th-9-10-q1 · supporting: Explore

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, thinking is concrete and literal, and learning happens through play, doing, and collecting rather than abstract discussion. Kids this age are natural noticers and sorters — they love grouping, comparing, and asking 'why' — but they can't yet hold a hypothesis or run a fair test the way an older child can. Keep every loop short, hands-on, and finishing the same day, or attention drifts.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value at this age is being the one who *noticed* something real that everyone else walked past, and getting to share it. It's not money and not a product — it's 'look what I found out'. The audience is family and friends, and the reward is their genuine interest.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child becomes a 'noticer' — collecting and studying ordinary things (leaves, coins, sounds, bugs) and spotting things grown-ups miss. The pull is the pride of being sharp-eyed and the small delight of surprising an adult with something they noticed. Collecting and sorting are already deeply satisfying at this age, so the activity motivates itself.

THE ARTIFACT

A 'noticing journal' or discovery card: a small collection the child observed and sorted into groups, with one real 'why' question and their best guess at the answer.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child looked closely enough to describe details they hadn't noticed before.
- They sorted their collection into groups and can explain the rule they used.
- They asked one real 'why' question and offered a guess.

1 Look really closely

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Most people glance at things. A noticer *looks* — long enough to see the little details everyone else misses. Slowing down and really looking is the first thinking skill.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Look at a single leaf for a whole minute. Suddenly you see tiny lines, little holes, colours changing at the edge — all there the whole time, just unnoticed.

03 APPLY IT

Pick five ordinary things (a coin, a leaf, a shoe, whatever). Look at each for one minute and write or draw one detail you'd never noticed before.

04 REFLECT

Which thing surprised you most when you really looked? Was the detail there all along?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show an adult one of your things and share your detail. Ask if they'd ever noticed it. Their surprise is your reward.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Play the one-minute looking game with a younger child and help them find a detail.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a look-with-your-own-eyes game — no screen needed. The whole point is *you* noticing, which a computer can't do for you.

You'll need: Noticing journal pages (5 slots for detail drawings)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Five never-before-noticed details are recorded from real objects.

2 Sort it into groups

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Once you've collected things, you can sort them — big/small, smooth/rough, by colour. Sorting is thinking: you're deciding what's the same and what's different, and picking a rule.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Tip out a box of buttons and you'll naturally start grouping them — by colour, then by size. Scientists sort the whole world this way, from animals to stars.

03 APPLY IT

Gather a collection (leaves, rocks, toys, coins). Sort it into groups. Write down the rule you used, then re-sort it a totally different way.

04 REFLECT

You sorted the same things two different ways — so which grouping is 'right'? (Trick question: it depends on what you care about.)

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your groups to someone and see if they can guess your sorting rule. If they can't, was your rule clear?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Give a friend your collection and challenge them to sort it, then explain their rule to you.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Sort with your own hands and eyes — that's the thinking. No app needed to move real objects into real piles.

You'll need: Sorting mat / group labels

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A collection was sorted two different ways with each rule stated.

Unlocks after: Look really closely

3 Ask a big 'why?'

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Noticers don't just look — they wonder. Pick one thing you noticed and ask why it's like that. Then make your best guess. A good guess isn't cheating; it's how thinking starts.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Why are most leaves green?' or 'Why do heavier coins feel colder?' You don't need the final answer yet — asking the question and guessing is the win.

03 APPLY IT

Pick one thing from your collection and write a 'why' question about it. Then write your best guess at the answer.

04 REFLECT

Where did your guess come from — something you already knew? Good guesses usually connect to things you've seen before.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask an adult your 'why' question. Compare their answer to your guess. Were you close?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Ask a family member to make up their own 'why' question about something at home, and swap guesses.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Make your *own* guess first, before anyone (or any computer) tells you the answer. The guessing is the exercise; getting handed the answer skips the workout.

You’ll need: Why-question + guess card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ One real 'why' question and a reasoned guess are written down.

Unlocks after: Sort it into groups

4 Share your discovery

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

A discovery isn't finished until you share it. Telling someone what you noticed, sorted, and wondered turns you from a looker into a discoverer.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Show-and-tell works because sharing a real find is exciting for everyone. 'Look what I noticed' is a great thing to be able to say.

03 APPLY IT

Finish your noticing journal (details + your groups + your why-question and guess) and present it to your family like a real discovery.

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to share something *you* noticed? Which part were you proudest of?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your listeners what they found most interesting. Note it — it tells you what makes a discovery exciting to others.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help someone else in your family start their own noticing journal.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Share it with real people, face to face. The joy here is a real person going 'wow, I never noticed that' — that's a human moment, not a screen one.

You'll need: Completed noticing-journal template

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The child presented a completed noticing journal to a real audience.

Unlocks after: Ask a big 'why?'

THINK · Q2

The Deciding Game

th-9-10-q2 · supporting: Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children can compare two things but tend to decide on impulse or on a single flashy feature — the biggest, the shiniest, the one their friend picked. They're ready to learn that a choice can be made *on purpose*, by listing reasons, if the choices are concrete and real (which pet, how to spend Saturday, which project to do). Having just practised noticing in Q1, they can now notice the differences that matter between options.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is being a good decider — making a choice you can actually explain, instead of 'I just wanted to'. At this age it's the pride of being trusted to decide something real, and being able to give your reasons like a grown-up.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child gets to make a *real* decision that actually counts — and the deal is: you can choose, as long as you can explain why. Being genuinely trusted with a real choice is deeply motivating at this age, and the 'explain your reason' rule turns a snap judgement into real thinking without it feeling like a chore.

THE ARTIFACT

A real decision the child made using a good-points / not-so-good-points comparison, captured on a decision card with the final choice and the main reason for it.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child compared at least two real options side by side.
- They listed good and not-so-good points for each instead of deciding on one feature.
- They can explain the single reason that tipped their choice.

Unlocks after: The Noticing Game

1 Two choices, side by side

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

The first step in a good decision is putting your choices next to each other so you can really see them. It's hard to choose well when the options are jumbled in your head — line them up.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Deciding how to spend Saturday? Write it out: 'Option A: go to the park. Option B: build a fort.' Now you can actually look at them instead of just feeling torn.

03 APPLY IT

Think of a real choice you have this week. Write your two options side by side on a card.

04 REFLECT

Was it easier to think once you saw both written down? Our heads get muddled; paper helps.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your two options to a parent and check you've written them clearly.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a sibling line up two choices they're stuck between.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is your real choice about your real life — a computer doesn't know what you'd enjoy. Line the options up yourself.

You'll need: Decision card (two-option layout)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Two real options are written side by side.

2 Good points and not-so-good points

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Every choice has good bits and not-so-good bits. A good decider looks at *both* for each option, instead of only seeing the fun part of the one they already want.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Park: good — fresh air, friends; not-so-good — might rain. Fort: good — cosy, creative; not-so-good — big mess to clean up. Now the choice is clearer.

03 APPLY IT

For each of your two options, write two good points and one not-so-good point.

04 REFLECT

Did writing the not-so-good points change how you felt about your favourite? Sometimes it does.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask someone if they can think of a good or not-so-good point you missed.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend how to find the 'not-so-good points' of something they're excited about.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You know your life best — the real good and bad points come from you, not a screen. Do the thinking yourself.

You'll need: Good/not-so-good points sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Both options have good and not-so-good points listed.

Unlocks after: Two choices, side by side

3 What matters most?

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

Usually one thing matters most to you. Naming it helps you decide. If staying dry matters most today, that points one way; if being creative matters most, another. The deciding reason is the one you care about most.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

If you really don't want to clean up a big mess today, that one thing might tip you to the park — even if the fort sounded fun. Knowing what matters most decides it.

03 APPLY IT

Look at your points and circle the ONE that matters most to you right now. That's your deciding reason.

04 REFLECT

Was it easy to pick the one that matters most? Sometimes two feel equal — then you get to just choose.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell someone your 'matters most' point and see if they understand why it's the tie-breaker for you.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Ask a family member what would matter most to *them* in your choice — notice it might be different!

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

What matters most to you is *yours* — nobody else, and no computer, can decide what you care about most.

You'll need: Matters-most circle card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ One 'matters most' reason is identified.

Unlocks after: Good points and not-so-good points

4 Decide and explain

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Now make your choice and say your reason out loud. 'I chose the park because staying dry mattered most today.' A decision you can explain is a good decision — even if it turns out imperfect.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Explaining your reason is what makes you a decider, not a coin-flipper. And if it doesn't go perfectly, you'll know exactly what to think about next time.

03 APPLY IT

Make your real choice and write (or say) your one-sentence reason on your decision card. Then actually do it!

04 REFLECT

After doing it — was it a good choice? What did you learn for next time? (Both good and 'oops' are useful.)

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell a parent your choice and reason. Ask if your reason made sense to them.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk a sibling through the whole Deciding Game with a small choice of their own.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Owning your choice — and its reason — is the skill. It has to be your decision, made and explained by you.

You'll need: Completed decision card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real decision was made and carried out.
- ☐ The child stated a one-sentence reason for it.

Unlocks after: What matters most?

THINK · Q3

Step by Step

th-9-10-q3 · supporting: Build

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children often freeze at a task that looks 'too hard' because they see it as one big scary lump. Learning to break a tricky task into small steps and do them one at a time is a genuine superpower they can grasp now, especially with concrete tasks (a recipe, a build, a puzzle). Having learned to notice (Q1) and decide (Q2), they now learn to actually *tackle* something hard.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is getting through something that felt too hard by breaking it down — the proud realisation that 'hard' usually just means 'lots of small steps I haven't sorted yet'. It's the first taste of not giving up when something looks big.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child picks something they've wanted to do but that felt too hard, and conquers it by breaking it into steps. The triumph of finishing a 'too hard' thing — and realising the trick that made it possible — is powerfully motivating, and it builds the grit to try the next hard thing.

THE ARTIFACT

A tricky task the child broke into small steps and completed, with the steps written out as a 'step ladder' they followed.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child took something that felt too big and broke it into small steps.
- They put the steps in a sensible order and did them one at a time.
- They finished the task, or got much further than they would have by charging in.

Unlocks after: The Deciding Game

1 Big things feel scary in one lump

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

When something looks 'too hard', it's usually because you're seeing the whole thing at once. 'Tidy my whole messy room' feels impossible. But it's really just a pile of small, easy jobs hiding inside one big scary word.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Bake a cake' sounds hard. But it's really: get ingredients, mix, pour, bake, wait, decorate. Six small steps — each one easy. The lump was the only scary part.

03 APPLY IT

Pick one real thing you've been putting off because it feels too big. Just name it for now.

04 REFLECT

Why has this felt too hard? Is it really hard, or just big?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell a parent your 'too big' task and see if they agree it's been feeling scary as one lump.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Ask a family member about a task *they* find too big, and guess why it feels that way.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Pick something from your own real life — you know best what's been nagging at you. This is your task to name.

You'll need: Too-big-task card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ One real 'too big' task is named.

2 Break it into a step ladder

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Now chop the big task into small steps — each one a single easy thing you could do in a few minutes. Write them as a ladder, bottom to top. Suddenly the impossible thing is just a list of easy things.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Tidy my room' becomes: 1) pick up clothes, 2) put books on shelf, 3) clear the desk, 4) bin the rubbish, 5) make the bed. Five easy rungs instead of one scary word.

03 APPLY IT

Break your task into small steps and write them as a step ladder, in order.

04 REFLECT

Does the task look less scary now it's a list of small steps? That shrinking feeling is the whole trick.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your step ladder to someone. Ask if any step is still too big and needs splitting again.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a sibling turn one of their big tasks into a step ladder.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Try breaking it down yourself first — figuring out the steps is the brain exercise. If you get stuck, an adult can help more than a screen, because they know your task.

You'll need: Step-ladder worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The task is broken into ordered small steps.

Unlocks after: Big things feel scary in one lump

3 One step at a time

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Now just do the first step. Then the next. Don't look at the whole ladder — look at the one rung in front of you. Ticking off steps one by one is how big things actually get done.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You don't climb a ladder by jumping to the top — you take one rung at a time. Same with your task: first step done, tick, next step. Before long, you're at the top.

03 APPLY IT

Do your task one step at a time, ticking off each step as you finish it.

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to tick off each step? Small wins add up to a big finish.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show someone your ticked-off ladder as you go. Let them cheer each step.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why doing 'one rung at a time' beats staring at the whole ladder.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is you doing the real work, step by step. The doing is yours — a computer can't tick your rungs for you.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The child worked through the steps in order, tracking progress.

Unlocks after: Break it into a step ladder

4 Stuck? Try, tweak, ask

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

Sometimes a step is harder than expected. That's normal — it doesn't mean stop. Try it, tweak your way if it doesn't work, and ask for help if you're really stuck. Getting unstuck is part of the skill.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

If 'put books on the shelf' fails because the shelf is full, you tweak: maybe some books go in a box. A blocked step isn't the end — it's a little puzzle inside the big one.

03 APPLY IT

Find the step that was trickiest and write what you did to get past it — a tweak, a try, or asking someone.

04 REFLECT

When you got stuck, what helped most — trying again, changing your plan, or asking? Remember it for next time.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell an adult about a step you got stuck on and how you got unstuck. Ask if they'd have done it differently.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach someone the 'try, tweak, ask' trick for when a step gets hard.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

When stuck, a real person who knows your task usually helps more than a screen. Learn to ask for help — that's a strength, not a weakness.

You'll need: Got-unstuck card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The task was finished or substantially advanced.
- ☐ The child can describe how they handled a stuck moment.

Unlocks after: One step at a time

THINK · Q4

Plan the Showcase

th-9-10-q4 · supporting: Communicate, Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

This is the year's capstone, and Think leads it. At 9–10, a child can genuinely plan a small real event if it's broken into steps (Q3), helped along with clear decisions (Q2), and grounded in noticing what's needed (Q1). Owning the plan for a real Showcase Day — a small at-home event where they show and sell what they've made this year — is a huge, proud milestone. Keep the scope small and the child genuinely in charge.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is being the *planner* of a real event that actually happens — the whole year's thinking skills put to work on something that matters. It's the leap from doing small tasks to organising a whole day, and being trusted to do it.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child is put genuinely in charge of planning a real event that their family will attend. Being trusted to run the plan — making the decisions, owning the list, setting the date — is enormously motivating at this age. The event is real, the responsibility is real, and that pulls their best thinking out of them.

THE ARTIFACT

A written plan for Showcase Day: what the day will include, a list of everything needed, a step-ladder of things to do (with who and when), and the key decisions made — pulling together noticing, deciding, and step-planning from the whole year.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child decided what Showcase Day will include and can explain their choices.
- They listed what's needed and broke the preparation into ordered steps.
- They presented the plan and a real date was set.

Unlocks after: Step by Step

1 What's the showcase?

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

First, decide what your Showcase Day will be: a small event where you show and share the things you've made this year, with a little stall to sell some. Use your deciding skills to choose what to include — you can't do everything, so pick the best bits.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Your showcase might be: a table showing your inventions and digital creation, a little stall selling your bookmarks, and a five-minute 'tour' you give your family. Small, real, and doable in an afternoon.

03 APPLY IT

Decide what your Showcase Day will include. Write a short list of the 3–4 things that will happen.

04 REFLECT

Did you pick things you're proud of and that are doable at home? What did you leave out, and why?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Share your showcase idea with a parent and check it's the right size — not too big, not too small.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to a sibling what your Showcase Day will be and why you chose those parts.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is your day, built from your year — you decide what goes in it. That's yours, not a computer's.

You'll need: Showcase plan card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A short list of what Showcase Day will include is decided.

2 Notice what's needed

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Use your noticing skills to spot everything the day needs — a table, chairs, signs, snacks, money box, your things to show. Missing one thing can cause a wobble on the day, so list it all now.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A stall needs: a table, a sign with prices, your things laid out, a box for money, and a chair. Noticing all of it beforehand means no panic on the day.

03 APPLY IT

Walk through your Showcase Day in your mind and list everything you'll need for each part.

04 REFLECT

Which thing would be easiest to forget? Those are exactly the ones a good list catches.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your 'needed' list to a parent and ask what you've missed.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a family member list what's needed for something *they're* planning.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Picturing your real day at your real home is something only you can do. Walk through it in your own mind.

You'll need: Needed-things checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A checklist of everything needed for the day exists.

Unlocks after: What's the showcase?

3 Make the step ladder

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Now use your step-by-step skill to turn the whole plan into ordered steps: what to do this week, what to do the day before, what to do on the morning. A big event is just a step ladder, same as any tricky task.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

This week: make the goods and the sign. Day before: set up the table, make snacks. Morning of: lay out the stall, put up signs, invite everyone in. One rung at a time.

03 APPLY IT

Break your whole plan into a step ladder, in order, with roughly when each step happens.

04 REFLECT

Looking at your ladder, is anything left too late? Better to spot it now than the morning of.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your step ladder to a parent and agree which steps they might help with.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone how a whole event becomes a simple step ladder.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Build your own ladder — sequencing the steps is the thinking. An adult can help with timing since they know the household's week.

You'll need: Event step-ladder sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The preparation is broken into an ordered, timed step ladder.

Unlocks after: Notice what's needed

4 Share the plan and set the date

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

A plan isn't real until people agree to it. Present your whole plan to your family, get their buy-in, and set a real date. Now Showcase Day is actually happening — and the other three parts (inviting, making, selling) can begin.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You show your family the plan, they say 'great — let's do it two Saturdays from now', and suddenly it's real. That date is what turns a plan into an event.

03 APPLY IT

Present your full plan to your family and agree on a real date for Showcase Day. Write the date at the top of your plan.

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to present a whole plan you made? What questions did your family ask?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your family if the plan makes sense and if the date works for everyone.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone the whole plan for your Showcase Day as if inviting them to help.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a real family conversation to agree a real date — a very human, in-person moment. Present it yourself, proudly.

You'll need: Finalised plan with date

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The plan was presented to the family.
- ☐ A real date for Showcase Day was set.

Unlocks after: Make the step ladder

COMMUNICATE · Q1

Tell a Story People Remember

co-9-10-q1 · supporting: Create

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children love stories and can retell events, but they tend to ramble — every detail feels equally important and the point gets lost. 'Beginning, middle, end' is a handle they can genuinely grasp at this age, and they light up performing for a real audience. Keep it spoken and playful; writing long pieces is a different, harder skill best kept small here.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value at this age is a listener who's genuinely gripped — leaning in, laughing, remembering your story afterward. It's the first taste of holding an audience, usually family or friends, with something you experienced or imagined.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child tells a real story to a real listener and finds out whether it landed — did they laugh, gasp, remember it later? A live audience reacting (or not) is powerfully motivating at this age; performing and being enjoyed feels great, and the flat moments teach fast.

THE ARTIFACT

A short told-or-recorded story (2–3 minutes) about something real that happened, with a clear beginning, middle, and end, delivered to a real listener.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The story has a clear beginning, middle, and end a listener can follow.
- The child left out boring bits and kept the interesting part.
- A real listener could retell the main thing that happened afterward.

1 Beginning, middle, end

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Every good story has three parts: a beginning (who and where), a middle (what happened — usually a problem or surprise), and an end (how it turned out). That shape is what makes a story feel like a story.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'I went to the park (beginning), a dog stole my sandwich (middle), and the owner bought me an ice cream to say sorry (end).' Simple — but it's a real story because it has all three.

03 APPLY IT

Think of something real that happened to you. Say it in just three sentences: beginning, middle, end.

04 REFLECT

Which part was hardest to pin down? Often it's the middle — the actual interesting thing.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell your three-sentence version to someone. Ask if it felt complete or like something was missing.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a younger child turn something that happened to them into a beginning-middle-end.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Use your own real memory here — a story that happened to *you* beats any made-up one a computer could write, because you actually lived it.

You'll need: Three-part story card (beginning / middle / end)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real event is told in a clear three-part shape.

2 Keep the good part

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

A rambly story buries the good bit under boring details. Find the most interesting moment — the surprise, the problem, the funny part — and make sure it shines. Cut the rest.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Nobody needs to hear what you had for breakfast before the dog stole your sandwich. Skip to the good part — the theft!

03 APPLY IT

Take your story and underline the single most interesting moment. Cross out two boring details that don't help it.

04 REFLECT

Was it hard to cut things? We get attached to details even when they slow the story down.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell the trimmed version to someone. Did it feel snappier than before?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Listen to a friend's story and gently help them spot the one boring bit to cut.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You decide what the 'good part' is — it's your story and your sense of what's exciting. That judgement is yours to build, not a computer's to hand you.

You'll need: Story-trimming worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The most interesting moment is identified and at least two boring details cut.

Unlocks after: Beginning, middle, end

3 Use your voice and face

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

The same words are boring in a flat voice and thrilling with expression. Slowing down at the exciting bit, going quiet, making a face — that's how you pull a listener in.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Watch how a good storyteller drops their voice to a whisper right before the scary part. You lean in without even deciding to.

03 APPLY IT

Tell your story out loud twice — once totally flat, once with your best voice and faces. Feel the difference.

04 REFLECT

Which version would *you* rather listen to? What did your voice do at the exciting moment?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Perform the expressive version for someone and watch their face. Did they react more than to the flat one?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a family member the flat-vs-expressive trick with a single sentence.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is all you — your real voice and face. It's a performing skill, and no screen can do the performing for you.

You'll need: Expression practice prompts

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The story was performed with deliberate voice/expression changes at key moments.

Unlocks after: Keep the good part

4 Tell it for real

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Now put it together and tell your whole story to a real audience. The test of a story is simple: can they remember what happened afterward?

02 REAL EXAMPLE

If your friend is still talking about your sandwich-thief dog the next day, your story worked. Being remembered is the goal.

03 APPLY IT

Tell (or record) your full 2–3 minute story for a real listener, using your three-part shape, the good part, and your best expression.

04 REFLECT

Where did your listener react most? That's the part that worked — remember what you did there.

05 GET FEEDBACK

A little later, ask your listener to retell your story. What they remember (and forget) shows you what landed.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Coach someone else through telling their story to a real audience.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Tell it to a real person, not a device. The whole reward — a human remembering your story — only happens with a real listener.

You'll need: Listener retell check card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A complete story was told to a real audience.
- ☐ The listener could retell the main event afterward.

Unlocks after: Use your voice and face

COMMUNICATE · Q2

Ask and Listen

co-9-10-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children can ask questions but often wait to talk rather than truly listen, and their questions tend to be yes/no ones. Learning to ask an open question and actually listen to the answer is a real leap. Interviewing a real person they like — a grandparent, a neighbour, a family friend — is concrete, warm, and gives instant reward. Having learned to *tell* a story in Q1, they now learn to *draw out* someone else's.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is making a real person feel truly listened to, and learning something about them you never knew. At this age that connection — an older person lighting up because a child actually wanted to hear their story — is the whole reward.

MOTIVATION LEVER — BELONGING

The child interviews someone they care about and discovers a real story they'd never heard. The warm connection — someone feeling genuinely listened to, and the child feeling closer to them — is powerfully motivating at this age. It turns 'practising questions' into a real relationship moment they'll want to repeat.

THE ARTIFACT

A short interview of a real person: a few good questions asked, answers truly listened to, and one surprising or interesting thing learned, shared back to the family.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child asked at least two open questions (not just yes/no ones).
- They listened well enough to ask a follow-up based on the answer.
- They can share one thing they learned that they didn't know before.

Unlocks after: Tell a Story People Remember

1 Questions that open people up

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Some questions get a one-word answer ('Did you like school?' → 'Yes'). Others open people up ('What was school like when you were my age?'). Open questions start with what, how, or why and invite a real story.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Was your childhood fun?' gets a shrug. 'What did you do for fun when there were no phones?' gets a whole story. Same idea, very different question.

03 APPLY IT

Write three open questions (starting with what, how, or why) for someone you'd like to interview.

04 REFLECT

Which of your questions do you think will get the best story? Why that one?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Read your questions to a parent and ask which would open *them* up most.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a sibling turn a yes/no question into an open one.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI could suggest generic questions, but the best ones fit the real person you're interviewing — and only you know them. Write your own.

You'll need: Open-question starter card (what/how/why)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Three open questions are written for a real person.

2 Really listen

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

Listening isn't waiting for your turn to talk — it's actually taking in what the person says. Look at them, don't interrupt, and let there be little quiet gaps. Good listeners make people want to keep talking.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You can feel the difference between someone who's really listening and someone who's just nodding while thinking about themselves. Be the first kind.

03 APPLY IT

Practise listening with a family member for two minutes: they talk, you only listen — no interrupting. Then tell them one thing they said.

04 REFLECT

Was it hard not to jump in? Most people find it surprisingly tricky to just listen.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask the person: 'Did you feel listened to?' Their answer tells you how you did.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Play the two-minute listening game with a friend and swap roles.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Listening is a human-to-human skill — a screen can't practise it for you. This one's all about real attention to a real person.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The child listened without interrupting and recalled what was said.

Unlocks after: Questions that open people up

3 Ask 'tell me more'

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

The magic follow-up is simple: 'tell me more' or 'why was that?' It shows you were listening and it unlocks the best part of the story — the bit that doesn't come out in the first answer.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Grandpa says 'I had a dog named Rex.' You say 'tell me more about Rex!' — and out comes the whole adventure. The follow-up got the good stuff.

03 APPLY IT

Do your real interview. Ask your open questions, listen, and use 'tell me more' at least twice.

04 REFLECT

Which 'tell me more' got the best story? Following someone's answer beats sticking to your list.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Notice how the person responds when you ask for more — do they light up? That's you doing it right.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone the 'tell me more' trick and how it unlocks better stories.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Following up means responding to what the *real* person actually just said — you can only do that live, in the moment. No script or app can do it for you.

You'll need: Interview record sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A real interview happened with at least two follow-up questions used.

Unlocks after: Really listen

4 Share what you learned

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Finish by sharing the best thing you learned with your family. Passing on someone's story is a kind of gift — and it makes the person you interviewed feel special.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Did you know Grandpa once had a dog who followed him to school every day?' Now the whole family knows a story that might have been lost. You saved it.

03 APPLY IT

Share the most interesting thing you learned with your family, told as a little story (using your Q1 storytelling skills!).

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to pass on someone's story? Did the person you interviewed enjoy being talked about?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your family what surprised them most about what you learned.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Encourage a family member to interview someone and share what *they* learn.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Real stories from real people are treasures a computer could never invent. Share this one proudly — it's genuinely yours to tell.

You'll need: Story-share card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ One thing learned was shared as a short story to the family.
- ☐ The child connected it back to the real person interviewed.

Unlocks after: Ask 'tell me more'

COMMUNICATE · Q3

Make Your Case

co-9-10-q3 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children often ask for things by whining, demanding, or repeating 'pleeease'. They're ready to learn something better: making a calm, clear case with real reasons. They can hold two or three reasons in mind and, with help, anticipate the grown-up's likely 'but'. Real stakes make this land — a later bedtime, a pet, a class idea. Having learned to listen in Q2, they now learn to be worth listening to.

WHAT “CREATING VALUE” MEANS HERE

Value here is being taken seriously — getting a fair hearing, and sometimes a yes, because you made a thoughtful case instead of a fuss. It's the discovery that good reasons, said calmly, are far more powerful than volume.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child argues for something they genuinely want, and finds that a calm, reasoned case gets them taken seriously in a way whining never does. The pull is real influence over their own life — being heard and treated like someone with sensible reasons. That taste of being taken seriously makes them want to do it well.

THE ARTIFACT

A real case the child made to a real person (a parent or teacher) for something they want, using two or three reasons and a response to the likely 'but'.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child gave two or three real reasons, not just 'because I want it'.
- They thought about the other person's likely worry and had a response.
- They made the case calmly and can say how it was received.

Unlocks after: Ask and Listen

1 A good reason beats a whine

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

Whining and demanding make people say no faster. A calm, clear reason makes them actually think about it. The secret to getting a fair hearing isn't being louder — it's being reasonable.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Can I stay up later, PLEEEASE?' gets a quick no. 'Could I stay up 15 minutes later on Fridays, since there's no school the next day?' gets a real 'hmm, let me think.' The reason changed everything.

03 APPLY IT

Think of one real thing you'd like to ask for. Write it as a calm request instead of a demand.

04 REFLECT

How do you usually ask for things — calmly or with a fuss? Which do you think works better?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Try your calm version on a parent (just the request, no reasons yet) and notice if they listen differently.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a sibling the difference between whining for something and asking calmly.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is about your real wish and your real family — you know the situation. Frame your own request; it means more coming from you.

You'll need: Calm-request card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A real want is framed as a calm request rather than a demand.

2 Give two or three reasons

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

'Because I want it' isn't a reason — it's a wish. Real reasons explain *why* it's a good idea, ideally good for others too, not just you. Two or three solid reasons make a case hard to wave away.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

For the later Friday bedtime: 1) no school next day, 2) I'll still get enough sleep, 3) we could use it as family film time. Three reasons — and one even helps the whole family.

03 APPLY IT

Write two or three real reasons for your request. Try to make at least one good for someone besides you.

04 REFLECT

Which of your reasons is strongest? Reasons that help others too are often the most convincing.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Test your reasons on someone neutral. Ask which reason they find most convincing.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend find a 'good for others too' reason for something they want.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Come up with your own reasons first — thinking of *why* is the real skill. If you ask AI, you must believe the reasons yourself, or they'll sound fake when you say them.

You'll need: Reasons worksheet (2–3 slots)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Two or three genuine reasons are written, ideally one benefiting others.

Unlocks after: A good reason beats a whine

3 Answer the 'but'

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

The person you're asking will have a worry — a 'but'. If you think of it first and have an answer ready, your case gets much stronger. It shows you've thought about their side, not just yours.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The 'but' for a later bedtime is 'but you'll be tired'. Your answer: 'I'll have a quiet wind-down and still wake up fine — we can try it one Friday and see.' You met their worry head-on.

03 APPLY IT

Guess the other person's biggest 'but'. Write it down, then write your calm answer to it.

04 REFLECT

Was it easy to guess their worry? Thinking about the other person's view is a real thinking skill (and it's kind).

05 GET FEEDBACK

Check your guessed 'but' with someone who knows the person. Did you guess their worry right?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone how guessing the 'but' makes a request stronger.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Guessing what a *specific real person* worries about needs your knowledge of them — you know your parent or teacher far better than any computer does.

You'll need: Answer-the-but card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The likely objection is anticipated and answered.

Unlocks after: Give two or three reasons

4 Make your case for real

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Now put it together and actually make your case: calm request, your reasons, your answer to the 'but'. Then — importantly — listen to the reply gracefully, even if it's not a full yes. A good case-maker is always respectful.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You make your case well and get 'let's try it for two Fridays and see'. That's a win! Even a 'not yet' often comes with a reason you can work with next time.

03 APPLY IT

Make your real case to the real person, calmly. Afterward, write down how it went and what they said.

04 REFLECT

How did making a calm, reasoned case feel compared to how you'd normally ask? What was the result?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Whatever the answer, ask the person: 'Did I make my case well?' Their feedback helps you next time.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone the story of your case — your reasons, the 'but', and how it went.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a real, calm conversation between you and a real person — no script can do it for you. Listening well to their reply is as important as your reasons.

You'll need: Case outcome card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The case was made calmly to a real person.
- ☐ The child listened to the response and can describe how it went.

Unlocks after: Answer the 'but'

COMMUNICATE · Q4

Invite and Present

co-9-10-q4 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Communicate becomes hosting. At 9–10 a child can invite people by making a case (Q3), tell the story of what they made (Q1), and talk with visitors by listening (Q2) — and now they pull all three together on a real day, in front of a real audience. Presenting to guests is a stretch but a thrilling one, and the whole year has built toward being able to do it.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is being a real host: getting people to come, and helping them understand and enjoy what you show. It's the year's communication skills made real — inviting, storytelling, and talking with guests all in one afternoon.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child hosts real guests at their Showcase Day, presenting what they made all year. A real audience — coming because they were invited well, then listening to the child's story — is deeply motivating. The child is briefly the star of their own event, which pulls out their best, bravest communicating.

THE ARTIFACT

Real invitations made for Showcase Day, plus a short 'welcome and tour' the child gives visitors on the day, telling the story of what they made this year.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child invited real guests with a genuine reason to come.
- They prepared and rehearsed a short spoken welcome/tour.
- On the day they presented to guests and answered questions by listening.

Unlocks after: Make Your Case, Plan the Showcase

1 Invite people well

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

An invitation is a little case: give people a real reason to come. Use your 'make your case' skill — tell them what they'll see and why it'll be fun, not just when and where.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Come to my Showcase Day! I'll show the inventions and digital story I made this year, and there's a stall with things I made — plus snacks!' That's an invite people actually want to say yes to.

03 APPLY IT

Make invitations for your guests. Include a real reason to come, plus the date and time from your plan.

04 REFLECT

Which part of your invite is most tempting? A good reason to come is what fills the room.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show an invite to a parent and ask if they'd want to come based on it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a sibling write an inviting invitation for something of theirs.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Invite your real people in your own warm words — a heartfelt invite from you beats a fancy one from a computer.

You'll need: Invitation template

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Real invitations with a reason to come were made and given out.

2 Prepare your story

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Guests will want to know about what you made. Use your storytelling skill: prepare a short beginning-middle-end story of your year — what you tried, what was tricky, what you're proud of.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'At the start of the year I could barely finish a project (beginning). I learned to break things into steps and fix real problems (middle). Now I've made all this — my favourite is my invention (end).' A real story of your year.

03 APPLY IT

Write a short beginning-middle-end story of your year's making to tell your guests.

04 REFLECT

What are you proudest of from this year? That belongs in the 'end' of your story.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell your year-story to a parent and ask if it's clear and interesting.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Ask a family member to tell *their* beginning-middle-end of something they learned this year.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is your real year and your real pride — only you can tell it truthfully. Use your own memories, not a made-up story.

You'll need: Year-story card (beginning/middle/end)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A short three-part story of the year is prepared.

Unlocks after: Invite people well

3 Practise your welcome

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Rehearse a short 'welcome and tour' — greet guests, tell your year-story, and point out what you made. Practising a few times means you'll feel calm and proud on the day instead of frozen.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Good hosts rehearse. 'Welcome! Let me show you around — here are my inventions, and this is the digital story I made…' Said a few times in practice, it flows easily on the day.

03 APPLY IT

Practise your welcome and tour out loud two or three times, using your best voice and expression (from Q1).

04 REFLECT

Where do you stumble? Those spots need one more practice — that's what rehearsing is for.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Do your welcome for a family member as a dress rehearsal. Ask what would make it warmer or clearer.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone why hosts rehearse, using your before/after.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Rehearsing your real voice for a real welcome is all you — a screen can't practise being a warm host for you.

You'll need: Welcome/tour script card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The welcome/tour was rehearsed until it flowed.

Unlocks after: Prepare your story

4 Host on the day

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

On Showcase Day, welcome your guests, tell your story, show your work — and when they ask questions, use your listening skill to really hear them and answer. You're the host now: everything this year has led here.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A guest asks 'how did you make the phone stand?' You listen, then tell them the story of that invention. That back-and-forth — presenting and listening — is you being a real host.

03 APPLY IT

On Showcase Day, give your welcome, tell your year-story, and answer at least three guest questions by listening carefully.

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to host? Which part were you proudest of? What surprised you?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Afterward, ask a guest what they enjoyed most about your welcome and tour.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone who missed it the story of hosting your Showcase Day.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Hosting real guests is a fully human moment — presenting, listening, answering, all live. This is the year's communication skills, all yours.

You'll need: Host-day question notes

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The child presented a welcome/tour to real guests.
- ☐ They answered guest questions by listening and responding.

Unlocks after: Practise your welcome

BUILD · Q1

Make Something Real

bu-9-10-q1 · supporting: Create

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children love making things with their hands and can follow a few simple steps, but they lose heart quickly if a project is too big or the first try looks messy. They don't need computers or code — they need the pure experience of turning an idea into a real object someone enjoys. Keep it finishable in one or two sittings so the pride of 'I made this' arrives before frustration does.

WHAT “CREATING VALUE” MEANS HERE

Value at this age is 'I made this real thing, and someone likes it or uses it.' The magic is watching an idea in your head become an actual object in your hands. Usefulness or joy to one real person matters far more than how polished it looks.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child makes one real thing — a card, a paper toy, a simple gadget, a decoration — and gives it to someone who genuinely enjoys it. The deep satisfaction of finishing something real with your own hands, plus a real person's delight, is the driver. Finishing is the reward; keep it small enough to finish.

THE ARTIFACT

One simple made thing (a craft, a paper build, a decoration, or a very simple digital drawing) that a real person uses or enjoys.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child finished a real thing, not just started one.
- They planned it before making it (even a quick sketch).
- A real person used or enjoyed it, and the child improved one thing after seeing them.

1 Pick something small to make

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

The trick to finishing is starting small. Pick one simple thing to make for one real person. Big dreams are exciting but small things actually get finished — and a finished thing beats a giant unfinished one.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'A birthday card for Grandma' will get made. 'A giant castle model' probably won't. Small and finished wins.

03 APPLY IT

Choose one small thing to make and one person to make it for. Say it out loud: 'I'll make a ___ for ___.'

04 REFLECT

Is your thing small enough to finish today or tomorrow? If not, what's a smaller version?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell an adult your plan and ask: 'Is that small enough to finish?' Listen to their honest answer.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a sibling pick one small thing to make instead of something too big.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You pick the thing and the person — a computer doesn't know who in your family would love a homemade gift. That's yours to decide.

You'll need: Make-it plan card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A small, finishable thing and a real recipient are chosen.

2 Plan it first

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Before you make, plan: draw what it'll look like and gather what you need. A quick plan means fewer 'oh no, I don't have glue' moments halfway through.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Builders draw a picture and lay out their tools before starting. Two minutes of planning saves a lot of stopping and starting.

03 APPLY IT

Draw a quick picture of your thing and list what you need to make it. Gather it all before you start.

04 REFLECT

Looking at your plan, is anything missing or too tricky? Better to spot it now than halfway through.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your plan to someone and ask if they see anything you forgot.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend why drawing a plan first makes making easier.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Draw your plan yourself — the plan is your idea taking shape, and doing it by hand helps you think it through.

You'll need: Plan-and-gather sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A simple plan drawing and a materials list exist, and materials are gathered.

Unlocks after: Pick something small to make

3 Make it and finish it

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Now make your thing, following your plan, all the way to finished. It won't be perfect — that's completely fine. Finished-and-a-bit-wonky beats perfect-and-unfinished every time.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The first thing anyone makes is a little rough. That's not failure, that's normal — every maker's first try looks like a first try.

03 APPLY IT

Make your thing from start to finish. If a bit goes wrong, keep going — you can fix it after.

04 REFLECT

What was trickier than you expected? That's the part you'll be better at next time.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your finished thing to an adult. Ask what they like about it before you point out the flaws.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone why 'finished but wonky' is better than 'perfect but never done'.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is hands-and-materials making — no screen. The wobbly bits are proof you made it yourself, and that's a good thing.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A real finished thing exists, completed by the child.

Unlocks after: Plan it first

4 Give it and make it better

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Give your thing to the person it's for and watch. What they enjoy, and any little thing that could be better, tells you how to improve — the first real lesson of every maker.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You give Grandma the card and notice her name is spelled wrong. Next card, you check the spelling first. The person using it shows you the fix.

03 APPLY IT

Give your thing to the real person. Watch their reaction, then improve one small thing (or note it for next time).

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to give something you made? What one thing would you do better next time?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask the person what they liked most and if there's anything they'd change. Take it kindly.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend give something they made and spot one improvement together.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

A real person's smile is the feedback that matters here — that's a human moment no device can give you.

You'll need: Improve-one-thing card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The thing was given to its real person.
- ☐ The child named or made one improvement based on the real reaction.

Unlocks after: Make it and finish it

BUILD · Q2

Fix a Real Problem

bu-9-10-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children can spot small annoyances and are thrilled by the idea of 'inventing' a fix, but they need the problem kept small and the materials kept simple (household bits, tape, cardboard). Having practised making a thing in Q1, they now aim it at a real problem — the first taste of building *to solve*, not just to make. Keep it finishable so the 'it actually works!' moment arrives.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is 'I made something that fixed a real annoying thing'. It's the leap from making for fun to making that's *useful* — an invention, however humble, that genuinely helps in daily life.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child becomes an inventor: they hunt down a real little annoyance at home and build a fix for it. The pull is the pride of solving a real problem with your own hands and hearing 'oh, that's clever, it actually helps!' Spotting a problem nobody bothered to fix, and fixing it, feels genuinely powerful at this age.

THE ARTIFACT

A simple hand-made solution to a real small problem at home (a cable tidy, a phone stand, a reminder chart, a door-stopper) that actually helps.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child identified a real, specific annoyance — not an invented one.
- They built a fix from simple materials and finished it.
- The fix was tried against the real problem and genuinely helped (or was improved until it did).

Unlocks after: Make Something Real

1 Hunt for an annoying problem

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Inventors don't start with an idea — they start with a problem. Look around your home for small annoying things: tangled cables, a door that won't stay open, a lost pencil. Annoyances are invention opportunities.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Someone got annoyed that their phone kept sliding off the table while playing music. That annoyance became the phone stand — a real invention born from a real irritation.

03 APPLY IT

Walk around your home and list three small annoying problems. Circle the one you'd most like to fix.

04 REFLECT

Is your circled problem small enough to fix with things you have at home? Keep it simple.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your family which of your three annoyances bugs *them* too. A shared annoyance is a great one to fix.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a sibling hunt for their own annoying-problem to fix.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The annoyances in *your* home are yours to spot — a computer can't walk around your house. This hunting is real-world detective work.

You'll need: Problem-hunt list (3 slots)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Three real home annoyances are listed and one chosen.

2 Think of a simple fix

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Now dream up a fix. It doesn't need to be fancy — the best fixes are usually simple. Sketch a couple of ideas and pick the one you could actually build with what you have.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

For the sliding phone: idea one, a blob of sticky putty; idea two, a folded cardboard stand. The cardboard one is cheap, simple, and buildable — perfect.

03 APPLY IT

Sketch two different fixes for your problem. Pick the simplest one you can build from stuff at home.

04 REFLECT

Why did you pick that fix over the other? Simple-and-buildable usually beats clever-but-hard.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your two ideas to an adult and ask which they'd try first, and why.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend come up with two fixes for their problem and choose one.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You could ask AI for fix ideas, but try your *own* ideas first — inventing the fix is the fun, brain-stretching part, and you might surprise yourself.

You'll need: Two-idea sketch sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Two fix ideas sketched, one chosen for being simple and buildable.

Unlocks after: Hunt for an annoying problem

3 Build your fix

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Time to build. Gather your materials and make your fix, following your sketch. First inventions are often rough and that's fine — you just need it to work, not to be beautiful.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The first cardboard phone stand might be a bit wobbly. Doesn't matter — if the phone stays up, it works. Wobbly-but-working is a real invention.

03 APPLY IT

Build your fix from start to finish. If a bit doesn't work, adjust and keep going.

04 REFLECT

What was trickier to build than you expected? That's where you learned the most.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your built fix to someone before testing it. Ask what they think might work or not.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone how you built your fix, step by step.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is real building with real materials — hands, not screens. The making is yours, wobbles and all.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A finished fix exists, built by the child from their chosen idea.

Unlocks after: Think of a simple fix

4 Does it actually help?

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

The real test: does your fix solve the real problem? Try it against the actual annoyance. If it helps — you're an inventor! If not quite, tweak it until it does. Real inventors improve until it works.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Put the phone on your stand and play music. Does it stay up now? If it tips, add a bit more support and try again. Testing against the real problem is how you know.

03 APPLY IT

Test your fix on the real problem. Does it help? If not fully, make one improvement and test again.

04 REFLECT

Did your fix work first time, or did it need a tweak? Most real inventions need at least one tweak.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your family if the annoying problem is better now. Their 'oh, that helps!' is your success.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone your working fix and how you tested it against the real problem.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The real test is the real problem in your real home — no simulation needed. Trust what actually happens when you try it.

You'll need: Test-and-improve card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The fix was tested against the real problem.
- [ ] It helped, or was improved until it did.

Unlocks after: Build your fix

BUILD · Q3

Make Something on a Screen

bu-9-10-q3 · supporting: Create

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, after two quarters of hands-on making, a first *digital* creation is exciting and doable with kid-friendly tools — a slideshow story, a digital comic, a simple animation. Keep it small and purposeful, and hold the same rule as always: understand what you make and stay the boss of the tool. This is the gentle on-ramp to the 'Build' skills that grow through the later years, introduced without drowning them in screens.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is the thrill of a new kind of making — 'I made a real thing on a screen, and it's mine.' The same pride as a hand-made object, now in a digital shape someone can view and enjoy.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child makes their first real digital creation and shows it to someone who enjoys it. The novelty of making on a screen, combined with the familiar pride of finishing something real, is highly motivating — and doing it with the 'I understand every part' rule means they feel like a maker, not just a button-presser.

THE ARTIFACT

One simple digital creation (a short slideshow story, a digital drawing or comic, or a simple animation) made with a kid-friendly tool and viewed by a real person.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child planned the digital thing before making it.
- They can explain what every part of it is and how they made it — nothing is a mystery button.
- A real person viewed it and the child improved one thing based on the reaction.

Unlocks after: Fix a Real Problem

1 You can make on a screen too

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

You've made things with your hands — now you can make things on a screen: a story slideshow, a comic, a little animation. It's the same idea (make a real thing someone enjoys), just with a digital tool instead of glue and cardboard.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A slideshow that tells the story of your weekend, with your own drawings or photos on each slide, is a real digital creation — and you can share it with family far away.

03 APPLY IT

Pick one small digital thing to make and who it's for. Say it: 'I'll make a ___ for ___.'

04 REFLECT

Is your digital idea small enough to finish? Same rule as hand-making: small and finished beats big and abandoned.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell an adult your idea and ask them to help pick a simple, safe kid-friendly tool for it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to a sibling that making on a screen follows the same steps as making by hand.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

A grown-up should help you choose a safe tool. And remember: the *idea* is yours — the tool just helps you make it. You're the maker, not the tool.

You'll need: Digital project brief card · List of kid-safe creation tools

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A small digital creation and its audience are chosen.

2 Plan it first (yes, still!)

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Making on a screen doesn't skip the planning. Sketch your slides or scenes on paper first — what's on each one, in what order. A paper plan makes the screen part quick and calm instead of confusing.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Before touching the computer, comic-makers draw tiny boxes on paper showing each scene. Then the digital part is just 'copy my plan onto the screen' — much easier.

03 APPLY IT

Sketch your digital thing on paper — each slide, scene, or part, in order.

04 REFLECT

Did planning on paper first make the idea clearer? It almost always does.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your paper plan to someone and check the order makes sense before you build.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend why planning on paper first makes screen-making easier.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Plan with your own hands on paper — this is your thinking. Doing it yourself keeps you the boss of the whole project.

You'll need: Storyboard/plan sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A paper plan of the digital creation exists, in order.

Unlocks after: You can make on a screen too

3 Make it — and understand every part

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Now build your digital thing from your plan. The golden rule: understand every part you add. If a tool (or AI) makes something for you, make sure you know what it is and could explain it — otherwise it's not really yours.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

If you use a tool to add a picture, you should be able to say 'I chose that picture and put it there because…' If you can't explain a part, you're not the maker of it yet.

03 APPLY IT

Make your digital creation from your plan. For each part, be ready to say what it is and why it's there.

04 REFLECT

Is there any part you can't explain? If so, learn it or change it — a maker understands their own work.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show a parent the thing as you build and have them point to any 'mystery part' you can't explain. Go understand it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk someone through your digital creation, explaining each part in your own words.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

If AI helps you make a part (like a picture), you must still understand and choose it — **never keep a part you can't explain.** A maker who can't explain their work is just copying; you're better than that.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A finished digital creation exists.
- ☐ The child can explain every part in their own words.

Unlocks after: Plan it first (yes, still!)

4 Show it and make it better

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Show your creation to a real viewer and watch how they react. Where they smile, where they look confused — that tells you what to keep and what to fix. Then improve one thing. Same as hand-making: real viewers make your work better.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You show your slideshow story and your viewer looks lost on slide 3. That's your fix — maybe slide 3 needs to be clearer or split in two.

03 APPLY IT

Show your creation to a real person, stay quiet, and note where they react or get confused. Improve the most confusing part.

04 REFLECT

Was the confusing part one you were proud of? Making for a viewer is different from making for yourself.

05 GET FEEDBACK

After improving, show it again. Did the fix work?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach someone the 'show it, watch quietly, fix what confused them' rule for digital things too.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

A real human viewer's reaction is the best feedback — a screen can't be delighted or confused the way a person can. Trust the real reaction.

You'll need: Viewer-reaction card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real person viewed the creation.
- ☐ One improvement was made from real reaction and re-checked.

Unlocks after: Make it — and understand every part

BUILD · Q4

Make the Showcase Things

bu-9-10-q4 · supporting: Create, Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Build supplies what the day shows and sells. At 9–10 a child can make a small batch of things and a sign, pulling together hand-making (Q1), problem-solving (Q2), and their first digital creation (Q3). Keep the batch small — a few good items plus one digital piece — so 'finished and good' beats 'lots and rushed', the lesson they've heard all year.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is having real things to show and sell — the maker's contribution to the day. It's every making skill from the year, aimed at one real event: a small collection the child is proud to put on a table in front of guests.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child produces the actual stuff of their Showcase Day — things people will look at, pick up, and buy. Knowing real guests will see and judge the work raises the bar in a good way, and the pride of a table full of things you made yourself is a powerful finish to the year of building.

THE ARTIFACT

A small set of things for Showcase Day: a few physical items to show or sell, plus at least one digital piece (a sign, poster, or slideshow made on a screen).

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child made a small batch of good-quality physical things (not many rushed ones).
- They made at least one digital piece and can explain every part of it.
- The display was set up and tested, with one thing fixed after testing.

Unlocks after: Make Something on a Screen, Plan the Showcase

1 What to make for the day

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

Decide your small batch: a few items to show or sell, plus one digital piece like a sign. Remember the year's rule — a few good things beat a pile of rushed ones. Choose what you can make really well in the time you have.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Your batch might be: six good bookmarks to sell, your phone-stand invention to show, and a digital price sign made on screen. Small, doable, and proud-making.

03 APPLY IT

List your small batch: the physical things and the one digital piece you'll make for the day.

04 REFLECT

Is your batch small enough to make *well* in the time before the day? Quality over quantity, as always.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your batch plan to a parent and check it fits the time in your step ladder.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to a sibling why a small batch of good things beats lots of rushed ones.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You decide what to make from your year's skills — that's yours. Keep it to what you can genuinely do well.

You'll need: Batch plan card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A small, realistic batch (physical + one digital) is planned.

2 Make the physical things

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Make your batch of physical items using everything you've learned about hand-making — plan, gather, make well, finish. These are going in front of guests, so make each one something you'd be proud to sell.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Making six bookmarks: you plan the design, gather materials, and make each one carefully. They don't have to be identical — but each should be good enough that you'd happily hand it over.

03 APPLY IT

Make your batch of physical things, finishing each to a quality you're proud of.

04 REFLECT

Would you pay for these yourself? If not, which needs improving before the day?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your finished items to an honest family member and ask which is best and which needs work.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone your batch and explain how you kept the quality up.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Hand-making is yours — the care in each item is what makes guests want them. No shortcut replaces good making.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A small batch of good-quality physical items is finished.

Unlocks after: What to make for the day

3 Make the digital sign

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Make your digital piece — a sign, price list, or slideshow — using your screen-making skill. Keep the golden rule: understand every part. A neat digital sign makes your stall look real and welcoming.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A digital sign reading 'Aisha's Handmade Bookmarks — RM2 each' with a little drawing, made on screen and printed out, makes the whole stall look proper.

03 APPLY IT

Make your digital sign or slideshow from a quick plan. Be ready to explain every part of it.

04 REFLECT

Can you explain every part of your digital piece? If any bit is a mystery, learn it or change it.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your digital piece to a parent and have them check it's clear and readable from a distance.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk someone through how you made your digital sign, part by part.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

If AI helped with an image or layout, you must still understand and have chosen it — **never show a part you can't explain.** The sign is yours because you understand it.

You'll need: List of kid-safe creation tools

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A digital piece is finished and the child can explain every part.

Unlocks after: Make the physical things

4 Set it up and test

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Before the day, set up your display exactly as it'll be — items laid out, sign up. Then test it like a guest would see it, and fix the one thing that looks off. A tested setup means a calm, proud day.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You lay out your stall the night before and notice the sign is hard to read from where guests will stand. You move it higher — problem fixed before anyone arrives.

03 APPLY IT

Set up your full display and look at it as a guest would. Fix the one thing that most needs it.

04 REFLECT

What looked different once it was all set up? Seeing it as a guest often reveals a quick fix.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Have a family member look at your setup as a 'pretend guest' and say what catches their eye or confuses them.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach someone why testing the setup beforehand makes the real day go smoothly.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Seeing your real display in your real space is something only you can do — trust your own eyes and a family member's.

You'll need: Setup checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The full display was set up and tested from a guest's view.
- [ ] One improvement was made before the day.

Unlocks after: Make the digital sign

CREATE WEALTH · Q1

Make and Share

cw-9-10-q1 · supporting: Build, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, money is barely abstract and profit means little — but the idea that you can make something real that another person genuinely *wants* is powerful and graspable. A 'mini-business' at this age is very simple: handmade cards, a helper coupon, a small treat. The reward isn't earnings; it's the discovery that making something good and offering it can lead to a real 'yes, please' or 'thank you'. Keep any money tiny and the loop short.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here means a real person *chooses* to have the thing you made — a genuine 'yes' or a delighted 'thank you', not just a grown-up being kind. It's the very first taste of creating something others actually want, which is the seed of every business.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child makes something small and real, then offers it to a real person and finds out if they truly want it. Even without money, a real person choosing your thing feels different from pretend play — it's a small, safe, genuine stake. Landing that first honest 'yes' is a memorable milestone that makes them want to make the next thing.

THE ARTIFACT

One small thing made and offered to a real person, with the honest response recorded (a genuine yes/thank-you, or a no with its reason).

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child made something real to offer.
- They offered it to a real person outside their own household or immediate family.
- They can say, in the person's own words, why the answer was yes or no.

1 What would make someone happy?

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

To make something people want, first notice what would make a real person happy. Watch and listen — what does someone near you enjoy, need, or wish for?

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A girl noticed her neighbour loved her garden but had no plant labels. Little painted labels were a perfect gift — because she spotted what would make *that* person happy.

03 APPLY IT

Think of one real person and write down two things that might make them happy that you could make or do. Pick one.

04 REFLECT

Did you pick something *they'd* like, or something *you'd* like to make? The best pick is a bit of both.

05 GET FEEDBACK

If you can, gently ask that person (or someone who knows them) what they enjoy. Adjust your idea.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a sibling think of something that would make a specific family member happy.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

A computer can't see who's around you or what they'd love. This noticing is yours — it's the real skill.

You'll need: Who-would-love-this card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] One idea is chosen based on what a real, specific person would want.

2 Make one good one

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Make *one* really good version, not lots of rushed ones. A good thing earns a real 'yes'. A sloppy thing, however many you make, earns polite nos.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

One beautifully painted plant label makes the neighbour say 'oh, I'd love some!' Ten smudged ones don't. Quality does the asking for you.

03 APPLY IT

Make one really good version of your thing. Take your time and make it something you'd be proud to give.

04 REFLECT

Would you be happy to receive this yourself? If not, what would make it better?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your one good version to someone honest and improve it once based on what they say.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to a friend why one good one beats ten rushed ones.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The making is yours to do well. If it's something on a screen, you should still understand and control how it's made — don't hand the whole job to a computer.

You'll need: Proud-to-give checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] One good version exists, improved once after honest feedback.

Unlocks after: What would make someone happy?

3 Offer it for real

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

The big moment: actually offer your thing to a real person and ask if they'd like it. Whether it's a gift or a small trade, a real person really choosing is what makes it count.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The girl knocked on the neighbour's door: 'I made these plant labels — would you like some?' The neighbour's happy 'yes please!' was the whole reward.

03 APPLY IT

Offer your thing to a real person (beyond your own home). Ask kindly if they'd like it. Notice their honest reaction.

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to offer something you made? A little nervous? That nervous-brave feeling is part of it.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Notice exactly what they said and did. Write it down — those real words are gold.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell a family member about your offer and how you asked, so they could try it too.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

No device can make the offer for you — the little bit of bravery in asking a real person is exactly what you're practising.

You'll need: Offer record card (who / their reaction)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The thing was genuinely offered to a real person and their reaction noted.

Unlocks after: Make one good one

4 What happened?

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Look at what happened. A 'yes' or 'thank you' means you made something wanted — brilliant. A 'no' isn't bad; it usually comes with a reason that helps you make something even better next time.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

If someone says 'no thanks, I don't have plants', that's not a fail — it tells you to offer plant labels to gardeners next time. The no taught you who to ask.

03 APPLY IT

Write down what happened and why. If it was a yes, what made them happy? If a no, what was their reason?

04 REFLECT

What's the one thing you learned that would make your next 'make and share' go better?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Talk it over with a parent: what would you make, or who would you offer to, next time?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone the story of your make-and-share and the one thing it taught you.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Afterward, if you're puzzling over a 'no', you could talk it through with an adult or even AI — but the real lesson came from the real person, and that's what counts most.

You'll need: What-I-learned card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The outcome and its reason are recorded in the person's own words.
- [ ] The child named one thing to do differently next time.

Unlocks after: Offer it for real

CREATE WEALTH · Q2

Save, Spend, Share

cw-9-10-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, money is becoming a bit more real, and children can genuinely grasp the three-jar idea — some to save, some to spend, some to share — if it's concrete and the amounts are tiny. Waiting (delayed gratification) is hard at this age, so a saving goal must be short-term and visible. Having made and offered something in Q1, they now meet the natural next question: what do you do with what you get?

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is feeling genuinely in charge of your own small money — making a plan on purpose instead of spending it all the moment you get it. The reward is the grown-up feeling of having decided, and watching a small saving goal actually get closer.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child is trusted to manage a small, real amount of their own money and make real choices about it. Being in charge — genuinely deciding save vs spend vs share, and watching a goal jar fill — is deeply motivating at this age. The trust itself is the driver; nobody has to force a plan when the money and the choice are really theirs.

THE ARTIFACT

A three-jar (save / spend / share) plan for a small real amount of money, with a chosen saving goal and at least one real money choice recorded.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child split a small real amount into save, spend, and share.
- They chose a real short-term saving goal and can name it.
- They can explain one money choice they made and why.

Unlocks after: Make and Share

1 Money can do three jobs

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Money isn't just for spending right now. It can do three jobs: **save** (keep for something bigger later), **spend** (enjoy now), and **share** (give to help someone). Smart money people use all three.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Get RM6? You might put RM2 to save, RM2 to spend, RM2 to share. Three little jars, three jobs — and you decide how much goes where.

03 APPLY IT

Set up three jars (or cups) labelled Save, Spend, Share. They're ready for your money.

04 REFLECT

Which jar do you think will be hardest to put money in? For most people it's Save — because waiting is hard.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your three jars to a parent and talk about what each one is for.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain the three jobs of money to a younger child using the jars.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is about your real money and real jars you can touch — much more powerful than anything on a screen. Set them up for real.

You’ll need: Three jar labels (Save / Spend / Share)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Three labelled jars are set up.

2 Pick a save goal

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

Saving is much easier when you're saving *for* something. Pick one thing you really want that costs a bit more than you have now. That's your goal — the reason the Save jar is worth it.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Wanting a RM15 toy when you get RM3 a week means saving over a few weeks. But now every coin in the Save jar is exciting, because it's getting you closer.

03 APPLY IT

Choose one real thing you want to save for. Write it on your Save jar and how much it costs.

04 REFLECT

Is your goal something you'll still want in a few weeks? Good saving goals are things you really care about.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell a parent your save goal and check it's a realistic thing to save for.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a sibling pick a save goal worth waiting for.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Your goal is about what *you* really want — that's yours alone to choose. No computer knows what would make you happy.

You'll need: Save-goal label

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real, specific saving goal is chosen and its cost noted.

Unlocks after: Money can do three jobs

3 Choose on purpose

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

When you get some money, decide *on purpose* how to split it across your three jars — instead of spending it all at once. This is you being the boss of your money, not the other way round.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You get RM6. You *could* spend it all on sweets. Or you choose: RM3 to save for the toy, RM2 to spend now, RM1 to share. That's a plan you made, not an accident.

03 APPLY IT

Take a small real amount of money and split it across your three jars on purpose. Write down how you split it.

04 REFLECT

Was it tempting to put it all in Spend? How did it feel to save some on purpose?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show a parent your split and explain why you chose it. Ask what they think.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone how you split your money on purpose across the three jars.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This choice is yours to make — being the boss of your own money is the whole point, and that can't be handed to a computer.

You'll need: Money-split record card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A real amount was split across the three jars with the split recorded.

Unlocks after: Pick a save goal

4 Watch it grow

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

Keep adding to your Save jar and watch it get closer to your goal. Seeing it grow — and finally reaching the goal — teaches the best money lesson of all: waiting a little can get you something better.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Week by week the Save jar fills. The day it finally holds enough for the toy feels amazing — better than spending it on small stuff would have. That feeling is the reward for patience.

03 APPLY IT

Track your Save jar over the next few weeks. Mark how close you are to your goal each week.

04 REFLECT

How does it feel to watch your savings grow toward something you want? Was the waiting worth it?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show a parent your progress tracker. Celebrate together when you hit the goal.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone the story of saving up and reaching your goal — and how waiting paid off.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Watching real coins fill a real jar toward a real goal is the lesson here — no app needed. The patience is yours to build.

You'll need: Save-goal progress tracker

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The child tracked their savings toward the goal over time.
- ☐ They can explain what saving on purpose taught them.

Unlocks after: Choose on purpose

CREATE WEALTH · Q3

A Little Business

cw-9-10-q3 · supporting: Communicate, Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children can make a simple offer to a few real people and keep a simple tally, though real profit and complex pricing are still beyond them. The leap this quarter is doing it *more than once* and *keeping track* — discovering that repeating and counting teaches you what works. Keep money tiny and the whole thing playful. This sets up the year-end capstone where several skills come together.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is making something a few real people genuinely want, and using a simple tally to see what worked. It's the first real 'little business' — not about getting rich, but about the loop of offer, count, learn, improve.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child runs a tiny real business — a few offers to a few real people — and keeps score. Real people choosing (or not), and a tally that visibly adds up, makes it feel like a genuine venture rather than pretend. Watching the count grow and spotting what people liked is motivating in the same way keeping score in a game is.

THE ARTIFACT

A small repeated offer made to at least three real people, with a simple tally of yeses/nos and what was made or earned, plus one noticed pattern about what people liked.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child offered the same thing to at least three real people.
- They kept a simple written tally of the results.
- They can name one thing people liked or one thing they'd change, based on the tally.

Unlocks after: Save, Spend, Share

1 Do it more than once

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

In Q1 you made one offer. A little business means doing it a few times with a few people. Repeating is where you start to learn — one yes could be luck, but three tries shows you a real pattern.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Selling bookmarks to one aunt tells you little. Offering them to three neighbours tells you if people actually want bookmarks — or if you should make something else.

03 APPLY IT

Pick something simple to offer (make it, or a small service) and list three real people you could offer it to.

04 REFLECT

Why is trying three people better than trying one? What might three answers show you that one can't?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Run your idea past a parent and check your three people are ones you can safely reach.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to a sibling why doing a thing three times teaches more than doing it once.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The real people you'll offer to are from your own life — a computer can't pick them. That's yours to plan.

You'll need: Little-business plan card (offer + 3 people)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] An offer and three real people to approach are chosen.

2 Keep a simple tally

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

A little business keeps score. Make a simple tally: who you asked, yes or no, and what you made or earned. The tally turns your business from guessing into knowing.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A tally might read: Aunt — yes — RM2; Neighbour — no; Friend — yes — RM2. Now you can *see* it worked twice out of three, and earned RM4. Real numbers, not vibes.

03 APPLY IT

Make a tally sheet with columns: who, yes/no, what I made. Get it ready before you start offering.

04 REFLECT

Why write it down instead of just remembering? What might you forget without a tally?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your blank tally to an adult and check it's clear and easy to fill in.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend how a simple tally helps a little business keep score.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Keep your tally by hand — writing down your own real results helps you understand them. This is your score to keep.

You'll need: Tally sheet (who / yes-no / earned)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A clear tally sheet is ready to use.

Unlocks after: Do it more than once

3 Run it and notice what people liked

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Now make your offers and fill in your tally. As you go, notice *why* people said yes or no — 'she liked the colour', 'he didn't need one'. Those little reasons are the most valuable part of the tally.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You notice both yeses loved the sparkly bookmarks but nobody wanted the plain ones. That's gold — it tells you exactly what to make more of.

03 APPLY IT

Make your three offers, fill in your tally, and jot the reason next to each yes or no.

04 REFLECT

Do you see a pattern in the reasons? Patterns are the business telling you what to do next.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Share your filled tally with a parent and talk about what the reasons show.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone one pattern you spotted in why people said yes or no.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The reasons come from real people you spoke to — no computer could tell you why *your* neighbour said yes. That listening is the valuable skill.

You'll need: Filled tally with reasons

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ At least three real offers were made and tallied with reasons.
- ☐ The child spotted at least one pattern.

Unlocks after: Keep a simple tally

4 Do one thing better

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

The point of a tally is to improve. Look at your pattern and pick one thing to do better next time — make more of what people liked, change what they didn't. That's how a little business grows.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Your tally says sparkly sells, plain doesn't. Next time: make mostly sparkly ones. One clear improvement, straight from your own numbers.

03 APPLY IT

Based on your tally, write down the one thing you'll do better next time and why.

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to change your plan based on real results instead of guessing? That's what real businesses do.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell a parent or mentor your improvement idea and why your tally points to it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach someone the loop: offer, tally, spot the pattern, do one thing better.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Your improvement comes from your own real results — that's the honest way to get better. Trust your tally over any guess.

You'll need: Do-better card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ One specific improvement is chosen, justified by the tally.
- ☐ The child can explain the offer-tally-improve loop.

Unlocks after: Run it and notice what people liked

CREATE WEALTH · Q4

Run Your Stall

cw-9-10-q4 · supporting: Communicate, Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Wealth is the live stall on Showcase Day. At 9–10 a child can set simple prices, offer to real visitors (Q1), keep a tally (Q3), and then save/spend/share what they earn (Q2) — the whole year's money and value skills in one real event. This is also the final project of the year, so it closes with a reflection on how far they've come.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is running a real little stall, earning a little real money, and deciding what to do with it. It's every wealth skill from the year — make, offer, price, tally, manage — brought to life in front of real customers, for real.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child runs a genuine stall with real customers and real (small) money on a real day. The stakes are exciting and safe: actual guests deciding to buy, an actual tally climbing, actual earnings to manage afterward. Nothing motivates the year's wealth lessons like a real till at the end of a real event.

THE ARTIFACT

A stall run on Showcase Day with a tally of sales, followed by a save/spend/share plan for the earnings — plus a short reflection on the whole year.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child set simple prices and ran a stall for real guests.
- They kept a tally of what sold and what they earned.
- They made a save/spend/share plan for the earnings and can reflect on their year.

Unlocks after: A Little Business, Plan the Showcase

1 Set your prices and offers

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

Decide what you'll sell and for how much, using your little-business skills. Keep prices simple and fair — a price is you saying what your thing is worth. Have your digital sign show the prices clearly.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Bookmarks RM2, or 3 for RM5.' Simple, clear, and the '3 for RM5' gives people a reason to buy more. Fair prices that a guest can understand in a second.

03 APPLY IT

Set a simple price for each thing you're selling. Write them on your sign.

04 REFLECT

Are your prices fair — not too cheap, not too dear? Think back to what you learned about pricing this year.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your prices to a parent and check they feel fair for what you made.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why a clear, fair price helps a stall sell.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Your prices depend on your effort and your real guests — you decide them. A computer's guess matters less than what feels fair to you.

You'll need: Price-setting card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Simple, fair prices are set and shown on the sign.

2 Run the stall

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

On the day, run your stall: greet guests warmly, tell them about your things, and make your offers. Use your listening skill — a friendly stall-holder who listens sells more than a pushy one.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Hi! These are bookmarks I made — this sparkly one's my favourite. Would you like one?' Friendly, honest, and you listen to what they say. That's how a real stall feels.

03 APPLY IT

Run your stall on Showcase Day. Greet each guest, offer your things kindly, and make some real sales.

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to sell to real guests? Easier or harder than you expected?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Notice which of your offers guests responded to best. That's real-time learning.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone the story of a sale you made and how you made it.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Running a real stall with real guests is fully human — warmth, listening, offering. No screen does this for you; it's your moment.

You'll need: Money box / float

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The stall was run for real guests with real offers made.

Unlocks after: Set your prices and offers

3 Keep the tally

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

As you sell, keep your tally — what sold, and what you earned. At the end, add it up. Your tally tells the true story of the day: what people wanted and how you did.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

End-of-day tally: 5 bookmarks sold, RM11 earned, and the sparkly ones went first. Real numbers that show you exactly what worked.

03 APPLY IT

Keep your tally through the stall, then add up your total earnings at the end.

04 REFLECT

What does your tally show about what guests liked most? Same lesson as your little business — the tally teaches.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your final tally to a parent and talk about what sold best and why.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone your tally and what it tells you about the day.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Keeping and adding your own tally helps you understand your own day — do the counting yourself.

You'll need: Sales tally sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A tally of sales and total earnings was kept and totted up.

Unlocks after: Run the stall

4 Save, spend, share — and look back

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Now use your three-jar skill on real earnings: decide how much to save, spend, and share, on purpose. Then look back on your whole year — everything you learned to get to this day. That's a lot to be proud of.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You earned RM11: maybe RM5 to save, RM4 to spend, RM2 to share. And you look back — a year ago you couldn't finish a project; today you planned and ran a whole showcase. That's real growth.

03 APPLY IT

Split your earnings into save/spend/share on purpose. Then write or tell one thing you're proudest of learning this year.

04 REFLECT

Looking across the whole year — noticing, making, telling stories, running a stall — what changed most about what you can do?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Sit with a parent and share your save/spend/share plan and your proudest moment of the year.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell a family member the story of your whole year of learning, ending with Showcase Day.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

How you split real earnings and what you're proud of are deeply yours. This is your year — own it, in your own words.

You'll need: Earnings save/spend/share card · Year-reflection card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Earnings were split across save/spend/share on purpose.
- [ ] The child reflected on their growth across the whole year.

Unlocks after: Keep the tally

Ages 11-12

THINK · Q1

The Question Detective

th-11-12-q1 · supporting: Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, thinking is mostly concrete but early abstract reasoning is appearing: a child can separate 'what I know' from 'what I'm guessing' if you give them the handle to do it. Fairness and rules feel enormous at this age, and they love catching an adult being wrong — that instinct is exactly the engine of good reasoning. Attention runs in shorter bursts than a teenager's, so loops must be quick and produce a visible result the same day.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age 'value' isn't money — it's being *trusted to figure something out*. Cracking a real question by yourself, and being able to show how you did it, is the reward. The audience is usually people they know (family, a friend, a teacher), and the win is 'you were right, and you can prove it'.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child picks a real question they personally want answered — is the '5-second rule' real, does our dog actually understand words, is the shortcut to school really faster — and gets to be the detective who settles it. The pull is the satisfaction of cracking it themselves plus the small thrill of proving something the grown-ups only assumed. No one has to make it fun; a genuine unanswered question they chose does that.

THE ARTIFACT

An 'investigation board' (paper or a simple slide) that states one real question, separates what was known / assumed / checked, shows the evidence gathered, and gives a verdict with the reasoning visible.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child can point to the difference between a fact, a guess, and an opinion on their board.
- They gathered at least one piece of real evidence themselves rather than just looking up an answer.
- They can explain, out loud, why their verdict follows from their evidence.

1 Fact, guess, or opinion?

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Three different things get said in the same confident voice: a **fact** (checkably true), a **guess** (might be true, not checked yet), and an **opinion** (how someone feels). Smart thinking starts with telling them apart.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'It rained here yesterday' is a fact you can check. 'It'll rain tomorrow' is a guess. 'Rainy days are the best' is an opinion. Same tone of voice — very different things.

03 APPLY IT

Grab five statements from a cereal box, an advert, or a family conversation. Label each one fact, guess, or opinion. The tricky ones are the point.

04 REFLECT

Which was hardest to label? Sneaky statements often dress an opinion up as a fact — did you catch any?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your five labels to a parent or friend. Where you two disagree, talk out why — the disagreement usually reveals the sneaky one.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach a younger child the three types using their own toys or snacks as examples. If they can label three new statements right, you nailed the teaching.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a *no-AI* lesson on purpose. The skill is your own ear catching the difference — outsourcing that to a chatbot defeats it. Later, once you can label reliably, AI can be a sparring partner to check yourself.

You'll need: Fact/Guess/Opinion sorting sheet (5 rows)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Five statements are labelled with at least one 'sneaky' one identified.

2 A question you can actually answer

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Big questions like 'are dogs smart?' can't be settled. Good detectives shrink a big question into a small, checkable one — 'does my dog come to the word *walk* even when I say it flat, with no excited voice?'

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Is the school shortcut faster?' is too vague. 'Is the alley route faster than the main road when I walk normally?' can be timed and settled this week.

03 APPLY IT

Take your big curious question and rewrite it as one small question you could actually check in a few days. Write both versions so you can see the shrink.

04 REFLECT

Did shrinking the question change what you'd need to look at? Smaller questions usually point straight at the evidence you need.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask an adult: 'If I checked this, would it really answer my big question?' Adjust if they poke a hole.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend shrink one of *their* big questions into a checkable one.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Fine to ask AI 'help me make this question more specific' — it's good at that. But you decide if the smaller question still matches what you actually wanted to know; the model can't feel your curiosity for you.

You'll need: Big-question / small-question worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ One checkable small question is written that clearly connects to the bigger curiosity.

Unlocks after: Fact, guess, or opinion?

3 Go get the evidence

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Evidence is proof you gather *yourself*: a measurement, a count, a test, a careful look. Looking up someone else's answer isn't evidence — it's borrowing a verdict.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

To test the alley shortcut, you don't Google it — you walk both routes with a timer, three times each, and write down the numbers. Now you *have* proof.

03 APPLY IT

Run your check at least three times and write down what happened each time. Three tries, because one could be a fluke.

04 REFLECT

Did every try give the same result? If not, what might explain the difference — and does it change your answer?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your raw results to someone and ask: 'Would you believe this? Is three tries enough?' Note their answer.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why doing the test three times beats doing it once.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Do NOT ask AI for the answer to your question — that skips the whole job. AI can help you *design* a fair test ('how do I make this timing fair?'), but the evidence has to come from you doing it.

You'll need: Evidence log (3+ rows for repeated tries)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] At least three real observations were gathered and recorded by the child.

Unlocks after: A question you can actually answer

4 Show your verdict — and your working

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

A detective doesn't just announce 'guilty'. They walk you through the clues so you can see it too. Your verdict is only as strong as the reasoning you can show.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'The alley is faster — here are my six times, the alley averaged 4 minutes, the main road 6. That's my proof.' Anyone can now check your thinking, not just trust your word.

03 APPLY IT

Finish your investigation board: the question, what you knew vs assumed, your evidence, and the verdict with the reasoning laid out.

04 REFLECT

If someone disagreed with your verdict, which part of your board would they attack? Is that part solid?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present the board to two people. Ask each to try to poke a hole. Fix the weakest spot they find.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk a family member through your whole investigation as if teaching them to be a detective — question, evidence, verdict.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you tidy how the board *reads*, but the reasoning must be yours and you must be able to defend every step without it. If you can't explain a line on your board yourself, take it off.

You'll need: Investigation board template (question / known / assumed / evidence / verdict)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A completed board shows the reasoning, not just the answer.
- ☐ The child defended their verdict against at least one challenge.

Unlocks after: Go get the evidence

THINK · Q2

Don't Get Fooled

th-11-12-q2 · supporting: Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children are increasingly online and surrounded by ads, headlines, and confident claims — but they tend to believe things that look official or that they *want* to be true. They're now ready for the crucial next step beyond Q1's 'investigate your own question': evaluating claims that other people are pushing at them, and asking 'who's telling me this, and why?'. This is real, immediately useful, and slightly thrilling — nobody likes being fooled.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is not being anyone's fool — seeing through a misleading ad, a clickbait headline, or a too-good-to-be-true claim, and knowing how to check before believing. It's the beginning of thinking for yourself instead of swallowing whatever you're told.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child learns to think for themselves rather than be told what to believe — and at this age, being 'nobody's fool', the one who spots the trick, feels genuinely powerful and a little cool. Catching a real ad or headline trying to manipulate them turns critical thinking into a satisfying game of not-getting-caught.

THE ARTIFACT

A 'fool-proofing' breakdown of three real claims, ads, or headlines the child found, each showing the trick being used and how they checked whether it was true.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- For each claim, the child identified who was saying it and what they wanted.
- They named the specific trick or missing information in each.
- They checked at least one claim against another source before deciding.

Unlocks after: The Question Detective

1 Who's telling you, and why?

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Before believing a claim, ask two questions: who is saying it, and what do they want? An ad wants your money. A headline wants your click. Knowing the motive behind a message tells you how carefully to check it.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Dentists recommend this toothpaste!' — but the ad was paid for by the toothpaste company. Who's telling you (the seller) and why (to sell) changes how much you should trust it.

03 APPLY IT

Find three real claims (ads, headlines, posts). For each, write who's saying it and what you think they want.

04 REFLECT

Did knowing the 'why' change how much you believed any of them? Motive is a big clue.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your three to a parent and compare your guesses about who benefits.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend how to ask 'who's telling me and why?' about an ad they've seen.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can also have a 'why' — it's trained to sound confident even when unsure. Ask 'who/why' about AI answers too, and never treat a confident tone as proof.

You'll need: Who/why breakdown sheet (3 claims)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Three real claims are analysed for source and motive.

2 Spot the common tricks

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Misleading messages use a few tricks over and over: exaggeration ('the BEST ever!'), fake urgency ('only 2 left!'), missing information (leaving out the bad bits), and cherry-picking (showing only the numbers that help them). Once you know the tricks, you see them everywhere.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'9 out of 10 people loved it!' sounds great — until you ask how many people they asked. If it was 10 friends of the seller, the number means nothing. That's cherry-picking plus missing information.

03 APPLY IT

Look at your three claims again and name the trick each one uses (or admit if one seems honest).

04 REFLECT

Which trick fools you most easily? Knowing your own weak spot helps you guard it.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask a parent if they can spot a trick you missed in your three claims.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach someone the four common tricks with an example of each.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you name the tricks in an ad — a fair use. But spotting them yourself first builds the instinct that protects you when no AI is around.

You’ll need: Trick-spotting reference card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Each claim's trick (or honesty) is identified.

Unlocks after: Who's telling you, and why?

3 Check before you believe

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

The real defence is checking. Cross-check a claim against a different, independent source — one that doesn't benefit from it. If you can't find the claim anywhere trustworthy, that's a red flag.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A post says a certain food is 'poison'. You check a couple of reliable health sources — none agree. The claim doesn't survive the check, so you don't spread it.

03 APPLY IT

Pick your most doubtful claim and check it against at least one independent source. Write what you found.

04 REFLECT

Was the claim true, false, or somewhere in between? How hard was it to find a trustworthy check?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your checking to an adult and ask if your source was a good, independent one.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone how to cross-check a surprising claim before believing it.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can point you toward sources, but it sometimes makes things up ('hallucinates'). Always confirm with a real, findable source — don't let a confident AI answer be your only check.

You'll need: Cross-check worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ At least one claim was cross-checked against an independent source.

Unlocks after: Spot the common tricks

4 Share what you found

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Put it together: present your three claims, the tricks they used, and what your checking revealed. Teaching others to spot tricks is how you protect your friends and family too — being fool-proof is more useful when it spreads.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You show your family: 'This ad exaggerates, this headline uses fake urgency, and this so-called fact turned out to be false when I checked.' Now they're a bit harder to fool too.

03 APPLY IT

Finish your fool-proofing breakdown of all three claims and present it to your family.

04 REFLECT

Which of your three was the sneakiest? What will you check more carefully from now on?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your audience which breakdown surprised them most. Note it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk a family member through all three claims and how you saw through them.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The judgement of what's misleading is yours, built from your own checking — that's the skill worth having. Share it in your own words.

You'll need: Fool-proofing summary template

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A three-claim breakdown was completed and presented.
- ☐ The child can explain the trick and the check for each.

Unlocks after: Check before you believe

THINK · Q3

Do Real Research

th-11-12-q3 · supporting: Create Wealth, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can run a simple structured investigation of what real people think — a small survey or a set of interviews — count the responses, and spot patterns. This is a real step beyond Q2's 'check other people's claims': now they *generate* new knowledge by gathering their own data. Keep the sample small and real. It also lays the groundwork for the year-end launch, where knowing your customer beats guessing.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is finding out what people actually think or want by asking properly, instead of assuming — real evidence you gathered yourself. It's the grown-up power of replacing 'I reckon' with 'I asked twelve people and here's what they said'.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child becomes someone who can *find things out* — running a real mini-study and discovering something they (and often the adults) didn't know. The satisfaction of a surprising, data-backed finding, and being able to say 'I have evidence', is powerfully motivating and makes them feel genuinely capable.

THE ARTIFACT

A mini research finding: a clear question, data gathered from at least five real people, patterns counted, and a conclusion drawn — even if it surprises them.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child wrote one clear research question they could actually answer by asking people.
- They asked the same questions to at least five real people and recorded answers.
- They counted the patterns and drew a conclusion supported by the data.

Unlocks after: Don't Get Fooled

1 Ask one clear research question

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Research starts with one clear question you can answer by asking people — 'what snack do kids in my class most wish the canteen sold?' Vague questions ('what do people like?') give mush. A sharp question gives usable answers.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Would people my age pay for a homework-reminder app?' is answerable. 'Is technology good?' is not — too big, too fuzzy to gather real data on.

03 APPLY IT

Write one clear research question you genuinely want answered and could ask real people.

04 REFLECT

Could five people actually answer your question in a sentence? If not, sharpen it.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Run your question past a parent — is it clear and answerable, or too broad?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend sharpen a fuzzy research question into an answerable one.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you narrow a question, but the thing you're curious about is yours. And AI can't tell you what your real classmates think — only asking them can.

You'll need: Research-question card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] One clear, answerable research question is written.

2 Ask real people

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Ask the *same* questions to several people — that's what makes it research rather than a chat. Same questions, several people, answers written down. Consistency is what lets you compare and count later.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You ask five classmates the exact same three questions about canteen snacks. Because the questions were identical, you can line up the answers and see what most people said.

03 APPLY IT

Ask your question (plus one or two follow-ups) to at least five real people. Write down every answer.

04 REFLECT

Did asking everyone the same way feel a bit formal? That sameness is exactly what makes the results trustworthy.

05 GET FEEDBACK

After two people, check with a parent that your questions are getting useful answers before doing the rest.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why asking everyone the *same* questions matters in research.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you word neutral questions (ones that don't push people toward an answer). But the answers must come from real people — invented data is worthless and dishonest.

You'll need: Response record sheet (5+ people)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The same questions were asked to at least five real people and answers recorded.

Unlocks after: Ask one clear research question

3 Count the patterns

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Now turn answers into numbers. Tally how many people said each thing. Patterns you can count ('4 out of 5 wanted spicy snacks') are far stronger than a vague feeling ('people seemed to like spicy stuff').

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Your tally: 4 of 5 want spicy snacks, 3 of 5 would pay RM2, nobody wanted sweets. Suddenly you can *see* what people want, in numbers.

03 APPLY IT

Tally your answers into counts. Note the clearest pattern in the numbers.

04 REFLECT

Did the numbers match what you expected before you started? Data often corrects our hunches.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your tally to a parent and check your counting is fair and accurate.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone how counting answers turns opinions into evidence.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Count your own data by hand — it's a small amount and doing it yourself keeps you honest about what it really says.

You'll need: Tally/pattern sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Answers are tallied and the main pattern is identified.

Unlocks after: Ask real people

4 Draw a conclusion

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Finish by stating what your data shows — your conclusion — in one clear sentence, backed by the numbers. Good researchers follow the data even when it disagrees with what they hoped.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Most kids my age want spicy snacks and would pay RM2 — so a spicy snack stall could work.' That conclusion is earned by real evidence, not a guess.

03 APPLY IT

Write your conclusion in one sentence, backed by your numbers. Note if it surprised you.

04 REFLECT

Did your evidence support your first hunch, or change your mind? Changing your mind because of data is a strength.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present your question, data, and conclusion to your family and ask if the conclusion follows from the numbers.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk someone through your whole mini-study, from question to evidence-backed conclusion.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The conclusion must come from *your* data, honestly read — not from what you wish were true, and not from an AI guess. Let the evidence lead.

You'll need: Conclusion card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A one-sentence conclusion supported by the data is written.
- ☐ The child can explain how the numbers back the conclusion.

Unlocks after: Count the patterns

THINK · Q4

Plan the Launch

th-11-12-q4 · supporting: Create Wealth, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

This is the year's capstone, and Think leads it: a real mini-launch to genuine customers. At 11–12 a child can plan it using evidence from their own research (Q3), make reasoned decisions (Q2), and break a real project into ordered steps. Grounding a launch in what they actually found out about customers — rather than hope — is a major, real-world milestone. Keep the scope small, safe, and adult-supported throughout.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is being the strategist of a real launch — using evidence, not wishful thinking, to decide what to sell, to whom, where, and how. It's every thinking skill from two years pointed at one genuine question: how do we make this actually work?

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child owns the plan for a real launch that real customers will attend or buy from. Being genuinely in charge of a strategy — one grounded in their own research and judged by real results — is deeply motivating at this age. The launch is real, the responsibility is theirs, and that pulls out serious, evidence-based thinking.

THE ARTIFACT

A launch plan grounded in research: what to launch, the target customer (from real data), where and when, an ordered step plan, and a clear measurable goal (e.g., 10 real customers or RM50 profit).

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The choice of what to launch is justified by research, not just a hunch.
- There is a specific target customer and a measurable goal.
- The plan has ordered steps and a set launch date agreed with an adult.

Unlocks after: Do Real Research

1 Decide what to launch

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Use your research to choose what to launch. The whole point of Q3 was evidence about what people want — now you spend it. Pick the thing your data says real customers will actually pay for, not just the thing you feel like making.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Your research found most classmates want spicy snacks and would pay RM2. So you launch a spicy-snack stall — a choice backed by evidence, far safer than guessing they'd want something.

03 APPLY IT

Using your research findings, decide what you will launch. Write one sentence linking your choice to the evidence.

04 REFLECT

Is your choice driven by your data or by what you personally fancy making? Let the evidence win.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Explain your choice and its evidence to a parent — does the launch idea follow from your research?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone how you used real research to pick what to launch.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This decision rests on your real data about your real community — yours to make. AI can't know what your customers said; only your research can.

You’ll need: Launch-choice card (idea + evidence)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A launch idea is chosen and justified by research.

2 Who's it for, and what's the goal?

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Name your target customer (from your research) and set one measurable goal for the launch — a number you can check afterward. A goal turns a vague hope into something you can actually hit or miss and learn from.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Target: kids in my year who buy snacks at break. Goal: sell to 10 real customers and make RM20 profit on launch day. Now success is a clear number, not a feeling.

03 APPLY IT

Write your target customer and one measurable goal for the launch (customers, sales, or profit).

04 REFLECT

Is your goal ambitious but reachable? Too easy teaches nothing; impossible just disheartens.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Check your goal with a parent or mentor — is it realistic for a first launch?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why a measurable goal beats 'I hope it goes well'.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Your target customer comes from your research; your goal is your judgement about what's reachable. Both are yours — set them honestly.

You'll need: Target + goal card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A specific target customer and a measurable goal are set.

Unlocks after: Decide what to launch

3 Where, when, and how

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Decide the launch setting — a safe pop-up (a school fair, a community table) or a small, adult-supervised online drop. Every launch needs a real place and time, and at your age it needs an adult in the loop for safety.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You and a parent decide: a stall at the school open day next Saturday. Real place, real date, adult present. That's a launch that can actually happen safely.

03 APPLY IT

With an adult, choose a safe launch setting, place, and date. Write them into your plan.

04 REFLECT

Is your setting somewhere your target customer will actually be? Right product, wrong place still fails.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Confirm the setting and safety plan with a parent before going further.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why the launch setting has to match where your customers are.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Anything public or online needs a real adult's approval and involvement — that's a safety judgement no tool makes for you. Keep an adult in the loop.

You’ll need: Launch-setting plan card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A safe, adult-approved launch setting, place, and date are decided.

Unlocks after: Who's it for, and what's the goal?

4 Build the step plan and get buy-in

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Turn the whole launch into an ordered step plan — what the three other tracks (promote, build, sell) each need to do and by when. Then present it to your family or mentor for buy-in. Now the launch is real and the other three parts can begin.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Your plan: this week — build the product and write the promo; next week — rehearse the pitch and promote; launch day — run the stall and track sales. Everyone knows their part.

03 APPLY IT

Break the launch into ordered steps across the four tracks. Present the full plan and confirm the date.

04 REFLECT

Does your plan connect all four pillars into one launch? That's the whole two years coming together.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present the plan to family/mentor and ask what you have missed or scheduled too late.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk someone through your entire launch plan as if recruiting them to help.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Sequencing your own launch is the strategic thinking that matters here — do it yourself. An adult helps with timing and safety, since they know the real-world constraints.

You'll need: Launch step-plan sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ An ordered step plan across all four tracks exists.
- ☐ The plan was presented and the launch date confirmed.

Unlocks after: Where, when, and how

COMMUNICATE · Q1

Say It So They Get It

co-11-12-q1 · supporting: Think, Create

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12 a child can hold a listener in mind — they're starting to notice when someone doesn't follow them, though they don't yet reliably adjust. They know a lot about the things they love and will happily info-dump; the growth edge is shaping that flood so someone else can actually receive it. Short, performable tasks with a real listener beat abstract 'communication skills' talk.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is a real person's face lighting up with 'oh, I get it now'. Making something you understand land in someone else's head is a genuine gift — and at this age it's mostly given to people they know: a parent, a friend, a younger sibling.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child explains something they genuinely love — a game, a hobby, an animal — to a real person who honestly doesn't know it, and finds out whether that person actually understood. The live reaction (confusion or the click of understanding) is the motivator; you can't fake your way past a real listener's blank face, and landing it feels great.

THE ARTIFACT

A 2-minute explainer (performed live or recorded as a short video) that makes one real listener genuinely understand something they didn't before — plus that listener's honest 'did you get it?' verdict.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A real listener can restate the main idea in their own words afterward.
- The explainer starts from something the listener already knew.
- The child cut at least one thing that was interesting to them but confusing to the listener.

1 Start where they already are

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

People understand new things by hooking them onto things they already know. Start from the listener's world, not yours — a bridge from something familiar to something new.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Explaining chess to someone new? 'It's like a battle where every soldier moves in its own special way' lands better than opening with 'the knight moves in an L'. The battle idea is already in their head.

03 APPLY IT

Pick your topic. Write one sentence that connects it to something your listener already knows and likes. That's your opening bridge.

04 REFLECT

What does your listener already know that you can build on? If you don't know, that's your first question to ask them.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Try your opening bridge on your real listener and watch: did they nod, or look lost? Adjust.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend how to make a 'bridge' opening for a topic *they* care about.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can suggest analogies if you're stuck — a fair nudge. But the best bridge uses what *this specific listener* knows, and only you know them. Don't hand your listener a stranger's analogy.

You'll need: Bridge-opening worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] An opening line exists that links the topic to the listener's existing knowledge.

2 One idea at a time

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

When you love a topic, everything feels important and it all rushes out at once — and the listener drowns. Great explaining is putting ideas in a line, one clear step after another.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A good recipe never says 'do everything now'. It's step 1, step 2, step 3. Explaining works the same way: land one idea, then the next.

03 APPLY IT

List everything you want to say, then number them into an order where each step makes sense only after the one before. Cross out any that don't earn a place.

04 REFLECT

Which idea *must* come first for the rest to make sense? Getting the order right is half the battle.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Read your ordered steps to someone. Ask where they got lost — that's usually where two ideas got crammed together.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help someone put their own jumbled explanation into a clear order.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You can ask AI to help sort your points into an order, then check the order yourself against your listener. If a step only makes sense to you and not to them, the order is still wrong — trust the human, not the tidy list.

You'll need: Idea-ordering worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The explanation is broken into an ordered sequence with at least one idea cut.

Unlocks after: Start where they already are

3 Show it, don't just say it

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

A picture, a demo, or a quick example lands harder than words alone. Showing turns a vague idea into something the listener can actually see.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Explaining how a lever works? Don't just describe it — grab a ruler and a pencil and lift a book. Now they *see* it, and they'll remember.

03 APPLY IT

Find one place in your explainer to show instead of tell — a drawing, an object, a quick demo. Build it into your 2 minutes.

04 REFLECT

Where in your explanation did the listener's eyes glaze? That's the spot that most needs a show-not-tell.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Do the explainer with your 'show' moment. Ask the listener which part stuck most — was it the shown bit?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Challenge a friend to add a 'show' moment to their explanation and compare before/after.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can suggest what to demonstrate, but the actual showing — the object, the drawing, your hands — is yours to make real. A demo you performed beats a clever one you only described.

You'll need: Show-don't-tell idea card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The explainer includes at least one concrete demonstration or visual.

Unlocks after: One idea at a time

4 Deliver it and read the room

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

The final skill is watching your listener while you talk and adjusting — slowing down at a frown, moving on at a nod. An explainer is a two-way thing, not a speech at someone.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A good teacher notices the class going quiet-confused and stops to re-explain. They're reading faces, not just reciting.

03 APPLY IT

Deliver your full 2-minute explainer to your real listener. Watch their face and adjust live at least once.

04 REFLECT

Where did you have to slow down or change course? Those spots show you what's genuinely hard to explain.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Afterward, ask your listener to say the main idea back in their own words. If they can, you succeeded. If not, find where it broke.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach someone the trick of 'ask them to say it back' as the real test of any explanation.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a *no-AI* delivery — it's a human moment between you and a real listener. Reading a real face and adjusting is the whole skill, and no tool can stand in that spot for you.

You'll need: Listener 'say-it-back' check card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The explainer was delivered live and adjusted at least once mid-way.
- ☐ The listener restated the main idea in their own words.

Unlocks after: Show it, don't just say it

COMMUNICATE · Q2

Write to Convince

co-11-12-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, writing is developing fast and children hold strong opinions they're keen to defend. They can now learn to structure a persuasive piece — claim, then reasons, then evidence — and publish it somewhere real. This builds on Q1's clear spoken explaining and adds the harder discipline of persuading on paper, where you can't read the listener's face and every word has to carry itself.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is actually changing someone's mind or decision with your writing — a real person reads what you wrote and reconsiders, recommends, or acts. It's the first taste of influence through words that outlive the moment you speak them.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child writes a persuasive piece and publishes it to a real audience — a family chat, a class board, a note on the fridge — then sees genuine reactions. Real readers responding (agreeing, pushing back, acting on it) makes writing feel powerful rather than like homework. The stakes of a real audience sharpen every choice.

THE ARTIFACT

A short persuasive piece (roughly 150–250 words — a review, a recommendation, or an opinion) published to a real audience, containing a clear claim, reasons, and evidence.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The piece opens with one clear claim or opinion.
- It supports the claim with reasons and at least one piece of real evidence.
- It was published to a real audience and the child noted the reaction.

Unlocks after: Say It So They Get It

1 Start with your claim

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Persuasive writing begins with one clear claim — the single thing you want the reader to believe or do. If your reader can't tell what you're arguing for in the first line, you've already lost them.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'This game is the best value on the app store' is a claim. 'Some thoughts about games' is not. The claim tells the reader exactly where you're taking them.

03 APPLY IT

Pick something you have a real opinion on (a game, book, place, idea). Write your claim in one clear sentence.

04 REFLECT

Is your claim something people could actually disagree with? If nobody could disagree, it's not worth persuading.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your claim to someone and ask if it's clear what you're arguing. Sharpen it if not.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend turn a vague opinion into one sharp claim.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The opinion must be genuinely *yours* — persuasion built on a claim you don't actually believe reads hollow. Don't let AI pick your position.

You'll need: Claim-writing card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] One clear, arguable claim is written.

2 Back it with reasons and evidence

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

A claim without support is just a shout. Give two or three reasons, and back at least one with real evidence — a fact, an example, a number, a comparison. Evidence is what turns 'because I say so' into 'because look'.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Claim: this game is great value. Reason + evidence: 'It costs RM10 but has 40 hours of levels — that's cheaper per hour than a single cinema trip.' The number makes it convincing.

03 APPLY IT

Write two or three reasons for your claim, and add one real piece of evidence to your strongest reason.

04 REFLECT

Which reason is strongest? Persuasive writers lead with their best, not their first.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Read your reasons to someone and ask which convinced them most — and which fell flat.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone the difference between a reason and actual evidence for it.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

If you use AI to check a fact, verify it's real before you publish — putting a made-up statistic in your writing destroys your credibility. Real evidence only.

You'll need: Reasons + evidence organiser

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Two or three reasons with at least one real piece of evidence are written.

Unlocks after: Start with your claim

3 Answer the other side

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Strong persuasion admits the other side exists — then answers it. Naming the main objection and responding to it shows you've thought it through and makes doubters trust you more, not less.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Some say RM10 is too much for a phone game — but most games at that price give a few hours; this gives forty.' You raised the objection and knocked it down. Now the reader has no easy escape.

03 APPLY IT

Write the strongest objection to your claim, then add a sentence answering it, into your piece.

04 REFLECT

Was it uncomfortable to argue against yourself? Doing it well is what separates convincing from ranting.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask someone who disagrees with you what their objection is. Did you already answer it? If not, add it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone why answering the other side makes an argument stronger, not weaker.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can suggest objections you hadn't thought of — a genuinely useful sparring partner here. But you decide which are real and how to answer them honestly.

You'll need: Objection + answer card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The main objection is named and answered within the piece.

Unlocks after: Back it with reasons and evidence

4 Publish and see the reaction

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Finish, polish, and publish to a real audience — a family group, a class board, a note somewhere people will read it. Then watch what happens. Real reactions are the truest feedback a writer gets.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You post your game review in the family chat and your cousin actually buys the game because of it. That's persuasion working — your words changed a real decision.

03 APPLY IT

Polish your piece and publish it somewhere real. Note who read it and how they reacted.

04 REFLECT

Did anyone agree, disagree, or act on it? What in your writing seemed to land hardest?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask one reader what convinced them most and what they'd push back on. Keep it for next time.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone the story of publishing your piece and the reaction it got.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you fix spelling and flow before publishing, but the argument and voice must stay yours — readers can feel when writing isn't really a person's. Keep it sounding like you.

You'll need: Publish + reaction log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The piece was published to a real audience.
- [ ] The child recorded real reader reactions.

Unlocks after: Answer the other side

COMMUNICATE · Q3

Pitch It

co-11-12-q3 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can prepare and deliver a short spoken pitch to a small group, with a hook, a clear core message, and basic handling of questions. This steps up from Q2's written persuasion to live, on-your-feet persuasion in front of several people — where nerves are real and rehearsal genuinely helps. It directly prepares them to pitch their year-end launch.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is winning a room — getting a group interested in and on board with your idea, live and in person. It's a high-stakes, high-status skill at this age: the ability to stand up, say something well, and have people lean in.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child delivers a real pitch to a real small group and feels the room respond. Standing up in front of peers or family and landing it carries real weight at this age — a successful pitch feels like a genuine win, and that pull makes the rehearsal and nerves worth pushing through.

THE ARTIFACT

A short pitch (about 60–90 seconds) delivered live to a real small group, with a strong hook, one clear message, and at least one audience question handled.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The pitch opens with a hook that grabs attention in the first line.
- It has one clear message the audience could repeat afterward.
- The child delivered it live and handled at least one real question.

Unlocks after: Write to Convince

1 The hook

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

You have about five seconds before a group tunes out. A hook — a surprising fact, a question, a bold claim — buys their attention. Open strong, or the best pitch in the world goes unheard.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'What if I told you our class wastes 200 sheets of paper a week?' grabs everyone. 'Um, so, I want to talk about paper…' loses them instantly. Same topic, totally different opening.

03 APPLY IT

Pick something you want to pitch. Write three possible hooks, then choose the strongest.

04 REFLECT

Which hook would make *you* look up if you were half-listening? That's your winner.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Try your top hook on someone and watch — did they actually look up?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend write a hook for something they want to pitch.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can brainstorm hook ideas, but pick and shape the one that fits your real idea and your voice — a hook you don't believe falls flat when you say it.

You’ll need: Hook-writing card (3 options)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A strong opening hook is chosen from several options.

2 One clear message

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

A pitch isn't everything you know — it's *one* thing you want them to remember or do. Pick your single core message and build the whole pitch around it. If the audience leaves remembering one sentence, what should it be?

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Core message: 'Let's put a paper-recycling box in every classroom.' Everything else in the pitch supports that one idea. Clear and repeatable.

03 APPLY IT

Write your one core message in a single sentence. Then note two quick points that support it.

04 REFLECT

If your audience forgot everything but one sentence, is your core message the one they'd keep?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Say your message to someone and, a minute later, ask them to repeat it. Did it stick?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone why a pitch needs one core message, not ten.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you tighten your message to one line, but the idea and the two supporting points should be yours and true — you have to defend them live.

You'll need: Core-message + support card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] One clear core message and two supporting points are written.

Unlocks after: The hook

3 Handle questions

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

After a pitch, people ask things — and how you handle it matters as much as the pitch. Listen fully, don't panic, and it's fine to say 'good question' and think for a second. Honest answers beat bluffing.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Who empties the recycling boxes?' You don't have a perfect answer, so you say: 'Good question — I'd suggest a class rota; I can work out the details.' Calm and honest wins trust.

03 APPLY IT

Guess the three hardest questions your pitch might get. Write a calm, honest answer for each.

04 REFLECT

Which question worried you most? Preparing it turns a scary moment into an easy one.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Have someone fire your three questions (and a surprise one) at you. Practise staying calm.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend the trick of 'listen, pause, answer honestly' for tough questions.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you anticipate questions — useful prep. But answer honestly in the moment; if you don't know, saying so is stronger than a confident bluff.

You'll need: Anticipated-questions sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Three likely questions are anticipated with prepared honest answers.

Unlocks after: One clear message

4 Deliver it live

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Now put it together and pitch — hook, message, support — to a real small group, then take their questions. Stand tall, speak up, use the voice and expression skills you've built. This is the whole skill, live.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You pitch the recycling idea to your family or class, land the hook, deliver your message, and field two questions calmly. Whether they say yes or not, you *pitched* — and that's the win.

03 APPLY IT

Deliver your pitch live to a real small group and handle at least one real question.

04 REFLECT

How did it feel up there? What worked, and what would you tighten next time?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your audience: was the message clear, and was the hook strong? Note their answers.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Coach someone else through delivering a short pitch of their own.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Delivering live to a real group is fully human — presence, nerves, real questions. No tool stands up there for you; this one's all yours.

You'll need: Pitch delivery checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The pitch was delivered live to a real group.
- ☐ At least one real question was handled.

Unlocks after: Handle questions

COMMUNICATE · Q4

Promote and Pitch

co-11-12-q4 · supporting: Think, Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Communicate brings in the customers. At 11–12 a child can pull together persuasive writing (Q2) and live pitching (Q3) to promote a real launch and win over real potential customers — not just family. This is persuasion aimed at driving actual action (show up, buy), the highest-stakes communicating of the two years.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is getting real people interested enough to turn up or buy — persuasion that moves strangers to act. It's the difference between a good product nobody hears about and a launch people actually come to.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child promotes to real potential customers and pitches live at the launch, then sees whether their words brought people in. Persuasion that visibly works — a stranger showing up because of your promo, buying after your pitch — is thrilling and validating, and it makes every rehearsal worth it.

THE ARTIFACT

Promotional materials (a written promo plus a short spoken launch pitch) prepared, rehearsed, and delivered to real potential customers before and at the launch.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The written promo is honest, clear, and tempting to the target customer.
- The spoken pitch has a hook and one clear message and was rehearsed.
- Both were delivered to real potential customers (safely, with adult approval).

Unlocks after: Pitch It, Plan the Launch

1 Write the promo

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Write a short promotional message using your persuasive-writing skills: a clear claim, a reason to care, aimed at your target customer. Keep it honest — over-promising wins one sale and loses all trust.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Spicy homemade snacks at Saturday's open day — RM2, made fresh, tested on the whole class. Come hungry!' Short, honest, tempting, and aimed right at snack-buyers.

03 APPLY IT

Write your promo message (a few lines) for your target customer. Make it honest and tempting.

04 REFLECT

Would your target customer stop and read this? Does it promise only what you can deliver?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your promo to a parent for approval and a 'would this make you come?' check.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend how to write an honest promo that still tempts people.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help polish the wording, but keep it true and in your voice — and never promise what your product can't deliver. Honesty is your reputation.

You'll need: Promo-writing card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ An honest, tempting promo aimed at the target customer is written.

2 Prepare the launch pitch

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Prepare a short spoken pitch for launch day using your Q3 pitching skills — a hook, one clear message, and a friendly close that invites the sale. This is what you say to someone standing at your stall or watching your drop.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Hungry? These are fresh spicy snacks I made and tested with my whole class — RM2 each, and the first batch always goes fast. Want to try one?' Hook, message, invite to buy.

03 APPLY IT

Write your 20–30 second launch pitch: hook, core message, and a friendly invitation to buy.

04 REFLECT

Does your pitch end by actually inviting the sale? Many pitches forget to ask.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Say your pitch to a parent and ask if it would make them want to try one.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone the shape of a good sales pitch: hook, message, invite.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help draft it, but you deliver it live in your own voice — a pitch that sounds scripted or fake loses customers. Make it sound like you.

You'll need: Launch-pitch card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A short launch pitch with hook, message, and invitation is prepared.

Unlocks after: Write the promo

3 Rehearse and refine

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Rehearse your pitch until it flows, and get a second pair of eyes on your promo. The launch is a one-shot moment — practising now means you'll be confident and clear when real customers are watching.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You practise the pitch ten times and it stops sounding stiff. A friend reads your promo and points out a confusing line. Both are far better before launch day than during it.

03 APPLY IT

Rehearse your pitch several times aloud, and refine your promo based on one piece of feedback.

04 REFLECT

Where does your pitch still stumble? Those spots need one more run-through.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Do a full dress rehearsal for a family member and ask what would make it land better.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why rehearsing a one-shot pitch matters so much.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Rehearsing your real voice is all you. AI can suggest a tweak to wording, but the confident delivery only comes from your own practice.

You'll need: Rehearsal checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The pitch was rehearsed to fluency and the promo refined once.

Unlocks after: Prepare the launch pitch

4 Promote for real

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Put your promo out (safely, adult-approved) before the launch, and deliver your pitch to real customers on the day. This is the whole communication arc — writing and speaking to persuade — driving a real event.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Your promo goes up on the approved school board mid-week; on Saturday you pitch to everyone who stops by. Some came because of the promo; some buy because of the pitch. Persuasion, working.

03 APPLY IT

Share your promo (adult-approved) ahead of the launch, then deliver your pitch to real customers on launch day.

04 REFLECT

Did your promo bring anyone in? Did your pitch turn lookers into buyers? What worked best?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Afterward, ask a customer what made them stop or buy — the promo, the pitch, or the product?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone the story of promoting and pitching your launch and what landed.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Delivering to real customers is fully human and needs adult-approved, safe channels. This is your voice winning real people — no tool does it for you.

You'll need: Promo + pitch outcome log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The promo was shared safely and the pitch delivered to real customers.
- ☐ The child noted what drew customers in.

Unlocks after: Rehearse and refine

BUILD · Q1

Make a Thing That Works

bu-11-12-q1 · supporting: Think, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can follow a multi-step plan and love making something *real* appear from their own effort, but they get discouraged fast when a first attempt is messy. They don't need programming syntax; they need the experience of turning an idea into a working thing and seeing a real person use it. Keep the build small enough to finish in a sitting or two so the payoff arrives before the patience runs out.

WHAT “CREATING VALUE” MEANS HERE

Value at this age is: 'I made this, and it actually works, and someone used it.' The thrill is the gap between an idea in your head and a real thing on a screen that does something. Usefulness to one real person beats polish.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child builds the smallest possible working version of something useful — a quiz for a friend, a tiny web page for a family event, a simple automation — and watches a real person use it. The magic of 'the thing I imagined now exists and works' is the driver, sharpened by one real user actually trying it. Finishing something real is the reward.

THE ARTIFACT

One small working digital thing (a quiz, a one-page site, a simple automation) that does something useful, tried at least once by a real person who isn't the builder.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The thing runs and does what it's meant to for a real user.
- The child can explain in plain words what each part does — nothing in it is a mystery to them.
- They changed at least one thing after watching a real person get confused by it.

1 Who is it for, and what does it do?

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Before building anything, name the one person it's for and the one thing it does for them. A builder who skips this makes something cool that nobody needs.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'A quiz to help my little brother practise his times tables' beats 'a maths app'. One person, one job — now you know exactly what to build.

03 APPLY IT

Write one sentence: 'This is for [name], and it helps them [do one thing].' If you can't, your idea isn't ready yet.

04 REFLECT

Is the one thing small enough to actually finish? Beginners always pick too big — what could you cut?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Tell your chosen person your sentence and ask: 'Would that actually help you?' Listen for a real yes.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend write their own 'for [name], helps them [do X]' sentence.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Fine to brainstorm ideas with AI, but *you* pick the real person and the real job — the model doesn't know who's actually in your life to help.

You'll need: One-sentence project brief card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A one-person, one-job project sentence is written and checked with the real person.

2 Sketch before you build

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Draw the thing on paper first — what's on the screen, what happens when you tap. A sketch is cheap to change; a half-built project is painful to change.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Game designers draw levels on paper before touching a computer. Ten seconds with a pencil can save an hour of building the wrong thing.

03 APPLY IT

Sketch every screen or step of your thing on paper, with arrows showing what happens next. Keep it rough.

04 REFLECT

Walking through your own sketch, where does it get confusing? Better to find it now, on paper.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the sketch to your real user and have them 'tap' through it with a finger. Note where they hesitate.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone why sketching first saves time, using your own before/after.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Sketch by hand yourself — this is thinking, not decoration. AI can't do your thinking about what the thing should be; that has to live in your own head first.

You'll need: Blank sketch/flow sheets

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A hand sketch shows every screen/step with the flow between them.

Unlocks after: Who is it for, and what does it do?

3 Build the smallest version

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

Build the tiniest version that works at all — one question, one page, one action. You can always add more, but only once the small thing runs. Understand every piece you put in.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The first version of a big app is usually embarrassingly basic — one screen that barely works. That's correct. Small-and-working beats big-and-broken every time.

03 APPLY IT

Build the smallest working version from your sketch, using whatever tool fits (a no-code builder, a simple site maker, AI help). Get it to actually run.

04 REFLECT

Can you explain what every part does? Anything you can't explain is a part you don't yet control.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show a mentor or parent the running thing and have them point to any part that looks like a 'mystery box' to you. Go understand that part.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk someone through your build and explain what each piece does in plain words.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you build — but the rule is: **never ship what you can't explain.** If AI made a piece you don't understand, either learn it or take it out. A builder who can't explain their own thing isn't really building, they're copying.

You'll need: List of kid-safe no-code / site-builder tools

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A minimal version runs and does its one job.
- ☐ The child can explain every part of it in their own words.

Unlocks after: Sketch before you build

4 Test it on a real person and fix one thing

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

You can't see your own thing clearly — you know how it's *meant* to work, so you skip past the confusing bits. A real user finds them in seconds. Then you fix the worst one.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Watch someone use your quiz without helping them. Where they get stuck or press the wrong thing tells you exactly what to fix — no guessing needed.

03 APPLY IT

Hand your thing to your real user and stay quiet. Write down every place they get confused. Then fix the single most confusing one.

04 REFLECT

Was the confusing part the bit you were most proud of? That happens a lot — building for yourself vs building for them are different.

05 GET FEEDBACK

After fixing, have them try again. Did the fix work? If not, you found the wrong thing to fix.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach a friend the rule: 'watch them use it, stay silent, fix what confused them.'

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

A real human tester beats any AI check here — AI won't get confused the way a real 8-year-old will. Use AI afterward only to help *fix* the specific thing your tester tripped on.

You'll need: User-test observation sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real person tested the thing while the builder observed silently.
- ☐ At least one change was made based on real confusion, then re-tested.

Unlocks after: Build the smallest version

BUILD · Q2

Build Version Two

bu-11-12-q2 · supporting: Think, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can handle the real iteration loop: get a thing into several people's hands, gather feedback that's actually useful, decide what matters, and build a genuine second version. This is a clear step up from Q1's single-user test — the leap from 'I made a thing' to 'I made it noticeably better because I listened'. It also introduces a mature judgement: not every request should be built.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is making something measurably better by listening to real users — the core loop every real builder lives by. It's the difference between a one-off project and a thing that actually improves, and the pride is in the visible jump from v1 to v2.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child watches several real people use their creation, then builds a version two that's clearly better — and gets to see users prefer it. The satisfaction of a real, visible improvement driven by their own good decisions is deeply motivating, and it feels like how 'real' makers and companies work.

THE ARTIFACT

Version two of a digital or physical thing, improved from feedback gathered from at least three real users, with a short before/after showing what changed and why.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- At least three real people used version one, and the child gathered their feedback.
- The child chose which changes mattered instead of trying to do all of them.
- A real version two exists, and the child can explain why each change was made.

Unlocks after: Make a Thing That Works

1 Get it into real hands

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

One tester tells you a little; several tell you a pattern. Get your thing (from Q1, or a new small one) into the hands of at least three real people and let them actually use it — no hovering, no explaining.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A quiz app tested by one friend seems fine. Tested by five, you notice three of them get stuck on the same screen — that's a real pattern you'd never have seen from one.

03 APPLY IT

Get your thing used by at least three real people. Just watch and let them use it naturally.

04 REFLECT

Did more testers reveal problems one wouldn't have? Patterns need a few people to show up.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask each tester to simply use it while you watch quietly. Note where each one struggles.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why three testers beat one for finding real problems.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Real human testers find real human confusion — something AI can't simulate well. Use real people here; no shortcut.

You'll need: Tester observation grid (3+ users)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] At least three real people used the thing while the child observed.

2 Gather feedback that's useful

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Vague feedback ('it's nice') is useless. Ask questions that get real answers: 'What was confusing?' 'What would you change?' 'Where did you get stuck?' And trust what you *saw* them do over what they politely say.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A tester says 'it's great!' but you watched them fail the same button three times. What they *did* is the real feedback; the polite words are just being kind.

03 APPLY IT

For each tester, write down one thing they said and one thing you saw them struggle with.

04 REFLECT

Where did what people said differ from what they did? Which do you trust more, and why?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Compare your notes with a parent — do any struggles show up across multiple testers?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend how to ask feedback questions that get useful answers, not just 'it's nice'.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you write good feedback questions to ask. But the feedback itself must come from real users doing real things — that's the data that counts.

You'll need: Feedback capture sheet (said vs did)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Useful feedback (said and observed) is captured for each tester.

Unlocks after: Get it into real hands

3 Decide what to change

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

You can't and shouldn't build every request. Pick the changes that matter most — the problems several people hit, or the one that ruins the experience. Saying no to some feedback is as important as saying yes to the rest.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Testers asked for rainbow colours, a login, and a fix for the stuck button. The stuck button broke the whole thing for three people — that's the one that matters. The rainbow can wait forever.

03 APPLY IT

List all the feedback, then circle the two or three changes that matter most. Note why you're skipping the rest.

04 REFLECT

Was it hard to ignore some requests? Good builders choose; they don't just obey every suggestion.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Explain your chosen changes to a mentor and why you're skipping the others. Does your reasoning hold?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone why building every request would actually make a thing worse.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This choosing is judgement — the most human part of building. Don't outsource it; a list of 'what users want' isn't a decision about what to build.

You'll need: Change-prioritisation sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Two or three priority changes are chosen with reasons for skipping others.

Unlocks after: Gather feedback that's useful

4 Build v2 and compare

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Build your version two with the changes that mattered. Then show the before and after — ideally to a tester — so the improvement is visible. Seeing v1 and v2 side by side is proof your listening paid off.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

V2 fixes the stuck button and adds clearer instructions. You show a tester both versions and they breeze through v2. That visible jump is the whole reward.

03 APPLY IT

Build version two with your priority changes. Write a short before/after: what changed and why.

04 REFLECT

Is v2 clearly better? What did listening to real users get you that guessing wouldn't have?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show v2 to at least one original tester. Ask if it's better and where.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk someone through your v1 → v2 story and how feedback drove it.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you build the changes, but keep the rule from Q1: understand every part. A v2 full of parts you can't explain isn't really your improvement.

You'll need: Before/after comparison card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real version two exists with the priority changes built.
- ☐ The child can explain each change and show the improvement.

Unlocks after: Decide what to change

BUILD · Q3

Build for Strangers

bu-11-12-q3 · supporting: Communicate, Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can take a build that worked for friends and make it work for people who've never met them: clear instructions, works without anyone explaining, looks trustworthy, and handles mistakes without breaking. This is a genuinely new design skill — empathy for a user you'll never talk to — and a clear step past Q2's iteration with friends. It prepares them to ship to real customers at the launch.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is a thing that works for people who've never met you — the real line between a friend-project and an actual product. When a stranger can pick it up and succeed with no help, you've built something that can stand on its own in the world.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child watches a true stranger — someone who's never seen the thing and can't ask them for help — use their creation successfully. That moment, when it works without the maker in the room, feels like leveling up from 'kid who made a thing' to 'someone who builds real products'. It's a proud, concrete milestone.

THE ARTIFACT

A build made 'stranger-ready': clear instructions, works unaided, looks trustworthy, handles at least one common mistake, and tested by someone who didn't know it beforehand.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The thing can be used by someone with no explanation from the maker.
- It guides a first-timer and handles at least one likely mistake gracefully.
- A real person who'd never seen it succeeded in using it.

Unlocks after: Build Version Two

1 Strangers don't have you to explain

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

When friends test your thing, you're standing there to explain. Strangers aren't — they have only what's on the screen or page. So everything a user needs must be built *in*. If it needs you to explain it, it's not ready for strangers.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Your quiz made sense because you told your friend 'tap the green one to start'. A stranger sees no green button explained anywhere and is stuck on the first screen. The instruction lived in your mouth, not the product.

03 APPLY IT

Look at your Q2 build and list every place where a stranger would need you to explain something. Those are your gaps.

04 REFLECT

How many hidden 'you have to explain it' moments did you find? Most builds have more than the maker expects.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask a parent to spot places where your thing assumes the user already knows something.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why a thing that needs the maker present isn't really finished.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You know your build; imagining a stranger's confusion is your job here. AI can't feel lost the way a real first-timer will — but it can help you write clearer instructions once you've found the gaps.

You'll need: Stranger-gap checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Places needing explanation are identified across the build.

2 Clear instructions and signposting

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Guide the first-timer. A short instruction, a clear label, an obvious 'start here' — these signposts let a stranger find their way. Good design quietly tells people what to do next, without a manual.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Adding 'Tap START to begin' and numbering the steps turns a confusing screen into one a stranger breezes through. Small signposts, big difference.

03 APPLY IT

Add clear instructions and signposts to fix the gaps you found. Keep them short and obvious.

04 REFLECT

Could a stranger now get started without asking anyone? Read it as if you'd never seen it.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the updated version to someone and ask if it's now clear where to begin.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend how one good 'start here' signpost helps a first-timer.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI is genuinely helpful for drafting clear, friendly instructions. But test them on a real person — clarity is judged by a confused human, not by how good the words look.

You'll need: Instruction/signpost worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Clear instructions and signposts were added to guide a first-timer.

Unlocks after: Strangers don't have you to explain

3 Handle mistakes gracefully

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Strangers will do unexpected things — tap the wrong button, leave a box blank, get it 'wrong'. A good build expects this and handles it kindly, with a helpful nudge instead of breaking or a scary error. Plan for the mistake.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A stranger leaves the name box empty and taps submit. Instead of crashing, your quiz gently says 'Please add your name first'. It caught the mistake and helped, rather than breaking.

03 APPLY IT

Think of one common mistake a stranger might make. Build a graceful response to it (a gentle message or a safe default).

04 REFLECT

What's the most likely 'wrong' thing a stranger could do? Handling that one well covers a lot.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Have someone deliberately 'do it wrong' and see if your build handles it kindly.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why good things expect mistakes instead of assuming everyone does it right.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you build the graceful response, but keep the Q1 rule — understand every part. And you must decide *which* mistakes matter; that's judgement about your real users.

You'll need: Mistake-handling card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ At least one common user mistake is handled gracefully.

Unlocks after: Clear instructions and signposting

4 Test with a true stranger

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

The real test: someone who has never seen your thing and can't ask you for help. Watch them (silently!) try to use it. If they succeed alone, it's stranger-ready. If they get stuck, you've found the last gaps to fix.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You give your quiz to a cousin who's never seen it, say nothing, and watch. They start, play, and finish with no help. That silent success is proof you built for strangers.

03 APPLY IT

Find someone who's never seen your build. Let them try it with zero help while you watch. Note any sticking points and fix the worst one.

04 REFLECT

Where did the stranger struggle that friends never did? Strangers reveal the truth about your design.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask the stranger afterward: was anything confusing or missing? Take it seriously.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone why a true stranger is the best test of whether a thing is really finished.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Only a real, unfamiliar human can truly test this — AI already 'knows too much' and won't get lost like a real first-timer. Use a real stranger.

You'll need: Stranger-test observation sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A true first-timer used the build unaided.
- ☐ Remaining gaps were noted and the worst one fixed.

Unlocks after: Handle mistakes gracefully

BUILD · Q4

Ship the Product

bu-11-12-q4 · supporting: Think, Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Build produces what the launch sells. At 11–12 a child can pull together iteration (Q2) and building-for-strangers (Q3) to make the actual product or service customers will buy — tested, stranger-ready, and in enough quantity to hit the launch goal. This is the leap to making something genuinely ready to sell to people they've never met.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is a real product or service ready for real customers — the maker's contribution to the launch. It's every building skill from two years, aimed at one bar: a stranger can buy it, use it, and be happy, with no help from you.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child produces the real thing that real strangers will pay for and use on launch day. Knowing paying customers — not just friends — will judge the work raises the bar in a motivating way, and a table of finished, sell-ready product (or a service ready to deliver) is a powerful, tangible source of pride.

THE ARTIFACT

The finished, stranger-ready product or service, produced in enough quantity/capacity for the launch goal, and given a final test by a stranger.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The product/service is stranger-ready: usable and trustworthy with no help from the maker.
- There is enough stock or capacity to meet the launch goal.
- A final stranger test was done and the last issue fixed before launch.

Unlocks after: Build for Strangers, Plan the Launch

1 Decide the product and how much you need

~15 min

01 CONCEPT

Match your product to the launch goal. If the goal is 10 customers, you need enough for at least 10 (plus a few spare). Making too little means turning customers away; too much wastes effort. Plan the quantity on purpose.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Goal: 10 snack sales. So you make 12 portions — enough for the goal plus a couple extra, without over-making and wasting ingredients you paid for.

03 APPLY IT

Decide exactly what you're making/offering and how many, based on your launch goal. Write the number.

04 REFLECT

Does your quantity match your goal, with a small buffer? Too little or too much both cost you.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Check your quantity plan with a parent against your goal and your budget.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why you plan quantity from the goal, not just 'as many as possible'.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is simple planning tied to your real goal and budget — do it yourself so you understand your own numbers.

You'll need: Quantity-plan card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Product and quantity are decided to match the launch goal.

2 Make it stranger-ready

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Apply your Q3 skills: the product must work for strangers. That means clear labelling, obvious use, trustworthy presentation, and no need for you to explain anything. A launch customer should 'get it' instantly.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Your snacks get clear labels ('Spicy — RM2'), neat packaging, and an allergy note. A stranger can see what it is, what it costs, and trust it — no explanation needed.

03 APPLY IT

Make your product stranger-ready: labelling, presentation, and anything a customer needs to know without asking.

04 REFLECT

Could a total stranger understand and trust your product at a glance? If not, what's missing?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your prepared product to someone unfamiliar and ask if anything is unclear.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend what 'stranger-ready' means for a product on a stall.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help with clear label wording or a neat design, but keep the Q1 rule — understand and stand behind every part. And a real stranger's glance is the true test of clarity.

You'll need: Stranger-ready checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The product is labelled, presented, and usable with no maker explanation.

Unlocks after: Decide the product and how much you need

3 Produce enough for the launch

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Now actually produce your batch (or prepare to deliver your service) to the quantity you planned — at consistent quality. The tenth item should be as good as the first. Consistency is what a real customer expects.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You make all 12 snack portions to the same standard, not great-then-sloppy. Every customer gets the quality you promised in your pitch.

03 APPLY IT

Produce your full batch (or set up your service capacity) at consistent quality.

04 REFLECT

Did quality hold from first to last? Tiredness makes the last few slip — how did you keep them good?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Have someone check a few items from across your batch for consistent quality.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why consistency across a whole batch matters for real customers.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Production is your real work and craft — no shortcut. The consistency that builds a good name comes from you.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Enough product for the goal is produced at consistent quality.

Unlocks after: Make it stranger-ready

4 Final stranger test and fix

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

One last check before launch: have a stranger 'buy' and use your product exactly as a customer would. Any confusion or flaw they hit is your final fix — far better found now than in front of paying customers.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A neighbour 'buys' a snack, and you notice the label smudges when handled. You fix the labels the night before — crisis avoided before real customers ever see it.

03 APPLY IT

Run a final stranger test of the whole customer experience. Fix the last issue it reveals.

04 REFLECT

What did the final test catch? The last stranger always finds something the maker can't see.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your final tester: as a customer, would you buy this and be happy? Take the answer seriously.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone why a final stranger test right before launch is worth the effort.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Only a real, fresh stranger can catch what you've gone blind to — AI can't experience your product as a surprised customer. Use a real person for the final check.

You'll need: Final-test card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A final stranger test of the full experience was done.
- ☐ The last issue was fixed before launch.

Unlocks after: Produce enough for the launch

CREATE WEALTH · Q1

Your First Real Yes

cw-11-12-q1 · supporting: Build, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, money is becoming real but is still often secondary to the pride of *making something people want*. A child this age can make one good thing and offer it, but handling many customers, real pricing strategy, or rejection from strangers is a stretch — the first 'yes' often comes from someone they know, and that's developmentally right. Keep stakes tiny and real, and keep the loop short so the yes arrives quickly.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value at this age means someone *chooses* to have the thing you made — a real, voluntary yes, even from a neighbour or aunt, as long as it isn't just to be kind. The lesson isn't profit; it's the discovery that making something good and offering it can lead to a genuine 'yes, I'd like that'.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child makes one real thing (a baked treat, a small craft, a simple helper service) and aims for one honest yes from a real person. The stakes are small but real — a real person really deciding — which feels different from pretend play. Landing the first genuine yes is a memorable, motivating milestone at this age.

THE ARTIFACT

One real thing made or one real service offered, plus a record of the first genuine yes (who, what they said) and any nos with their reasons.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child made or prepared something real to offer.
- They made a real ask to at least one person outside the immediate household.
- They can say why the person said yes or no, in the person's own words.

1 What do people around you actually want?

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

You can only sell or give something people actually want. So start by *noticing* — what do the people near you wish they had, or wish was easier?

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A kid noticed her neighbours' plants dying while they were at work. 'I'll water your plants for RM5 a week' was an offer people actually wanted — because she spotted a real wish first.

03 APPLY IT

Watch the people around you for a day. Write down three things they seem to want or find annoying. Circle one you could help with.

04 REFLECT

Is the thing you circled something *they* want, or something *you'd* enjoy making? The best ideas are both — but their want has to be real.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask the person: 'Would something like this be useful to you?' Write down their actual words.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to a sibling why you should find out what people want *before* making something.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you think of ideas after you've watched real people — but it can't see your neighbours. The noticing has to be yours; that's the actual skill.

You'll need: Noticing worksheet (3 wants + circle)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Three real wants are noted and one is chosen based on a real person's want.

2 Make one good one

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Beginners rush to make ten of something and they're all a bit rubbish. Make *one*, and make it genuinely good. One good thing earns a yes; ten rushed ones earn nos.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A boy selling friendship bracelets made one beautiful sample first. People saw the good one and *then* ordered — the quality did the selling.

03 APPLY IT

Make one really good version of your thing (or plan your service carefully). Take your time; this one has to be good enough to earn a yes.

04 REFLECT

Would *you* say yes to your own thing? If not, what needs to be better before you offer it?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your one good version to someone honest and ask what would make it better. Improve it once.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell a friend why 'one good one' beats 'ten rushed ones'.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

If your thing is digital, AI might help you make it — but you must be able to make it good *and* understand it. For a hands-made thing, the craft is yours; don't fake quality you didn't build.

You'll need: Quality checklist card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] One genuinely good version exists, improved at least once after feedback.

Unlocks after: What do people around you actually want?

3 What's it worth?

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

A price (or a trade) is you saying what your thing is worth. Too cheap and it feels worthless; too dear and people say no. You're looking for a fair number that feels right to both sides.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The plant-watering kid started at RM2 and everyone said yes instantly — too cheap. At RM5, people still said yes, and she earned more for the same work. The price was a question she tested.

03 APPLY IT

Decide a fair price or trade for your thing and write one sentence on why. Think about the time and materials it took.

04 REFLECT

Does your price feel a little scary to say out loud? A price that feels slightly bold is often about right.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Say your price to one person and watch their reaction before they answer. Note whether they blinked.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why a price that everyone accepts instantly might be too low.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can tell you what similar things cost, as a rough guide. But the fair price depends on your effort and your real people — trust what they show you over what the model guesses.

You'll need: Simple pricing worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A price or trade is set with a stated reason.

Unlocks after: Make one good one

4 The first ask

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Everything so far was getting ready. It becomes real when you actually ask someone: 'Would you like this?' A yes is exciting; a no isn't failure — it usually comes with a reason you can learn from.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A girl selling cookies heard 'no thanks, I don't like chocolate' — so her next batch had a plain option, and that person bought. The no taught her the fix.

03 APPLY IT

Make your real ask to at least one person outside your home. Write down what they said — yes or no — and their reason.

04 REFLECT

How did asking feel? If a no stung, remember: it's information, not a verdict on you. What did it teach you?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Share your yes/no and the reason with a parent or mentor, and decide together one thing to try differently next time.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone the story of your first ask — the yes or the no — and what you learned from it.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

No tool can make the ask for you, and that's the point — the small nervousness of a real ask is exactly the thing you're practising. Use AI only afterward, to help think through what a no was telling you.

You'll need: First-ask record card (who / yes-no / reason)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real ask was made to someone outside the household.
- ☐ The response and its reason were recorded, and one next step was chosen.

Unlocks after: What's it worth?

CREATE WEALTH · Q2

Did You Actually Make Money?

cw-11-12-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can grasp a genuinely important idea that younger kids can't: money coming in is not the same as money made. They can list simple costs, track revenue, and work out real profit by subtracting. This builds directly on Q1's first sale — now they look behind the sale at whether it was actually worth it, which is the foundation of all real business thinking.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is knowing whether your thing *actually* makes money — the difference between feeling successful (money came in!) and being successful (money was left over after costs). It's a grown-up truth that reframes every little venture they'll ever run.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child discovers the real answer to 'did I make money?' about their own venture — sometimes a surprising, slightly deflating one — and then gets to fix it. The stakes are real (it's their own money and effort), and the satisfying 'aha' of seeing the true profit, then improving it, drives the learning far better than a lecture on costs ever could.

THE ARTIFACT

A simple profit calculation for a real or realistic little venture: costs listed, revenue listed, profit worked out, and a decision about what the number means.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child listed all the costs that went into their venture, not just the obvious one.
- They calculated profit as revenue minus costs and can explain the difference.
- They made one decision (raise price, cut a cost, or change) based on the real profit.

Unlocks after: Your First Real Yes

1 Money in isn't money made

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

'I sold RM20 of bracelets!' feels like success. But if the beads cost RM15, you only actually *made* RM5. The money that comes in is 'revenue'; the money you keep after costs is 'profit'. Only profit is real earnings.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A lemonade stand takes RM30 in sales — sounds great. But lemons, cups, and sugar cost RM22. Real profit: RM8. The RM30 was never the real number.

03 APPLY IT

Think of your Q1 venture (or a realistic one). Write down the revenue — all the money that came in.

04 REFLECT

Before counting costs, how much did you *feel* you made? Hold that number — it might change.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Explain 'revenue vs profit' to a parent in your own words and check you've got it right.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach a friend why 'I sold RM50!' doesn't mean 'I made RM50'.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The numbers are yours to gather from your real venture — a computer doesn't know what you actually sold. Do the counting yourself.

You'll need: Revenue tracking card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Revenue is listed and the child can define revenue vs profit.

2 Count your costs

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Costs are everything that went in: materials, packaging, even a share of things you reused. Beginners forget the small costs and think they made more than they did. A real count includes all of it.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

For the bracelets: beads RM15, string RM3, little bags RM2. That's RM20 of costs — easy to forget the string and bags and overcount your profit by RM5.

03 APPLY IT

List every cost that went into your venture — the obvious ones and the easy-to-forget small ones. Add them up.

04 REFLECT

Which cost did you almost forget? Those hidden costs are exactly what trip people up.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your cost list to a parent and ask what you might have missed.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show someone how forgetting a small cost makes you think you made more than you did.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You might ask AI to help you think of cost categories you forgot — a fair prompt. But the real amounts come from your real venture.

You’ll need: Cost checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A full cost list (including small/hidden costs) is totalled.

Unlocks after: Money in isn't money made

3 Work out your profit

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Now the moment of truth: profit = revenue − costs. This one subtraction tells you whether your venture actually made money. Sometimes the answer is a happy surprise; sometimes it's a useful shock.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Revenue RM30, costs RM20, profit RM10. Or maybe revenue RM30, costs RM32 — a loss of RM2! Either way, now you *know*, instead of guessing.

03 APPLY IT

Subtract your total costs from your revenue. Write down your real profit (or loss).

04 REFLECT

Was your real profit higher or lower than you felt in lesson 1? What surprised you?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your full calculation to a parent and check the maths is right.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk someone through the profit = revenue − costs calculation with your real numbers.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Do this subtraction yourself — it's simple and it's *your* money. Understanding your own number matters more than any tool doing it for you.

You'll need: Profit calculation sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Profit (or loss) is correctly calculated from real numbers.

Unlocks after: Count your costs

4 What does it mean?

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

A profit number is only useful if you act on it. Low or negative profit? You have three real levers: raise the price, cut a cost, or change what you make. Deciding which to pull is real business thinking.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Profit was only RM2 per bracelet. Options: raise price from RM5 to RM7, find cheaper beads, or make a fancier bracelet people happily pay more for. You pick the lever that fits.

03 APPLY IT

Based on your profit, choose one lever — raise price, cut a cost, or change the product — and write why.

04 REFLECT

Which lever felt right for your venture? What would you expect it to do to your profit?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Talk your chosen lever over with a parent or mentor. Would they pull the same one?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach someone the three levers for improving profit and when to use each.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you think through options, but the decision depends on your real venture and your judgement — you're the one who knows your customers and your costs.

You'll need: Profit-lever decision card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ One improvement lever is chosen based on the real profit.
- ☐ The child can explain why that lever fits their venture.

Unlocks after: Work out your profit

CREATE WEALTH · Q3

Get Customers

cw-11-12-q3 · supporting: Communicate, Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can grasp that a venture has to reach people who don't already know them — the basics of marketing: who exactly is your customer, where are they, what's your message, and does one real attempt to reach them work. This steps up from selling to friends and family, and prepares them to bring real customers to the year-end launch. Keep every channel safe and adult-approved.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is reaching new people who become real customers — growing a venture beyond the people who already love you. It's the discovery that a good thing doesn't sell itself; you have to reach the right people with the right message.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child tries to win a customer who isn't a friend or relative — a real stranger choosing their thing because the message reached them. That first 'cold' yes is a genuine thrill and a real stake, and the feedback loop (did the message work?) makes marketing feel like a solvable puzzle rather than luck.

THE ARTIFACT

A simple marketing plan tried for real: a defined customer, a chosen channel, a clear message, and the recorded result of one real attempt to reach new people.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child defined a specific customer rather than 'everyone'.
- They wrote a clear message/offer and chose one safe channel to try it.
- They made one real attempt to reach new people and recorded what happened.

Unlocks after: Did You Actually Make Money?

1 Who exactly is your customer?

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

'Everyone' is not a customer. The clearer you are about *who* your thing is for, the easier it is to reach them and speak to them. A specific customer is a marketing superpower.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Bookmarks for everyone' is hard to sell. 'Cute bookmarks for kids in my school who love reading' tells you exactly who to reach and what to say. Specific wins.

03 APPLY IT

Describe your ideal customer in one specific sentence — age, interest, what they'd want it for.

04 REFLECT

Is your customer specific enough that you could picture three real people who fit? If not, narrow it.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Run your customer description past a parent — is it specific or still too broad?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend why 'everyone' is a weak answer to 'who's your customer?'

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You know your real community and who'd want your thing — that's yours to define. AI guessing 'your customer' can't match your on-the-ground knowledge.

You'll need: Customer-definition card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A specific customer is defined in one sentence.

2 Where are they, and what's your message?

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

To reach your customer you need two things: a channel (where they'll see you — a noticeboard, a family group, a safe class chat) and a clear message (why they'd want your thing, in a line or two). Right place plus right words equals reach.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Channel: the class reading-club board. Message: 'Handmade bookmarks that keep your page and look great — RM2, from a fellow book-lover.' It reaches the right people with the right pitch.

03 APPLY IT

Pick one safe, adult-approved channel where your customer will see you, and write a clear one- or two-line message.

04 REFLECT

Does your message speak to what your specific customer cares about? Generic messages get ignored.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your channel and message to a parent for approval and a clarity check.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why the right channel matters as much as the right message.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you polish your message wording. But keep it honest and true to your thing — and a grown-up must approve any channel where you'll post publicly.

You'll need: Channel + message worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A safe channel and a clear message are chosen and approved.

Unlocks after: Who exactly is your customer?

3 Try one channel for real

~25 min

01 CONCEPT

Now actually do it — post the message, put up the flyer, make the announcement (safely, with adult okay). One real attempt teaches you more than endless planning. You're finding out if your message reaches real new people.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

You put your approved bookmark message on the reading-club board with a few samples. Now you wait and watch — do new people, not just friends, come and ask?

03 APPLY IT

Make one real, adult-approved attempt to reach new customers through your channel. Then watch for responses.

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to put your thing out to people who don't know you? A bit nervous is normal and good.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Check in with a parent about how the attempt went and whether it was safe and appropriate.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone about your real marketing attempt and what you did.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The real-world attempt is yours to make (with adult approval) — no tool can reach your real community for you. This is real action, not a simulation.

You'll need: Attempt log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] One real, safe attempt to reach new customers was made.

Unlocks after: Where are they, and what's your message?

4 Did it work?

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Measure the result: how many new people noticed, asked, or bought? Whatever the number, it's data. If it worked, do more of it. If not, change the message or the channel — that's marketing, a loop of try, measure, adjust.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Three new people asked and one bought — so the board works, but maybe the price note wasn't clear. Next time you make the price bigger. The result told you exactly what to tweak.

03 APPLY IT

Count the response to your attempt. Write down one thing that worked and one thing to change next time.

04 REFLECT

What did this real attempt teach you that guessing never could? Marketing is learned by trying.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Share your result and your next-time change with a parent or mentor.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach someone the marketing loop: define customer, pick channel, try, measure, adjust.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Judge your real results honestly — a small real response beats an imagined big one. Trust what actually happened over any optimistic guess.

You'll need: Result + adjust card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The result of the attempt was measured.
- ☐ One thing that worked and one change for next time were identified.

Unlocks after: Try one channel for real

CREATE WEALTH · Q4

Run the Launch

cw-11-12-q4 · supporting: Communicate, Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Wealth runs the live launch. At 11–12 a child can bring together pricing (Q1), profit (Q2), and getting customers (Q3) in one real event: set the price, sell to real people including new ones, track the full revenue-cost-profit picture, and measure against the goal. As the final project of the young cohort, it closes with a reflection on the whole two-year journey from 'make and share' to 'run a launch'.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is running a genuine launch — hitting the goal (or learning exactly why not) and knowing the real profit. It's the complete wealth arc made real: price, sell, reach new customers, and read the true numbers, all in one day that the whole two years built toward.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child runs a real launch with real customers, real money, and a real goal to hit. The stakes are exciting and safe: an actual till, actual new customers won by their promotion, an actual profit to calculate. Nothing makes two years of wealth lessons click like a live launch with a scoreboard at the end.

THE ARTIFACT

The launch run with real sales (including new customers), a full revenue-cost-profit calculation measured against the goal, and a written reflection on the two-year journey.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child set a price and ran a real launch to real customers.
- They tracked revenue, costs, and profit, and compared the result to their goal.
- They reflected on their growth across the whole 9–12 journey.

Unlocks after: Get Customers, Plan the Launch

1 Set price and confirm the goal

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

Set your launch price using everything you know — it must cover costs and leave real profit (Q2), while staying fair to customers (Q1). Then confirm your measurable goal so you'll know, by day's end, whether you hit it.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Snacks cost RM0.80 each to make; you price at RM2, leaving RM1.20 profit each. Goal: 10 sold = RM12 profit. Price set, goal locked, scoreboard ready.

03 APPLY IT

Set your final price (covering costs plus profit) and write your target number for the day.

04 REFLECT

Does your price leave real profit after all costs? Recheck against your Q2 profit thinking.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Confirm your price and goal with a parent or mentor before launch.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone how you set a price that's both fair and profitable.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Your price rests on your real costs and customers — your judgement. Do the profit maths yourself so you truly own the number.

You'll need: Price + goal confirmation card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A profitable, fair price and a target number are set.

2 Run the launch

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Launch day: sell to real customers, including new ones your promotion brought in. Be friendly, deliver your pitch, handle money carefully, and give every customer the quality you promised. This is the whole venture, live.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Customers arrive — some friends, some strangers who saw your promo. You pitch, they buy, you hand over the product and the change. A real business, running, with you at the helm.

03 APPLY IT

Run your launch: sell to real customers, use your pitch, and handle the money carefully (with adult support).

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to sell to strangers, not just friends? What was harder or easier than expected?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Notice which customers came from your promotion versus who you already knew. That tells you if marketing worked.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone the story of a sale to a brand-new customer at your launch.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Running a real launch with real customers and money is fully human and needs adult support for safety. This is your moment — no tool runs it for you.

You'll need: Money float · Sales record sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The launch was run and sales made to real customers, including new ones.

Unlocks after: Set price and confirm the goal

3 Track revenue, costs, and profit

~20 min

01 CONCEPT

After the launch, do the full picture: total revenue in, all costs out, and real profit (revenue − costs). This is the true scoreboard of your launch — the honest number behind the busy, fun day.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Revenue: 11 sold at RM2 = RM22. Costs: RM9 of ingredients and packaging. Real profit: RM13. Now you know exactly how the launch really did.

03 APPLY IT

Calculate your launch's total revenue, total costs, and real profit.

04 REFLECT

Was the real profit more or less than it felt like during the busy day? The numbers tell the truth.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your full revenue-cost-profit calculation to a parent and check the maths.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk someone through your launch's real profit using your numbers.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Do your own launch maths — understanding your real numbers is the whole wealth skill. A tool doing it for you skips the learning.

You'll need: Launch P&L sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Real revenue, costs, and profit for the launch are correctly calculated.

Unlocks after: Run the launch

4 Did you hit the goal? And look back

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Compare your result to your goal — hit, missed, or beat it, each teaches something. Then look back across two whole years: from making and sharing at 9, to researching, building for strangers, and running a real launch now. That's a remarkable distance.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Goal was RM12 profit; you made RM13 — beaten! And two years ago you were nervously offering a bookmark to a neighbour. Now you research, build, pitch, and launch. That growth is the real prize.

03 APPLY IT

Compare your profit to your goal and note why. Then write your proudest moment and biggest lesson from the whole 9–12 journey.

04 REFLECT

Across two years — thinking, communicating, building, creating value — what changed most in what you can do and dare to try?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Sit with a parent or mentor and share your goal result and your two-year reflection.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone the story of your whole journey, ending with launch day.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Whether you hit the goal, and what you're proud of, are honestly yours to judge and tell. This is your journey — own it in your own words.

You'll need: Goal-vs-result card · Two-year reflection sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The result was compared to the goal with a reason.
- ☐ The child reflected on their growth across the whole 9–12 journey.

Unlocks after: Track revenue, costs, and profit

Ages 13-14

THINK · Q1

A Case for a Change

th-13-14-q1 · supporting: Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, abstract reasoning is genuinely coming online: a teen can hold a hypothetical, argue a position they don't hold, and reason about their own reasoning — but unevenly, and with a catch: their ego is now fused to their opinions, so being wrong feels like a status injury. They crave being taken seriously by adults and can detect adult inauthenticity instantly. They can sustain a multi-week project if the payoff is visible and the stakes are theirs. The capability to separate a claim from the person making it exists at this age — but only if it's exercised deliberately.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At 13–14, 'creating value' with your thinking means **being taken seriously enough that a real decision changes**. Not winning a debate trophy — earning a real concession from the adult world because your case was genuinely good. The currency is trust and expanded autonomy, which is exactly what a 13-year-old wants most and can now legitimately earn.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The quarter's artifact is a written case for a real change the teen actually wants — a later curfew, a new privilege, a purchase, a change to a family or school rule — argued in person to the person who can actually grant it, with an agreement up front that the decision will be made on the strength of the case. The stakes are the teen's own autonomy: the single most motivating currency at this age. No adult needs to nag; wanting the change does the work.

THE ARTIFACT

A one-page written case brief for a real change the teen wants — the claim, evidence with fair baselines, the strongest version of the opposing side with their answer to it, and a small testable ask — argued in person to the real decision-maker, with the verdict and its reasons recorded at the bottom.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A one-page written case exists containing a claim, compared-to-what evidence, a steelman of the other side, and a small testable ask.
- The decision-maker confirmed, out loud, that the written steelman states their real concerns fairly.
- The case was presented in person and a real decision — yes, no, or trial — was received with reasons.
- The teen can name what evidence would change their own mind.

1 Claim or evidence?

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

A claim is what someone *says* is true. Evidence is what they can *show*. Most arguments — including yours — fail because the two get blended. The first move of a strong thinker is the split: what exactly is being claimed, what has actually been shown, and how big is the gap between them.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Everyone in my year has a phone' is a claim. A count of your actual class — 19 of 27 own one — is evidence. Ads and headlines are usually claims wearing evidence costumes: 'studies show' with no study named is still just a claim in a lab coat.

03 APPLY IT

Choose the real change you'll argue for this quarter and write your main claim in one sentence. Then split everything you'd say for it into two columns: what you can currently SHOW versus what you're merely SAYING. The 'saying' column is your evidence-hunting to-do list.

04 REFLECT

Which items in your 'show' column turned out to be just claims when you looked hard at them? Why did they *feel* like evidence?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your two columns to an adult and ask them to attack your weakest piece of evidence. Note which one fell first — that's where your case needs work.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Take one headline or ad this week and teach the split to a family member: what's claimed, what's shown, what's the gap. Then have them do the next one on their own while you coach.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Do the split with your own head first — the split IS the skill, and outsourcing it trains nothing. Afterwards, AI is useful for *hunting* evidence to fill your gaps. But treat every number and fact it gives you as a claim until you've seen the source yourself: AI is a fast librarian, not a witness.

You'll need: Claim/evidence split sheet (show vs. say columns)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The chosen change is written as a one-sentence claim.
- ☐ A written show-vs-say split exists with at least three real evidence gaps identified.

2 Find the hidden assumption

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Every argument stands on things nobody said out loud. 'I should get a later curfew because I'm 13 now' silently assumes that age alone earns trust. Find the load-bearing assumption and you know exactly where an argument will crack — including your own.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A shop sign says '9 out of 10 customers recommend us.' Hidden assumption: the ten people asked were typical customers — maybe they only asked the happy ones. Companies, politicians, and teenagers all lean on hidden assumptions; the person who can *name* them controls the conversation.

03 APPLY IT

Write your case's core argument in two or three sentences. Then list every assumption it needs to be true — aim for at least three. Mark the load-bearing one: the assumption that, if false, kills the whole case. Write one line on how you'll support it.

04 REFLECT

Which assumption was hardest to spot? What does that suggest about the assumptions hiding in arguments you already *agree* with?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Without showing your list, ask your decision-maker what they think your argument assumes. Compare their list with yours — theirs is a preview of the objections your case will face.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach a friend or sibling the assumption hunt using an ad or a school rule: have them find what it silently assumes, and don't help until they've found at least one alone.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

List your assumptions unaided first. *Then*, if you like, ask an AI to list the assumptions in your argument and compare — if it found one you missed, ask yourself why you missed it. Never run it the other way round: reading the machine's list first blinds you to your own blind spots, and spotting your own is the entire skill.

You'll need: Assumption-hunt worksheet (argument + 3 assumptions + load-bearing mark)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The case's argument is written with at least three named assumptions.
- ☐ The load-bearing assumption is marked with a plan to support it.

Unlocks after: Claim or evidence?

3 Compared to what?

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

A number on its own is a mood; a comparison is information. 'I'm on my phone three hours a day' — is that a lot? Compared to your classmates? To last year? To time spent on homework? Strong thinkers refuse naked numbers: they always demand the baseline.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A game boasts 'over 1 million downloads!' Compared to what? The biggest games have hundreds of millions, so a million might mean tiny. '50% more effective!' — than what, than doing nothing? The comparison carries the meaning; the number is just decoration.

03 APPLY IT

Find the two or three numbers your case actually turns on (sleep, screen time, cost, marks — whatever your change touches). For each, find a *fair* baseline and rewrite the naked number as a comparison sentence for your brief.

04 REFLECT

Did any honest comparison turn out to hurt your case? What's the stronger move — hiding it, or addressing it head-on before the decision-maker finds it themselves?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your comparison sentences to someone good with numbers and ask one question: is each baseline fair, or did I pick the one that flatters me?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Next time someone quotes a number at dinner or in the group chat, ask 'compared to what?' out loud — then walk them through how the baseline changes what the number means.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a genuinely good AI use: finding baselines fast ('what's the average screen time for 13-year-olds?'). But a confident number without a source is a rumor. Get the source, check it exists, and check it says what the AI said it says. If you can't verify it, it doesn't go in your brief — one fake number and your whole case loses its credibility.

You'll need: Compared-to-what table (number / baseline / comparison sentence)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every number in the case is written as a comparison against a named, checkable baseline.
- [ ] At least one comparison that does not flatter the case is included and addressed.

Unlocks after: Find the hidden assumption

4 Steelman the other side

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

A strawman is the weakest version of the other side; a steelman is the strongest. Beating a strawman convinces nobody — least of all your parents. If you can state their side so well they say 'yes, that's exactly my worry', you've earned the right to answer it. That's the move that changes minds.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Lawyers prepare the other side's case before their own. Chess players study the opponent's *best* move, not the worst one. The teen who opens with 'here's the strongest reason you'd say no — and here's my answer to it' sounds ten years older than the one who pretends there's no reason at all.

03 APPLY IT

Write the case *against* your change as if you believed it: the real worries — safety, sleep, cost, trust — at full strength, about half a page. Then write your honest answer to its single strongest point.

04 REFLECT

While writing the other side, did any of their points start to feel… right? What did that do to your own case — weaken it, or make it more honest?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Read *only* the steelman to your decision-maker and ask: did I miss a reason, or state one too weakly? Revise until they say 'that's fair' out loud. That sentence is your green light.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Find a disagreement a friend is stuck in and coach them to state the other person's side at full strength before responding. Watch what it does to the temperature of the argument — then explain to them why it works.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

First draft unaided: if you can't voice the other side without a screen, you don't understand it yet. *After* that, AI makes an excellent sparring partner — 'argue against my case as hard as you can' — to find angles you missed. Use it to pressure-test your steelman, never to outsource the understanding itself.

You'll need: Steelman worksheet (their side at full strength / your answer)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A written steelman of about half a page exists, plus an answer to its strongest point.
- ☐ The decision-maker said 'that's fair' (or equivalent) to the steelman after revision.

Unlocks after: Compared to what?

5 Make the case — for real

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Thinking that never meets a decision is just practice; thinking that gets a verdict is real. Assemble the one-page brief: claim, evidence with baselines, the steelman and your answer, and — the closer — a *small, testable ask*: not 'forever', but 'a three-week trial with a review'. Small reversible asks are how good cases win.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

In real companies, big changes get pitched as small experiments: 'try it for a month, measure, then decide.' A trial with a review date is far easier to grant than a permanent change — and if your case is good, the trial itself does the rest of the arguing for you.

03 APPLY IT

Assemble your one-page case brief from lessons 1–4 and present it in person. Propose the trial version of your ask. Get an actual decision — yes, no, or trial — and write their reasons at the bottom of the brief.

04 REFLECT

Whatever the verdict: which part of your case did the most work, and which did nothing? And the thinker's question — what evidence would change *your* mind about your own ask?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Debrief the decision-maker afterwards: what nearly changed their mind, and what actually did (or would have)? Add their answer to the brief as a note to your future self.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the whole method — claim, evidence, assumptions, compared-to-what, steelman, small ask — to a friend who wants something from *their* parents, and help them draft their own one-pager. If your friend's case wins, you've really learned it.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The brief must be in your own words — a parent can smell generated text a mile away, and it costs you the exact trust you're trying to earn. The legitimate use: hand AI your *finished* draft and ask 'what's the weakest point in this case?' — then fix it yourself. If AI writes the case, you didn't make it; you just delivered someone else's.

You'll need: One-page case brief template (claim / evidence / steelman / ask / verdict)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A completed one-page brief exists and was presented in person.
- ☐ A real decision with stated reasons is recorded on the brief.

Unlocks after: Steelman the other side

THINK · Q2

The Decision Journal

th-13-14-q2 · supporting: Live Well

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, teens start making decisions with real consequences — how to spend money they earned, which commitments to take on, what to quit — but their forecasting is untrained: they overweight the vivid outcome, underweight the likely one, and rarely notice the option they didn't consider. The equipment for better deciding is present: they can hold multiple hypotheticals, imagine futures, and reflect on their own past calls. What's missing is a *practice* — and this is the age where one can be installed.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At 13–14, thinking creates value when it produces **decisions the teen can stand behind** — made with named options, honest odds, and a written prediction that reality later gets to grade. The value isn't being right every time; it's becoming someone whose calls visibly improve, which is what earns a teen bigger decisions to make.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The whole quarter runs on the teen's own real decisions — what to buy, join, quit, or build — not exercises. The deal that powers it: decisions worked through the journal are the teen's to make. Owning real calls, and getting visibly better at them, is the autonomy a 13-year-old is negotiating for everywhere; here it's the explicit reward for thinking well.

THE ARTIFACT

A decision journal containing at least five real decisions, each with named options, a one-way/two-way door label, best/worst/likely outcomes, the opportunity cost, and a written prediction — plus review entries where at least two predictions were graded against what actually happened.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The journal contains five real decisions with options, door type, outcomes, and predictions written before deciding.
- At least two decisions were reviewed later, with the prediction honestly graded against reality.
- The teen can explain one thing their reviews taught them about their own predicting.

Unlocks after: A Case for a Change

1 Name your real options

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Most bad decisions aren't bad choices between options — they're choices made before all the options were on the table. There are almost always more than two, and one is invisible: *do nothing*, which is also a choice. The first move: list at least three real options, including the default you'd drift into.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Should I buy the new console or not?' feels like two options. Written out, it's at least five: buy now, wait for the price drop, buy used, put the money toward something else entirely, or do nothing and keep saving. The best option is often one that wasn't in the original question.

03 APPLY IT

Start your decision journal. Take one real decision you're facing now and write at least three genuine options — including the do-nothing default. Star any option you hadn't consciously considered before writing.

04 REFLECT

Was the option you were leaning toward before the list still the best one after it? What does that tell you about deciding inside your head versus on paper?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your option list to someone who knows the situation and ask: 'what option am I missing?' Add whatever they find — the exercise works even when their option is bad, because now you chose against it consciously.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Next time a friend says 'should I do X or not?', teach them the three-options rule and help them find the hidden third option. Watch how often it changes the decision.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Write your own option list first — noticing options is the muscle. *Then* AI is a fair prompt-partner: 'what options might someone be missing here?' If it surfaces one you missed, add it and note that you missed it — that's calibration data about your own blind spots. What AI must never do is pick for you: the choosing is the entire point.

You'll need: Decision journal template (options / door / outcomes / prediction / review)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A journal entry exists with three or more real options including the do-nothing default.
- ☐ One option was added or starred that wasn't considered before writing.

2 One-way doors and two-way doors

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Some decisions are two-way doors — walk through, dislike it, walk back (join a club, try a price, change a hairstyle). Some are one-way — hard or impossible to undo (quit the team mid-season, post something public, spend all your savings). The rule that saves years: decide *fast* on two-way doors and *slow* on one-way doors. Most people do the opposite.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Agonising for three weeks over which free app to try is slow-deciding a two-way door — you could have tried all three in an afternoon. Impulse-posting an angry message in the group chat is fast-deciding a one-way door: the delete button doesn't unsend what forty people saw.

03 APPLY IT

Label every decision currently in your journal as a one-way or two-way door, with one line on why. Then add one real decision you've been overthinking: if it's a two-way door, decide it *today* and write down what walking it back would cost if you're wrong.

04 REFLECT

Which do you naturally do — agonise over reversible things, or rush irreversible ones? What's one one-way door you walked through this year without noticing it was one?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask a parent about a one-way door they rushed and a two-way door they overthought. Compare their patterns with yours — the mislabeling habit runs in families.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the door test to a sibling or friend with a decision on their plate: have them label it, then apply the rule — fast if two-way, slow if one-way. Make sure they can explain *why* the speed should differ.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The door label is a judgment about *your* life — how reversible something is depends on your money, your school, your family — so label it yourself. One good AI use: for a one-way door, ask 'what would make this harder to reverse than it looks?' Hidden one-way-ness is exactly the thing worth a second set of eyes. For two-way doors, skip the AI entirely: just decide.

You'll need: Door-label column in the journal

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Every journal entry carries a door label with a reason.
- ☐ One overthought two-way door was decided the same day.

Unlocks after: Name your real options

3 Best case, worst case, likely case

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Untrained deciding runs on the most *vivid* outcome — the daydream or the disaster. Trained deciding writes three: best case, worst case, and the boring likely case. Then it asks the two questions that matter: can I live with the worst case, and am I choosing based on the likely one — or just the shiniest one?

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Spending your savings on concert tickets to resell: best case, double your money. Worst case, the show flops and you lose most of it. Likely case, you make a little after fees and stress. The daydream sells the plan; the likely case is what you'll actually get — and the worst case is what you have to be able to afford.

03 APPLY IT

For two live decisions in your journal, write all three cases, then mark how likely each feels (a rough percentage is fine). Answer in writing: can I live with the worst case? Am I deciding on the likely case or the best case?

04 REFLECT

For which decision were the best case and the likely case furthest apart? What was making the best case feel more real than it deserved?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your three cases to someone with more experience of that kind of decision. Ask one question: 'is my likely case actually likely?' Adjust, and note how far off you were.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

When someone near you is excited about a plan, ask them for their three cases out loud — kindly. Teach them the 'can you live with the worst case?' question and watch it either sober the plan or strengthen it.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Write your three cases and your percentages *before* asking anything — your untrained guess is the thing being trained. Then AI is a decent reality-checker: 'what do people usually underestimate about doing X?' If its answer moves your likely case, move it — but the percentages stay yours, because in the review lesson it's *your* calibration being graded, and borrowed numbers grade nothing.

You'll need: Three-cases section in the journal

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Two decisions have written best/worst/likely cases with rough likelihoods.
- ☐ The 'can I live with the worst case?' question is answered in writing for both.

Unlocks after: One-way doors and two-way doors

4 Every yes is a no

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Every choice spends something — money, time, energy — that can't also be spent elsewhere. The real cost of a decision isn't its price tag; it's the *best thing you gave up* to make it. Thinkers call it opportunity cost. Until you can name what your yes is saying no to, you don't know what the decision costs.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Saying yes to a Saturday job pays RM40 a week. It also says no to the Saturday football league — and if football is where your closest friends are, the job's real price includes that. It might still be worth it. But 'worth it compared to *what*' is the only honest version of the question.

03 APPLY IT

For each live decision in your journal, add a line: 'this yes is a no to ___' — the best real alternative use of the same time or money. If you can't name one, look harder: the no is always there.

04 REFLECT

Which of your yeses had the most expensive hidden no? Have you ever made a choice that felt free but quietly cost you something you cared about?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Trade journals (or just one decision) with a friend doing the same exercise, and try to spot each other's hidden nos. Other people see your trade-offs more clearly than you do.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain opportunity cost to a younger sibling using their pocket money: the sweets they buy are also the game they're not saving for. Keep going until they can produce their own example.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Naming what *you'd* otherwise do with the time or money requires knowing your own life — that part can't be delegated. Where AI helps is completeness: 'what do people typically give up when they take on X?' can surface a category you forgot (sleep is the classic). Take the category; fill in the specifics yourself.

You'll need: 'This yes is a no to' column in the journal

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Every live decision in the journal names its opportunity cost.
- ☐ The teen can say aloud which yes had the most expensive hidden no.

Unlocks after: Best case, worst case, likely case

5 Predict, decide, review

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Here's what separates people who get better at deciding from people who just get older: they write the prediction down *before* deciding, and they come back and grade it. Memory rewrites history — 'I knew it all along' — but the journal doesn't. Predict, decide, review. Run that loop for a year and your judgment compounds like savings.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Poker players and fund managers keep decision journals for exactly this reason: they can't trust their memory of what they believed before the outcome. One teen's review showed she rated things '90% sure' that happened about half the time — one page of reviews taught her more about her own overconfidence than a year of being told.

03 APPLY IT

Finish the loop: make sure all five decisions carry written predictions, then review at least two whose outcomes have arrived. Grade each honestly — what did I predict, what happened, what did I miss — and write one sentence on the pattern your misses share.

04 REFLECT

Were your predictions too confident, too timid, or blind in one particular direction? What will you check for in your *next* decision because of what the reviews showed?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Walk your decision-maker (a parent works well) through one full journal entry — options, door, cases, cost, prediction, review. Ask them: 'based on this, is there a decision you'd now trust me to make alone?' That answer is the quarter's real payoff.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Set up a decision journal for a friend or sibling: template, first entry, and a review date in their calendar. Teach them the line 'memory rewrites history; the journal doesn't' — if they're still reviewing a month later, you taught it well.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The predictions and the grading must be yours — calibration is a measurement of *your* head, and letting AI write either side breaks the instrument. After several reviews, one genuinely good use: paste in your misses (just the predictions and outcomes) and ask 'what pattern do you see?' A pattern-spotter on your own honest data is AI at its best; a ghost-writer for your judgment is AI at its worst.

You'll need: Review pages in the journal + a calendar reminder for review dates

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Five decisions carry pre-decision predictions; at least two are reviewed and graded.
- ☐ One written sentence names the pattern in the teen's prediction misses.

Unlocks after: Every yes is a no

THINK · Q3

Find the Real Bottleneck

th-13-14-q3 · supporting: Build

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, a teen can finally think about *systems* — not just events but the loops and flows behind them: why cramming keeps happening, why the group chat always derails, why their venture's Saturdays feel chaotic. Younger children see a bad grade; this age can see the study-system that produced it. What's still hard is resisting the flashy fix: teens (like most adults) instinctively fix the most *visible* part of a system rather than the part that's actually setting the pace.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, thinking creates value when it **fixes the cause instead of the symptom** — one intervention at the right point that makes a whole routine, team, or venture measurably better, instead of ten effortful fixes that change nothing. A teen who has once found a real bottleneck and felt the whole system speed up owns a way of seeing that most people never acquire.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The quarter has a magic-trick payoff: map a system you're stuck in, find the one constraint, change *only that*, and watch a measured number move while everything you didn't touch improves anyway. That feeling — small lever, big result, proven by your own before/after numbers — is the purest mastery hit thinking can deliver, and it makes the skill self-reinforcing.

THE ARTIFACT

A one-page map of a real system the teen lives in (their study routine, morning routine, team process, or their venture's order-to-delivery flow), with the bottleneck identified and defended, one fix applied at the bottleneck only, and a before/after measurement showing what it did.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A drawn system map exists with parts, flows, and at least one feedback loop labelled.
- The claimed bottleneck is written down with the evidence for why it — and not the noisiest part — sets the system's pace.
- One fix was applied at the bottleneck and a before/after measurement of the whole system's output exists.
- The teen can explain why fixing a non-bottleneck wouldn't have helped, using their own map.

Unlocks after: The Decision Journal

1 See the system, not the event

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

An event is what happened; a system is the machine that keeps making it happen. 'I got a bad mark' is an event. The system is: when homework lands, where it gets written down, when studying actually starts, what interrupts it, and how tiredness feeds back into all of it. Events invite blame; systems invite fixes. The first skill is drawing the machine.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen kept 'forgetting' homework. Drawn as a system: assignments announced in six places → some never reach the planner → the missing ones surface at 9pm → panic work → late night → tired morning → worse notes → more missing assignments. Nobody in that loop is lazy. The *system* forgets — and you can't fix a system you haven't drawn.

03 APPLY IT

Pick a real system you're stuck in — study routine, mornings, your venture's order-to-delivery, a team's weekly chaos. Draw it: the stages as boxes, the flows between them as arrows, and where things pile up or vanish. Ugly is fine; complete matters.

04 REFLECT

Drawing it, where were you tempted to write a person's name as the problem? What changes when you replace 'I'm lazy' or 'he's annoying' with a box and an arrow?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the map to someone else inside the same system. Ask: 'what did I leave out?' Insiders always find a missing arrow — usually the embarrassing one. Add it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach someone the event-versus-system distinction using their own recurring annoyance ('I'm always late', 'we always argue about dishes'). Help them draw their machine — stop before suggesting any fix. Seeing precedes fixing.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The map must come from your own observation — AI has never seen your mornings or your market stall, and a generic 'study system' diagram will be neat, plausible, and wrong. After you've drawn yours, one fair use: describe the system in words and ask 'what stage or flow might I be missing?' Treat its suggestions as questions to check against reality, not additions to paste in.

You'll need: System-mapping sheet (boxes / arrows / pile-up marks)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A drawn map of a real system exists with stages, flows, and pile-up points marked.
- ☐ One missing piece found by an insider was added.

2 Spot the loops

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Systems don't run in straight lines — they loop. Some loops spiral things worse (tired → cram → sleep late → more tired). Some compound things better (small win → confidence → more practice → bigger win). Loops are why systems resist one-off fixes: push once and the loop pulls everything back. Find the loops in your map and you've found the system's engine room.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen's bracelet stall had a vicious loop: rushed making → uneven quality → fewer repeat buyers → lower takings → more rush to compensate. Her friend's study system hid a virtuous one: revising with a friend → slightly better marks → parents extend screen time → happier revision → better marks. Neither teen had noticed the loop pushing them — loops are engines that don't announce themselves.

03 APPLY IT

Find at least two loops touching your mapped system — one that makes things worse, one that makes things better (it may be small or only occasional). Draw them as circles of arrows on the map and label each 'vicious' or 'virtuous', with one line on what keeps each loop spinning.

04 REFLECT

Which loop has been running your system without your permission? If you could feed one loop and starve the other, which single arrow would you touch first?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Explain your two loops to an adult and ask them to name one loop — vicious or virtuous — running in *their* work or household. Comparing loops across lives makes the pattern portable.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach a younger sibling what a vicious cycle is using something from their world (rushing homework → mistakes → redo → less time → more rushing). Then show them a virtuous one. If they can find a third on their own, it stuck.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Trace the loops yourself first, on paper, following your own arrows — the tracing is the skill being built. AI is decent at loop-spotting if you describe your map ('what feedback loops might exist here?'), and it may name one you missed; verify it against a real week before believing it. A loop that sounds logical but doesn't actually spin in your life is a story, not a system.

You'll need: Loop overlay on the system map (circles + vicious/virtuous labels)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Two loops are drawn on the map, labelled vicious/virtuous, each with what keeps it spinning.
- [ ] The teen can say which loop currently dominates the system.

Unlocks after: See the system, not the event

3 Find the bottleneck

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

In any system, one stage sets the pace for everything — the bottleneck. Speed up anything else and the system doesn't care; speed up the bottleneck and everything moves. The tells: work piles up *in front of* it, stages after it sit hungry, and it's where everyone quietly waits. The discipline is proving which stage it is — because the noisiest, most annoying stage usually isn't it.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

At a busy burger stand, the till has the longest queue — but watch: orders pile up at the *grill*. Hire a second cashier (the visible fix) and the queue just moves. The grill is the bottleneck; a second grill-cook is the fix that actually shortens everyone's wait. The queue lies about where the problem lives.

03 APPLY IT

Interrogate your map: where does work actually pile up? Which stage do other stages wait on? Name your bottleneck and write the evidence — real waits, real pile-ups from a real week, not vibes. Then write the decoy: the stage that *looks* like the problem but isn't, and how you know.

04 REFLECT

Was your bottleneck the stage you'd been complaining about? If not — how much effort have you already spent 'fixing' stages that were never setting the pace?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present bottleneck-plus-evidence to someone in the system and let them argue for a different stage. Defend yours with the pile-up evidence, or update — either way, the claim gets stress-tested before you spend a fix on it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Next time you're in any queue — canteen, checkout, traffic — bottleneck-spot out loud with whoever's next to you: where's the real constraint, and what's the decoy? Make it a game; the game installs the eye.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The bottleneck is an empirical fact about *your* system — it's found by watching where things pile up, and no model can watch for you. Where AI helps is the decoy trap: describe your system and your candidate bottleneck and ask 'what would have to be true for this to be wrong?' — then go check those things in reality. Diagnosis by observation, cross-examination by machine: that's the right division of labour.

You'll need: Bottleneck evidence card (claimed stage / pile-up evidence / the decoy)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A bottleneck is named with written pile-up/wait evidence from a real week.
- ☐ The decoy stage is identified with the reason it fooled (or nearly fooled) the teen.

Unlocks after: Spot the loops

4 Fix the constraint, only the constraint

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Now the discipline that separates system-thinkers from busy people: change *one thing, at the bottleneck, and nothing else*. Measure the whole system's output before and after — not effort, output. Fixing only the constraint feels lazy ('but I could also improve…'), which is exactly why almost nobody does it and why it works: every unit of effort lands where the system actually bends.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The homework teen's bottleneck was capture — assignments announced in six places, written down in none. Her one fix: a two-minute end-of-school ritual, checking all six places once, into one list. She changed nothing else — not her desk, not her app, not her 'discipline'. Late-night panics went from four a week to one. One fix, at the constraint, measured.

03 APPLY IT

Design the smallest fix that directly widens your bottleneck. Write the before-number first (this week's waits, pile-ups, late nights, orders delivered). Apply the fix for at least a week, touching nothing else. Record the after-number next to it.

04 REFLECT

What other 'improvements' did you have to resist making during the week — and why would making them have ruined the experiment even if they helped?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your before/after pair to the insider from lesson one. Ask: 'did you feel the difference, and where?' If the numbers moved but nobody felt it — or everyone felt it but the numbers didn't move — dig into which measure is lying.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell the story — map, loops, bottleneck, one fix, numbers — to your family in five minutes. The punchline to teach: 'I changed one thing and the whole system moved.' If they ask 'what one thing should I change about X?', teach them to map X first.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Choosing the fix is judgment built on your evidence — AI can suggest candidate fixes for a bottleneck you describe, and that's a fair idea-source, but it will suggest five and the discipline is picking *one small one* and holding the rest. Never let it talk you into a bundle: bundled fixes teach you nothing about which one worked. One change, one week, one number.

You'll need: Before/after card (before number / the one fix / after number)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ One fix was applied at the bottleneck with everything else deliberately held constant.
- ☐ A before/after measurement of system output exists spanning at least a week.

Unlocks after: Find the bottleneck

5 And then what?

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Every fix changes the system that receives it — so the final thinking move is the second-order question: *and then what?* Fix one bottleneck and the constraint moves somewhere new (widen the grill and the till really is next). Some fixes even feed a vicious loop you didn't price in. Thinking one move past your fix is what separates a good decision from a good-looking one — and it's the habit this whole pillar has been building toward.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A town added a lane to its jammed highway — and then what? Easier driving attracted more drivers; two years later, jammed again (planners call it induced demand). The homework teen asked it too: capture fixed — and then what? The new constraint became *starting* the work she now reliably knew about. Different bottleneck, same method. The method is the possession.

03 APPLY IT

For your applied fix, write the second-order forecast: where does the constraint move next? What new behaviour might your fix attract or excuse? Watch the system for another week and record what actually shifted — then update your map: new bottleneck, new loops if any.

04 REFLECT

Did the constraint move where you predicted? Looking at the updated map: is the next bottleneck worth fixing now, or is the system good enough — and how do you know when to stop optimising?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present the full arc — original map, fix, numbers, where the constraint moved — to your decision-maker or peer group. Ask them for one system in *their* life they'd want this done to; talking them through how you'd start is the final test.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach 'and then what?' as a two-word habit to a friend planning any fix or purchase: make them answer it three times in a row ('and then what? …and then what?'). Three rounds deep is where the interesting consequences live — and where your teaching either lands or doesn't.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Second-order forecasting is a genuinely strong AI use — 'here's my system and my fix: what knock-on effects might follow?' casts a wider net than any one head, and comparing its list against your own forecast trains you fast. The discipline that stays yours: writing *your* forecast first, and letting the real week — not the plausible list — decide what actually happened. Plausible and true are different species; the map only eats what reality confirms.

You'll need: Second-order forecast card + updated system map

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A written second-order forecast exists from before the follow-up week.
- ☐ The map is updated with where the constraint actually moved, compared against the forecast.

Unlocks after: Fix the constraint, only the constraint

THINK · Q4

Plan the Venture Month

th-13-14-q4 · supporting: Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

By the fourth quarter of this band, a teen has real assets: a venture with margins and a channel, a tool that runs without them, an audience that expects updates, and a year of decision, argument, and systems practice. At 13–14 they can genuinely plan a month — hold a goal, forecast capacity, imagine failure in advance — but planning discipline is new and fragile: the pull is always toward the exciting parts (the offer! the launch!) and away from the boring load-bearing ones (hours available, what could kill it). This quarter makes the boring parts the whole point.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, thinking creates value when it turns ambition into an **operable plan other people will bet on** — a month of real business, sized to real hours, with risks named before they arrive and a review rhythm that catches drift early. The plan's value is proven the moment a real adult reads it and signs off — not to be kind, but because the plan actually holds.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

This plan is not homework — it is the operating licence for the Venture Month, in which the teen's real offer runs at full rhythm with the family's real backing. A weak plan means a chaotic month with their name on it; a strong one means four weeks of running something real with everyone watching. The sign-off meeting at the end is a real gate: the month doesn't start until the plan earns it.

THE ARTIFACT

A one-page Venture Month operating plan: the goal and its one or two metrics, weekly targets, an honest capacity budget, a pre-mortem risk list with planned responses, the weekly review cadence on a calendar — presented to and signed off by the real decision-maker.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A one-page plan exists with a goal, one or two metrics, and weekly targets that add up to it.
- The capacity budget is honest: planned hours fit inside actually-available hours, shown against a real week.
- A pre-mortem list names at least five ways the month could fail, each with a planned response.
- The weekly review ritual is on the calendar, and the decision-maker signed the plan after hearing its risks — not just its hopes.

Unlocks after: Find the Real Bottleneck

1 Pick the goal and its number

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

A month of effort needs one goal and one or two numbers that measure it — no more. And the numbers come in two kinds: *result* numbers you can't directly control (profit, customers) and *input* numbers you fully control (asks made, batches produced, posts shipped). A strong plan sets a result goal and steers by input numbers — because you can always do the inputs, and the inputs are what move the result.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Have a great month' steers nothing. 'RM200 profit, steered by two inputs — 20 asks a week and the Tuesday/Friday channel routine' steers everything: any week the inputs happened and the result didn't, you learn something about the venture instead of about your mood.

03 APPLY IT

Write your Venture Month goal as one result number (profit, customers, or opt-ins — your venture's truth from the money picture). Choose one or two input numbers that most drive it, from your own Q2–Q3 data. Break the result into four weekly targets that actually add up.

04 REFLECT

Is your result number ambitious or safe — and which would teach you more? Why is 'I control the inputs, not the outcome' a calming thought rather than a depressing one?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show goal and numbers to a fellow builder or adult and ask: 'do these inputs actually drive this result, or are they just activity?' Adjust until the causal chain is defensible with your own data.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the result-versus-input distinction to a friend with any goal — grades, sport, savings — and help them find their two input numbers. It's the single most portable planning idea they'll ever get.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The goal must be sized from *your* real numbers — last quarter's margins and channel data — not from a model's idea of what a teen venture 'should' make. Fair use: describe your venture's numbers and ask 'is this weekly target consistent with this history?' — an arithmetic sanity check. The ambition level itself is yours to set; that's not a math question.

You'll need: Goal card (result number / input numbers / four weekly targets)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A result goal with one or two input metrics is written, grounded in the teen's own data.
- ☐ Four weekly targets exist that genuinely add up to the goal.

2 Pre-mortem: imagine it already failed

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

A post-mortem examines a failure after it happens; a *pre-mortem* does it in advance: 'It's a month from now and the Venture Month flopped — write the story of why.' The trick works because imagining the failure as already real unlocks honesty that optimism blocks. Every cause you write down now is a risk you get to answer *before* it's an emergency.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen's pre-mortem story surfaced what her planning had politely ignored: exam week landing mid-month (capacity crater), her one supplier going quiet (single point of failure — her Build quarter recognised it instantly), and rain on both market Saturdays. None were exotic. All were invisible until she wrote the failure story first.

03 APPLY IT

Write the failure story: half a page, past tense, 'here's why my Venture Month failed.' Mine it for at least five distinct risks. For each: label the door (one-way or two-way), rate likely × bad, and write the response — prevent it, prepare for it, or accept it consciously.

04 REFLECT

Which risk in your story embarrassed you to write down — and is that because it's unlikely, or because it's likely and you'd been avoiding it? What does the pre-mortem let you say that planning meetings don't?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Read your failure story to someone who knows your month (a parent knows exam week; a teammate knows the schedule). Ask: 'what did my story miss?' Their addition goes on the list with its own response.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Run a five-minute pre-mortem with a friend before anything they're planning — a trip, a tryout, an event. Teach the magic sentence: 'it's afterwards and it failed — tell me the story.' Watch how much truth the past tense unlocks.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Write your own failure story first — the pre-mortem's power is *your* honesty, and it surfaces the risks you already secretly know. Then AI earns its seat: 'here's my venture and my month; what failure causes might I be missing?' — machines are tireless pessimists, and a cause you missed is worth having (note that you missed it). The responses and the accept-decisions stay yours: it's your month, your hours, your risk appetite.

You'll need: Pre-mortem sheet (failure story / risks / door / likely×bad / response)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A written failure story exists and yielded five or more distinct risks.
- ☐ Every risk has a door label, a rating, and a written response.

Unlocks after: Pick the goal and its number

3 Budget the hours like money

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Plans fail on capacity more than on ideas. Hours are a budget exactly like money: count what a real week actually offers (after school, homework, sport, family, sleep), then 'spend' those hours on the month's work — production, selling, the routine, the review. If the plan needs more hours than the week has, the plan is fiction, and it's better to know now. Cut scope until it fits; a plan that fits is a plan that happens.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen's draft plan needed 14 hours a week. Her honest week-audit found 6, maybe 8 in a light week. The fix wasn't 'try harder' — it was scope: fewer product lines, batch production on Sunday, the channel routine kept (highest return per hour, said her own Q3 numbers), the new packaging idea dropped. The plan shrank; the odds of the month *happening* roughly doubled.

03 APPLY IT

Audit a real week: count truly available hours, honestly (your Q2 time-audit skills apply). Then cost each planned activity in hours per week and fit the plan inside the budget — cut or batch until it fits with about 20% slack for the unexpected. Mark your capacity bottleneck: the resource (a day, a helper, an oven, you) that caps everything.

04 REFLECT

What did you cut to make it fit — and why was that the right sacrifice? Where's the bottleneck, and does your plan protect it (your Q3 eye should twitch here)?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the hour budget to someone who shares your week (a parent, honestly, is ideal). Ask: 'which of these hours don't actually exist?' Families are ruthless and correct about this. Refit the plan with what survives.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach 'hours are a budget' to an overcommitted friend: audit their real week together, cost their commitments, and watch the fiction reveal itself. Then teach the punchline — cutting scope isn't giving up; it's how plans become real.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The hour-audit must come from your actual week — a model doesn't know about Thursday training or how long your homework really takes, and an agreeable AI will happily bless a fictional budget. Use it after the honest count: 'here's my budget and my activities — what am I under-costing?' (Everyone under-costs travel, setup, and replies.) The cuts are judgment calls about your own life; make them yourself, out loud.

You'll need: Hour budget sheet (available / planned per activity / slack / bottleneck)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real-week hour audit exists and the plan fits inside it with ~20% slack.
- ☐ The capacity bottleneck is named and the plan visibly protects it.

Unlocks after: Pre-mortem: imagine it already failed

4 Set the weekly review

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

A month is too long to steer blind — so the plan installs a rhythm: one fixed weekly review, twenty minutes, same day, three questions: *what happened* (the numbers versus target), *what did we learn* (from customers, incidents, misses), *what changes next week* (one change, not five). The review is where all your year's tools report for duty: the journal's predictions, the log's honesty, the bottleneck eye. Plans don't survive contact with reality; plans with reviews do.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Two teens ran venture months. One checked her numbers 'whenever' — and discovered in week four that week two had quietly broken her. The other held a Sunday review; in week two, seeing asks up but sales flat, changed one thing (the offer sentence), and weeks three and four paid for the whole month. Same effort. The rhythm was the difference.

03 APPLY IT

Design your review: the fixed day and time, the numbers checked (your goal card's metrics), the three questions, and where answers get written (the venture's journal). Put all four reviews in the calendar now. Then dry-run one review on last week's real data to prove the ritual takes twenty minutes, not ninety.

04 REFLECT

What's the realistic failure mode of your review — skipping it when the week went badly? Notice: that's the week it's worth the most. What will make it happen anyway (a shared slot with a parent is the classic answer)?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the ritual design to whoever will be nearby during the month and ask them to hold you to it — not to run it, just to ask 'did you review?' every week. Accountability for the rhythm, not the results.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the three-question review to a friend or your family for anything ongoing — a team season, a savings goal, a group project. Run their first one with them. The ritual is small enough to gift in fifteen minutes and big enough to change their year.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The review's answers must be written by you from your logs — the moment 'what did we learn' gets generated, the review is theatre. One honest use per review: after writing your answers, ask AI 'what question should I be asking about these numbers that I'm not?' — a standing outside prompt against your own blind spots. But the twenty minutes belong to you, your numbers, and one honest change.

You'll need: Review ritual card (day / numbers / three questions) + four calendar slots

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The weekly review is designed and all four slots are in the calendar.
- ☐ One dry-run review happened on real data inside twenty minutes.

Unlocks after: Budget the hours like money

5 Earn the sign-off

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

The plan's final exam is a real one: present it to your decision-maker and earn a signature. The winning structure is the one you built in Q1 — and the counterintuitive move is to lead with the *risks*: 'here's my goal, here's how it fits my hours, here are the five ways it could fail and my answer to each.' Adults sign plans that have already argued against themselves. Hope is not a plan; a pre-mortem with responses is.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Two pitches for the same month: 'I'm going to make RM200, it'll be great' — met with worried questions and a vague maybe. Versus: 'RM200, inside 8 real hours a week; the three big risks are exams, supplier, weather — here's my response to each; here's the Sunday review where you can see the numbers.' Signed on the spot — with the parent volunteering the Sunday slot. Steelmanning your own plan is what being taken seriously *is*.

03 APPLY IT

Assemble the one-page plan: goal and metrics, weekly targets, hour budget, top risks with responses, review calendar. Present it in person. Take questions; where they find a real hole, fix the plan — that's the process working. Get the signature and the agreed support (the review slot, the market lift, the exam-week accommodation).

04 REFLECT

Which question in the meeting was hardest — and had your pre-mortem predicted it? Compare this sign-off to your Q1 case: what's different about arguing for a *plan* versus arguing for a *change*?

05 GET FEEDBACK

After the signature, ask your decision-maker one more question: 'what would make you *stop* the month early?' Write their answer into the plan as a tripwire. Knowing the stop-condition in advance is what makes the green light real.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the risk-led pitch to a friend who needs a yes for anything: help them build the one-pager — goal, fit, risks, responses — and rehearse leading with the risks. When their adult says 'that's fair' before saying yes, the method has been fully passed on.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The plan on the page and the voice in the room must be yours — the signature is being given to *you*, and a decision-maker can hear borrowed words instantly (your Q1 lesson, still true). Final rehearsal use, the same one that's served all year: 'here's my plan — attack it as the skeptical parent.' Patch what the attack finds, then close the laptop and make the case yourself. That's the whole pillar in one move: machine as sparring partner, human as the one who stands up and argues.

You'll need: One-page plan + sign-off sheet (signature / support agreed / stop-condition)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The one-page plan was presented in person, risks first, and signed by the decision-maker.
- ☐ Agreed support and a written stop-condition are recorded on the plan.

Unlocks after: Set the weekly review

COMMUNICATE · Q1

Publish Something Worth Reading

co-13-14-q1 · supporting: Create

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14 the 'imaginary audience' is at full volume — teens feel watched and judged constantly, which makes publishing feel enormous, but it also means they finally *care* about audience reaction enough to revise. They can now hold a draft–edit–redraft loop across weeks, take critique of their work (if it's clearly not critique of them), and write with an authentic voice adults can't fake. What they can't yet do is judge their own writing cold — they need real reader reactions, not a grade.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, communication creates value when **strangers choose to spend their attention on your words** — not politeness-reads from family. Publishing one piece that real, unobligated readers actually finish is the first time a teen's words are judged purely on whether they're worth reading. That's a different act from writing for a teacher, and it's the one that matters.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The piece is written for — and published in — a place where its real audience already gathers: the school paper or newsletter, a club or team chat, a community noticeboard, a blog shared where their people are. Real readers, reacting honestly and voluntarily, are the payoff. The teen watches actual humans respond to their words, which no grade or parental praise can substitute for.

THE ARTIFACT

One published piece (roughly 400–700 words, or the equivalent as a recorded script) on a topic the teen genuinely knows, published where its intended audience actually gathers — plus the first draft kept alongside the final to show the cuts, and a record of real reader responses.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The piece is published somewhere its intended audience actually gathers, not just shown to family.
- The teen can state the one idea of the piece in a single sentence.
- The final draft is visibly shorter and sharper than the first draft, and both exist to compare.
- At least three genuine responses from readers outside the family are recorded.

1 One idea, one reader

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Writing aimed at 'everyone' reads like it was written for no one. A piece works when one specific kind of reader feels it was written *for them* — and when it carries exactly one idea. Two ideas make two weak pieces wearing one title.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Ten tips for better gaming' vanishes into the noise. 'What I learned coming back after my account got hacked — written for players who think it can't happen to them' gets read, because a real reader recognises themselves in it and one clear idea pulls them through.

03 APPLY IT

Pick a topic you actually know from experience — not one you'd have to research from zero. Write your one idea in a single sentence, and describe your one reader in a phrase ('year 8s who skip breakfast', 'players in my league who rage-quit'). Everything you draft later must serve those two lines.

04 REFLECT

Is your one idea something your reader hasn't already heard ten times? If it's what everyone says, what do *you* know that changes it?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Say your idea sentence to one person who fits your reader description. Watch their face: interest or politeness? Ask which — and note what they say.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain the 'one idea, one reader' rule to a friend who has to write something for school, and help them boil their piece down to the two lines.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The idea must come from what *you* know — an AI's take on any topic is the average take, and average is invisible. One sharp use: ask AI 'what would most people say about this topic?' so you know exactly what NOT to write. If your idea matches the machine's list, dig deeper into your own experience until it doesn't.

You'll need: One-idea/one-reader card (two lines, kept visible while drafting)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A one-sentence idea and a one-phrase reader description are written down.
- [ ] One real target reader reacted to the idea and their reaction is noted.

2 Earn the first ten seconds

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

A stranger gives your piece about ten seconds before deciding to stay or scroll. The opening has to earn the rest — with a real question, a surprising fact, or the moment the story starts. One rule: the piece must pay off whatever the opening promises. A hook the piece can't cash is clickbait, and readers never forgive it twice.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Cyberbullying is a serious problem in today's society' loses the reader at 'society'. 'The message arrived at 11:43pm, and it was from my best friend' — same topic, but now you have to know what happened. Both openings are honest; only one earns the next paragraph.

03 APPLY IT

Write five different openings for your piece — a question, a moment, a surprising fact, a bold claim, and one wild card. Read each aloud. Pick the one that pulls hardest *and* that your piece can genuinely pay off.

04 REFLECT

Which opening was easiest to write, and which actually works best? Why are those usually not the same one?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show just your top two openings to someone in your reader group and ask: which one would make you keep reading — and would you feel cheated if the piece didn't deliver on it?

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Collect three openings from things you read this week — one great, one boring, one clickbait — and teach someone the difference, using the 'can it pay it off?' test.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Draft your five openings yourself first — generating hooks is exactly the muscle this lesson trains. Afterwards, AI can pitch alternatives to react against; steal a *shape* if it helps, never a whole line. And reject any AI hook your piece can't pay off: borrowed clickbait spends your reader's trust, and you're the one who loses it.

You'll need: Five-openings worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Five distinct openings exist and one is chosen with a reason.
- ☐ A target reader picked between the top two and their choice is noted.

Unlocks after: One idea, one reader

3 Draft it, then cut it in half

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

First drafts are for finding what you mean; editing is where writing gets good. Nearly every first draft is a third too long — warm-up sentences, repeated points, words doing nothing. Cutting feels like losing work. It isn't. It's the work.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Due to the fact that many students find it quite difficult to wake up early in the morning' — cut to 'Most students hate early mornings' and nothing is lost except fog. Professional writers routinely cut their favourite sentences; they call it 'killing your darlings' because it hurts and it works.

03 APPLY IT

Write the full first draft in one sitting — messy is fine, just get to the end. Then make a copy and cut it by at least a third: warm-ups, repeats, every word not carrying weight. Keep both versions; the before/after is part of your artifact.

04 REFLECT

Read the two versions aloud. What did the piece *gain* by losing a third of its words? Which cut hurt most — and was the piece worse without it, honestly?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Give someone both versions without saying which is which. Ask which they'd rather keep reading and why. If they pick the long one, find out what the cut version lost.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Take a paragraph a friend or sibling wrote (with permission), and edit it together — teach them to hunt warm-up sentences and dead words. Cutting someone else's fog trains your eye for your own.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The draft must be yours — drafting is where you find what you actually think, and skipping it means publishing without ever thinking. For editing, one sharp AI use: 'what could be cut from this without losing the idea?' — then decide line by line yourself. Never 'rewrite this better': the voice stops being yours, and your reader can tell in one paragraph.

You'll need: Draft + cut-pass checklist (warm-ups, repeats, dead words)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A complete first draft exists.
- ☐ A cut version at least a third shorter exists alongside it.

Unlocks after: Earn the first ten seconds

4 Test it on real readers

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

You can't judge your own writing cold — you know what you *meant*, so your brain fills every gap. Real readers don't have that help. Watching where an actual reader slows down, skims, or stops tells you more than any opinion about whether it's 'good'.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A writer watches someone read their piece and sees them skim the third paragraph — the one the writer worked hardest on. The reader can't even say why. That skim is data no compliment can give: the paragraph is doing less than it costs.

03 APPLY IT

Give the piece to two or three people from your reader group. Watch them read if you can. Then ask exactly one question: 'where did you lose interest, even a little?' Revise the piece based on what they showed you — not just what they said.

04 REFLECT

Did their stumbling points surprise you? What does the gap between what you meant and what they read tell you about writing for strangers?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show one reader the before/after of your revision and ask if the fix worked. A reader confirming the fix is your sign-off to publish.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Offer the same service to a friend: watch them read *your* method — one reader, one question, revise from the stumble. Then watch a reader read their piece and hand them what you observed.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI cannot lose interest — it reads everything with infinite patience, which makes it useless for this lesson's question. Simulated 'reader feedback' from a model is practice at best. The one thing that counts here is a real human's attention faltering in front of you. Save AI for after: it can help you tighten the paragraph your real reader stumbled on.

You'll need: Reader-test sheet (reader / where they slowed / what changed)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] At least two target readers read the piece and their lose-interest points are recorded.
- [ ] The piece was revised and one reader confirmed the revision works.

Unlocks after: Draft it, then cut it in half

5 Publish where they already are

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

A piece nobody can find isn't published — it's stored. Publishing means putting it where your reader already spends attention: the school paper, the club chat, the noticeboard, the feed. And it means your name on it, in public, which is exactly why it counts.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The same piece posted on a blog nobody visits gets three views from family; pinned in the club's group chat where its actual readers live, it gets read, replied to, and argued with the same day. Placement did that, not the writing.

03 APPLY IT

List the two or three places your one reader actually gathers. Pick the best, handle its rules (ask the editor, the coach, the admin), and publish. Then collect what comes back: a simple tally of who read it and every genuine response, kept with the piece.

04 REFLECT

How did it feel the moment it went public under your name? Which response mattered most — and was it the one you expected to matter?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Debrief with one reader who responded: what made them read to the end? What would have made them share it with someone else? Note both for your next piece.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk a friend through the whole path — one idea, one reader, the hook, the cut, the reader test, the placement — and help them get their first piece actually published, not just written.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Never publish AI-written text under your name. Your name is the asset this whole quarter builds, and getting caught once — and readers do catch it — spends all of it. The legitimate final uses: a proofread for typos where you approve each fix, and afterwards asking 'why might this piece not have been shared?' as input for your next one. The words that carry your name must be yours.

You'll need: Publication checklist + response tally sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The piece is live in a place its intended audience actually gathers.
- ☐ A response record exists with at least three genuine reader responses from outside the family.

Unlocks after: Test it on real readers

COMMUNICATE · Q2

Reach Out and Interview

co-13-14-q2 · supporting: Explore

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, teens can hold a real conversation with an unfamiliar adult — ask, listen, follow up — but almost never do, because initiating contact feels socially radioactive at exactly the age when embarrassment peaks. The capability that's genuinely ready: composing a considered message, preparing questions, and listening for substance. The fear is the obstacle, not the skill — which makes this the highest-leverage quarter to install the habit, because a teen who can comfortably reach out to adults has an advantage that compounds for decades.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, communication creates value when it **opens a door that was closed** — a busy adult who owed the teen nothing gives an hour, answers honestly, and remembers them afterwards. The teen walks away with knowledge that isn't on any feed, and something rarer: proof that the adult world answers when you knock properly. That proof changes what a 13-year-old believes they're allowed to attempt.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

Getting a yes from a busy stranger, then running an interview that makes them talk for an hour, is a visible, unfakeable skill — and every rep gets measurably less scary and more smooth. The quarter is built as a ladder of reps: warm contact first, then colder, each one scored and debriefed. The pull is watching yourself get good at the thing most adults still fear.

THE ARTIFACT

Two completed interviews with adults doing work the teen finds genuinely interesting — landed through the teen's own outreach messages — plus a published write-up of what was learned (using the Q1 publishing skills) and thank-you notes actually sent.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- At least three real outreach messages were sent, and at least two interviews actually happened.
- The teen ran each interview from their own prepared questions and can retell the best thing each person said.
- A write-up of what was learned is published where others can read it, and thank-you notes were sent within two days.
- The teen can describe how outreach number three felt compared to number one.

Unlocks after: Publish Something Worth Reading

1 Who's worth an hour?

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Outreach starts with a real question, not a famous name. The best person to interview isn't the biggest name you can think of — it's someone close enough to reach who is actually *doing* a thing you want to understand: running the shop, coding the app, coaching the team, working the job you're curious about. Specific curiosity beats celebrity every time.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen curious about game design messaged a famous YouTuber (no reply, ever) and then the developer of a small indie game he liked — who replied in a day and talked for an hour. The indie dev gets ten messages a month, not ten thousand. Reachability is a feature, not a compromise.

03 APPLY IT

Write down what you genuinely want to understand — a job, a craft, a path. List three real, reachable people who are living it: one you already half-know (a coach, a family friend, a neighbour), two colder. For each, write the one thing you'd most want to ask them.

04 REFLECT

Is your list built on what *you* actually want to know, or on who would impress your friends? What would change if nobody ever saw who you interviewed?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your list to an adult who knows your world and ask two things: 'who am I missing?' and 'can you introduce me to any of these?' A warm introduction doubles your yes rate — asking for one is part of the skill.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend build their own three-person list for something *they're* curious about. Teach them the rule: reachable and real beats famous and silent.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The curiosity must be yours — AI doesn't know what pulls at you, and a borrowed question produces a dead interview. Where AI earns its keep here is research: once you've chosen your people, use it to learn what they've made and said publicly, so your questions start where their public answers end. Knowing someone's work before you knock is respect; asking what a two-minute search would answer is the opposite.

You'll need: Target list sheet (person / what they do / the one question)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Three reachable people are listed with the one thing to ask each.
- ☐ One possible warm introduction is identified.

2 The message that gets a yes

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Busy people say yes to messages that are short, specific, and easy. The formula: who you are in one line, why *them* specifically (proof you know their work), one clear small ask (20 minutes, their choice of time), and an easy out. No flattery walls, no life story, no 'pick your brain'. And silence isn't a no — one polite follow-up a week later is normal, not desperate.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Hi, I'm Mira, 13, I run a small bracelet stall at my school market. I read that you started your bakery at 19 with RM500. Could I ask you three questions about your first year — 20 minutes, whenever suits you? Totally fine if you're too busy.' Four lines. She got a reply in two hours, because saying yes to that is *easy*.

03 APPLY IT

Draft your outreach message using the formula, out loud until it sounds like you. Send it to your warmest target today — before the nerves organise themselves. Log the send in a simple tracker: who, when, reply or silence, follow-up date.

04 REFLECT

What was the exact feeling in the ten seconds before you hit send? Now that it's sent — how big was the thing you were afraid of, really?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your draft to an adult before sending the colder two: 'would you say yes to this? what would make it easier to say yes to?' Tighten, then send both.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the four-line formula to a friend who wants something from an adult — a trial, a signature, an interview — and stand next to them while they hit send on their first one. The standing-next-to matters.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Draft the message yourself, then let AI tighten *your* draft — cutting is a thing it does well. Never let it write the message from scratch: recipients can smell template outreach instantly, and the whole message works because a real 13-year-old wrote it. Same for follow-ups — short, human, yours. One genuine use: paste in your message and ask 'what would make a busy person ignore this?'

You'll need: Outreach tracker (who / sent / reply / follow-up date)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Three outreach messages in the four-line shape were actually sent.
- ☐ The tracker shows send dates and scheduled follow-ups.

Unlocks after: Who's worth an hour?

3 Questions that open people up

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Weak questions get facts you could have googled; strong questions get stories only this person can tell. The craft: open questions ('how did you…', 'what surprised you…') beat yes/no ones; 'tell me about the time…' beats 'do you like…'; and the best question in any interview is the follow-up — 'what happened next?', 'why was that hard?' — because it proves you're actually listening.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Do you like being a vet?' gets 'yes, mostly'. 'What's a day that almost made you quit — and why didn't you?' gets ten minutes you'll never forget. Same person, same knowledge; the question decided which one you got.

03 APPLY IT

Write eight questions for your first confirmed interview: two about how they started, two about the hardest parts, two about what surprised them, one 'tell me about the time…', and one you're slightly scared to ask. Then star the three you'd keep if you only got ten minutes.

04 REFLECT

Look at your eight: how many could be answered by their website or a search? Replace those — what does that rule teach you about what an interview is actually *for*?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Test your starred three on a family member, having them role-play the interviewee. Which question made them think longest before answering? That pause is what you're hunting.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach a sibling or friend the open-vs-closed question game at dinner: take turns turning dull questions into story questions, and score whose version gets the longer answer.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Write your eight before consulting anything — the questions carry your curiosity, which is the one thing the interview runs on. Afterwards, two fair uses: ask AI what a beginner typically fails to ask people in this field, and check your list against it; and cut questions whose answers are already public. What you must not do is walk in with a machine's script — the follow-ups, which matter most, can only come from you listening.

You'll need: Question sheet (8 questions, 3 starred)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Eight questions exist with three starred, none answerable by a basic search.
- ☐ The starred three were tested on a stand-in and the strongest identified.

Unlocks after: The message that gets a yes

4 Run the interview

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

The interview is won by listening, not performing. Talk 20%, listen 80%. Let silences sit — people fill them with the good stuff. Follow the interesting thread even if it breaks your question order; your list is a safety net, not a script. Capture as you go: short notes for facts, full attention for stories, and always ask permission before recording anything.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen interviewing a paramedic froze when her third question got answered in one word. Then she used the rescue line — 'what happened next?' — and the paramedic talked for eight unplanned minutes about a night that changed his career. None of it was on her sheet. All of it was the interview.

03 APPLY IT

Run your first interview. Open by thanking them and saying what you're hoping to learn in one line. Ask your starred questions, chase at least one unplanned thread, and close with: 'what should I have asked that I didn't?' Write your notes up within an hour, while it's warm — then run the second interview within the fortnight.

04 REFLECT

Where did you talk when you should have listened? What was the best thing they said — and did it come from a planned question or a follow-up?

05 GET FEEDBACK

At the end of each interview, ask directly: 'how was that to be interviewed by me — anything I should do differently next time?' Adults give gold feedback to teens who ask for it straight.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Retell the best story from your interview to your family at dinner — properly, with the details that made it land. Retelling is both the retention step and the proof you were actually listening.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Nothing about the live hour can be delegated — the listening, the silences, the followed thread are the entire craft. Two hard rules: never record or transcribe a person without asking first, and never paste someone's private words into an AI tool without their permission — what they gave you, they gave *you*. After writing your own notes, it's fine to use AI to help organise them; the hour itself belongs to humans.

You'll need: Interview one-pager (starred questions + note space + closing question)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Two interviews were completed with notes written up within a day.
- [ ] At least one unplanned follow-up thread per interview is visible in the notes.

Unlocks after: Questions that open people up

5 Write it up, say thanks, keep the door open

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

An interview isn't finished when the call ends. Three moves complete it: a thank-you within two days that names the specific thing that helped you most; a write-up that shares what you learned (your Q1 publishing skills, back on stage); and the long game — a door left open is worth more than the hour itself. Adults remember teens who close the loop, because almost nobody does.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Six months after interviewing a local shop owner, a teen messaged her: 'I used your advice about starting smaller — here's the stall it turned into.' She replied the same day and offered him a market slot. The interview got him an hour; the closed loop got him an ally.

03 APPLY IT

Send both thank-yous, naming the one specific insight each person gave you. Then write and publish your piece — the two or three things you learned that nobody had told you before — where your Q1 audience can read it, and send each interviewee the link.

04 REFLECT

What did you learn across the two interviews that genuinely surprised you? And what did you learn about *yourself* between outreach number one and interview number two?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Note what each interviewee says when you send them the write-up — whether they correct something, share it, or offer more. Their reaction is feedback on both your listening and your writing.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Coach one friend through the full ladder — list, message, questions, interview, thank-you, write-up — for a person *they* want to learn from. When their thank-you note goes out, you've taught the whole skill.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The thank-you must be handwritten-level personal — one specific detail from *your* conversation — and the write-up must be in your voice, since your name is on it and the interviewee will read it. Fine uses: AI as proofreader, and as an organiser for your quotes (with the speaker's permission to share them). The relationship itself — the door you're keeping open — can only be maintained by a human. That's the asset. Guard it.

You'll need: Thank-you checklist + write-up template (3 things nobody had told me)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Both thank-you notes were sent within two days, each naming a specific insight.
- ☐ The write-up is published and the link was sent to both interviewees.

Unlocks after: Run the interview

COMMUNICATE · Q3

Show Your Work

co-13-14-q3 · supporting: Build

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, teens curate their public image obsessively — which makes showing *unfinished* work feel dangerous, and precisely why learning it now is so valuable. The capabilities are ready: they can write short and concrete, capture a photo or 30-second demo, sustain a weekly rhythm, and read an audience's reaction. What needs scaffolding is the emotional reframe — that documenting real progress, including what went wrong, builds more durable status than polished announcements ever do.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, communication creates value when it **turns your work into a signal** — a public trail of real progress that peers, adults, and future opportunities can find and trust. One honest build log outweighs a hundred vague bios: it proves you do things. Teens who learn to show work-in-progress own the discovery that opportunities come to people whose work is visible.

MOTIVATION LEVER — PEER STATUS

The build log is public in the teen's real world — the class, the club, the community group — and updates arrive on a rhythm, so the audience starts *expecting* them. Being known as 'the one building the thing, who shows the real progress' is a durable status position no single post can buy. Watching the reactions arrive, update after update, does the motivating.

THE ARTIFACT

A three-part public build log about the teen's real ongoing project (their venture, tool, or automation) — each update in the did/learned/next format with something visual, posted where their real audience gathers over three weeks — plus a recorded log of the reactions and what the teen learned about what resonates.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- Three updates were actually posted, roughly a week apart, where the real audience gathers.
- Each update contains what was done, what was learned (including something that went wrong), what's next, and something visual.
- Reactions to each update are recorded, and the teen can say which update resonated most and why.
- At least one reply or conversation happened because of the log that wouldn't have happened otherwise.

Unlocks after: Reach Out and Interview

1 Progress beats polish

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Most people only announce finished things — so their work is invisible for months, then over-polished for a day. Builders who show progress own the space in between: a short, regular update in three moves — what I did, what I learned, what's next. The 'learned' line carries the weight, and it hits hardest when it includes what went wrong. Honesty is the interesting part.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Two teens built stalls for the same market. One went silent for a month, then posted 'launching Saturday!' — politely ignored. The other posted weekly: burnt batch photos, a price test that flopped, the fix that worked. By market day, her updates had made her stall the one everyone already had an opinion about. Same work; only one made the work *visible*.

03 APPLY IT

Choose the real project your log will follow — your venture, your tool, your automation. Write update #1 in the three-move format: 5–8 sentences, concrete numbers where you have them, and at least one line about something that didn't work. Don't post yet — that's next lesson. Today is getting the shape right.

04 REFLECT

Which felt more uncomfortable to write — the brag or the went-wrong line? Whose updates do *you* actually enjoy following, and how honest are they?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Read your draft to someone who knows the project. Ask: 'does this sound like me, and would you want the next episode?' If it reads like an ad, cut until it reads like a note to a friend.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the did/learned/next format to a friend with any ongoing effort — training, art, a team season — and help them draft their first update. The format transfers to everything.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The update must be written by you, in your voice — a build log is proof-of-person, and generated updates defeat its entire purpose. Fair use: after drafting, ask AI 'which sentence sounds least like a real teenager wrote it?' and fix that one yourself. The went-wrong line especially must be yours: machines can't know what actually went wrong, and inventing struggle is worse than hiding it.

You'll need: Update template (did / learned / next + visual slot)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Update #1 exists in the three-move format with a genuine went-wrong line.
- ☐ A listener confirmed it sounds like the teen and invites a next episode.

2 Make it seeable

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Words tell; visuals prove. Every update needs one thing the eye can land on — a photo of the actual bracelets, a screenshot of the spreadsheet, a 30-second phone demo of the tool doing its job. The bar isn't pretty; it's *real*. A blurry photo of the true thing beats a stock image of nothing every single time.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

An update saying 'the automation works now' got two likes. The next one attached a 20-second screen recording of messages turning into planner rows by themselves — and got questions, shares, and one 'can it do mine?'. Nothing about the project changed. Being *seeable* changed everything.

03 APPLY IT

Capture the visual for update #1: photograph the real thing, screenshot the real numbers, or record a phone demo under 30 seconds (one take is fine; say what we're seeing out loud). Then post update #1 — text plus visual — where your real audience gathers.

04 REFLECT

What could you show *only because the work is real*? That's the visual no competitor and no faker can produce — how does knowing that change how you feel about blurry-but-true?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Watch the first reactions land. Note which arrived within a day, what people reacted to (the visual? the went-wrong line?), and exactly what any comment said. This is baseline data for the next two updates.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend make their first 30-second demo of something they do — a skill, a recipe, a build. Teach the rule: show the true thing doing its job; narrate; stop at 30 seconds.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The visual must be of the real thing — never generate an image of work you claim to have done; one faked visual poisons every honest update before and after it. AI is fine for trims: cropping advice, caption tightening, 'is 30 seconds too long for this?'. The camera points at reality. That's the law of the log.

You'll need: Visual checklist (real thing / real numbers / ≤30s demo)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Update #1 is posted with a visual of the real thing.
- ☐ First reactions are recorded with what they responded to.

Unlocks after: Progress beats polish

3 Read the reactions

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Public work gets three kinds of response: engagement (questions, shares, 'how did you—'), criticism (useful or lazy — learn to tell them apart), and silence (the loudest one; usually means unclear, wrong channel, or wrong hook — not 'you're bad'). Each is data. Reply to questions warmly, thank useful critics, ignore lazy ones, and treat silence as a puzzle rather than a verdict.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen's update got one comment: 'prices seem high tbh'. Sting, then gold — she replied asking what price would feel fair, got three answers, and update #3's price experiment came directly from that thread. Meanwhile her friend's unanswered update wasn't bad — it was posted at 7am in a chat nobody reads before noon. The silence was a clock problem, not a quality problem.

03 APPLY IT

Post update #2 (did/learned/next + visual — the 'learned' can include what update #1's reactions taught you). Then work the responses: reply to every genuine question within a day, thank any useful critic, and write one line diagnosing any silence: unclear, wrong place, wrong time, or wrong hook?

04 REFLECT

Which reaction affected you most — and was its *usefulness* proportional to its sting? What would change if you treated every reaction, including silence, as information about the update rather than about you?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask one engaged reader directly: 'what would make these updates worth following?' Their answer shapes update #3 — an audience consulted becomes an audience invested.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach a friend the three-response model (engagement/criticism/silence) and the useful-versus-lazy criticism test: useful tells you what to change; lazy only tells you how someone felt. Practice sorting real comments from any public post together.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Replies to real people must come from you — audiences invest in humans, and a templated reply reads as contempt. Where AI helps: drafting a *calm* response to criticism that stung (write your angry version, ask for the graceful one, then rewrite it in your voice), and brainstorming silence-diagnoses you hadn't considered. The feelings management is the skill; the machine is scaffolding, not spokesperson.

You'll need: Reaction log (update / reactions / replies sent / silence diagnosis)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Update #2 is posted and every genuine question received a reply within a day.
- ☐ The reaction log covers both updates, including any silence diagnosis.

Unlocks after: Make it seeable

4 Consistency compounds

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

One update is a post; three on a rhythm is a *show*. Rhythm does the heavy lifting: the audience starts expecting the next episode, and expectation is attention you no longer have to earn from zero. The secret that makes rhythm sustainable: lower the bar, keep the beat. A short honest update on time beats a brilliant one that never ships.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Serialised stories, weekly podcasts, season episodes — every attention machine humans love runs on rhythm, not one-off brilliance. The stall teen's third weekly update opened with 'week 3:' and nothing else — and got her fastest reactions yet, because by then the audience was *waiting*. Nobody waits for someone whose last post was 'launching soon!' two months ago.

03 APPLY IT

Post update #3 on schedule, even if the week's progress was small — especially if it was small; write the small week honestly. Then close the loop on the arc: note in the update one thing that changed across the three weeks that readers watched happen.

04 REFLECT

Was there a day you nearly skipped the update? What got it shipped anyway — and what does that tell you about systems versus motivation (your Think quarter should be nodding here)?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask two followers of the log: 'did you notice the updates became expected? which week would you have missed if it hadn't come?' Expectation confirmed by a reader is the quarter's quiet victory.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Convince a friend, using your own three-week evidence, that 'small but on-beat' beats 'perfect but someday' — then help them commit to a three-update rhythm for their own project, with dates in the calendar before they can reconsider.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

On the tempted-to-skip day, the honest short update you write in ten minutes is worth more than the impressive one AI could fake in one — the entire value of the log is that it's true, and rhythm built on generated filler is a debt that comes due the first time someone asks a follow-up question. Use AI to trim on busy weeks, never to pretend a week happened differently than it did.

You'll need: Posting calendar (3 dates) + arc-closing checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Update #3 was posted on schedule, completing three updates in three weeks.
- ☐ The update names one change readers watched happen across the arc.

Unlocks after: Read the reactions

5 What did the log earn you?

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

A build log isn't a diary — it's an asset, and assets get audited. Look back across the three updates: which earned the most real attention, what did the reactions teach you about your audience, and — the big one — what happened *because* the work was visible that wouldn't have happened in silence? That last answer is why builders keep logging long after this quarter ends.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Auditing her log, the stall teen found: the burnt-batch update outperformed both polished ones, questions beat compliments ten to one as useful data, and — the kicker — a parent who'd seen the log ordered thirty bracelets for a birthday party. The order didn't come from an ad. It came from a month of being visibly, honestly at work.

03 APPLY IT

Audit the log: for each update, note reach, reactions, and what you'd keep or change. Write the one-line answer to 'what did visibility earn me that silence wouldn't have?' Then decide, in writing, the log's future: continue on rhythm, change format, or pause with a stated reason.

04 REFLECT

Three weeks ago, showing unfinished work felt like a risk. What actually happened to your standing with the people who watched? What does that teach you about where the real risk was?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Share the audit's headline findings as a mini-update (yes, one more) and ask your audience what they'd want from a season two. Their answers are next quarter's launch-communication research, banked early.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Give a five-minute 'why you should show your work' talk to your class, club, or family — your own three updates as the evidence, the earned surprise as the closer. If one person starts a log because of it, the skill has officially left your head and entered the world.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The audit judgments — what resonated, what it earned, whether to continue — are readings of *your* audience and *your* trade-offs; make them yourself, on your recorded reactions. One strong final use: paste in your (own) three updates and reaction notes and ask 'what pattern do you see in what landed?' — a second pair of eyes on honest data. Then check its pattern against the reader who actually ordered the bracelets. Reality outranks pattern-matching, always.

You'll need: Log audit sheet (per-update reach & reactions / earned outcomes / verdict)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A written audit exists covering all three updates and their reactions.
- ☐ The 'what visibility earned me' line and a stated continue/change/pause decision exist.

Unlocks after: Consistency compounds

COMMUNICATE · Q4

Launch Loud

co-13-14-q4 · supporting: Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

By Q4, this teen has published for strangers, interviewed adults, and run a three-week build log — the audience exists and the voice is trained. The Venture Month asks communication to do a new job: *selling in public, honestly, on a rhythm, while the thing is actually running*. At 13–14 the twin risks are overclaiming (hype feels like competence at this age) and going silent mid-month when energy dips. The craft this quarter installs is the professional middle: proof-based promotion sustained by rhythm rather than mood.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, communication creates value when **words move real customers without spending trust** — an offer message that says exactly what the thing is and proves it, objections answered in the open, and a month narrated honestly enough that the audience roots for the venture. A teen who learns that trust compounds faster than hype has learned the only marketing lesson that still works in ten years.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

Everything this quarter ships goes to the teen's real, warm audience — the people who followed the build log and the customers who bought before — and the results are visible in real numbers: replies, orders, referrals during the month. The audience watching the launch is the same one that watched the work get built, which raises the stakes honestly: they'll notice hype, and they'll reward truth.

THE ARTIFACT

The Venture Month's communication kit, used for real: a proof-based offer message, a launch announcement posted where the audience gathers, a public FAQ built from real objections, a weekly promotional drumbeat synced to the venture's routine, and a closing public recap of the month with its real numbers and thanks.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A proof-based offer message exists and every claim in it can be pointed to in the venture's real records.
- The launch announcement was actually posted and its immediate responses are logged.
- A public FAQ exists built from at least five real questions or objections, including one about price.
- The weekly drumbeat shipped every week of the month, and the closing recap with real numbers was posted.

Unlocks after: Show Your Work, Plan the Venture Month

1 Claims need receipts

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

A selling message is a set of claims — and this year taught you exactly what claims need (your Think Q1 is about to earn its keep in public). The offer message formula: who it's for, what it does, and *proof* — a real customer's words, a real number, a real photo. 'Amazing quality!' is a claim wearing a costume. '38 orders delivered, zero returns; here's what Aisha said' — those are receipts. Sell like someone who has them, because you do.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Two market posts for the same bracelets. 'Beautiful handmade bracelets, the best gift!' — scroll. 'Made 40 this month for customers in our neighbourhood — here's the one Mrs Tan ordered for her daughter's birthday (photo), and what she messaged me after (screenshot, with her permission).' The second sells because it can't be faked — a year of real work is the one marketing asset nobody can copy.

03 APPLY IT

Write your offer message: who / what / benefit (your cw Q1 one-liner, matured), plus two receipts — a permissioned customer quote and a real number from your money picture or logs. Check every sentence: claim or receipt? Nothing ships with a claim that has no receipt behind it.

04 REFLECT

Which receipt was most satisfying to include — and what did earning it cost you across the year? Why does proof-based selling get *easier* every month a venture runs honestly?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the message to one real customer and one person who's never bought. Ask both: 'what do you doubt?' Any doubted claim gets a receipt or gets cut. That's the editing rule for the whole month.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach claim-versus-receipt to a friend promoting anything — a bake sale, a club event. Rewrite their poster together so every claim carries proof. Watch the message get shorter and stronger at the same time.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can tighten your message — but it will also cheerfully generate glowing copy with no receipts, because it has none: it never delivered your orders. The rule that keeps you honest: the machine may polish sentences, never add claims. And receipts are sacred — real quotes (with permission), real numbers, real photos. One invented testimonial, even a 'harmless' one, and the entire kit is poisoned. Your proof is the one thing that must be 100% human.

You'll need: Offer message card (who/what/benefit + two receipts, permissions noted)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ An offer message exists where every claim is backed by a checkable receipt.
- ☐ Customer permission for any quoted words is recorded.

2 The launch announcement

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

A launch announcement is a story with a door in it: here's what I've been building (your log audience already knows), here's what's new for the month, here's exactly how to get it — one clear action, one clear way in. The build log did the trust-building for weeks; the announcement's only job is to open the door and point.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Season two announcement: you watched me test prices and survive the burnt-batch week. This month I'm running the real thing — 60 bracelets, four Saturdays, orders open now, two ways to get one: reply here or find me at the market. First ten orders get pick-of-the-batch.' Warm audience, clear door, small honest incentive. Twelve orders in 48 hours — and every one of them already knew the story.

03 APPLY IT

Write the announcement in three beats: the story so far (one line, for the log audience), what's new this month (the offer, from lesson one), and the door (exactly how to order, when, where). Post it where your audience actually gathers — the same places your log lived. Log every response in the first 48 hours.

04 REFLECT

Compare launching to a warm audience now versus announcing cold in Q1 of this year. What did the build log buy you — and what would launching cold have cost?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask one person who responded and one who saw it but didn't: 'what made you act?' / 'what would have made you?' Both answers tune the drumbeat for the rest of the month.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the three-beat announcement (story / new / door) to a friend launching anything. The move to insist on: one door, clearly marked — announcements with three different calls to action get zero of them taken.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

By now the pattern is muscle memory: your draft, machine polish, your voice final — the announcement must sound like the person the audience has been following, or the warmth you banked evaporates. One good check: paste your draft and ask 'what's unclear about how to order?' Door-clarity is a thing machines test well, because unlike your audience, they haven't been rooting for you.

You'll need: Announcement draft (story / new / door) + 48-hour response log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The announcement was posted with a single clear door.
- ☐ 48-hour responses are logged, including at least one 'what made you act' answer.

Unlocks after: Claims need receipts

3 Answer objections in the open

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Every unanswered objection is a silent no. The move most sellers never make: collect the real questions and doubts — 'why so expensive?', 'is it really handmade?', 'what if it breaks?' — and answer them *in public*, once, well. A good FAQ is your steelman skill pointed at your own product: state the doubt at full strength, then answer it honestly, including the answers that admit limits. 'It's not for you if…' converts better than pretending it's for everyone.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The bracelet seller's public FAQ included the hard one: 'RM15 seems a lot for a bracelet.' Her answer, receipts attached: materials RM4.10, about 40 minutes of work, and a repair-for-free promise — 'if that's more than you want to spend, the imperfects box at my stall is half price.' The objection she answered in public stopped arriving in private — and two customers said the price answer was *why* they trusted the rest.

03 APPLY IT

Collect every real question and objection from the year — customer messages, market conversations, the announcement replies. Pick the five most common (price must be one). Write the public FAQ: each doubt stated at full strength, each answer honest with receipts where they exist, at least one 'this isn't for you if…'. Post it with the offer.

04 REFLECT

Which objection was hardest to answer honestly — and did writing the answer change anything about the offer itself? (The best FAQs quietly improve the product.)

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the FAQ to your most skeptical known customer: 'what doubt did I miss or dodge?' A dodge they catch in private is a sale saved in public. Add what they find.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach a friend the full-strength rule: an FAQ that answers weak versions of the doubts convinces nobody (they've met your Q1 strawman). Help them write the price answer for their own venture — it's always the hardest and always the most read.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The objections must be real ones people actually raised — a model can generate plausible FAQs, but plausible-and-real diverge exactly at the doubts specific to *your* product and *your* price, which are the only ones that convert. Fair use: after collecting real objections, ask 'what's the strongest version of this objection?' — machine as sparring partner, the year's oldest move. The honesty in the answers, especially the limits, is yours to keep.

You'll need: Objection collection sheet + public FAQ (5 doubts, full strength, receipts)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A public FAQ exists with five real objections including price, answered with receipts.
- ☐ At least one answer honestly names who the product is not for.

Unlocks after: The launch announcement

4 The drumbeat

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

A launch isn't a bang; it's a rhythm. The month's communication runs on a drumbeat synced to the machine you already built: the acquisition routine's posts (cw Q3), the build-log update (co Q3), the week's receipt — a delivery photo, a customer's words, this week's number. Small, honest, on schedule, every week. The audience's attention is a fire; the drumbeat is how you feed it without burning your hours.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Her month's beat, twenty minutes twice a week: Tuesday — fresh photo + order reminder (the routine); Sunday — the week's log update with real numbers ('week 2: 17 orders, one late delivery — fixed with Friday batching'). By week three, customers were *asking* for the Sunday number. The drumbeat had turned marketing into a show her buyers followed — and the late-delivery honesty got more replies than any promotion.

03 APPLY IT

Design the month's drumbeat on one card: which beats, which days, what each contains (post / update / receipt), synced with your venture plan's weekly rhythm. Time-box it inside the plan's hour budget. Ship the first week's beats on schedule and log responses beat by beat.

04 REFLECT

Which beat is at risk when the month gets hard — and what did your co Q3 quarter teach you about the week you most want to skip? What makes a drumbeat sustainable that a launch-bang isn't?

05 GET FEEDBACK

After week one, ask two followers: 'which beat do you actually look forward to?' Feed that one; shrink or merge the ones nobody misses. A drumbeat is pruned by the audience, not the drummer.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the drumbeat idea to a friend whose project announcements always spike and vanish. Help them design a two-beat week they can sustain for a month — and put the beats in their calendar before the enthusiasm fades.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Templates for recurring beats are exactly what AI is for — the Tuesday post's skeleton, drafted once, refilled weekly with the week's *real* photo and number. The rule that keeps the drumbeat honest: the skeleton can be machine; the week's flesh — what actually happened, the real number, the real photo — is always yours. A drumbeat of generated weeks is a show about a venture that isn't happening.

You'll need: Drumbeat card (beats / days / contents) + week-one response log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A drumbeat card exists, synced to the venture plan and inside its hour budget.
- ☐ Week one's beats all shipped on schedule with responses logged.

Unlocks after: Answer objections in the open

5 Tell the month's true story

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

The month ends in public, the way it ran: a closing recap with the real numbers — orders, the goal hit or missed, the week that nearly broke it — plus thanks by name (with permission) to the customers and helpers who made it real. Missed goals told honestly build more trust than hit goals told vaguely. This post is the year's graduation: an audience that watched the work, the launch, and now the truth of how it went, will follow this teen's *next* thing anywhere. That's what a reputation is.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Month closed: 61 orders against a goal of 60. Week three nearly sank it — exam week plus a supplier delay; the Thursday mini-batches and my sister's packing shift saved it (thanks, Lina). Real numbers: RM214 profit, 9 refer-a-friend orders, 2 imperfects sold honestly at half price. What's next: taking December off, then season three.' Shares, congratulations, and — two days later — a bulk order for a school event from someone who'd 'been following the whole thing'. The recap is never just a recap.

03 APPLY IT

Write and post the closing recap: the goal and the real result, the hardest moment and what fixed it, three real numbers, thanks by name (permissions checked), and one line about what's next. Post it everywhere the drumbeat lived. Then log what comes back — replies, shares, and anything that walks through the door because of it.

04 REFLECT

Reading your own recap: is this a story you're proud to have your name on? Across the year — the case, the interviews, the log, the launch — what has 'being good at communication' turned out to actually mean?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your most-followed reader one final question: 'what should season three's communication do differently?' Bank the answer — it's the first entry in next year's plan.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend write the honest closing post for *their* project — the real numbers, the hard week, the thanks. Teach the counterintuitive rule: the miss told straight is worth more than the win told shiny. When their honest recap outperforms their old hype posts, the year's biggest lesson has been passed on.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This post, more than any other this year, must be entirely yours — it's the one your customers, your family, and future-you will reread. The numbers come from your close-of-books, the thanks from your real memory of who showed up, the voice from twelve months of practice. If you want a machine's help, use the year's final honest trick: 'here's my recap — what would make a reader doubt it?' Fix that. Then sign your name to a month that actually happened.

You'll need: Closing recap checklist (result / hard moment / 3 numbers / thanks / next) + response log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The closing recap was posted with real numbers, an honest hard moment, and permissioned thanks.
- ☐ Post-recap responses and any resulting opportunities are logged.

Unlocks after: The drumbeat

BUILD · Q1

Build Something People Keep Using

bu-13-14-q1 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14 a teen can sustain a multi-week build–test loop, debug systematically instead of by frustration, and teach themselves a new tool from scratch when the project demands it. What drives them now is competence *witnessed by peers* — a build that stays invisible gets abandoned, however good it is. So the build must live in front of its users early. Frustration tolerance is better than at 11, but progress still needs to be visible weekly or motivation leaks away.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, building creates value when something you made becomes **part of someone's routine** — used a second time, without being asked. Not the demo, not the compliment: the return visit. A teen who has watched three real people come back to their tool has learned the difference between 'I built something' and 'I built something useful', and that difference is the whole craft.

MOTIVATION LEVER — PEER STATUS

The tool is built for a real group the teen already belongs to — the class, the team, the club, the family group chat — and it lives where the whole group can see it. Being 'the one who built the thing we actually use' is visible competence, which is exactly the status currency of this age. Watching people actually use your thing, in public, does the motivating; no adult needs to push.

THE ARTIFACT

A working tool — digital or physical: a shared tracker, a sign-up system, a small app, a spreadsheet automation, a physical organiser — that a real group the teen belongs to has used more than once, plus a usage log and a change log showing at least one v2 change made because of what the users actually did.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The tool exists, works, and at least three people in the target group have used it at least twice.
- A written usage log and change log exist, with at least one change driven by observed use rather than opinions.
- The teen can explain how every part of the tool works.

1 Find a recurring pain

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

A one-off problem earns you one thank-you. A *recurring* problem earns you users. Builders hunt for things a group does repeatedly and grumbles about every time — collecting money for something, remembering whose turn it is, sharing the same information again and again. Repetition is what turns a fix into a tool.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen noticed his football team spent ten minutes of every practice arguing about who was bringing what to the next match. One shared checklist, pinned in the team chat, killed the argument — and because the problem returned weekly, so did the users.

03 APPLY IT

Watch the groups you belong to for a week. List five things a group does repeatedly and grumbles about. For each, note how often it happens and who feels it. Circle the one that recurs most often for the most people — that's your build.

04 REFLECT

Which problems on your list happen weekly or more, and which happened only once? Why would building for the once-off feel productive but be a trap?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Describe the circled pain — just the pain, not your solution — to two people in that group. Ask: 'how annoying is this, honestly, out of ten?' Write their numbers down.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to a parent or friend the difference between a one-off problem and a recurring one, and why builders should chase the second. Use your own list as the example.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The noticing must be yours — AI doesn't know your team's chat or what your class grumbles about, and generic 'problems teens have' lists will point you at things nobody around you actually feels. After you've chosen, it's fair to ask AI how other groups solve this pain — copy the boring parts of their answers, and keep the part that fits *your* group yours.

You'll need: Recurring-pain log (pain / how often / who feels it)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Five observed recurring pains are logged with frequency and who feels them.
- ☐ One is circled, and two group members rated its annoyance.

2 Scope the smallest useful version

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Version one is the smallest thing that is *genuinely useful this week* — not the dream version. The core builder's skill isn't adding features; it's deciding what v1 will NOT do, and writing that list down before you start. Every feature you postpone is time your users get the tool sooner.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The team-checklist teen imagined an app with logins, reminders, and stats. What he shipped in week one was a single shared checklist with names next to items. It solved the argument at the very next practice. The dream version would still have been half-built a month later — solving nothing.

03 APPLY IT

Write one sentence: what v1 does, for whom, by when (within two weeks). Then write the NOT list — at least three tempting features v1 will not have — and one line on what v1 will be made of (chat pin, shared doc, spreadsheet, cardboard — whatever ships fastest).

04 REFLECT

Look at your NOT list. Which feature was hardest to postpone? Is that because users need it — or because building it sounds fun? Those are different reasons.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your v1 sentence to one person from the group and ask: 'if this existed next week, would you actually use it?' If they hesitate, the scope is wrong — adjust before building anything.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

A friend has a big project idea? Teach them the NOT list. Help them write what their version one will refuse to do — and watch how much more real the project instantly becomes.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Scoping is judgment, and the judgment must be yours: ask AI to plan your tool and it will cheerfully design the ten-feature dream version — that's the trap this lesson exists to avoid. The one sharp use is the opposite direction: show it your v1 plan and ask 'what would you cut?' If it finds something, cut it.

You'll need: v1 scope card (does / for whom / by when / NOT list)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A one-sentence v1 scope and a NOT list of 3+ postponed features exist.
- [ ] One group member confirmed they'd use v1 as scoped.

Unlocks after: Find a recurring pain

3 Ship it to the group

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

'Done' doesn't mean finished — it means *in their hands*. Put v1 where the group already is, tell them what it's for in one sentence, and then watch the first real uses. Something will break or confuse in front of you. Good: fixing what breaks in front of users is the fastest building there is.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The checklist went into the team chat on a Tuesday. Within an hour two players couldn't edit it — permissions. Fixed in five minutes, *because the builder was watching*. If he'd polished it privately for another month, he'd have found that bug a month later, in front of everyone, with less goodwill.

03 APPLY IT

Build v1 within your scope and ship it to the group this week — post it, pin it, hand it out. Announce it in one sentence: what it's for and how to use it. Stay close for the first uses and fix the first thing that breaks or confuses, the same day.

04 REFLECT

What was the gap between how you imagined the first use and what actually happened? What did shipping feel like — and did any of the fears come true?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask the first two users one question each: 'what nearly stopped you using it?' Fix the biggest answer within a day and tell them you fixed it — users who see their feedback land come back.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell the story of your first hour after shipping — what broke, what you fixed — to a friend who's afraid to show anyone their project. Make the case that shipping early is safer than polishing in private, not braver.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Use AI freely for the boring parts of the build — a spreadsheet formula, a code snippet, a template; tools are disposable and speed is a real gain. One hard rule: you must understand every part well enough to fix it when it breaks in front of a user, because it will. If AI produced a part you can't explain, rebuild that part simpler — a tool its builder can't repair isn't yours.

You'll need: Ship-day checklist (announce line / where posted / first fixes)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] v1 is live in the place the group actually gathers, announced in one sentence.
- [ ] The first breaking or confusing thing was found and fixed the same day.

Unlocks after: Scope the smallest useful version

4 Watch what they do, not what they say

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

People will tell you your tool is 'cool' and never open it again; others will grumble and use it every day. Opinions are polite; usage is honest. From today your instrument panel is the usage log: who used it, when, unprompted or reminded. A second unprompted use is the only compliment that counts.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen built a homework-sharing doc. Everyone said it was a great idea — the log showed three people opened it once and nobody came back. The praise said 'build more'; the log said 'something's wrong'. The log was right: it was three taps too far away. Moved into the class chat, real usage started.

03 APPLY IT

Keep a usage log for one week: each real use — who, when, and whether they came back without being reminded. Rough counts are fine; honesty isn't optional. At week's end, write the single clearest pattern the log shows.

04 REFLECT

Where do what-they-said and what-they-did disagree in your log? Which do you instinctively want to believe — and what does the log actually tell you to do?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the log's pattern to one heavy user and one non-user. Ask the non-user only: 'what stopped you?' Their answer plus the log is your v2 brief.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach someone the sentence 'usage is the only honest feedback' with your own log as evidence — show them where politeness and behaviour disagreed and which one turned out to be true.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Count real uses yourself — the log must record what actually happened, and no model can see your group. Don't ask AI to *guess* why people aren't using the tool; ask the people, or watch them. Once you have a real log and real answers, AI is fine for a second opinion on the pattern — but the data comes from the world, never from the machine.

You'll need: Usage log sheet (who / when / prompted or unprompted)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A week-long usage log exists with unprompted repeat uses marked.
- ☐ One written pattern from the log, plus a non-user's 'what stopped you' answer, are recorded.

Unlocks after: Ship it to the group

5 Version two, from evidence

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

v2 is not 'add the features I postponed' — it's 'change what the evidence demands'. Take the usage log and the non-user answers, choose the one change most likely to increase real use, make it, and measure again. Keep or kill by evidence. That loop — ship, watch, change, watch — is the entire craft of building, and you now own it.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Real product teams run exactly this loop: they propose a change, predict what it will do to usage, ship it, and check. Half their smart-sounding changes do nothing — which is why they measure instead of argue. Your checklist tool is small; the loop is the same one.

03 APPLY IT

Write a change log entry: the change, and a one-line prediction of what it will do to usage. Make the change, tell the group in one sentence, and log another week of use. Compare before and after — did the evidence match your prediction? Keep or roll back accordingly.

04 REFLECT

Did your change do what you predicted? If not — what did the users know that you didn't? And which postponed feature from your NOT list now looks like it was never needed at all?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show a before/after usage comparison to the group's most honest member and ask: 'what one change would make you use this twice as much?' That answer is v3's brief — whether or not you build it this quarter.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the full loop — recurring pain, smallest version, ship, watch usage, change from evidence — to a friend with a project idea, and stay with them until their v1 is actually in front of real users.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The decision of *what* to change comes from your log and your users — never from a model's feature ideas, which are guesses about a group it has never met. Once you've chosen the change, AI is a fine assistant for implementing it. Predict first, then measure: if you let AI both choose and build, you're no longer the builder — you're the audience.

You'll need: Change log template (change / prediction / result / keep-or-rollback)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A change log entry exists with a prediction and a measured before/after result.
- ☐ The keep-or-rollback decision is written down with its evidence.

Unlocks after: Watch what they do, not what they say

BUILD · Q2

Automate the Boring Part

bu-13-14-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, a teen can decompose a task into steps, express rules ('if this, then that'), and learn a tool from a tutorial without an adult driving — the raw material of automation. What's new at this age is the ability to think about *process itself*: to watch themselves do a chore and see the loop inside it. What still needs scaffolding is honesty about results — teens (like adults) fall in love with what they built and stop measuring whether it actually helps.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, building creates value when it **gives time back** — theirs or someone else's, every single week, without further effort. An automation that reliably saves twenty minutes a week is a machine that manufactures freedom. Learning that you can *build* leverage instead of just spending effort is one of the biggest ideas a 13-year-old can own, and this quarter makes it physical.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The quarter runs on a visible scoreboard: minutes saved per week, measured before and after, honestly. Watching a thing you built quietly do work while you don't is intrinsically addictive — and the measured number turns 'I made a cool thing' into 'I made a thing that provably works', which is the mastery feeling that keeps builders building.

THE ARTIFACT

One working automation — a spreadsheet that fills itself, a phone shortcut, a no-code workflow, a small script, a template pipeline — that removes a genuinely repeated task, with a before/after time measurement, a one-page 'how it works' note, and a keep-or-kill verdict based on the real numbers.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A real repeated task was measured before automation and the automation now performs it, with the weekly minutes saved written down.
- The automation survived at least one weird input or edge case, or was fenced so the weird case is handled by a human on purpose.
- A one-page 'how it works' note exists that another person could use to understand and fix it.
- The teen can explain every part of how the automation works.

Unlocks after: Build Something People Keep Using

1 Hunt the repetition

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Automation candidates hide in plain sight: tasks that are *repeated* and *rule-based* — done the same way every time, on a schedule, by rote. The hunt is a time audit: for a week, log the tasks you (or your family, or your Q1 tool's group) do repeatedly. If you can write the rule for doing it, a machine can probably follow the rule.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen logged her week and found she spent ~25 minutes every Sunday copying the week's homework deadlines from four class chats into her planner. Repeated: weekly. Rule-based: completely. That half-hour was a machine's job wearing a human's name.

03 APPLY IT

Run a five-day time audit: log every task you notice yourself or your household repeating, with rough minutes and how often. Mark each as rule-based or judgment-based. Circle the best candidate: most minutes × most rule-based. Write its rule out in plain words.

04 REFLECT

How many minutes a week does your circled task actually eat? Multiply by 52 — what does the yearly number make you feel about 'it only takes a few minutes'?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your audit to someone in your household and ask what repeated task *they'd* pay to never do again. Their answer either confirms your circle or gives you a better one with a built-in grateful user.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach a friend the two-question test — 'is it repeated? is it rule-based?' — and help them find one automation candidate in their own week.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The audit must come from watching your real week — AI can't see your Sundays, and generic 'tasks teens can automate' lists point at nobody's actual life. Once you've circled a candidate, asking AI 'how do people usually automate X?' is a fine scout for what's possible. But choose the target with your own eyes first.

You'll need: Time-audit log (task / minutes / frequency / rule-based?)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A five-day audit exists with minutes and frequency per repeated task.
- ☐ One candidate is circled with its rule written in plain words.

2 Draw the flow before you build

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Every automation is the same shape: input → steps → output. Drawing that flow on paper *before* touching any tool is what separates an afternoon of building from a week of thrashing. The drawing forces the two questions that kill most automations later: where exactly does the input come from, and what happens when the input is weird?

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The homework-deadline teen drew her flow: input = messages in four chats; steps = spot dates, extract subject + due date; output = planner rows. The drawing immediately exposed the hard part — the messages weren't written in any standard way. Knowing where the hard part is *before* building is the whole point of the drawing.

03 APPLY IT

Draw your automation's flow: the input and where it lives, each step as a box with its rule, the output and where it goes. Then add a 'weird input' list — at least three ways the input could arrive broken or strange — and mark which step each weird case would hit.

04 REFLECT

Which box in your flow is the hard one? Is it hard because the rule is complicated — or because the input is messier than you admitted in lesson one?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Walk someone through your drawing box by box and have them play saboteur: 'what if the input is empty? doubled? in the wrong format?' Every break they find on paper is an hour saved in the build.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the input → steps → output shape to someone using a non-computer example — making breakfast, doing laundry — and have them draw one. The shape is the lesson; the tool never was.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Draw the flow yourself — the drawing is you *understanding* the task, and skipping it means building something you don't understand. Then a genuinely strong AI use: describe your flow and ask 'what edge cases am I missing?' Machines are excellent at imagining broken inputs. Add the good ones to your weird list — with a note of which ones you missed, because that's your blind spot showing.

You'll need: Flow-drawing sheet (input / steps / output / weird-input list)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A complete flow drawing exists with input, rule-labelled steps, and output.
- ☐ A weird-input list of 3+ cases exists, each mapped to the step it would break.

Unlocks after: Hunt the repetition

3 Build it with any lever

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Tools are disposable; the flow is forever. Build the drawn flow with whatever lever ships fastest — spreadsheet formulas, a phone shortcuts app, a no-code automation, a template, a tiny script. Rule of the build: make the *smallest version that completes one real run end-to-end*, today if possible. A half-automation that runs beats a full one that doesn't exist.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The deadline teen's v1 wasn't clever: a spreadsheet where she pasted the four chats' messages into one column, and formulas pulled out anything that looked like a date. Not magic — but Sunday went from 25 minutes to 6 on the very first run, and v1 taught her exactly what v2 needed.

03 APPLY IT

Pick your lever and build the smallest end-to-end version of your flow. Run it once on real input, today's or last week's. Log what worked, what needed a human shove, and how long the run took versus your before-measurement.

04 REFLECT

Where did the build match your drawing, and where did reality disagree with the plan? What did the first real run teach you that no amount of planning would have?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Demo the working v1 to the person who feels this pain (maybe you — then demo to your household anyway). Ask: 'would you trust this to do the task without checking it?' Their hesitation points at exactly what v2 must fix.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a friend the before and after of your task, then help them build the smallest version of *their* candidate from lesson one — in any tool. Getting someone else's first automation running cements every step of yours.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is the lesson where AI shines as a lever: formulas, shortcut recipes, snippets of code — ask for them freely, tools are disposable. One law, same as your Q1 tool: **you must understand every part well enough to fix it when it breaks**, because automations break quietly and wrong. If AI hands you a piece you can't explain, make it explain the piece until you can — or rebuild that piece simpler. An automation you can't repair isn't leverage; it's a debt.

You'll need: Build log (lever chosen / first-run result / time vs. before)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A smallest end-to-end version ran on real input at least once.
- ☐ The first run's time was logged against the before-measurement.

Unlocks after: Draw the flow before you build

4 Break it on purpose

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

An automation that works on nice input is a demo. One that survives *weird* input is a tool. Today you attack your own build with the weird-input list from your drawing: empty inputs, doubles, wrong formats, the message written by the one teacher who never writes dates like anyone else. For each break: fix it, or *fence* it — make the automation stop and hand the weird case to a human on purpose.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Real engineers do this daily; they call it testing, and the good ones are proud of how hard they attack their own work. The deadline spreadsheet's famous failure: a teacher wrote 'next Friday' instead of a date. The fix wasn't teaching the sheet English — it was a fence: anything unparseable lands in a 'check me' box for human eyes. Fences are not defeats; they're design.

03 APPLY IT

Run every case on your weird-input list through the automation, plus two new weird cases invented today. Log each result: passed, fixed, or fenced. The goal isn't zero fences — it's zero *silent* failures: nothing weird may pass through looking normal.

04 REFLECT

Which break surprised you most? What's the difference in consequences between an automation that fails loudly and one that fails silently — and which kind had you built?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Hand the automation to someone else with the instruction 'try to break this'. Outsiders find breaks the builder can't imagine. Log and handle whatever they find.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach someone the demo-versus-tool distinction and the idea of a fence, using your own best break as the example. If they can explain why a loud failure beats a silent one, it landed.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Ask AI to invent attacks — 'here's what my automation does; list ten inputs that might break it' — that's the machine doing exactly what it's good at, and every attack it invents is free testing. The judgment calls stay yours: which breaks are worth fixing, which get fenced, and what the fence hands to the human. Never let 'the AI says it handles it' replace running the weird case for real.

You'll need: Break log (case / result / fixed-or-fenced)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Every weird-input case was actually run, with results logged as passed, fixed, or fenced.
- ☐ No weird case can pass through silently looking normal.

Unlocks after: Build it with any lever

5 Did it actually save time?

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

The last discipline is the honest ledger. Total time invested building versus minutes saved per week — divide, and you get the payback point: the week the machine breaks even. Some automations never do, and finding that out from your own numbers is not failure; it's the lesson that separates builders from tinkerers. Then write the one-page note that lets someone else run and fix it — leverage you have to babysit isn't leverage yet.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The deadline sheet: about six hours to build and debug, saves 19 minutes a week — payback in around 19 weeks, then pure profit every Sunday after, forever. Her friend's elaborate chore-wheel bot: eleven hours to build, saved four minutes a week, abandoned in a month. Same skills, honest ledgers, opposite verdicts — and both teens learned exactly the right thing.

03 APPLY IT

Fill in the ledger: hours invested, weekly minutes saved (measured across at least two real runs, not guessed), payback week. Write the keep-or-kill verdict and why. Then write the one-page 'how it works' note — what it does, where the pieces live, what the fences catch, how to fix the two most likely breaks — and have someone else run one cycle using only the note.

04 REFLECT

Does your ledger say keep or kill — and would you have believed that verdict in week one? What would you automate differently next time, knowing the build cost runs double the guess?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present the ledger and the note to your household or group: numbers, verdict, and what the fences catch. Ask whether they'd trust the automation running unattended — and what would earn that trust if not.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the payback-point idea to a friend with their own build: help them fill in the same ledger and reach an honest verdict. If you can talk someone through *killing* an automation they love because the numbers say so, you own this quarter.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The measurements must be real and yours — enthusiasm cooks numbers, and an AI asked 'estimate how much time this saves' will happily hallucinate a flattering figure. Measure with a clock. AI is fine help for drafting the how-it-works note from your bullet points — but walk the final note yourself against the real automation, because documentation that's *almost* right is worse than none when something breaks at 11pm.

You'll need: Payback ledger + one-page how-it-works template

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A completed ledger exists with measured (not guessed) weekly savings and a payback week.
- ☐ A keep-or-kill verdict is written, and someone else ran one cycle using only the how-it-works note.

Unlocks after: Break it on purpose

BUILD · Q3

Make It Run Without You

bu-13-14-q3 · supporting: Lead

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, a teen can hold another person's perspective well enough to write instructions for them — a genuinely new capability — and can tolerate the ego hit of watching someone fumble with their creation without grabbing it back. They can also now think in failure modes: 'what breaks if…' is answerable. What's developmentally hard is letting go: at this age the builder and the build feel like the same thing, so a tool that only works with its maker hovering feels *safe*. This quarter teaches that it's actually fragile.

WHAT “CREATING VALUE” MEANS HERE

At this age, building creates value when the thing you built **keeps working while you're not there** — through weird inputs, through other operators, through a week of your absence. A tool that needs its builder is a hobby; a tool that runs without them is infrastructure. The teen who crosses that line has learned what 'reliable' actually costs and why the world pays so much for it.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The tool from Q1 (or the automation from Q2) has real users now — and this quarter the teen steps away for a real week while someone else operates it from their runbook. If the docs are bad or the tool is fragile, real people feel it and say so. The stake is the builder's reputation with their own users, riding on work they can't touch for seven days. Nothing focuses documentation like knowing you won't be in the room.

THE ARTIFACT

The teen's real tool or automation, hardened and handed off: a failure-mode list with fixes or fences, a runbook another person actually operated from for a week without the builder's help, an incident log from that week, and a weekly health-check ritual the builder now runs.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A written failure-mode list exists and the top risks are fixed or fenced, including the 'builder disappears' risk.
- Another person operated the tool for a full week using only the runbook, with the builder forbidden from helping.
- The week's incidents are logged with what the operator did and what the runbook was missing.
- The runbook was updated from the incidents, and a recurring health-check ritual exists.

Unlocks after: Automate the Boring Part

1 List the ways it dies

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Reliability starts morbid: sit down and list every way your tool could fail. The categories: inputs go weird (you know this one), parts go missing (the shared doc gets deleted, the phone dies), people go wrong (a user does the unexpected), and the big one — *you* go missing. Any failure whose answer is 'well, I'd just fix it' is really the you-failure wearing a costume. Count how many of your answers are secretly you.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen's team-kit checklist ran perfectly for a month — then he got flu, missed the week, and nobody else knew how to reset it for the new match. The tool hadn't failed; the *system around the tool* had a single point of failure with a name and a temperature. Every builder discovers this; the good ones discover it on paper first.

03 APPLY IT

Take your real tool or automation and write its death list: at least eight ways it could fail, sorted into inputs / parts / people / builder-missing. For each, note how likely and how bad. Circle the top three by likely × bad — those are this quarter's targets.

04 REFLECT

How many failures on your list end with 'I'd just fix it'? What does that number tell you about the difference between a working tool and a reliable one?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the death list to one of your tool's actual users and ask: 'what have you seen it do, or almost do, that isn't on here?' Users have watched failures you never saw. Add them.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Play 'how could this die?' with a family member about any system in the house — the wifi, the meal plan, the bin rota. Teach the four categories, and especially the invisible one: the person everything quietly depends on.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Machines are excellent pessimists: describe your tool and ask 'list ways this could fail' — merge its list with yours and note which failures you missed (miss-patterns are self-knowledge). What stays yours is the triage: which failures are likely and costly *in your group's reality* — a model has never met your teammates or your teacher's formatting habits. AI proposes deaths; you rank them.

You'll need: Death list sheet (failure / category / likely / bad / top-3 circles)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A death list of 8+ failures exists across all four categories with likely/bad ratings.
- ☐ The top three are circled, and at least one 'I'd just fix it' answer is recognised as the builder-missing failure.

2 Fix, fence, or accept

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

Every failure on the list gets one of three verdicts: **fix** it (make it impossible), **fence** it (catch it loudly and route it to a human), or **accept** it (rare + cheap = write it down and move on). Trying to fix everything is how builders burn out and ship nothing; the craft is spending your effort on the circled three and consciously accepting the long tail. 'Accepted, on purpose, in writing' is a professional answer.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The checklist teen's verdicts: deleted-doc → fix (a weekly backup copy); flu-week → fence for now (a second person gets edit rights and a two-line 'if I'm gone' note); a teammate typing in the wrong column → accept (happens monthly, costs thirty seconds). Three verdicts, one afternoon — and the tool went from 'works' to 'survives'.

03 APPLY IT

Give every death-list entry a written verdict: fix, fence, or accept. Then implement the verdicts for your circled top three this week — the backup, the second key-holder, the loud error, whatever they need. Log what each took to implement.

04 REFLECT

Which accept-verdict felt most uncomfortable to write down? What's the difference between accepting a risk consciously and just hoping — and which had you been doing before this week?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Walk a user through your three implemented protections and ask: 'which failure that I *accepted* would actually annoy you most?' If their answer surprises you, your likely × bad ratings need their reality mixed in — re-verdict that one.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach fix/fence/accept to a friend using their own project or even their phone habits (lost phone: fix = backup on; fence = find-my-phone; accept = cracked screen). Three verdicts, everything sorted — watch how fast the framework sticks.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Implementation help is fair game — 'how do I auto-backup this doc?' is exactly what AI answers well, same rules as always: understand every piece you install. The verdicts themselves are budget decisions — your hours, your users' patience — and budget decisions belong to the person who pays. Beware the machine's completionism: asked for protections it will propose ten; your job is choosing the three that matter and writing 'accept' on the rest with a steady hand.

You'll need: Verdict column on the death list + implementation log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Every listed failure has a written fix/fence/accept verdict.
- ☐ The top three verdicts are actually implemented and logged.

Unlocks after: List the ways it dies

3 Write the runbook

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

A runbook is instructions for operating your tool written for someone who isn't you and can't ask you: what it does in one line, the routine (daily/weekly steps), what 'healthy' looks like, the three most likely problems with their fixes, and who to contact if truly stuck. The test of every sentence: could a smart stranger follow it at 9pm with you unreachable? Write for that stranger. They're coming.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Real operations teams live by runbooks — hospitals, data centres, theatres — because the person on duty is never the person who built the system. First drafts always fail the same way: 'reset the sheet like usual' (like *what*?), 'it's in the folder' (*which* folder?). The curse of knowledge is invisible to its owner, which is why the runbook gets tested next lesson, not trusted this one.

03 APPLY IT

Write your tool's runbook, one to two pages: one-line purpose, the operating routine step by step, a 'healthy looks like' picture or checklist, the top-three problems with exact fixes, and the escalation line. Include real names, real locations, real clicks — nothing 'as usual', nothing 'you know where'.

04 REFLECT

Which step was hardest to write down precisely — and is that because it's complicated, or because you've never actually watched yourself do it? What does the hard-to-write step tell you about what you do on autopilot?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Do a tabletop read-through with your chosen operator (next lesson's volunteer): they read aloud, you stay silent, and every time they frown you mark the sentence. Rewrite every marked sentence before the real test.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Have a family member write a mini-runbook for something *they* run on autopilot — the washing machine, the family calendar — and be their frowning stranger. Teaching someone else to see their curse of knowledge is the fastest way to see your own.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Draft the runbook yourself — writing it is how you discover what you do on autopilot, and that discovery is half the quarter. Then a genuinely sharp use: paste the draft in and ask 'what would confuse someone following this at step N? what's ambiguous?' — machines are ruthless ambiguity-detectors. Accept its clarity fixes; reject any step it *invents*, because a runbook that's confidently wrong is worse at 9pm than one that's honestly incomplete.

You'll need: Runbook template (purpose / routine / healthy / top-3 problems / escalation)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A complete runbook exists with all five sections and zero 'as usual' steps.
- ☐ Every sentence that made the read-through operator frown was rewritten.

Unlocks after: Fix, fence, or accept

4 The handoff week

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

Now the real test: someone else operates your tool for a full week, using only the runbook. Your rule is brutal and non-negotiable — *you may not help*. Watch, log, but don't touch: every question they'd ask you is a hole in the runbook, and answering it out loud patches the operator instead of the document. The tool and the docs take the exam; you sit in the corner learning what you actually built.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Software teams call this a bus test — could the project survive its creator being hit by a bus (or flu, or exams)? The checklist teen's handoff week produced four incidents: three the operator solved from the runbook (pass), one where she improvised something better than his documented fix (the runbook got *her* version). The week hurt his pride slightly and his tool not at all — which is the entire point.

03 APPLY IT

Recruit your operator, hand over the runbook, and step away for seven real days. Keep an incident log from a distance: what happened, what the operator did, whether the runbook had it covered. If you catch yourself about to intervene, write down what you were going to say instead — that sentence belongs in the runbook.

04 REFLECT

What was hardest about not helping? Which incident would have been invisible to you forever if you'd hovered and quietly fixed things — and what did your absence make visible?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Debrief the operator at week's end with three questions: where did the runbook fail you? what did you work out yourself? would you run it another week? Their third answer is the tool's real reliability grade.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell the handoff-week story to another builder — the incidents, the not-helping, what the absence revealed. Then challenge them to name who could run *their* project for a week, and help them plan their own handoff. The bus test spreads one uncomfortable week at a time.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The one thing this week measures is whether the *system* — tool plus runbook plus fences — stands without any clever head nearby, so don't let the operator quietly substitute AI for you as the helper of last resort; if they must ask something outside the runbook, they ask a human and it gets logged as an incident. After the week, AI can help you sort the incident log into runbook fixes versus tool fixes. During the week: hands off, all of you.

You'll need: Incident log (event / operator action / runbook covered?) + operator debrief sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A full week's handoff happened with the builder verifiably not helping.
- ☐ An incident log exists, and the operator answered the three debrief questions.

Unlocks after: Write the runbook

5 The health-check habit

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Reliability isn't a project; it's a rhythm. Systems drift — data piles up, workarounds accumulate, the fence everyone ignores rusts open. The finishing move of this quarter is a small recurring ritual: a weekly five-minute health check against your 'healthy looks like' list, plus folding the handoff week's lessons back into the runbook and the tool. Builders who check weekly fix things while they're small. Everyone else meets their failures fully grown.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Pilots walk around the plane before every flight — not because they expect a problem, but because the walk-around finds the problem *before altitude does*. The checklist teen's five-minute Friday check has twice caught the backup silently failing — a failure that costs nothing on Friday and everything the week the doc gets deleted. Drift never announces itself; the ritual is how you hear it anyway.

03 APPLY IT

Update the runbook and tool from the handoff week's incident log — every hole patched, the operator's better fix adopted. Then design your health check: five minutes, a fixed day, a short checklist against 'healthy looks like'. Run it for the first time now, put it in your calendar as recurring, and log what the first run found (even if the answer is 'all healthy').

04 REFLECT

Look back across the quarter: death list, verdicts, runbook, handoff, ritual. Which single piece would have saved past-you the most pain if you'd had it in Q1? What will you build *differently from the start* next time because of this quarter?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the updated runbook and the health-check ritual to your operator and ask the graduation question: 'would you now trust this tool for a month without me?' If yes, the quarter succeeded. If no, their reason is your next verdict to implement.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the whole reliability ladder — death list, fix/fence/accept, runbook, handoff, health check — to a friend with a project that has real users, and help them run their first health check. When their calendar has a recurring five-minute slot with the tool's name on it, you've handed the habit on.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can turn your incident log into runbook edits and draft the health-check checklist from your 'healthy looks like' notes — clerical lifting, fine, verify every line against the real tool. The habit itself cannot be delegated: the ritual works because a human who cares looks at the real system on a real day each week. The machine can remind you it's Friday. Only you can do the walk-around.

You'll need: Updated runbook + health-check checklist + recurring calendar slot

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The runbook and tool are updated from every handoff incident.
- [ ] A recurring five-minute health check exists in the calendar and its first run is logged.

Unlocks after: The handoff week

BUILD · Q4

Build the Delivery Machine

bu-13-14-q4 · supporting: Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

By Q4 of this band a teen has built tools with users, automated real work, and survived a handoff week — so they know the difference between something that works once and something that runs. What the Venture Month demands is new: *throughput under pressure*. At 13–14 they can batch work, design simple processes, and keep quality standards when tired — but only if the process decides for them. Willpower-based quality collapses in a busy week at any age; process-based quality is what this quarter installs.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, building creates value when the venture can **take an order and deliver it, reliably, at the pace the month demands** — without heroics and without the founder doing every step by hand. The teen who turns their craft into a delivery machine discovers the difference between selling their hours and building something that multiplies them: the deepest builder-lesson this band can teach.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The pull is watching the machine hum: a peak Saturday that used to mean chaos now flows — orders in, batches out, quality holding, buffer absorbing the surprise. The stress-test at the quarter's end is a real performance with a clock and a scoreboard, and passing it is proof of a skill no one can fake: the teen didn't just make things this year; they built the thing that makes things.

THE ARTIFACT

The venture's delivery machine, documented and stress-tested for the Venture Month: an order-to-delivery flow map, founder-only steps reduced by templates and batching, a production plan with buffers sized to the month's targets, a busy-week quality check, and the results of one real peak-load test with its fixes applied.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A drawn order-to-delivery flow exists and the teen can point to where orders wait and why.
- At least two steps that only the founder could do are now templated, batched, or handed off.
- A production plan with a buffer exists that covers the month's weekly targets inside the plan's hour budget.
- One peak-load test was actually run, its failures logged, and at least one fix applied.

Unlocks after: Make It Run Without You, Plan the Venture Month

1 Map order-to-delivery

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Every venture has a hidden assembly line: the path from 'yes, I'll buy' to 'delivered, thanks'. Most founders have never drawn theirs — it lives in their head as a blur of doing. Draw it as stages with times: order arrives → confirmed → made/prepared → packed → delivered → followed up. The map turns 'busy' into something you can point at — and your Think-quarter eye will immediately start hunting the pile-ups.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A bracelet seller drew her line and was shocked: making a bracelet took 12 minutes, but each *order* took closer to 40 — confirmation messages back and forth, finding the right beads mid-order, walking deliveries one at a time. The product was fast; the *process* was slow. Nobody can fix a blur; everybody can fix a map.

03 APPLY IT

Draw your venture's order-to-delivery map: every stage, who does it, how long it really takes (time one real order end-to-end if you can). Mark where orders wait, where mistakes happen, and which stages the customer actually notices versus the ones only you see.

04 REFLECT

Where does an order spend most of its life — being worked on, or waiting? What surprised you about the gap between product time and process time?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Walk one recent customer's actual order through the map with someone — does the map match what really happened? Every mismatch is a stage you forgot you do. Add it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Map a household 'order line' with a family member — dinner from decision to table, laundry from basket to drawer. Teach the move: stages, times, waits. Household lines are full of the same lessons, minus the customers.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The map must come from timing your real orders — a model can sketch a generic fulfilment flow, but the 40-minute bracelet truth only comes from your own stopwatch. After you've drawn it, fair use: describe your map and ask 'what stages do sellers like this usually forget?' (Follow-up and rework are the classics.) Check its suggestions against a real order before adding them.

You'll need: Order-to-delivery map sheet (stages / who / time / waits)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A complete map exists with real times from at least one traced order.
- ☐ Wait points and mistake points are marked.

2 Fire yourself from two jobs

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Look at your map and mark every stage with a crown: *only I can do this*. Some crowns are real (your craft, your judgment). Most are fake — things only you do because only you've ever done them. The three de-crowning tools: **template** it (the confirmation message, the label, the FAQ answer), **batch** it (all deliveries in one trip, all replies at 5pm), or **hand it off** (your runbook skills make this possible now). Every fake crown you remove is capacity the month will need.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The bracelet seller's crowns: designing (real — her taste is the product) and answering every message live (fake — a saved reply template answered 80% of questions), plus walking each delivery separately (fake — Tuesday and Friday delivery batches, announced in advance, cut delivery time by two-thirds). Her making time didn't change; her *order* time halved.

03 APPLY IT

Crown-audit your map. For every crowned stage, write real or fake and why. Then fire yourself from at least two fake-crown stages: build the template, set the batch schedule, or hand the stage off with a mini-runbook. Re-time an order through the new line.

04 REFLECT

Which fake crown was hardest to give up — and was that about quality, or about liking being needed? What's the difference between a venture that needs you and one that needs *your best*?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask a customer who experienced both versions (or show them both flows): did the template or batch make service worse, better, or invisible? 'Invisible' is a pass; 'better' is a bonus; 'worse' means the crown was real — put it back.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the crown audit to a friend drowning in their own project or chores: mark the crowns, sort real from fake, pick one to template or batch. The phrase to gift: 'only-I-can-do-this is usually a habit wearing a crown.'

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI is a template factory — saved replies, label formats, FAQ drafts — and using it here is exactly right; polish its drafts into your voice once and reuse forever. The judgment it can't make: which crowns are real. Your taste, your quality bar, your customer relationships — a model will happily suggest templating those too, and that way lies a venture that feels like a vending machine. You decide what stays human; the machine helps with everything you've decided shouldn't need you.

You'll need: Crown audit sheet + templates/batch schedule for two de-crowned stages

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Every crowned stage is marked real or fake with a reason.
- ☐ Two fake-crown stages are templated, batched, or handed off, and an order was re-timed through the new line.

Unlocks after: Map order-to-delivery

3 Batch, buffer, and the make-ahead question

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

The month's plan (your Think Q4 hour budget) sets a pace: so many units, so many hours. Two machine-design questions decide whether the pace is survivable. *Make-ahead or make-to-order?* — ahead is efficient but risks waste; to-order is safe but slow under load. *Where's the buffer?* — the small stock of finished goods, prepped materials, or reserved hours that absorbs a surprise spike without breaking the week. Every real operation, from bakeries to hospitals, lives on these two answers.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A cookie seller's month needed 60 cookies a week. To-order meant baking four separate school nights — impossible inside her hour budget. Her machine: one Sunday batch of 70 (make-ahead), the extra 10 as buffer for the week's surprise orders, and a rule — buffer empty by Wednesday means a Thursday mini-batch. Same oven, same hours, but now the *plan* did the worrying instead of her.

03 APPLY IT

Take your weekly target from the venture plan. Decide make-ahead vs make-to-order (or the split) for each product/service, with the reason. Size your buffer: how much extra, stored where, and the rule for when it triggers a top-up. Write the week's production schedule — which hours, which days — inside your real hour budget.

04 REFLECT

What does your buffer cost (materials, storage, risk of waste) versus what does it buy (calm, speed, saved Saturdays)? Where did you choose safety over efficiency, and why is that the right trade for a month with your name on it?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the production schedule to whoever shares your kitchen/space/materials. Ask: 'which of these slots will collide with real life?' Fix the collisions now — the pre-mortem said exam week is coming.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain make-ahead versus make-to-order to a family member using a real shop you both know (the bakery makes ahead; the satay stall grills to order — why?). Then show them your machine's answer and let them challenge it.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Buffer math is honest arithmetic on your own numbers — targets from your plan, times from your map — and AI can check it ('does this schedule actually produce 60 units in these hours?'). What it can't know: your fridge space, your Sunday energy, how your product ages. The classic failure is letting a model optimise for efficiency when what your month needs is *slack* — machines under-value slack because they've never had a bad week. You have. Size the buffer like someone who has.

You'll need: Production plan (make-ahead decisions / buffer size & rule / weekly schedule)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A make-ahead/make-to-order decision exists per product with reasons.
- [ ] A sized buffer with a top-up rule and a weekly schedule fit inside the plan's hour budget.

Unlocks after: Fire yourself from two jobs

4 Quality that survives a busy week

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Quality by inspection-when-you-remember dies in week two of a real month. Machine-grade quality is a *checklist at a chokepoint*: one fixed check, at the stage where catching a problem is cheapest, with a written bar for what ships and what doesn't. And decide *now*, while calm, what happens to the not-quite-right ones — the 'seconds' policy: fix, discount honestly, or don't ship. Deciding at 9pm on a busy Friday, you'll ship them. Deciding today, you won't have to.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Week three, 40 orders, tired hands: this is when the crooked bracelet ships and a customer posts a photo. The seller's defence, built in advance: a ten-second check against three written criteria (clasp holds, pattern matches order, no sharp edges) at packing — the chokepoint — and a seconds-box whose contents get sold honestly at the market as 'imperfects, half price'. Quality stopped being a mood and became a station on the line.

03 APPLY IT

Write your quality bar: the three to five things that make a unit shippable, phrased so a tired you can check them in seconds. Choose the chokepoint stage for the check and add it to the map. Write the seconds policy. Then check a real batch against the bar and log what it catches.

04 REFLECT

Think of the worst unit you've ever shipped — would this bar have caught it, and at what stage? Why is 'decide the standard while calm' the same move as the pre-mortem and the stop-condition (your whole year is one idea wearing different hats)?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Give a customer or honest friend two units — one that passes your bar, one from the seconds box — without labels. If they can't tell which is which, your bar may be stricter than your customers need; if they instantly can, it's about right. Calibrate.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach 'checklist at the chokepoint' to a friend whose work gets sloppy under pressure — homework, sport kit, anything. Help them write a three-line bar and pick the chokepoint. The skill is identical at every scale from bracelets to aircraft.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help phrase your criteria crisply and suggest what quality checks makers of your kind of product use — worth asking. The bar's *height* is a promise between you and your customers, and only you know what they paid for and what your name should mean; a model will set it generically. And never let 'the checklist passed' replace looking at the thing — the check serves your eyes, it doesn't retire them.

You'll need: Quality bar card (3-5 criteria / chokepoint / seconds policy)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A written quality bar and seconds policy exist, with the check placed at a chosen chokepoint.
- ☐ A real batch was checked against the bar and the catches were logged.

Unlocks after: Batch, buffer, and the make-ahead question

5 Stress-test the machine

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Before the month bets on the machine, break it on purpose one more time — at full speed. Simulate (or better, really run) a peak week: the biggest plausible order load from your pre-mortem, inside real hours, with the templates, batches, buffer, and quality check all live. Log every buckle: the stage that jammed, the check that got skipped, the buffer that ran dry. Then fix the worst one. A machine that has survived its stress-test gives you the month's rarest asset: earned calm.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Fire drills, dress rehearsals, load tests — every serious operation rehearses its peak before the peak. The cookie seller's test Saturday: a fake rush of 25 orders (friends recruited as customers, some deliberately awkward — 'no nuts', 'can I change my order?'). The line held except at packing, which jammed for 20 minutes — so packing got a template and a second pair of hands on rush days. The real month's biggest Saturday later beat the test by three orders. The machine held. She knew it would; that's the point.

03 APPLY IT

Design and run your peak-load test: the load (from your pre-mortem's biggest week), the awkward cases to inject, and the numbers to watch (orders completed, time per order, quality catches, buffer level). Run it for real. Log every buckle, pick the worst, fix it, and update the map, plan, and runbook to match what the test taught.

04 REFLECT

What buckled first — and had you predicted it? Compare your calm about the coming month before and after the test: what exactly did the rehearsal buy you, and what did it cost?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Debrief the test with your recruits: where did they wait longest, what felt chaotic from the customer side, what impressed them? The customer-side view catches what your logs can't. Fold it in.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell the stress-test story to another builder — the load, the buckle, the fix — and help them design a test for *their* venture's machine before their next big day. When they've scheduled a fake rush of their own, this quarter's craft has been fully passed on.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI is a good test designer — 'here's my machine; design a peak-load test with awkward cases I wouldn't think of' — and a good analyst afterwards on your logged results. The test itself must be run in the physical world with real hands and a real clock: the whole point is discovering what reality does to the plan, and no simulation of your Saturday knows your Saturday. Machine designs the drill; reality grades it; you fix what it finds.

You'll need: Stress-test plan (load / awkward cases / metrics) + buckle log + updated docs

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A peak-load test was actually run with metrics logged.
- ☐ The worst buckle is fixed and the map, plan, and runbook reflect what the test taught.

Unlocks after: Quality that survives a busy week

CREATE WEALTH · Q1

Ship a Real Micro-Offer

cw-13-14-q1 · supporting: Communicate, Build

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, abstract reasoning is coming online: a teen can hold a hypothesis, test it, and revise. Peer standing is now a dominant social force — being *seen* as competent matters more than adult approval. They can handle real transactions and real rejection, and money stops being abstract. What they can't yet do reliably is sit with delayed payoff, so feedback loops must be short and visible.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, 'creating value' means a **real stranger voluntarily pays or opts in** — not a parent buying to be kind, not a simulation. The unit of proof is the first genuine yes from someone with no obligation to say it. Scale, margin, and branding come later; the whole quarter turns on crossing from 'imagined customer' to 'real one'.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The teen sets a public, concrete target — first RM100 (or $100) of genuine revenue, or first 20 real opt-ins — and reports progress to a small group of peers doing the same. Real money and visible peer progress do the motivating; the adult never has to nag. The stakes are small enough to be safe and real enough to sting, which is exactly the range that drives effort at this age.

THE ARTIFACT

A live micro-offer (product or service) with a written one-line value proposition, a price, and a record of its first real customer interactions — captured in a simple one-page 'offer sheet' plus a running tally of yeses and nos.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child can state, in one sentence, who the offer is for and what problem it solves.
- At least three real people outside the family were asked to buy or opt in, and the responses (yes/no + why) are written down.
- The child can explain why they set the price they set.

1 Value = someone else's problem, solved

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Value isn't how hard you worked or how cool your idea is — it's whether it removes a problem *someone else* actually has. If no one has the problem, there's no value, however clever the solution.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A 14-year-old noticed neighbours struggling to set up new phones. She didn't build an app — she offered a 30-minute 'new phone setup' visit for RM20. The problem was real and annoying enough that people paid.

03 APPLY IT

Write down five real problems you've personally watched someone struggle with in the last month. Not global problems — small, specific, local ones. Circle the one where you could imagine helping this week.

04 REFLECT

Which of your five is a problem *you* find interesting versus one *others* actually feel? Are they the same? If not, which should win?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Read your circled problem to one person who fits the group that has it. Ask: 'Is this actually annoying to you, or only a little?' Write down their exact answer.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to a younger sibling or friend, in under a minute, why a brilliant idea nobody needs is worth nothing. Use your own example.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Use AI to *broaden* your problem list — 'what do people my age's parents commonly find annoying about tech?' — after you've written your own five. Do NOT let it generate the list first: the point is to train your own noticing. And never let AI tell you whether a problem is real; only a real person you ask can answer that.

You'll need: Problem-spotting worksheet (5 rows + circle)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Five real, specific, observed problems are written down.
- ☐ One is circled with a reason it was chosen.

2 Find one real person, not an imaginary market

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

Beginners invent a giant 'everyone' who wants their thing. Real founders find *one* actual person first. One real yes teaches more than a thousand imagined ones.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Before building anything, a teen selling custom study playlists messaged three classmates by name and asked if they'd use one. Two said yes, one said 'only if it's free' — which taught him his price was the problem, not his product.

03 APPLY IT

Name three specific real people (first names, people you can actually reach) who have the problem you circled. Not 'students' — actual humans.

04 REFLECT

Was it easy or hard to name three? If it was hard, that's a signal — maybe fewer people have this problem than you thought. What does that tell you?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Message or speak to one of the three. Just describe the problem, not your solution, and ask if they recognise it. Write down whether they lit up or shrugged.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell a parent the difference between 'my market is teenagers' and 'my first customer is Aisha in my class', and why the second is more useful.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you script an opening message so you're not awkward — a fine use. But it cannot be your customer. If you catch yourself asking AI 'would people want this?' instead of asking a person, stop: you're using the machine to avoid the scary-but-essential step of talking to a human.

You'll need: Named-customer worksheet (3 slots)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Three named, reachable people are listed.
- ☐ At least one was actually contacted and their reaction recorded.

Unlocks after: Value = someone else's problem, solved

3 Price is a question, not a guess

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

A price is really a question you ask the market: 'is it worth this to you?' A 'no' isn't failure — it's an answer that tells you where the real line is.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The phone-setup teen first said RM10, and everyone said yes instantly — which meant it was too cheap. She raised it to RM25; some said no, most still said yes. The 'some no' is how she knew she'd found roughly the right number.

03 APPLY IT

Pick a starting price for your offer and write one sentence on why. Then write the price you'd raise to if the first three people all say yes too easily.

04 REFLECT

How did it feel to attach a number to your own work? If it felt too high, is that the price talking or your nerves talking?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Say your price out loud to one person in your target group and watch their face before they answer. Note the reaction — the pause before 'yes' is data.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to someone why a price that everyone accepts instantly might actually be a mistake.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Ask AI how similar things are priced to get a rough range — useful reference. Then ignore it if your real three people tell you something different. The people paying always outrank the model guessing.

You'll need: Pricing worksheet (start price + raise-to price)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A starting price and a reason are written down.
- ☐ The price was said to at least one real person and their reaction noted.

Unlocks after: Find one real person, not an imaginary market

4 The one-line offer

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

If you can't say what you do in one sentence, the customer can't either — and a confused customer never buys. The offer sentence is: I help [who] do [what] so they [benefit].

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'I help busy neighbours set up a new phone in 30 minutes so they don't lose their photos or spend a whole afternoon.' One sentence, and the buyer instantly knows if it's for them.

03 APPLY IT

Write your offer in that exact template. Then cut every word that isn't doing work. Read it aloud — if you stumble, it's not clean yet.

04 REFLECT

Which was harder to pin down — the *who*, the *what*, or the *benefit*? The hard one is usually the part of your idea that's still fuzzy.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the sentence to two people. Ask each to tell you, in their words, what you're offering. If they get it wrong, the sentence — not the listener — needs fixing.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend write *their* one-line offer using the template. Teaching the format is the fastest way to own it.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a good place to let AI give you five rewrites of your sentence to react against — it's a sharp editor. But you must choose and finalise the line yourself, out loud, in your own voice. If the sentence sounds like a robot wrote it, your customer will feel it.

You'll need: Offer-sheet template (one page)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A single-sentence offer exists in the who/what/benefit format.
- ☐ Two people were able to correctly restate it back.

Unlocks after: Price is a question, not a guess

5 The first real ask

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

Everything so far was preparation. The venture becomes real the moment you ask someone to actually say yes and pay or commit. Rejection here is the tuition — every no carries a reason you can use.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen selling handmade bracelets got four nos before the first yes. The nos weren't random: three said 'too expensive', so she offered a two-for-one and the yeses started. The rejections wrote her next move.

03 APPLY IT

Make your first three real asks this week. Record each as: who, yes/no, and the reason they gave. Aim for the first genuine yes.

04 REFLECT

What did the nos have in common? A pattern in your nos is more valuable than a lucky yes — what is yours telling you to change?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Bring your yes/no tally to your peer group or mentor. Together, name the single change most likely to turn the next no into a yes.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell someone the story of your first no and what it taught you. Framing rejection as information — not failure — is the skill you're really building.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Use AI afterward to help you spot patterns across your nos if you're stuck. Do NOT use it to avoid making the asks — no model can make the first real ask for you, and that discomfort is the whole point of the quarter.

You'll need: Yes/No tally sheet (who / result / reason)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ At least three real asks were made and logged with reasons.
- ☐ The child can name one pattern in the responses and one change they'll make next.

Unlocks after: The one-line offer

CREATE WEALTH · Q2

Know Your Numbers

cw-13-14-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, abstract quantities become workable: a teen can hold ratios, percentages, and per-unit thinking, and — crucially — can now treat *their own time* as a quantity with value, which younger children genuinely cannot. Having run a real micro-offer, they have real numbers of their own to reason about, which changes everything: arithmetic about your own money is a different subject from arithmetic about apples. The trap at this age is motivated math — bending the numbers to protect the venture they're proud of.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, wealth-thinking creates value when the teen can look at their own venture and answer, with evidence: **am I actually making money, per unit and per hour — and what should I change because of it?** Revenue is applause; margin is truth. A 13-year-old who has once computed their real hourly earnings and *acted* on it owns an idea most adults still avoid.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The numbers under the microscope are the teen's own — their real offer, their real costs, their real Saturday afternoons. The quarter ends in a real decision (raise the price, cut a cost, change the offer, or drop it) that changes what lands in their pocket next month. Getting the math right literally pays; getting it wrong literally costs. No worksheet can compete with that.

THE ARTIFACT

A one-page money picture of the teen's real micro-offer: true per-unit cost (materials and time included), effective hourly rate, margin, and a simple profit summary — plus one pricing or cost decision actually made and carried out because of what the numbers showed.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A written per-unit cost exists for the offer that includes materials, fees, and the teen's time.
- The teen can state their effective hourly rate and how it was computed.
- One real decision (price change, cost cut, offer change, or drop) was made from the numbers and actually carried out.
- The teen can explain the difference between revenue and profit using their own figures.

Unlocks after: Ship a Real Micro-Offer

1 What does one really cost?

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Most young sellers know their price and almost nothing else. The first real number is the true cost of *one* — one bracelet, one phone-setup visit, one commission. True cost means everything: materials, packaging, fees, transport, the free samples, the failed batch. Until you know what one costs, your price is a guess and your profit is a rumor.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen selling cookies at RM2 each 'made money' every weekend — until she costed one cookie honestly: ingredients 60 sen, packaging 15, stall share 25, plus the burnt tray split across the batch. True cost: RM1.15. Her 'RM2 profit per cookie' was actually 85 sen. Still profit — but half of what she was celebrating.

03 APPLY IT

Cost one unit of your real offer, honestly: list every material and fee, split shared costs (equipment, transport, spoilage) across the batch, and land on a true cost-per-unit. If you sell a service, cost one *delivery* of it. Keep the working — the working is the artifact.

04 REFLECT

Which cost surprised you most by existing at all? What were you unconsciously leaving out — and why is it always the costs that make the venture look better?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your cost sheet to an adult who buys things for a household and ask: 'what am I still forgetting?' Household veterans find invisible costs instantly. Add what they catch.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Take a product a friend or sibling loves — a bubble tea, a game skin — and work out together what one probably costs to make versus what it sells for. Teach them the phrase 'true cost of one'.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The costs must come from your receipts and your reality — a model asked 'what does it cost to make cookies?' invents a generic bakery, not yours. Use AI as a checklist-checker after your own pass: 'here are my cost categories for X; what do sellers of X usually forget?' Take the categories it suggests, then fill in real numbers yourself. Never let it fill in a number.

You'll need: Cost-of-one worksheet (materials / fees / shared costs / true cost)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A written true cost-per-unit exists with every category included and shared costs split.
- ☐ At least one previously invisible cost was found and added.

2 Your hour has a price

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

The biggest cost in a teen venture never appears on a receipt: your time. Total the hours one unit really takes — making, selling, travelling, messaging — and divide your profit by them. That's your *effective hourly rate*, and it's the venture's most honest number. It doesn't tell you to quit; it tells you what the venture must beat, and what your time is currently teaching you it's worth.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The cookie teen: 85 sen profit per cookie, about 40 cookies per weekend — RM34. But baking, packing, selling and cleaning took nine hours: RM3.80 an hour. A neighbourhood car-wash gig pays RM10. She didn't quit cookies — she decided the extra RM6/hour was the price of learning to run something of her own. But now it was a *decision*, not a blur.

03 APPLY IT

Track or reconstruct the full hours behind your last batch or week of the offer — every stage, honestly. Compute your effective hourly rate: total profit ÷ total hours. Write one sentence: 'my venture currently pays me RM__ per hour, and that is/isn't fine because ___.'

04 REFLECT

Is your rate higher or lower than you assumed? If a friend offered you that rate to do the same work for *them*, would you take it — and what does your answer tell you?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask a working adult what they'd say to your hourly rate and your 'because' sentence. Their reaction — impressed, alarmed, or nodding — is context you can't compute.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach a friend with a side hustle to compute their own effective hourly rate. Warn them it might sting, and teach the follow-up line: the number isn't a verdict, it's information.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The hours must be tracked or honestly reconstructed by you — nobody else was there, and rounding your hours down is the most popular way ventures lie to their owners. AI can help with the arithmetic and with framing comparisons ('what do typical part-time options pay a 13-year-old?') — but if you catch yourself wanting the machine to make the number look better, stop: the number is doing its job.

You'll need: Hours log + hourly-rate calculation sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A full hours count for one batch/week exists, all stages included.
- ☐ The effective hourly rate is computed with a written 'and that is/isn't fine because' sentence.

Unlocks after: What does one really cost?

3 Margin is the game

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Margin is the slice of each sale you actually keep: (price − true cost) ÷ price. It's the number that decides whether growth helps or hurts — selling more of a zero-margin thing just makes you busier. And there are exactly three levers that move it: raise the price, cut the cost, or cut the time. Every business decision you'll ever see is someone pulling one of the three.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Two stalls sell drinks. One sells 100 cups at 10 sen margin (RM10). The other sells 30 cups at 60 sen margin (RM18) — less work, more money. The busy stall *looks* more successful all day long. Margin is why looks lie, and why 'how many did you sell?' is the amateur question. The pro question is 'what do you keep per sale?'

03 APPLY IT

Compute your offer's margin from lessons one and two. Then write one concrete idea for each lever: what raising the price could look like, which cost could shrink, which step eats time without adding value. Rank the three by how much they'd move the margin.

04 REFLECT

Which lever feels scariest to pull — and is that fear about the business, or about awkwardness (like telling customers a higher price)? Ideas that are cheap to try but feel scary are usually the underpriced ones.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your three lever ideas to a fellow seller (or an adult who's run anything) and ask which they'd pull first and why. Note where their pick differs from your ranking.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain margin to a family member using the two-stalls story, then work out together the margin on something your household buys or makes. End with the three levers — see if they can name which one supermarkets pull hardest.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Margin math is simple enough to own with a calculator — do it yourself so the number feels like yours. Where AI helps is lever brainstorming breadth: 'how do small sellers of X usually cut costs?' will list ideas worth stealing. Where it can't help is the ranking: which lever fits *your* customers and *your* nerve is judgment, and it's the judgment this quarter is training.

You'll need: Margin worksheet + three-levers sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The offer's margin is computed and written down.
- ☐ One concrete idea per lever exists, ranked by expected effect.

Unlocks after: Your hour has a price

4 Run a margin experiment

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

You don't find out what a lever does by debating it — you pull it, briefly and reversibly, and measure. Pick your top-ranked lever, predict what it will do (to sales *and* margin), run it for one real selling cycle, and compare. A price rise that loses a few customers but lifts total profit is a win the spreadsheet can see and your nerves can't.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The cookie teen raised RM2 to RM2.50 — a two-way door, tested one Saturday. Prediction: lose maybe a quarter of buyers. Reality: sold 34 instead of 40, but margin per cookie jumped from 85 sen to RM1.35. Total profit went from RM34 to RM45.90 for *less* baking. The scary lever was the profitable one — which is exactly why it had gone unpulled.

03 APPLY IT

Write the experiment card: which lever, what change, your predicted effect on sales and profit. Run it for one real cycle (one market day, one week of orders). Record actual sales, margin, and total profit next to the prediction. Keep the change or roll it back — in writing, with the reason.

04 REFLECT

What did customers actually do versus what you feared they'd do? Where does your prediction error point — do you under-rate your offer, or over-rate your customers' price-sensitivity?

05 GET FEEDBACK

If any customer pushed back or walked away, note exactly what they said — that's the market speaking. Share the before/after card with your peer group or an adult and ask what they'd test next.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the experiment shape — predict, change one thing, measure one cycle, decide — to a friend with any venture, and help them run their first pricing test. The shape transfers to everything; the sooner they own it, the better.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The prediction goes down *before* the experiment and it's yours — that's how you learn what your instincts are worth (your Think decision journal should recognise this move). AI can help design a clean test ('what would make this price test unfair or misleading?') — a genuinely good use. But no model knows your customers; only the Saturday knows. Run the Saturday.

You'll need: Experiment card (lever / change / prediction / result / keep-or-rollback)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ An experiment card exists with a pre-registered prediction.
- ☐ One real cycle ran, results are recorded next to the prediction, and a keep-or-rollback decision is written with its reason.

Unlocks after: Margin is the game

5 The one-page money picture

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Everything this quarter compresses onto one page: what comes in, what goes out, what one unit truly costs, what an hour of you earns, the margin, and the experiment's verdict. Businesses call it a P&L; call it your money picture. Its job is to make the next decision obvious — and to be simple enough that you'll actually keep it updated.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Investors read a one-page summary before anything else, because a venture that can't fit its truth on a page usually doesn't know its truth. The cookie teen's page ended with one line — 'RM2.50 stays; next: cut packaging cost, it's 18% of true cost for zero taste' — which is a 13-year-old running a business by the numbers. That line is the whole quarter.

03 APPLY IT

Build your one-page money picture from the quarter's sheets. End it with two written lines: the decision you already made (and its measured result), and the *next* decision the page points to. Then act on the next decision — or schedule exactly when you will.

04 REFLECT

Looking at the finished page: is this venture worth your hours as-is, worth it after changes, or teaching you things worth more than the money? All three answers are wins — but which is true, on the evidence?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present the page to your decision-maker or peer group in under three minutes. Take one question you can't answer from the page, and add whatever number would have answered it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend with any venture — bake sales, commissions, reselling — build their own one-page money picture from scratch: cost of one, hourly rate, margin, next decision. If their page ends with a real next decision, you've taught the whole quarter.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can lay out the page and check your arithmetic — clerical work, fine. The two ending lines it must never write: what the numbers *mean* and what you'll *do* — that's the judgment the page exists to sharpen, and outsourcing it turns your money picture back into decoration. One last honest use: show it your page and ask 'what would a skeptical investor question here?' Then answer the question yourself, with a number.

You'll need: One-page money picture template (in / out / cost-of-one / hourly / margin / decisions)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A complete one-page money picture exists with all five numbers current.
- ☐ It ends with the made decision (with result) and a committed next decision.

Unlocks after: Run a margin experiment

CREATE WEALTH · Q3

Customers on Repeat

cw-13-14-q3 · supporting: Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, a teen can run a genuine comparison — two approaches, measured, winner chosen — and can handle the social exposure of asking for referrals and posting offers, which younger children find unbearable. Having real customers and real margins (Q1–Q2), they're ready for the question that separates ventures from lemonade stands: where does the *next* customer come from? The trap at this age is novelty-chasing — trying a new channel every week because trying feels like progress, instead of measuring one properly.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, wealth-thinking creates value when the teen builds a **repeatable path to the next customer** — not a lucky spike from one market day, but a channel they've tested, measured, and can run again next week for a known cost in time and money. Owning even one repeatable channel changes the venture from something that happens *to* the teen into something the teen operates.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

Every channel test is run with the teen's real offer, real time, and (sometimes) real money — and the scoreboard is real customers gained per hour or ringgit spent. A test that works grows their actual income; a test that flops costs a real Saturday. The quarter ends with a working acquisition routine, which means the stakes compound: the winner they find keeps paying every week after.

THE ARTIFACT

A channel test log covering at least two acquisition channels run for real — each with its cost in time and money, customers gained, and cost-per-customer computed — plus a referral ask actually made to real customers, and a written weekly acquisition routine built around the winning channel.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- At least two channels were tested for real, each with time/money spent and customers gained recorded.
- Cost-per-customer is computed for each channel and the teen can explain why the winner won.
- A referral ask was made to at least three real customers and its results are logged.
- A written weekly routine exists for running the winning channel, and it was run at least once.

Unlocks after: Know Your Numbers

1 Where do customers actually come from?

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Ask any seller where their customers come from and you'll get a shrug or a guess. But every customer arrived by some path — saw the stall, heard from a friend, read the group-chat post. Those paths are *channels*, and the first discipline of growth is embarrassingly simple: ask every customer 'how did you hear about this?' and write it down. You can't repeat a path you can't name.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen selling phone-setup visits assumed his poster did the work — it was his biggest effort. Asking his last ten customers: seven came from one neighbour's recommendation, two from his mum mentioning it, one from the poster. His marketing budget was pointed at his weakest channel. Ten questions fixed a month of guessing.

03 APPLY IT

Reconstruct where your existing customers actually came from — ask them if you don't know ('quick question: how did you first hear about my thing?'). Build the source map: every channel that has ever brought you a customer, with its rough count. Star the surprise.

04 REFLECT

Which channel was doing more work than you realised, and which less? Why do sellers instinctively credit the channel they *worked hardest on* rather than the one that worked?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your source map to a fellow seller or adult and ask what channels they'd add to the untested list — places your kind of customer gathers that you haven't touched. List every suggestion, even the awkward ones.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Next time you buy anything from a small seller, tell them how you found them — then teach a friend with a venture to ask the 'how did you hear?' question and keep the tally. It's the cheapest market research on earth.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The source map must be built from real answers by real customers — a model can only guess where customers *typically* come from, and 'typically' is exactly the guessing this lesson exists to kill. Where AI helps: brainstorming the untested-channels list for your kind of offer and your kind of town. It widens the menu; your customers' answers pick from it.

You'll need: Source map sheet (channel / customers so far / untested ideas)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A source map exists with real how-did-you-hear answers behind the counts.
- [ ] At least three untested channels are listed for the next lesson.

2 Design a fair test

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Channels can't be judged by feel — they get *tested*: pick two, define the same success measure for both (customers gained), cap what you'll spend on each (hours and money), and decide the finish line before you start. The cost side matters as much as the customer side, because the real question isn't 'did it work?' but 'what does one customer cost me through this door?'

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen tested 'posters at the community centre' against 'a post in the neighbourhood group chat, twice a week'. Same offer, same fortnight, budget capped: three hours + RM10 for posters, two hours for the chat posts. Without the caps and the finish line, she'd have done what everyone does — quit the slow one early and over-credit the fun one.

03 APPLY IT

Pick two channels from your untested list (or one untested versus your current best). Write the test card: the offer, the success measure, the spend cap for each (hours and RM), the finish line (two weeks or N attempts), and your prediction of which wins and by how much.

04 REFLECT

Which channel are you secretly rooting for — and is it the one that's fun to do, or the one the evidence from lesson one points at? What would it cost you to be wrong in each direction?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the test card to someone numerate and ask the lesson's own question back: 'is this test fair — same offer, same effort accounting, same finish line?' Fix any tilt they find before launching.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain to a friend why 'I tried posters once and nothing happened' isn't a test — no cap, no counter, no finish line. Help them design a fair two-channel test for their own venture using your card as the template.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Prediction first, in your own hand — this is your Decision Journal move applied to money. AI is a strong test-design assistant: 'what would make this comparison unfair or misleading?' catches tilts like different weeks, different offers, or forgetting travel time as a cost. But it doesn't know your neighbourhood; the channel *choice* comes from your source map and your read of where your customers actually are.

You'll need: Channel test card (channels / measure / caps / finish line / prediction)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A written test card exists with capped spend, a finish line, and a pre-registered prediction.
- ☐ An outside check confirmed the test is fair.

Unlocks after: Where do customers actually come from?

3 Run it and count everything

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

Now run the test exactly as designed — and count like an accountant, not a fan. Every hour spent, every ringgit, every customer gained *and which door they came through* (keep asking the how-did-you-hear question; it's your tracking system). At the finish line, compute the only number that settles arguments: cost per customer, in time and money, for each channel.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Her fortnight's tally: posters — three hours, RM10, two customers (1.5 hours + RM5 each). Chat posts — two hours, zero RM, five customers (24 minutes each). The chat won by a landslide she hadn't predicted; she'd rated posters higher because they felt more like *real marketing*. The counting beat the feeling — which is precisely the counting's job.

03 APPLY IT

Run both channels to the finish line, logging every cost and every customer with their door. Then compute cost-per-customer for each — hours and money separately — and write the verdict next to your prediction: what won, by how much, and how wrong were you?

04 REFLECT

Where did the numbers disagree with the feeling of the fortnight? Which channel *felt* productive versus which *was* — and what was making the loser feel good?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your tally to your peer group or an adult seller before declaring the verdict final. Ask one question: 'what am I not counting?' (Common answers: travel, materials for samples, replies to messages at 10pm.) Recompute if they catch something real.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach cost-per-customer to a friend with any venture using your own two-channel tally as the worked example. If they can compute theirs for even one channel, they've left the shrug-marketing club forever.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Every number in the tally comes from your logs — hours from your clock, customers from your how-did-you-hear answers. AI can check the arithmetic and, once the tally is honest, help you probe it ('what might explain the poster channel underperforming?'). What it must never do is fill a gap in your counting with a plausible estimate: one invented number and the verdict is fiction wearing a spreadsheet.

You'll need: Channel tally log (hours / RM / customers by door / cost-per-customer)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Both channels ran to the finish line with complete cost and customer logs.
- [ ] Cost-per-customer is computed for each and the verdict is written against the prediction.

Unlocks after: Design a fair test

4 The referral ask

~30 min

01 CONCEPT

Your cheapest channel is hiding inside your happiest customers — but word of mouth mostly doesn't happen on its own; it happens when you *ask*. The referral ask is one sentence at the moment of delight: 'If you know anyone else who'd want this, I'd love it if you passed my name on.' Optional: a small thank-you for referrals that land. The ask costs ten seconds and outperforms almost everything you'll ever pay for.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The phone-setup teen already knew seven of ten customers came from one neighbour's mouth — that was an *accidental* referral engine. He made it deliberate: after each visit, the one-sentence ask plus a card with his name. Referrals went from sometimes to steadily — same neighbourhood, same offer, ten deliberate seconds per customer.

03 APPLY IT

Write your referral ask in your own words, plus the moment you'll say it (right when the customer is happiest). Make the ask to at least three real customers this week. Log each: who, their reaction, and any referral that arrives in the following weeks (keep the door-tracking running — referrals are a channel now).

04 REFLECT

How did the ask feel the first time versus the third? Why do most sellers never ask — and what does the answer have in common with why most teens never send the outreach message (your Communicate quarter is smiling)?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask one customer who *did* refer someone: 'what made you pass my name on, and what would make it easier?' Their answer tells you whether the engine needs a better ask, a card, a reward, or just a better product.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the referral ask to any friend who sells or performs anything — the sentence, the moment, the log. Stand nearby for their first ask like they stood the queue with you. Ten seconds of courage, taught on, is a real gift.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The ask works because it's personal and deserved — a real teen, at a real moment of delight, in their own words. Drafting help is fine (tighten *your* sentence), but the moment-reading can't be delegated: no model knows when your customer's face says 'delighted'. And never fake urgency or invent 'my friend also wanted one' pressure tactics a model might suggest — trust is the asset the whole channel runs on.

You'll need: Referral ask card (the sentence / the moment / the log)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The ask was made to at least three real customers and logged with reactions.
- ☐ Referral arrivals are being tracked as their own channel door.

Unlocks after: Run it and count everything

5 Double down and make it a routine

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Growth isn't finding new channels forever — it's finding one that works and *running it on schedule*. Take your winner (tested channel or referral engine), and turn it into a weekly routine: what gets done, which day, how long it takes, and the one number you check (customers per week, cost per customer). A mediocre channel run every week beats a brilliant one run when you remember.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Her routine after the test: every Tuesday and Friday, 20 minutes — post in the neighbourhood chat with one fresh photo, answer replies, make the referral ask to the week's happiest customer, update the tally. Boring on purpose. Within a month the question changed from 'will anyone buy this week?' to 'how many this week?' — which is the sound of a venture becoming an operation.

03 APPLY IT

Write the weekly acquisition routine for your winning channel: steps, day, time-box, and the number you'll check. Run it once for real this week. Then close the quarter's loop: update your one-page money picture (Q2) with the new line — what a customer costs you to acquire, and what they're worth against it.

04 REFLECT

Customer worth minus customer cost: is the gap healthy? And the strategist's question — if you doubled the routine's hours, would customers double, or does this channel have a ceiling? How would you find out?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present the routine and the acquisition math to your peer group or decision-maker in three minutes. Take the hardest question you get; if you can't answer it from your logs, that's the number your routine starts tracking next week.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the whole quarter's ladder to a fellow seller — source map, fair test, cost-per-customer, referral ask, weekly routine — and help them find their one winning channel. When their routine has a fixed day and a number, the skill has been fully handed on.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you systematise — turning your winning channel into checklist steps, drafting the recurring post format — and that's honest leverage for the boring parts. The strategy stays yours: which channel deserves the routine, when a channel has hit its ceiling, when to test a new door. Those calls come from your logs and your neighbourhood, and by now you've earned the right to trust your own numbers over anyone's guess — including the machine's, and including your own feelings.

You'll need: Weekly routine card (steps / day / time-box / the number) + updated money picture

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A written weekly routine exists for the winning channel and was run at least once.
- ☐ The money picture now includes acquisition cost per customer beside customer worth.

Unlocks after: The referral ask

CREATE WEALTH · Q4

Run the Venture Month

cw-13-14-q4 · supporting: Think, Lead

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

This is the quarter where a 13–14-year-old does something most adults have never done: operate a real venture for a sustained month against a signed plan. Developmentally, everything required is now in place — the delayed-payoff tolerance the band started without has been trained by a year of short loops, and the teen can hold a plan, a rhythm, and a setback in the same week. What still needs holding is perspective when reality diverges from plan: at this age a bad week feels like a verdict. The month teaches that it's a data point.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, creating value means **a month of real operation, honestly accounted** — customers served week after week, money tracked to the ringgit, a wobble survived, and at the end a decision made from evidence: keep, change, or stop. The number matters less than the completeness: a teen who has run a whole month and closed the books owns an experience that no simulation, class, or summer camp can substitute.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

Everything from the year converges with real weight: the signed plan with the family watching, real customers with real orders arriving weekly, real money accumulating (or not) toward the goal, and a stop-condition that makes the green light meaningful. The month's stakes are the truest kind — visible weekly numbers against a public commitment — and the payoff at the end is owned outright: the verdict, the profit, and the story are all genuinely the teen's.

THE ARTIFACT

The completed Venture Month: four weeks of real operation logged, four weekly reviews held, one wobble diagnosed and handled, the books closed with final revenue-costs-profit against the plan, and a written keep-change-stop verdict with a plan for what the money becomes — all presented in a final review to the decision-maker who signed the plan.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The venture operated for four real weeks and all four weekly reviews happened with written answers.
- At least one mid-month problem was diagnosed with the year's tools and the response is documented.
- The books are closed: revenue, costs, profit, and hours against the plan's goal, arithmetic checkable.
- A written keep-change-stop verdict exists with reasons, the money's destination is decided and acted on, and the final review was presented to the plan's signer.

Unlocks after: Customers on Repeat, Plan the Venture Month

1 Week one: run the plan, log the truth

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Week one has one job: execute the plan as written and log what actually happens — orders, hours, costs, the input numbers, all of it. Not because week one will go to plan (it won't, quite) but because the *gap* between plan and reality is the month's most valuable information, and it's only visible if the logging is honest from day one. Operators log; dreamers remember.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Her week one: the Tuesday post shipped on time, the Sunday batch ran 40 minutes long (the log now knows batches cost more than the plan thought), 13 orders against a target of 15, and one cost nobody budgeted — RM6 of tape and labels. Nothing dramatic. But four such weeks, honestly logged, is exactly what 'running a business' means — and the tape line saved week three's budget.

03 APPLY IT

Run week one: the production schedule, the drumbeat, the acquisition routine, deliveries — all of it, logging as you go (money in/out, hours, input numbers, anything surprising). End the week by holding weekly review #1 on schedule: what happened, what did we learn, what one thing changes in week two.

04 REFLECT

Where did reality diverge from the plan first — and was it in the direction your pre-mortem guessed? What's the difference between how tired you expected to feel and how tired you are?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Share review #1's three answers with your plan's signer at the agreed slot. Their only job this week: confirm the review happened and hear the one change. The rhythm being real matters more than week one's numbers.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell a friend who 'wants to start something someday' what week one of really running something is like — the logging, the small gaps, the tape money. Puncture the dream gently and replace it with the real thing; the real thing is better.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The log is the month's foundation and it must be kept by the person living it — numbers typed in at the end of each real day, not reconstructed by anyone (or anything) later. AI's honest role starts at review time: with week one's real log in front of you, 'what should I be asking about these numbers?' is a fair prompt. The answers you act on remain yours — it's your name on the plan.

You'll need: Venture Month log (money / hours / inputs / surprises) + review #1 sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Week one ran with a complete daily log of money, hours, and input numbers.
- ☐ Review #1 happened on schedule with written answers and one change chosen.

2 Steer by the numbers

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Weeks two and three are where the review rhythm earns its keep. Each week the same discipline: inputs versus targets, results versus goal, one change — and only one, so you can tell what worked (your experiment training, now running live). The operator's skill being built: reading which gaps are noise ('rain Saturday') and which are signal ('asks are up, sales aren't — the offer message is leaking'). Noise you ride out. Signal you act on.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Week two's review showed the classic split: input numbers on target (posts shipped, 20 asks made) but sales at 60% of goal. Noise or signal? The log had the answer — replies were warm but 'maybe next week' kept appearing: a timing objection, not an interest one. One change: pre-orders for the following Saturday with pick-of-the-batch for early birds. Week three: 118% of target. That's steering — and it only works because only one thing changed.

03 APPLY IT

Run weeks two and three at full rhythm, holding both reviews. At each: sort the plan-versus-reality gaps into noise or signal (write which and why), choose the one change, and predict its effect before the next week grades it — your decision journal running at business speed.

04 REFLECT

Which gap did you initially misread — noise called signal, or signal called noise? What information settled it, and how would you spot it faster next time?

05 GET FEEDBACK

At each review slot, present the noise/signal sort to your signer and defend one call they question. Being made to defend the sort *is* the training; a signer who pushes back is worth double.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the noise-versus-signal sort to a friend tracking anything — grades, training times, follower counts. The gift phrase: 'one bad week is weather; the same bad week twice is climate.' Help them sort their own last month.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The noise/signal call is the month's hardest judgment and it belongs to you — but it's also where a second opinion is legitimately useful: paste the (real) weekly numbers and both hypotheses in and ask 'what evidence would distinguish these?' That's the machine as your Q1 sparring partner, pointed at operations. What it must never do is pick the change for you: the predict-then-grade loop only trains *your* judgment if the predictions are yours.

You'll need: Reviews #2-3 sheets with noise/signal sort and predicted-effect line

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Weeks two and three ran with reviews held, gaps sorted noise/signal in writing.
- ☐ Each week's single change carried a written prediction, graded the following week.

Unlocks after: Week one: run the plan, log the truth

3 Handle the wobble

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

Every real month contains a wobble — the supplier delay, the demand dip, the week your hours evaporate. The pre-mortem meant you saw it coming in category if not in costume. The operator's protocol: name it precisely (which stage, which number), check the plan's prepared response, size it honestly (annoyance, problem, or stop-condition?), act small and fast, and tell the people affected before they find out. Panic is a wobble plus silence. Calm is a wobble plus a protocol.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Week three, the classic double: exam week (pre-mortem, prepared — the buffer and the light schedule) plus the bead supplier going quiet (pre-mortem, prepared — the backup shop, 15% pricier). She ran the protocol: named both, triggered both responses, messaged the four affected customers a day early with the new delivery date — and logged the extra cost against the month. Two customers replied 'thanks for telling me'. The wobble cost RM11 and zero trust. That's the whole skill.

03 APPLY IT

When your wobble arrives (it will), run the protocol in writing: name it, check the pre-mortem, size it against the stop-condition, act, and communicate to anyone affected before they notice. Log the full cost — money, hours, and any trust spent or banked. If the month somehow stays smooth, run the protocol once as a drill on your most likely pre-mortem risk.

04 REFLECT

How did the wobble compare to the pre-mortem's imagined version — scarier or smaller? What did having a prepared response change about how it *felt*, not just how it went?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Debrief the wobble at the next review with your signer: what happened, what the protocol did, what it cost. Ask them about a wobble from their own working life and what their version of a pre-mortem would have caught. Trade stories; that's how operators learn.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell the wobble story to your peer group or a younger builder — including the message you sent customers before they noticed. Teach the line 'panic is a wobble plus silence'. The story of a handled problem is worth ten stories of smooth sailing.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

In the middle of a live wobble, the temptation is to ask a machine 'what should I do?' — resist the framing. The right prompt, if you use one, is your own protocol's: 'here's what happened and my planned response — what am I not seeing?' Thirty seconds of that is a fair check; but the sizing call against your stop-condition and the message to your customers are human duties. People forgive a problem told straight by a person. They don't forgive discovering it, or being handled by a robot when it mattered.

You'll need: Wobble protocol card (name / check / size / act / tell) + wobble log entry

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real wobble (or a full drill) was handled through the written protocol.
- ☐ Affected people were told before they noticed, and the full cost is logged.

Unlocks after: Steer by the numbers

4 Close the books

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

The month ends the way real businesses end periods: books closed, honestly. Total revenue, total costs (including the tape, the backup beads, the batch that failed), profit, hours worked, effective hourly rate — each against the plan's numbers. Then the operator's questions: where did the plan hold, where did it break, and *why* — with the answer traced to a specific week's log, not a feeling. A closed book is the difference between 'I think it went well' and 'I know exactly how it went'.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Her close: revenue RM486 (goal RM450), costs RM272 (plan said RM240 — the wobble and the tape), profit RM214, 41 hours, RM5.22/hour (up from Q2's RM3.80 — the machine and the channel earned their keep). Plan held on revenue, broke on costs, and the *why* was written in week three's log before she even looked. Closing took forty minutes, because the logging had done the work all month. Books that close fast are the receipt for a month logged honestly.

03 APPLY IT

Close the books: totals for revenue, costs, profit, hours, and hourly rate, each side-by-side with the plan. Write the holds and breaks with their traced whys. Update the one-page money picture with the month's final numbers — it now describes a business that has *operated*, not just sold.

04 REFLECT

Your hourly rate versus Q2's: what changed it — and which quarter's work (the machine? the channel? the plan?) deserves the credit? If the number went down: what did the month buy that the rate doesn't show?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Have someone numerate audit your close — check the arithmetic, question one cost, verify a traced why against the log. Passing an audit is a business skill in itself; welcome the red pen.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach a friend with any money-making activity to close one month of books — even roughly. Sit with them through the uncomfortable parts (the forgotten costs, the honest hours). The moment their real hourly rate lands is the moment you've passed on the year's most clarifying number.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Arithmetic checks and layout help: fine, as always — and by now you know why the numbers themselves must come from your log, not a model's reconstruction. The new frontier this lesson: resist asking AI to *explain* your variances. The whys must be traced to specific logged events, because 'plausible explanation' and 'what actually happened' are different things, and a closed book full of plausible stories is a beautifully formatted lie. Trace, don't theorize.

You'll need: Books-close sheet (totals vs plan / holds and breaks with traced whys) + updated money picture

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The books are closed with every total side-by-side against the plan and arithmetic verified by an auditor.
- ☐ Every hold and break carries a why traced to a specific logged event.

Unlocks after: Handle the wobble

5 Keep, change, or stop — and what the money becomes

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

The year's final decision is the fullest one: keep the venture as is, change it (what, exactly, and why), or stop it well — and every answer can be right. The evidence is all in: the closed books, the reviews, the hourly rate, what it cost your weeks. Then the second decision most young sellers never make consciously: what the money *becomes* — a split across save, reinvest, give, and spend, decided on purpose. Ventures end or continue; the habit of deciding-from-evidence is the asset that compounds either way.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Three real verdicts from three real teens, all correct: keep (the numbers work and season three has a waiting list); change (the product's fine but Saturdays cost too much — moving to pre-order only); stop — written with pride: 'RM214 profit, but 41 hours a month isn't what I want year two for; I'm taking the operating skills to something new.' The third teen's parents later said the stop-memo impressed them more than the profit had. Stopping well, from evidence, is an operator's move.

03 APPLY IT

Write the verdict memo: keep/change/stop, the three strongest pieces of evidence behind it, and — echoing your Q2 journal — what would have changed your mind. Decide the money split (save/reinvest/give/spend) with a reason per bucket, and act on it. Then present the whole arc — plan, month, books, verdict, split — to your plan's signer as the final review.

04 REFLECT

A year ago you made your first real ask; this week you presented audited books and a verdict. What's the biggest change — in the venture, or in you? And what does your verdict memo teach you about how you want to decide things at 15?

05 GET FEEDBACK

At the final review, ask your signer two questions: 'what did this year change about what you'd trust me with?' and 'what would you have done differently in my month?' Write both answers into the memo — the first is your earned autonomy in writing; the second is free consulting.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Package the year for the next teen: walk a younger sibling, cousin, or friend through the whole arc — first yes, real numbers, the machine, the channel, the month, the verdict — in fifteen minutes with your real artifacts as the slides. You're not just teaching a venture; you're proving to both of you that the whole thing is learnable. That proof is the band's true capstone.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The verdict is the one decision this year that must be made entirely unaided first — sit with the closed books and write keep/change/stop in your own hand before consulting anyone, machine or human. Then take counsel in the right order: the machine for stress-testing ('argue against my verdict'), the humans who watched your month for wisdom the numbers can't hold. The money split is a values question, not an optimisation — no model knows what saving, giving, or a new bet means to you at 14. A year of AI judgment comes down to this: the machine sharpened your thinking all year precisely because it was never allowed to do it for you.

You'll need: Verdict memo template (verdict / evidence / mind-changer / money split) + final review checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A verdict memo exists with evidence, a mind-changer line, and an acted-on money split.
- ☐ The final review was presented to the plan's signer and their two answers are recorded in the memo.

Unlocks after: Close the books

Ages 15-16

THINK · Q1

Choose Your Problem

th-15-16-q1 · supporting: Explore

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 15–16, abstract reasoning is essentially adult-grade: a teen can weigh long horizons, reason about their own aptitudes, and commit to something for a year. What's new — and urgent — is that choices start to *compound*: subjects, skills, and projects picked now visibly shape what's reachable at 18. The risk at this age is not inability but drift (defaulting into whatever's nearest) or its opposite, paralysis (keeping every option open until options expire). Choosing deliberately, with evidence and exit criteria, is developmentally ready and rarely taught.

WHAT “CREATING VALUE” MEANS HERE

At 15–16, thinking creates value when it picks the **right thing to spend a year on** — a domain or problem chosen at the intersection of genuine interest, demonstrated aptitude, and real demand, committed to in writing with kill-criteria. The deliverable isn't certainty (nobody has that); it's a defensible bet the teen can pursue wholeheartedly *because* they know exactly what would change their mind.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

This quarter hands the teen the steering wheel of their own year: the domain they choose here becomes the backbone of their Build craft, their Wealth bets, and their year-end Open Door. No parent or teacher picks it. The seriousness of the commitment — a year of their one life, chosen by them, in writing — is the motivation; at 15, being trusted with a real bet on yourself outranks any external reward.

THE ARTIFACT

A year-bet memo: the domain or problem the teen will go deep on this year, chosen from a researched shortlist — with the evidence for interest, aptitude, and demand; the strongest case against it; kill-criteria that would trigger a re-decision; and a first-quarter commitment calendar.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A shortlist of at least three candidate domains was researched with real evidence gathered for each.
- The memo states the chosen bet with evidence on all three axes — interest, aptitude, demand — and an honest case against.
- Written kill-criteria exist: observable conditions that would trigger reconsidering the bet.
- The teen can explain why the runner-up lost, and the choice is reflected in an actual weekly time commitment.

1 The compounding decade

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

From here, effort compounds: a year of focused work on one thing beats three years of scattered dabbling, because skill, reputation, and opportunity feed each other — but only when they stack in one place. The strategic question of being 15 isn't 'what am I passionate about?' (feelings change) but 'where should my next year of hours stack?' That's a decision, and decisions can be made well.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Two capable teens, same year: one spent it sampling — a month of chess, a month of editing, a month of three other things; the other spent it on video editing alone — awful in January, paid by a local business in November. Sampling *felt* safer and taught surfaces; stacking built something the world could see and pay for. (Sampling has its place — it's how you build a shortlist. It's just not a strategy for a year.)

03 APPLY IT

Audit your last twelve months: where did your discretionary hours actually go? Cluster them and ask of each cluster: did this stack (skills building on skills) or scatter? Write the one-line verdict on your current default trajectory — because doing nothing this quarter *is* choosing it.

04 REFLECT

If your last year's pattern simply repeats until 18, where does it land you — and is that a place you chose or a place you drifted? What's the difference in how those two futures feel?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your hours audit to an adult who knows you well and ask: 'what do you see me getting genuinely better at — and what am I just cycling through?' Their outside view of your stacking is data your inside view can't produce.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain compounding-versus-scattering to a friend using your own audit as the exhibit. If they immediately ask 'so what should I stack?', resist answering — teach them that the *question* is the gift; the shortlist comes next.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The hours audit is archaeology on your own life — calendars, chats, memory — and no model can dig that site. Where AI serves here: after your audit, ask it to challenge your clustering ('are these really one skill or three?'). The temptation to resist: asking AI what's *worth* stacking in, in general. Generic answers about 'high-value skills' are averages over millions of strangers; your bet must be built from your evidence, which is the next four lessons' work.

You'll need: Twelve-month hours audit sheet (clusters / stacked or scattered / trajectory verdict)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A twelve-month audit exists with clusters marked stacked or scattered.
- ☐ A one-line default-trajectory verdict is written.

2 Build the shortlist honestly

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

A good year-bet is found at an intersection: **interest** (you return to it without being pushed), **aptitude** (you improve faster than peers who try equally hard), and **demand** (someone, somewhere, pays for or deeply values it). One axis alone misleads — loving what you're bad at, being good at what bores you, chasing demand you feel nothing for. The shortlist is three to five candidates that plausibly score on all three, each written as a testable claim, not a vibe.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen's honest shortlist surprised her: 'drawing' (deep interest, slow aptitude growth despite years — hard to admit), 'explaining things' (she was the one everyone asked before exams; never counted it as a *thing*), and 'organising events' (two successful ones, enjoyed the chaos, real demand at school). The strongest candidates are often invisible because they don't look like subjects. Aptitude leaves tracks; follow the tracks, not the labels.

03 APPLY IT

Draft your shortlist of three to five candidate domains. For each, write one sentence per axis: the evidence of interest (what you return to unprompted), of aptitude (where you improve unusually fast — with an example), and of demand (who values it enough to pay, admit, or promote). Mark every sentence that's actually a hope rather than evidence.

04 REFLECT

Which candidate has the most hope-sentences dressed as evidence? And which axis do you systematically flatter — most people inflate interest, deflate aptitude, and ignore demand entirely?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the shortlist to two people who've seen you work — a parent and a non-parent. Ask each: 'where have you watched me improve fastest?' and 'what would you add that I've missed?' Unnoticed aptitude is the most common gift this conversation gives.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the three-axis test to a friend circling their own future. Help them draft a shortlist and hunt the hope-sentences. The move to model: admitting an axis is weak without abandoning the candidate — weak evidence means *gather more*, which is exactly the next lesson.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Interest and aptitude evidence lives in your history — only you (and people who know you) can testify. Demand is where AI genuinely helps: 'who pays for X? what adjacent skills does X unlock? what does the path from beginner to paid look like?' are researchable questions, and a model is a fast first pass — verified against real postings, real people, real prices, because models describe yesterday's demand. The synthesis — which candidates survive all three axes — is judgment, and it's yours.

You'll need: Shortlist grid (candidate × interest / aptitude / demand, hope-sentences marked)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A shortlist of 3-5 candidates exists with per-axis evidence sentences.
- ☐ Hope-sentences are marked, and outside observers contributed at least one addition or correction.

Unlocks after: The compounding decade

3 Test before you bet

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

You don't resolve a shortlist by more thinking — you resolve it by *cheap tests*: a weekend project per finalist, designed to generate the missing evidence. A good test is small (hours, not weeks), real (produces something or touches someone outside your head), and aimed at your weakest axis for that candidate. This is your old two-way-door discipline pointed at your own future: try before you buy, on doors that swing both ways.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Testing 'explaining things', she ran two cheap probes in a fortnight: recorded one ten-minute tutorial on the maths topic her class feared (aptitude test — was it actually clear?) and tutored two younger students for a fee (demand test — would anyone pay?). The video took a Saturday; the tutoring paid RM30 and produced a rebooking. Total cost: one weekend. Information gained: more than a year of wondering.

03 APPLY IT

For your top two or three candidates, design and run one cheap test each within two weeks: name the weakest axis, the test that probes it, what result would count as strong or weak evidence — written *before* you run it. Then run them and log what actually happened.

04 REFLECT

Which test result surprised you most against your prediction? Notice the feeling of *wanting* a test to succeed — how did you keep the scoring honest anyway, and where does that skill come from in your training?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show each test's result to someone from that domain if you can reach one (your outreach skills exist for this). Ask: 'is this beginner work promising or ordinary?' Calibration against the real field beats family applause.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the cheap-test move to a friend stuck choosing between futures: help them design one weekend probe for their favourite candidate, with the evidence bar written in advance. Deciding by experiment instead of agonising is the most transferable gift in this whole quarter.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Use AI to *design* sharper tests ('what's the cheapest way to test real demand for X?') and to critique your evidence bars before you run ('is this bar actually diagnostic?') — good uses both. The tests themselves must touch reality: real viewers, real students, real feedback from the field. A model's opinion of your tutorial is not evidence of aptitude; a confused real student is. Run the probes in the world; the world is the examiner.

You'll need: Test cards (candidate / weakest axis / test / evidence bar / result)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Cheap tests ran for the top candidates with evidence bars written before running.
- [ ] Results are logged against the bars, including at least one surprise.

Unlocks after: Build the shortlist honestly

4 Write the bet — and its kill-criteria

~50 min

01 CONCEPT

Now commit, on paper: the year-bet memo. The chosen domain, the evidence on all three axes, the strongest honest case *against* (your steelman years pay off here), and the part almost nobody writes — **kill-criteria**: the observable conditions under which you'd re-decide ('if by June I still haven't produced X', 'if three cheap attempts to find demand all fail'). Kill-criteria aren't pessimism; they're what makes wholehearted commitment safe. You can go all-in precisely because you know exactly where the exit is.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Her memo bet on 'explaining things — specifically, tutoring and tutorial content for maths-anxious students'. Case against, stated at full strength: crowded field, and she'd never sustained content-making beyond a month. Kill-criteria: 'if by end of Q2 my rebooking rate is under 50%, or I've skipped content three weeks running and don't miss it — re-decide.' Two years later she still quotes the memo's last line: *a bet with an exit written down is the only kind you can make with your whole chest.*

03 APPLY IT

Write the memo, one page: the bet, the three-axis evidence (from your tests, not your hopes), the runner-up and why it lost, the full-strength case against, two or three observable kill-criteria with dates, and the weekly hours you're committing. This memo feeds your Build, Wealth, and year-end quarters — write it like the founding document it is.

04 REFLECT

Does writing the kill-criteria make the bet feel weaker or stronger? Why do serious investors and scientists — the people whose bets matter most — insist on writing the exit before the entry?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present the memo to your decision-maker with the case against *first* (the risk-led pitch — you know this move). Ask them to challenge the kill-criteria: too loose and you'll drift for a year; too tight and one bad month kills a good bet. Calibrate together.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk a friend through writing their own one-page bet memo, insisting on the two parts they'll want to skip: the case against and the kill-criteria. If they push back that it's 'negative', teach the reframe: the exit clause is what buys the wholeheartedness.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The memo is a promise from you to you — evidence yours, voice yours, signature yours. The machine's one legitimate seat at this table is the oldest one in your training: 'here is my bet memo; argue against it as hard as you can.' If its best attack is one your case-against already contains, your memo is ready. If it lands a hit you hadn't written — write it in, and thank the sparring partner. Then sign the thing yourself.

You'll need: Year-bet memo template (bet / evidence / runner-up / case against / kill-criteria / hours)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A one-page memo exists with three-axis evidence, a full-strength case against, and dated kill-criteria.
- ☐ The memo was presented risk-first and the kill-criteria were calibrated with the decision-maker.

Unlocks after: Test before you bet

5 Protect the bet from your calendar

~35 min

01 CONCEPT

A bet without protected hours is a wish with paperwork. The final move: install the bet into your real week — recurring, named, defended blocks — and set up the drift-alarm: a monthly fifteen-minute self-review against the memo (hours actually spent? evidence accumulating? kill-criteria approaching?). Your whole toolkit reports here: the hour budget, the review ritual, the health check — now pointed at the most important system you'll ever operate, which is you.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

January's bet memos die in March, always the same way: not rejected — *displaced*, by homework surges and the path of least resistance, two weeks at a time. Her defence was mechanical, not motivational: Tuesday and Sunday blocks named 'the bet' in the family calendar (public = defended), and a monthly memo-review with one question — 'did the bet get its hours, and if not, what took them?' Eleven months later the bet was alive. The calendar, not the passion, kept it breathing.

03 APPLY IT

Install the bet: recurring weekly blocks in your real calendar matching the memo's committed hours, visible to your household. Design the monthly drift-review (fifteen minutes: hours check, evidence check, kill-criteria check) and schedule all of them through the year. Run the first week and the first review now.

04 REFLECT

What will most plausibly eat your bet's hours — and is your defence against it structural (a system) or aspirational (a feeling)? You know from three years of this curriculum which kind survives. Why is 'protect the hours' the last lesson of choosing rather than the first lesson of doing?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your installed calendar and drift-review to your decision-maker and make the ask explicit: 'these blocks are load-bearing — help me defend them.' A family that knows the Tuesday block matters is a structural defence; a family that doesn't is a risk your pre-mortem should have caught.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help your bet-memo friend from last lesson do their installation: blocks in the calendar, drift-review scheduled, household informed. Teach the closing line of the quarter: *choosing is an event; staying chosen is a system.* Then go make your Tuesday block.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Scheduling mechanics, reminder systems, drift-review checklists — automate freely; this is exactly the boring infrastructure AI and calendars exist for. The monthly review's three answers, though, are readings of your own life and appetite, and the year's verdict will be built from them — so they get written by your hand, in your memo, every month. A machine can guard the door of the review. Only you can show up inside it.

You'll need: Installed calendar blocks + monthly drift-review card (hours / evidence / kill-criteria)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Recurring bet-blocks are installed in a calendar the household can see, matching the memo's hours.
- ☐ The monthly drift-review is scheduled through the year and the first one has run.

Unlocks after: Write the bet — and its kill-criteria

THINK · Q2

Don't Fool Yourself

th-15-16-q2 · supporting: Explore

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 15–16, a teen can follow a statistical argument, hold two competing explanations for the same data, and — the crucial new capacity — turn skepticism on their *own* conclusions, not just other people's. They now swim in claims dressed as data: screenshots of studies, influencer statistics, algorithmic feeds optimised for certainty. The developmental risk isn't gullibility — it's *selective* rigor: teens this age can demolish arguments they dislike while giving a free pass to ones that flatter their side. Symmetric skepticism is the skill, and it's trainable now.

WHAT “CREATING VALUE” MEANS HERE

At this age, thinking creates value when the teen can take a question that matters to them, gather real data honestly, and produce **an answer they'd bet on — with its limitations stated out loud**. The physicist Richard Feynman's line is the quarter's banner: 'the first principle is that you must not fool yourself — and you are the easiest person to fool.' A 16-year-old who has once caught their own motivated reasoning in the act owns a defence most adults never build.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The quarter runs as a detective ladder: each lesson hands the teen a sharper instrument for catching bad reasoning — first in the wild, where debunking is genuinely fun at this age, then pointed progressively closer to home until the final target is their own conclusion. The mastery payoff is a new kind of confidence: knowing your answer survived the same attack you'd use on anyone else's.

THE ARTIFACT

A completed mini-investigation: one real question the teen cares about, answered with honestly gathered data, methods and limitations written out, the strongest case against their own conclusion included — and the finding shared where its audience can challenge it.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- Three flawed claims from the wild are dissected in writing, each with the specific flaw named.
- The investigation's data was really gathered, with methods described precisely enough that someone could repeat it.
- The write-up includes a limitations section and the strongest case against the teen's own conclusion.
- The finding was shared publicly and at least one challenge was answered with evidence rather than defensiveness.

Unlocks after: Choose Your Problem

1 Correlation is not a cause

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Two things moving together is the world's most seductive lie. When A and B rise together, there are always at least four possibilities: A causes B, B causes A (reverse causation), some C causes both (the third variable), or coincidence. The trained move is mechanical: every time you meet 'X is linked to Y', generate all four stories before believing any. The one the headline picked is merely the one that sells.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

'Teens who eat breakfast get better grades' — so breakfast causes grades? Run the four: maybe. Or organised households produce both breakfast and homework routines (third variable). Or struggling students skip breakfast *because* they're up late cramming (reverse). Ice cream sales and drownings rise together every year — nobody thinks ice cream drowns people, because the third variable (summer) is obvious. It's only obvious because you have no stake in ice cream.

03 APPLY IT

Collect five 'X linked to Y' claims from your real feeds this week. For each, write the four stories and mark which the source wants you to believe versus which is most plausible. Keep the best one for your dissection portfolio — it's the first of three.

04 REFLECT

For which claim did you *want* one story to be true — and did wanting it make the other three harder to generate? That resistance you felt is the exact muscle this quarter trains.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Trade your five with someone else doing the exercise (or walk an adult through them). See if they generate a story you missed — third variables especially hide from single minds.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the four-stories move to a friend using the ice-cream-and-drownings example, then have them run it live on the next 'studies show' claim that crosses their feed. It takes ninety seconds and inoculates for life.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Generate your four stories *before* asking anything — the generating is the skill. Then AI is a strong fifth mind: 'what third variables could explain this correlation?' often surfaces candidates you missed; note which, because your misses have patterns. The caution cuts deeper here than usual: models are trained on the same headline-world that produced the bad claim, and will sometimes repeat a popular causal story confidently. Treat AI's causal claims exactly like a headline's — four stories, every time.

You'll need: Four-stories worksheet (claim / A → B / B → A / C → both / coincidence)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Five real claims each carry all four written stories.
- ☐ One dissection is finished with the flaw named and filed.

2 The missing data problem

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

The deadliest errors hide in data you never see. Survivorship bias: you study the winners because the losers left no trace ('every successful founder dropped out!' — the failed dropouts wrote no books). Selection bias: who ended up in the sample, and who never could? ('9 of 10 customers recommend us' — asked which customers?). The trained question is always the same: *who's missing from this picture, and would they tell a different story?*

02 REAL EXAMPLE

In World War II, analysts mapped bullet holes on returning bombers to decide where to add armour — until statistician Abraham Wald pointed out they were mapping the planes that *made it home*. The holes showed where a bomber could be shot and survive; the armour belonged where the returning planes were clean, because planes hit there never returned. The missing planes held the answer. They always do.

03 APPLY IT

Find two claims in your world built on missing data — one survivorship (success stories, 'this routine changed my life'), one selection (reviews, polls, 'everyone I know'). For each, write who's missing and how their inclusion would change the story. File the better one as dissection two of three.

04 REFLECT

Your own beliefs about success — study methods, training routines, business advice — how many are built entirely on people who survived to talk about it? Pick one and honestly ask: where are the failures who did the same thing?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present your two dissections to an adult who makes decisions with data (anyone who hires, buys, or invests). Ask for a missing-data error from their own field — every field has a famous one, and collecting them sharpens the eye.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Tell the bomber story to a friend or your family at dinner — it's the best five-minute statistics lesson ever devised — then help them find one survivorship claim in their own feed before the meal ends.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

'Who's missing from this sample?' is a genuinely good AI prompt — machines enumerate absence well once pointed at it. But notice the recursion, because it matters for the rest of your life: AI itself is trained on surviving data — the internet's writers, not its silent majority — so its picture of 'what people think' has selection bias built in at the foundation. Asking AI what's missing from a dataset is smart. Remembering what's missing from AI is wisdom.

You'll need: Missing-data worksheet (claim / who's absent / how they'd change the story)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ One survivorship and one selection dissection exist with the missing group named.
- ☐ The teen identified one of their own beliefs built on survivor-only evidence.

Unlocks after: Correlation is not a cause

3 Read the study, not the headline

~50 min

01 CONCEPT

Behind every 'science says' headline is a study the headline-writer may not have read. The six-question autopsy, runnable in ten minutes: Who was studied — and how many? (12 mice is not 'people'.) What was actually measured? (Often not what the headline claims.) How big is the effect? ('Doubles the risk' of something vanishingly rare is still vanishingly rare.) Compared to what? Who paid? And — the pro's question — has anyone replicated it? You don't need a lab coat to run these. You need the habit.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Headline: 'chocolate improves memory'. The study: 37 adults, aged 50–69, high-dose cocoa flavanol extract — not chocolate — for one specific memory task, funded in part by a chocolate company. Every word of the headline is a stretch of something real. This isn't rare; it's the standard journey from lab to feed, and the six questions catch it in minutes.

03 APPLY IT

Take one 'studies show' claim that matters to your life or your year-bet domain. Find the actual study (abstracts are free; AI can help locate — see the note). Run the six-question autopsy in writing. Verdict: does the study support the headline — fully, partly, or not at all? This is dissection three; your portfolio is complete.

04 REFLECT

How far did the headline drift from the study — and at which step did the drift happen (researcher's caution → press release → headline → the screenshot in your feed)? Who benefits at each step from the stretch?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your autopsy to a teacher of science or maths and ask them to grade it: did you read the study fairly, and what would a professional check that you didn't? Their additions are your seventh and eighth questions, permanently.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Run a live autopsy with a younger student on a headline they believe — gently. The goal isn't to humiliate the headline; it's to hand them the six questions. End with the reframe: this isn't 'science is fake' — it's 'read the label, not the advert'.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI is genuinely excellent at this lesson's mechanics: finding the underlying study, translating jargon, extracting sample size and funding. Use it as your research assistant, with the librarian's rules — every extracted fact checked against the actual text, because models summarising studies sometimes import the *headline's* version. The verdict is yours: a machine can list the six answers, but weighing whether 37 flavanol-dosed adults supports your chocolate habit is judgment, and judgment is the job.

You'll need: Six-question autopsy sheet (who-how-many / measured / effect size / baseline / funder / replicated)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ One real study was located and autopsied with all six questions answered from its text.
- ☐ A written verdict grades the headline against the study.

Unlocks after: The missing data problem

4 Run your own investigation

~90 min

01 CONCEPT

The fastest way to respect good data is to make some. Pick one real question you actually care about — from your venture, your school, your friends' debates — and run a small honest investigation: define what you'll measure *before* you measure (changing the question after seeing data is how fooling-yourself starts), gather from enough people or events to mean something, record everything including the inconvenient answers, and write your methods as you go. Every corner you're tempted to cut, a published study somewhere cut — now you know how it happens.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Her question, live in her year-bet: 'do students actually revise differently before morning versus afternoon exams?' Pre-registered measure: hours and method, self-reported, 25 students across three friend groups (she noted the selection bias — her school, her networks — in the write-up). Inconvenient finding: no real difference, killing her planned tutoring-guide chapter. She published anyway, methods and all. Two teachers replied; one shared better data. The dead chapter cost a week; the reputation for honest methods started compounding immediately.

03 APPLY IT

Design and run the investigation: the question, the pre-registered measure and sample plan, the gathering (your outreach and interview craft make this cheap), and the raw record kept intact. Write the finding with its methods — including what you'd distrust about your own sample.

04 REFLECT

Where were you tempted to bend the method — leading question, convenient sample, quietly dropping an outlier? What does feeling the temptation from inside teach you about every dataset you'll ever read?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Before finalising, show your raw data and method to one numerate person with no stake in the answer. Their one job: find where your method could have produced your finding even if the finding is false. Fix or disclose what they catch.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend design a mini-investigation for a question *they* care about — pre-registered measure first, sample plan, honesty rules. The pre-registration habit is the gift: deciding what counts as evidence before you see it is nine-tenths of not fooling yourself.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI serves well at both ends of an investigation and must be locked out of the middle. Ends: designing the method ('what would make this survey leading?') and, once data is honestly in, checking your arithmetic and testing interpretations. The locked middle: the data itself — every point gathered from reality by you, no gaps filled, no 'representative' responses synthesised, ever. A dataset with one imagined point isn't mostly real; it's fiction with props. That line is absolute, this quarter and for life.

You'll need: Investigation kit (pre-registered question & measure / sample plan / raw record / methods draft)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A pre-registered investigation was run with the raw record intact.
- ☐ The write-up states methods and sample limitations precisely enough to repeat.

Unlocks after: Read the study, not the headline

5 Attack your own answer, then publish it

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

The quarter's summit, and the habit that separates thinkers from debaters: before publishing, write the strongest case that *your own conclusion is wrong* — your steelman training, aimed at yourself. What would the missing data say? Which of the four stories did you privilege? If someone ran your own six-question autopsy on you, where would it bite? Then publish — finding, methods, limitations, self-attack and all — where people who might disagree can see it. Conclusions that have survived their author's honest attack, published with their weaknesses showing, are the only kind worth signing.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Charles Darwin kept a special notebook for evidence *against* his own theory, because he knew he'd forget exactly those facts fastest. The revision-study teen's self-attack section — 'three reasons not to trust my finding: self-reported hours lie, my sample skews to my friends, and 25 is small' — did something counterintuitive: the teachers who read it trusted the finding *more*. Stated limitations are credibility, not weakness. Every real scientist knows it; now so does she.

03 APPLY IT

Write the self-attack section: the three strongest reasons your conclusion might be wrong, drawn from every instrument this quarter gave you. Then publish the full investigation — question, methods, finding, limitations, self-attack — where its natural audience gathers (your build-log channels know the way). Answer whatever challenges arrive with evidence, or with 'good point — my data can't answer that', which is also evidence of something: you.

04 REFLECT

Did the self-attack change your confidence in the finding — up, down, or into something more precise than either? Feynman again: why is the person easiest to fool *you* — what does this quarter's inventory of your own temptations say?

05 GET FEEDBACK

After publishing, seek out one person who disagrees with the finding and ask them to make their best case. Practice the rare move: updating in public if they land a real hit. 'You're right, my data doesn't show that' costs ten seconds of pride and buys a reputation nothing else can.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the full detective kit to someone — four stories, missing data, the six questions, pre-registration, the self-attack — using your published investigation as the worked example. Then set them the challenge that locks it in: 'find one thing wrong with my study.' Applaud whatever they find. That applause, taught by demonstration, is the whole quarter.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The self-attack is the one section AI genuinely strengthens without corrupting — 'here is my investigation; argue that my conclusion is wrong, as hard as you can' is your oldest sparring move at its highest use, and any hit it lands belongs in the published limitations. What stays yours: the decision of what the attacks *amount to* — publish, soften, or withdraw — and the public replies under your name. A year from now, in your venture, your studies, your feeds, the reflex this quarter built has one test: when the data flatters you, do you attack it harder? The machine can help you attack. Only you can want to.

You'll need: Self-attack section template + publication checklist (finding / methods / limitations / attack)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] The published investigation includes a three-point self-attack drawn from the quarter's tools.
- [ ] At least one public challenge was answered with evidence or an honest concession.

Unlocks after: Run your own investigation

COMMUNICATE · Q1

Own the Room

co-15-16-q1 · supporting: Lead

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 15–16, a teen can construct a twenty-minute argument, hold a room's attention, and — critically — survive being questioned by adults without collapsing or bristling. The physiological fear of public speaking peaks in adolescence, which is exactly the argument for training it now: the fear never fully leaves anyone, but the skill of performing *through* it is learnable, and learned at 15 it pays for fifty years. What's genuinely new at this age is Q&A: thinking on your feet in front of witnesses, which younger teens can't reliably do and adults are mostly bad at.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, communication creates value when a teen can **stand in front of a real room — including adults — and move it**: teach it something, change its mind, or win its backing, then hold up under questions. A delivered talk that survives Q&A is the adult world's entrance exam, sat early. Passing it changes how every adult in that room treats the teen afterward — and how the teen treats themselves.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The quarter aims at one real event: a talk, actually delivered, to a real audience that includes adults who aren't family — a class, a club, a community group, a local business meetup. The date gets set in week one, which converts practice from optional to necessary. The room's real reaction — leaning in, laughing where intended, asking hard questions, applauding — is a payoff no rehearsal can counterfeit.

THE ARTIFACT

One real talk (10–20 minutes) on a topic from the teen's year-bet domain, delivered to a real audience including non-family adults — with the prepared structure, the rehearsal log, a survived Q&A, and recorded audience feedback.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A real venue and date were secured by the teen's own ask, and the talk actually happened.
- The audience included adults outside the family, and their questions were answered without reading from notes.
- The rehearsal log shows at least three full run-throughs including one to a live practice listener.
- Recorded feedback exists from at least three audience members, and the teen can name what they'd change for talk two.

1 One room, one change

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

A talk is not information with a person attached — it's a *change* you intend to cause in a specific room. Before writing a word, answer two questions: who exactly will be sitting there, and what should be different in their heads when you finish (one thing, not five)? Every great talk can state its change in one sentence: 'they'll leave believing X' or 'they'll leave able to do Y'. No change, no talk — just an essay read aloud.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen invited to speak at her school's parents' evening about study apps drafted a feature tour — forgettable. Reframed with the two questions (room: skeptical parents; change: 'they'll leave knowing the one setting that makes phones help instead of hurt homework'), the same knowledge became a talk parents actually acted on that night. Same speaker, same topic; the *change sentence* made the talk.

03 APPLY IT

Pick your talk's topic from your year-bet domain — the thing you're becoming the person who knows about. Then secure the room: identify two or three plausible venues (class slot, club night, community group, library event), and make the ask for a date using your outreach craft. Write the change sentence for that specific room and pin it above everything you draft.

04 REFLECT

How does knowing the exact room change what you'd say? And notice: the ask for a venue scared you more or less than the talk itself? Why is the ask the real gatekeeper of this skill?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Test your change sentence on someone who fits your future audience: 'if a talk left you with this, would it have been worth twenty minutes?' A shrug means the change is too small or too vague — sharpen before you build on it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the two questions (who's in the room / what's the one change) to a friend with any presentation looming. Watch their content problem dissolve into a selection problem — that's the sign the frame took.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The change sentence is a decision about your audience and your intent — yours to make. AI's fair contribution at this stage: reconnaissance ('what do parents typically already believe about study apps?') so you aim the change at what the room actually thinks, not a straw-room. The venue ask is human-to-human — draft it yourself, tighten with the machine if you like, send it under your own name. The date you get back is the quarter's engine; no model can book a room that wants *you*.

You'll need: Room-and-change card (venue / audience / change sentence) + venue ask tracker

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A change sentence exists for a specific real room.
- ☐ Venue asks were sent and a date is secured or pending with a fallback.

2 Build the spine

~50 min

01 CONCEPT

Rooms don't follow information; they follow *shape*. The reliable spine: a cold open that earns the room's attention honestly (a story, a stake, a surprising number — your hook craft, grown up); two to four points that each advance the one change, every point carried by a concrete story or demonstration; and a close that lands the change and tells the room what to do with it. Points without stories evaporate; stories without points entertain and change nothing. Weld each to each.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The most-watched talks in the world run on this spine — 18 minutes, one idea, story-carried points, an unmistakable close. Her parents'-evening talk: cold open, a live phone timer showing 4 hours of pickups ('this was my Tuesday'); two points, each a story with a number; close, the one setting changed live on stage, room invited to do it now. Spine visible from orbit. Nobody's attention left the room.

03 APPLY IT

Outline your talk as a spine, not a script: the cold open (written word-for-word — openings earn that), each point with its carrying story or demo named, the close (also word-for-word). Test: does every point serve the change sentence? Cut the orphans, however good they are. Then flesh the middle into talking points — bullets you speak from, not paragraphs you recite.

04 REFLECT

Which favourite bit did you have to cut for not serving the change — and why does a talk, like a venture, get stronger when scope gets cut? Where else have you learned that this year?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Deliver just the cold open and the close (two minutes total) to a practice listener. Ask: 'would you stay for the middle, and what do you think I want you to do?' If either answer is wrong, fix the ends before touching the middle — the ends carry the room.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the spine to a friend or younger student facing any presentation: open earned, points story-carried, close landed. Rebuild one of their slides-full-of-bullets into a spine together and watch the talk appear from under the deck.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Structure is where AI can genuinely spar: hand it your spine and ask 'where does attention sag? which point doesn't serve the change?' — a structural edit from a tireless reader. What it cannot supply is your stories — the Tuesday timer, the student who cried over maths — because it wasn't there, and rooms detect secondhand stories instantly. The spine can be machine-checked; the flesh must have been lived.

You'll need: Spine sheet (cold open verbatim / points + stories / close verbatim)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A complete spine exists with open and close written verbatim and every point story-carried.
- ☐ The two-minute ends test was run and both answers came back right.

Unlocks after: One room, one change

3 Rehearse like it's real

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Amateurs read through their notes; performers rehearse the *event*: out loud, standing, timed, from the talking points — because the talk you can give is only the talk you've already given. Three full run-throughs minimum: one alone (find the clunks), one recorded (meet your habits — the pacing, the filler words, the disappearing hands), one to a live practice listener (feel the room's gravity early). Rehearsal doesn't remove the fear; it gives the fear a well-worn path to run on.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Recording run two, she met her habits: 'basically' fourteen times, a sprint through the best story, eyes on the ceiling during transitions. None were audible from inside; all were obvious on tape. By run four the word was gone, the story had room to breathe, and the transitions had eye contact — not because she 'got confident', but because each habit, once seen, got a specific fix. Confidence isn't the entry fee for performing; it's the receipt.

03 APPLY IT

Run the three rehearsals across a week: solo (edit the clunks out of the spine), recorded (list your habits, pick the top two to fix, run again), live listener (their only brief: 'tell me where you lost me'). Log each run — time, what broke, what you fixed. The log is your evidence that delivery is a build, not a trait.

04 REFLECT

What surprised you most on the recording — and why could you not hear it from inside? Where else in your life might there be habits only a recording would show you?

05 GET FEEDBACK

After the live-listener run, ask your listener the two performer's questions: 'where did I lose you?' and 'what do you remember without looking at notes?' What they remember is what actually transmitted — compare it against your change sentence and adjust the emphasis.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Coach a friend through their first recorded rehearsal of anything — a talk, an interview answer, a music piece. Sit with them through the cringe of the playback and teach the reframe: the tape isn't judging you; it's the only honest mirror you'll ever get for free.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Feed AI your recording's transcript and it will count your fillers, flag your pacing, and mark repetitive phrasing — genuinely useful, like a coach with infinite patience. What the transcript can't carry is the room: warmth, timing, the pause that lands. Those calibrate only against live humans, which is why run three is a person. Machine for the mechanics, humans for the music — and the fear is conquered by neither; it's conquered by repetitions.

You'll need: Rehearsal log (run / time / habits found / fixes) + recording setup

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Three full run-throughs happened including one recorded and one live.
- ☐ The log shows named habits and their fixes across runs.

Unlocks after: Build the spine

4 Survive the questions

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

The talk proves you prepared; the Q&A proves you *know*. The craft: listen to the whole question (nerves make speakers answer the first six words), buy thinking time honestly ('good question — let me think for a second' is strength, not weakness), answer the question asked, and own the gaps — 'I don't know, but here's how I'd find out' outranks a bluff every time, because rooms forgive ignorance and never forgive bluffing. For the hostile question: steelman it back ('so your concern is…'), then answer the strongest version. You've trained for that move for two years.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The question she feared arrived from the back row: 'aren't you a bit young to be telling parents about parenting?' The bluff would have died. Instead: 'fair concern — you're asking why you should trust a sixteen-year-old on this. You shouldn't, on parenting. On what's actually on our phones and what one setting changed for my Tuesday nights — that I can show you.' The room laughed, the questioner nodded, and three parents quoted the answer back to her afterwards. The hostile question, steelmanned and honestly bounded, became the talk's best moment.

03 APPLY IT

Build the question bank: the eight most likely questions (ask your practice listener what they'd ask), the two you most fear, and one hostile one. For each, write the *first sentence* of your answer only — enough to start strong, not enough to sound recited. Then run a live fire drill: your listener asks in random order, including a curveball you haven't prepped, and you practice the full toolkit — whole-question listening, honest time-buying, owned gaps.

04 REFLECT

Which question scares you most and what exactly is the fear — not knowing, or being *seen* not knowing? What does 'I don't know, but here's how I'd find out' do to that fear once you've said it out loud twice?

05 GET FEEDBACK

After the drill, ask your questioner: 'which answer felt strongest, which felt recited, and did I ever answer a question you didn't ask?' Recited and mis-aimed answers get their first sentences rewritten — the bank serves the listening, never replaces it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Run a Q&A drill for a friend before their next exam viva, interview, or presentation: build their bank, throw their curveballs, and teach the two power moves — the honest pause and the owned gap. Watching someone else bluff is the fastest way to vaccinate yourself against it.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI is a superb question-generator: 'here's my talk — ask me the ten hardest questions this room might ask, including one hostile one.' Drill against its bank; let it surprise you. The live skill it can't train: reading *this* questioner in *this* moment — whether they want information, reassurance, or just to be heard. That's human weather, learnable only in weather. And carry the honest gap into every drill: a machine never says 'I don't know', which is exactly why rooms trust people who do.

You'll need: Question bank (8 likely / 2 feared / 1 hostile, first sentences only) + drill log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A question bank exists with first-sentence answers, including feared and hostile questions.
- ☐ A live drill ran with at least one unprepped curveball, and recited answers were reworked.

Unlocks after: Rehearse like it's real

5 Deliver, debrief, book the next one

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Then you walk into the room and give the talk — nerves included; the nerves mean it's real. Afterward, the professional's two moves: the debrief (collect real feedback while it's warm, watch the recording once, write what worked and what changes) and the *rebooking* — because one talk is an event, but the second talk is a skill, and speakers who book talk two within a week of talk one become people who speak. This room was never the destination; it was the door.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Her parents'-evening talk ran nineteen minutes; the Q&A ran twenty-five — the sign of a room engaged, not a talk overlong. The debrief caught what the applause hid: the second point had sagged (two parents checked phones — the irony noted), and the close had landed word-for-word as rehearsed. The rebooking came from the room itself: the librarian who'd listened asked if she'd give it again for the community centre. She said yes before the fear could vote. Talk two, same spine, half the nerves.

03 APPLY IT

Deliver the talk. Same day: collect feedback from at least three audience members (two questions: 'what stays with you?' / 'what would you change?'), and note every question the Q&A actually produced against your bank. Within three days: watch the recording once, write the debrief (what worked / what changes / what talk two looks like), and make one concrete rebooking move — an ask, an offer, a yes.

04 REFLECT

Standing in the room: which was true — the fear you'd rehearsed against, or something else entirely? And what does the gap between the feared room and the real room teach you about every ask you've delayed this year?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Compare the room's actual questions with your bank: what did you prepare that never came, what came that you never prepared? That delta is your model of this audience, corrected — carry it into talk two and into next quarter's professional voice.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Take everything the quarter built — the change sentence, the spine, the rehearsal log, the question bank, the debrief — and coach one person through their entire first talk, ask to applause. When *their* room applauds, you haven't just owned a room; you've minted another person who can. That's the pillar working at full compound interest.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The debrief's raw material is real — the recording, the room's questions, the feedback quotes — and AI can help you mine it ('what patterns do you see in this feedback?') once it's collected. What stays permanently human: the ninety seconds before you walk on. No tool goes there with you; that's the point of the whole quarter. You walk in alone, with your spine and your reps — and you come out someone who has done it, which is the one credential that can't be generated.

You'll need: Delivery-day checklist + debrief sheet (feedback / Q&A delta / talk-two plan / rebooking move)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The talk was delivered to the real room and feedback from 3+ audience members is recorded.
- ☐ A written debrief exists and one concrete rebooking move was made within a week.

Unlocks after: Survive the questions

COMMUNICATE · Q2

The Professional Voice

co-15-16-q2 · supporting: Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 15–16, teens begin genuinely needing the adult world's channels — applications, work inquiries, client messages, meetings — and they arrive fluent in exactly the wrong register: chat-speak that reads as careless, or stiff formality copied from templates that reads as hollow. The capability that's ready is register-switching itself: this age can hold multiple voices and pick deliberately. What they lack is calibration — nobody has shown them what professional-but-human sounds like from a sixteen-year-old, or told them that it's a learnable surface over the skills they already have.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, communication creates value when the teen can **operate in adult channels and be taken at face value** — an email that gets a reply from a busy stranger, a portfolio a professional bookmarks, a meeting where nobody adjusts for their age. The professional voice isn't pretending to be older; it's removing every accidental signal of carelessness so the work underneath gets judged on its merits.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

Every exercise this quarter is live ammunition: the emails go to real professionals, the portfolio goes to real reviewers, the meeting happens with a real adult about real work. The stakes are doors that actually open or don't — replies that arrive or never come — and each landed exchange visibly expands what the teen can reach without an adult intermediary. Nothing motivates register-learning like the first busy stranger who answers within the hour.

THE ARTIFACT

A working professional presence: a live portfolio page built on real work, a professional email voice proven in use, and a contact ledger recording three genuine professional exchanges conducted end-to-end — opening, thread, meeting or call where warranted, and follow-through.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A portfolio page is live, built on the teen's real work, reviewed by at least one professional.
- Three real professional exchanges were completed end-to-end, each with a purpose the teen can state.
- At least one exchange included a live meeting or call the teen prepared for and summarised afterward in writing.
- A contact ledger exists with every commitment made and kept, and no thread left dangling.

Unlocks after: Own the Room

1 Register is a choice

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

You already speak several languages — the group-chat voice, the teacher voice, the family voice. Professional is just one more register, and it has learnable rules: complete sentences without stiffness, warmth without emojis doing the work, specificity over filler, and zero apology-for-existing ('sorry to bother you' signals you agree you're a bother). The goal isn't sounding forty. It's sounding *deliberate* — like every word was chosen by someone careful, because it was.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Three versions of the same message to a shop owner. Chat-register: 'hey any chance u need help w socials?' — deleted on sight. Costume-register: 'Dear Esteemed Sir/Madam, I wish to inquire…' — deleted slower. Deliberate: 'Hi Mr Rahim — I'm Ana, 16, I run the photography account for our school's food fair (300 followers, mostly local parents). I noticed your window display changes weekly but your page doesn't. Could I make you three sample posts, free, to show what I mean?' Same ask. Only one sounds like someone worth replying to.

03 APPLY IT

Take three messages you'd realistically need to send this quarter (your Build practitioner, a venue, a potential client or supplier for your asset). Write each in all three registers — chat, costume, deliberate — then study your own gap: what specifically separates your deliberate version from the other two? Write your five personal rules from the comparison.

04 REFLECT

Which register error are you naturally closer to — too casual or too costumed? Where did you learn that voice, and what does the deliberate register keep from your natural one?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your deliberate versions to a working adult and ask the calibration question: 'if this arrived from a stranger, what would you assume about them?' Adjust until the answer is 'careful, competent, young — in that order'.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the three-registers exercise to a friend about to send their first professional message. Have them write all three versions — the comparison teaches faster than any rules list, including yours.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI speaks fluent costume-register — ask it for 'a professional email' and you'll get the exact hollow formality this lesson exists to kill. Better uses: paste your own draft and ask 'where does this sound careless, and where does it sound like a template?' — it diagnoses register drift well. The voice you're building must be recognisably yours with the carelessness removed, because you'll have to *speak* in this register too, live, where no model can follow you.

You'll need: Three-registers worksheet + personal rules card (5 rules)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] Three real messages exist in all three registers with a written gap analysis.
- [ ] A five-rule personal register card exists, calibrated by a working adult.

2 The portfolio page

~90 min

01 CONCEPT

A professional presence answers one question before anyone asks it: *what has this person actually done?* Your portfolio page is your real work — the Build trio, the published pieces, the venture numbers — arranged so a busy stranger gets the answer in ninety seconds: who you are in two lines, three to five best works each with one line of context (what it is, for whom, what happened), and how to reach you. No inflated titles, no skills-lists without evidence, nothing you can't back in conversation. The page's power is that everything on it is checkable.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Two sixteen-year-olds' pages. One: 'Passionate entrepreneur | Marketing expert | CEO @ …' — a costume made of words. The other: three work samples — 'Promo video for Kassim Bakery (they posted it; +40 followers that week)', a published article, a tutoring guide 'RM196 in sales to students I've never met' — plus two lines of who and one contact link. The second page got its owner a paid commission from a stranger who said, precisely: 'I could see exactly what I'd be getting.'

03 APPLY IT

Build the page with whatever tool ships fastest — a simple site builder, a clean document, a one-page PDF. Two lines of who; your three to five strongest real works, each with its one-line context and receipt; contact. Apply the checkable rule ruthlessly: if you couldn't discuss it comfortably in an interview, it doesn't go on.

04 REFLECT

What did you *want* to claim that the checkable rule made you cut — and what does the page look like without it? Sparser and stronger, or just sparser? (If just sparser, that's next quarter's to-do list, honestly discovered.)

05 GET FEEDBACK

Send the live page to one professional (your Build practitioner relationship exists for moments like this) with one question: 'what would make you take this person seriously — and what undermines it?' Fix what they name before the exchanges lesson points strangers at it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a friend build their first checkable portfolio page — the two lines, the works with receipts, the ruthless cut of everything unbackable. Watching someone else's costume-claims fall away shows you any that survived on yours.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Layout, tooling, tightening your context lines — all fair machine work. The two hard rules live where they've always lived: every word about your work must be checkably true (the page is a claims-and-receipts document — your training runs deep here), and the work itself follows your portfolio-honesty rule from the craft quarter — disclosed tools, your judgment, nothing you couldn't demonstrate. A portfolio inflated by machine-polish gets you one meeting, exactly once.

You'll need: Portfolio page (live) + checkable-rule audit of every claim

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A live page exists: two-line who, 3-5 checkable works with receipts, contact.
- ☐ One professional reviewed it and their named fixes are applied.

Unlocks after: Register is a choice

3 Threads, follow-ups, and kept commitments

~50 min

01 CONCEPT

One good email starts a relationship; *thread discipline* builds one. The rules professionals silently grade you on: reply within a day even if only to say when you'll properly reply; every commitment you type ('I'll send it Friday') is a promise with a deadline — track it, keep it, or renegotiate it *before* it's late; follow up on silence once, politely, after a week; and close every thread explicitly — 'thanks, this is done' — because dangling threads read as flakiness. None of this is charisma. It's bookkeeping, and bookkeeping is a competitive advantage precisely because most people won't do it.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A shop owner reflecting on two teens who'd both pitched her: 'The first one's message was actually better written. But the second one replied same-day, sent the samples exactly when he said, and checked back the following week like he said he would. I hired the second one. I'd have *forgotten* the first one existed — his thread just… stopped.' Deals at every level of the economy are lost exactly there: not to rejection, to silence.

03 APPLY IT

Open your contact ledger — every professional thread you now have (practitioner, reviewers, prospects), with columns for: last message, whose turn, commitments made, due dates, thread status. Then work it for two weeks: launch your first two real exchanges (from your lesson-one drafts), reply within a day, keep every typed commitment, follow up on any silence once, and close what completes.

04 REFLECT

Look at your ledger after two weeks: which discipline was hardest — the fast reply, the kept deadline, or the follow-up into silence? What does your answer predict about where you'll leak trust at twenty-five, and what system plugs the leak now?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the ledger (redacted if needed) to a working adult and ask what their version looks like — a CRM, a folder system, flags. Steal one mechanism from how they track promises. Everyone senior has one; nobody was born with it.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach thread discipline to a friend with a dangling opportunity — the unanswered message they're avoiding. Sit with them while they send the revival: 'following up on this — still interested if the door's open.' Half the time the door is. Teach them the moral: silence kills more chances than no ever does.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The ledger is pure systems territory — spreadsheet formulas, reminder automations, your Build training applied to relationships; machine help is exactly right here. The messages inside the threads stay yours by the register rules, and one new hazard appears at thread-scale: AI-drafted replies are fast enough to answer without *reading properly*, and a reply that misses what the person actually said is worse than a slow one. Read like a human, track like a machine, reply like yourself.

You'll need: Contact ledger (thread / last msg / whose turn / commitments / status)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A contact ledger exists and was worked for two weeks with no dangling threads.
- ☐ Two real exchanges are underway with every typed commitment kept or renegotiated early.

Unlocks after: The portfolio page

4 The meeting

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Sooner or later a thread graduates to a call or meeting — and meetings are won before they start. The professional's checklist: know what *both* sides want from the thirty minutes; prepare your three points and your questions (your interview craft, now bidirectional); handle the logistics flawlessly (on time is late for the person who called the meeting — be early, test the tech, have the documents open); take notes; and send the summary within a day — what was discussed, what was agreed, who does what by when. The summary is the move almost nobody makes. It quietly puts you in charge of the record, and the record is where commitments live.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A sixteen-year-old's first client call, for a logo commission: she'd prepared three questions about the shop's customers, showed two rough directions, and — the part the owner told everyone about — sent a five-line summary an hour later: 'Direction B, green tones, first draft next Friday, RM80 on approval.' The owner had had *adult* contractors who never did that. The summary didn't just impress; three weeks later, when memory blurred on the price, the thread settled it in her favour. The record always wins.

03 APPLY IT

Graduate one of your live exchanges into a real meeting or call with a purpose (portfolio review, client discussion, supplier terms — whatever your threads have earned). Run the full checklist: both-sides prep sheet, three points, logistics rehearsal, notes, and the summary sent within twenty-four hours. File everything in the ledger.

04 REFLECT

What surprised you about the live meeting versus the thread — pace, tangents, how decisions actually got made? And what did writing the summary force you to realise you *hadn't* pinned down in the room?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your meeting counterpart afterward for one professional-to-professional note: 'what should I do differently in my next meeting?' Adults hand this gold to any teen who asks it straight — and asking it is itself the register, demonstrated.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Prep a friend for their first real call — the both-sides sheet, the three points, the summary move. Then debrief them after. The summary habit, transplanted into one more person, will quietly run for decades; that's the kind of teaching this pillar is for.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Prep is fair machine territory: rehearsing answers, anticipating their questions ('what would a shop owner ask a teen designer?'), tightening your three points. The meeting itself is entirely human — and one bright line inside it: never record or transcribe a call without asking, and if you use an AI notetaker, say so out loud at the start; consent in professional settings isn't optional courtesy, it's the register. The summary afterward: drafted from *your* notes, machine-tightened if you like, checked against what was actually said — because the record you're creating is only powerful while it's true.

You'll need: Meeting kit (both-sides prep / three points / logistics check / summary template)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real meeting or call happened with written prep on both sides' goals.
- ☐ The summary went out within 24 hours and is filed in the ledger.

Unlocks after: Threads, follow-ups, and kept commitments

5 Three exchanges, closed properly

~50 min

01 CONCEPT

The quarter closes with proof at professional standard: three real exchanges, end-to-end — opened deliberately, threaded with discipline, met where warranted, every commitment kept, closed explicitly. Then the professional's retrospective: reread your own threads as if grading a stranger. Where did your register slip? Which reply took three days? What would the other party say about working with you? The voice is now installed; the retrospective is how it keeps calibrating for the next forty years — because the professional world rarely gives feedback. It just decides, silently, whether to reply to you next time.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Her quarter's ledger, closed: the practitioner exchange (portfolio review → critique → improved work returned → 'send me your next one' — door open); the bakery client (pitch → meeting → delivered posts → paid, testimonial banked for the portfolio); the supplier inquiry (quote requested → terms compared → politely declined — 'thank you, I've gone another way' — because *declining well is also professional*). Three threads, three different endings, zero silences. Reading them back, she found one two-day reply gap and a 'sorry to bother you' that had survived lesson one. Noted. Next quarter's threads won't have them.

03 APPLY IT

Complete and explicitly close your third exchange. Then run the retrospective: reread all three threads cold, grade yourself against every rule this quarter installed (register, thread discipline, commitments, summaries, closes), and write the three-line verdict: what's now installed, what still slips, and the one repair to make — then make it, including anywhere you owe a close or a thank-you.

04 REFLECT

Compare the person who wrote this quarter's first draft message with the one who just closed three professional threads. What actually changed — the writing, or your sense of what you're allowed to walk up to? Which change matters more?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Ask one counterpart from your three exchanges the closing question, framed exactly professionally: 'I'm building my professional habits deliberately — one thing I did well, one thing to improve?' File both answers in the ledger where next quarter will find them.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Package the quarter for a friend entering their first professional situation — job application, client, cold ask. Walk them through register, the checkable portfolio, thread discipline, the meeting kit, and the explicit close, using your real (redacted) threads as the textbook. When their first professional reply arrives and they message you a screenshot — that's this quarter, compounding in someone else's life.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The retrospective works because the threads are a complete honest record — and rereading your own words cold is a skill AI can assist ('grade these threads against these rules') but not replace, because the grader you're training is you. One closing calibration for the decades ahead: the professional world will increasingly be full of machine-written messages, which means the deliberate human voice — checkable, warm, specific, *present* — is appreciating in value every year. You now own one. The threads where a real person can tell a real person showed up: those are yours, and they're the ones that get answered.

You’ll need: Closed ledger (3 complete exchanges) + retrospective sheet (installed / slips / repair)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Three exchanges are complete and explicitly closed with all commitments kept.
- ☐ A written retrospective exists with one repair identified and actually made.

Unlocks after: The meeting

BUILD · Q1

Go Deep on a Craft

bu-15-16-q1 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 15–16, deliberate practice becomes fully available: a teen can practice at the edge of their ability on purpose, tolerate the specific discomfort of working just past competence, study masters analytically rather than just admiringly, and sustain a practice system for months. This is also the age where 'good for a kid' stops being the standard — the world begins comparing their work to everyone's, which stings and clarifies. The developmental trap is its own strength: capable teens plateau by practicing what they're already good at, because it feels like progress and photographs well.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, building creates value when the work **stands without the age disclaimer** — portfolio pieces judged good by the standards of the craft itself, not charming for sixteen. Reaching the edge of genuine competence in one craft teaches the meta-skill that matters more than any single craft: knowing, from inside, what the road from beginner to good actually feels like — which makes every future skill cheaper to acquire.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The quarter is built as a visible skill ascent in the teen's year-bet craft: baseline piece in week one, edge-practice system through the middle, three portfolio pieces at the end — with the baseline kept on purpose, so the distance travelled is undeniable. Nothing motivates a 15-year-old like objective evidence of getting good at their chosen thing; the before/after pair does the motivating that no lecture could.

THE ARTIFACT

Three portfolio-grade pieces in the teen's year-bet craft, produced through a documented practice system — plus the week-one baseline piece kept for comparison, a practice log showing edge-work across the quarter, and one piece critiqued by a real practitioner of the craft.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A baseline piece from week one exists alongside three end-of-quarter pieces, and the gap is visible to a stranger.
- The practice log shows a real system: regular sessions, specific edge-targets, and what each session attacked.
- At least one piece received critique from a genuine practitioner outside family and school, and the critique was acted on.
- The teen can articulate the craft's quality standards — what separates good from decent — in their own words.

1 Baseline, honestly

~90 min

01 CONCEPT

Every serious ascent starts with a fixed point: make one complete piece in your craft, now, at your current level, no excuses and no extra week of polish — then *keep it*. The baseline hurts a little to make (it's you, measured) and pays all year: it converts 'am I improving?' from a mood into a comparison. Skipping the baseline is the first symptom of practicing to feel good rather than to get good.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen betting his year on video editing made his baseline in one honest weekend: a 90-second edit of family footage, current skills only. It had every beginner tell — jump cuts, muddy audio, an ending that just stopped. He hated it and kept it. In June, his club's showcase reel next to that baseline made the case no words could: same person, same laptop, one system of practice between them.

03 APPLY IT

Define your craft precisely from your year-bet memo (not 'coding' — 'building small web tools'; not 'art' — 'digital character illustration'). Make your baseline piece this week: one complete, finished thing at today's skill level. Date it, store it where it won't be quietly deleted, and write three sentences on what you can see is weak — even if you can't yet fix it.

04 REFLECT

What did you feel looking at your finished baseline — and what would it mean to feel that in June about today's best work? Why is 'I can see it's weak but can't fix it yet' actually a hopeful sentence?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the baseline to one person and say the hard sentence out loud: 'this is my starting point; I'm going to make this look amateur by June.' The public stake converts the baseline from embarrassment into ignition.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Convince a friend starting anything — gym, language, instrument — to make and keep a baseline this week. Teach the reframe: the baseline isn't evidence you're bad; it's the 'before' photo that makes the 'after' mean something.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The baseline must be made without AI assistance even where AI could help — its whole value is measuring *you*, and a machine-assisted baseline poisons every comparison the year will make against it. (Where AI legitimately lives in your craft's real workflow, you'll add it deliberately in later lessons, and measure yourself with-tools against with-tools.) One fair use today: 'here's my piece — list what a professional would notice as beginner tells.' Seeing your weaknesses named early is a gift; just make sure the work they're named in is purely yours.

You'll need: Baseline piece (dated, stored) + three-sentence weakness note

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A complete baseline piece exists, dated and stored.
- ☐ A written weakness note names at least three specific weak points.

2 Steal like a student

~90 min

01 CONCEPT

Every craft has masters, and their work is an open textbook — if you read it analytically instead of admiringly. The study move: pick three works you wish you'd made, and *reverse-engineer* them — what exactly makes this good? Name the techniques, the decisions, the things they didn't do. Then the apprentice's oldest exercise: copy one, as closely as you can, purely to feel where your hands can't yet follow. Copying to learn is how every master started; copying to publish is theft. Know the line, use the first, never cross into the second.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The video teen chose three edits he loved and watched each a dozen times with a notepad: cuts landed on beats (he'd never noticed), audio led the image by a half-second in scene changes, every sequence ended one shot earlier than he would have. Recreating a 30-second stretch shot-for-shot taught him more about pacing in three hours than a month of tutorials — because his hands met the exact places the master's choices lived. The recreation went in his practice folder, never his portfolio, labelled 'study of'.

03 APPLY IT

Choose three exemplary works in your craft. For each, write the autopsy: five specific techniques or decisions that make it good, and one thing the maker *chose not to do*. Then copy one section of one work as a labelled study — close as you can — and log where your hands failed to follow. Those failure points are your practice targets for lesson three.

04 REFLECT

What did the copy teach you that watching never did? And where's the line, in your own words, between studying someone's work and stealing it — why does labelling a study 'study of X' matter morally and not just legally?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show a fellow craft-learner one autopsy and your study-copy with its failure log. Ask what *they* see in the master's work that you missed — two students autopsy better than one, and their eye trains yours.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the autopsy method to someone learning any craft: pick a work they admire, sit together and name five reasons it's good and one restraint. The shift from 'that's amazing' to 'that's amazing *because*' is the entire lesson — audible the moment it happens.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can accelerate the autopsy — 'what techniques are visible in this piece?' surfaces vocabulary you don't have yet, and knowing a technique's *name* unlocks a world of practice material. Two cautions. The failure log must come from your own hands attempting the copy — the machine can name the technique but only the attempt shows you which ones you lack. And never launder a study into original work, with or without AI transformation on top: the habit of honest labels, built now, is what will make your portfolio trustworthy for life.

You'll need: Three autopsy sheets (5 techniques + 1 restraint each) + labelled study-copy with failure log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Three written autopsies exist naming specific techniques and restraints.
- ☐ One labelled study-copy exists with a failure log naming where the hands couldn't follow.

Unlocks after: Baseline, honestly

3 Practice at the edge

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Practice only builds skill when it happens at the *edge* — the narrow zone where you fail about a third of the time. Below it, you're performing (fun, photographs well, builds nothing); above it, you're flailing. Deliberate practice is engineered discomfort: isolate one weakness (your baseline notes and copy-failures are the menu), design a drill that attacks it specifically, repeat with immediate feedback, and stop when quality collapses — tired reps train sloppiness. It's the least glamorous thing in this curriculum and the most powerful.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

His failure log said transitions. The drill: cut the same 20-second sequence five different ways in one session, each transition style twice, comparing against the master study after every attempt. Not making videos — making *transitions*, over and over, at the exact spot his hands had failed. Three weeks of Tuesday/Thursday drills and the weakness inverted: reviewers of his June reel called transitions his signature. Edges, attacked specifically, become strengths — that's the entire economics of practice.

03 APPLY IT

Build your practice system: two or three sessions a week inside your bet-blocks, each session opening with a named edge-target ('today attacks: ___'), a drill that isolates it, immediate comparison against a standard (the master work, the measurement, the playback), and a two-line log entry — what was attacked, what moved. Run the system for three weeks before judging it.

04 REFLECT

What's the emotional difference between a performing session and an edge session — and which do you naturally drift toward when tired? Your whole training says systems beat moods: what in your system's design forces the edge when the mood says coast?

05 GET FEEDBACK

After three weeks, show your practice log to someone who trains seriously in anything — an athlete, a musician, a coder. Ask: 'is this deliberate practice or organised performing?' Their outside read on your edge-honesty is worth more than a month of self-assessment.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Design an edge-drill for a friend stuck on a plateau in their thing: help them name the specific weakness, build the isolating drill, and set the failure-rate target. Plateaus are almost always performing-disguised-as-practice; teaching the diagnosis cements it in you.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI earns real wages here: drill design ('give me five exercises that isolate X'), instant feedback where the craft allows it ('critique this attempt against professional standards'), and spotting patterns across your log. The two things it cannot do: feel where *your* edge is this week — that's proprioception, yours alone — and do the reps. Beware especially the AI shortcut that skips the rep ('just generate the transition'): in the portfolio lessons, tools are fair game where the craft's professionals use them; in the drill, the struggling *is* the product. Protect the struggle.

You'll need: Practice system card (schedule / edge-target ritual / feedback source) + practice log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A practice system ran for three weeks with logged edge-targets per session.
- ☐ An outside trainer-type confirmed the log shows edge-work, not performing.

Unlocks after: Steal like a student

4 Make the portfolio pieces

~120 min

01 CONCEPT

Now convert practice into evidence: three finished pieces, chosen to *show range on purpose* — one that demonstrates your strongest technique, one that solves a real problem for a real person (craft applied, not just displayed), one that stretches into territory you couldn't touch at baseline. Portfolio pieces are finished to the craft's professional standard, which means the last 10% — the polish, the details, the boring completeness — that practice pieces skip. Finishing is its own skill, and the portfolio is where you build it.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

His three: a 60-second showcase built around his now-signature transitions (strength), a promo edit for his cousin's bakery that the bakery actually posted (real use — and his first work living in the world on its merits), and a short documentary-style piece requiring interview audio he'd never handled (stretch — it took three times longer than planned and taught him sound design exists). Strength, service, stretch: three pieces, three different proofs, one unmistakable ascent from the baseline.

03 APPLY IT

Plan the trio — strength piece, real-use piece (find a real person or org who needs your craft this month), stretch piece — with a finish bar for each written in advance: what does 'done to standard' mean, specifically? Then make them, edge-system still running underneath. Log where the last 10% fought you; that's the finishing skill being built.

04 REFLECT

Which fought harder — the stretch piece's new territory, or the last 10% of finishing the pieces you already knew how to make? What does that tell you about the difference between skill and *craftsmanship*?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Put the real-use piece in front of its real user and ship it — their acceptance (or their change requests) is the piece's true finish bar. For the other two, run your before/after: baseline beside new work, shown to two people, one question: 'what changed?'

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help a fellow learner plan their own strength/service/stretch trio in their craft. Teach the finish-bar move — writing 'done means…' before starting — and watch it kill the endless-tinkering problem that eats most first portfolios.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Portfolio pieces live by the craft's real rules, and in most modern crafts professionals use AI tools somewhere — so use what the professionals use, *disclosed the way professionals disclose*: you should be able to say exactly which tools touched the piece and what they did, and the judgment calls that make the piece yours must be yours. The line that matters: a piece is portfolio-honest when showing your process would increase respect, not end it. If a tool did the part you're claiming credit for, the piece belongs in the practice folder, not the portfolio.

You'll need: Trio plan (strength/service/stretch + finish bars) + the three finished pieces

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Three finished pieces exist matching their pre-written finish bars.
- ☐ The real-use piece was actually delivered to and accepted by its real user.

Unlocks after: Practice at the edge

5 Face the field

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

The quarter's final test isn't self-assessment — it's *the field's* assessment: real critique from a genuine practitioner of your craft, someone whose standards come from doing it, not from loving you. Getting critique is a skill with rules: ask specific questions ('what would you fix first?' beats 'do you like it?'), listen without defending (write, don't argue), separate the work from your worth (they're critiquing the piece — the piece is not you), and act on one thing within a week, because critique unacted-on trains the critic to stop bothering. This conversation, survived and used, is the moment 'good for a kid' dies.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Through a family friend, the video teen got fifteen minutes with a working editor. He asked the specific question and got specifics back: 'your cuts are genuinely good — your audio is what marks you as young. Learn levels and EQ basics and you jump a tier.' It stung precisely because it was true (the stretch piece had warned him). He spent the next fortnight on audio, re-finished the documentary piece, and sent it back with two lines of thanks. The editor's reply — 'better. Send me your next one' — was eleven words and worth more than any grade he'd ever received: a practitioner's open door.

03 APPLY IT

Find your practitioner — your outreach craft exists for exactly this — and ask for fifteen minutes of critique on your best piece, with two specific questions prepared. Take the critique with the rules: write everything, defend nothing, thank them. Within one week: act on the first-priority fix, and close the loop by sending the improved work with your thanks. Then write the quarter's closing entry: baseline vs trio, what the field said, what the practice system attacks next.

04 REFLECT

What did the practitioner see that nobody in your family could? Compare the sting of real critique to the comfort of praise — which one moved your work, and what does that teach you about which to seek for the next ten years?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show a peer the full arc — baseline, log, trio, critique, the improved piece — and ask them to judge one thing: 'does the improvement look like talent or like a system?' The answer you want is *system*, because systems are the only thing you can hand to someone else — or run again on the next craft.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Package the quarter's method — baseline, autopsy, edge-drills, strength/service/stretch, field critique — and walk one person through starting it in *their* craft this week, baseline and all. The method transferring intact to a different craft is the proof it was never about video, or code, or drawing. It was about the road — and now you both have the map.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

By now you've used AI as autopsy assistant, drill designer, and tireless first-pass critic — all real. Here's what the quarter's final lesson makes plain: the machine's critique and the practitioner's differ in kind, because the practitioner's carries *skin* — years of their life in the standards they hold you to, and a relationship that continues if you're worth investing in. 'Send me your next one' is not a feature any model has. Use AI to prepare for the field; never mistake it for the field. The door that opened at the end of this quarter opened to a person.

You'll need: Critique prep card (two specific questions) + closing entry (baseline vs trio / field verdict / next edge)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real practitioner critiqued the work and the first-priority fix was acted on within a week.
- ☐ The improved piece was sent back closing the loop, and the quarter's closing entry is written.

Unlocks after: Make the portfolio pieces

BUILD · Q2

Build With Others

bu-15-16-q2 · supporting: Lead, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 15–16, teens can genuinely divide creative labour — hold their piece of a shared design, trust a teammate's piece they didn't watch being made, and merge the two without either ego breaking. That's new: younger collaboration is mostly parallel play with a shared title. What makes it hard at this age is also what makes it teachable: peer relationships carry enormous weight, so the skills of disagreeing about work without damaging the friendship, and of being *depended on* by people whose opinion matters, land with full force. Every builder's career-ceiling is set by this skill, and almost nobody trains it deliberately.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, building creates value when a team ships something **no member could have built alone** — real division of labour, real interfaces between people's work, real friction survived — and each member can point at their part while honestly crediting the whole. Learning that coordination has costs, that agreements beat assumptions, and that reviewing a friend's work honestly is a form of respect: these are the lessons that turn good builders into people others want to build with.

MOTIVATION LEVER — BELONGING

The quarter's engine is the team itself: two or three builders shipping one real thing, with visible interdependence — my part doesn't work unless yours does. Being genuinely needed by people you chose, meeting the weekly rhythm because others are waiting, and the specific pride of 'we made this' are belonging at full strength, which at this age outpulls almost every other motivator. The retrospective at the end makes the bond explicit: teams that ship together, stay.

THE ARTIFACT

One shipped collaborative project — built by a team of two or three with a written work agreement, real division of labour, version discipline, and peer review — plus each member's visible individual contribution, the team's decision log, and a written retrospective on what the team made possible and what coordination cost.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A team of 2-3 shipped one real thing with genuinely interdependent parts — not parallel solo work stapled together.
- A written work agreement existed from the start: roles, interfaces, deadlines, and how disagreements get decided.
- Each member's work was reviewed by another member at least twice, and at least one review changed something.
- The teen can show their individual contribution and articulate, from the retrospective, one thing the team enabled and one thing coordination cost.

Unlocks after: Go Deep on a Craft

1 Pick the team and split the seams

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Team-building has two decisions, and most groups botch both in the first hour. The team: two or three people chosen for *complementary* skills and matched reliability — a brilliant flake costs more than a solid average, because teams run at the speed of their least reliable member. The split: divide the project along its natural seams so each person owns a whole part with a clear *interface* — the exact thing their part must hand to the next part. 'You do the design, I'll do the build, and the interface is: your files, in this format, by this date.' Vague splits are where friendships go to die.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Three friends building a school-event site split it 'you do some pages, I'll do some pages' — and produced three clashing styles, two half-built duplicates, and one argument. The rebuild split along seams: one owned design (interface: a style sheet and assets), one owned build (interface: working pages from those assets), one owned content and launch (interface: final text by Wednesday, promotion after). Same three people, zero duplicated work, and every argument became a question about an interface instead of a person.

03 APPLY IT

Form your team — two or three builders whose crafts complement yours (your professional voice knows how to make this ask well). Choose a project that genuinely needs all of you and can ship this quarter. Then map its seams together: each member's owned part, and every interface written as 'X hands Y to Z, in this form, by this date'.

04 REFLECT

Did you choose teammates for skill, reliability, or comfort — and which choice will you feel in week four? Where are your project's real seams, and which interface is the one most likely to tear?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your seam map to someone who has worked on real teams. Ask the veteran's question: 'which of these interfaces is going to fail first?' They'll spot it in seconds — vague handoffs glow in the dark to anyone who's been burned by one.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach seams-and-interfaces to a group tackling any joint task — a class project, an event. Convert one 'we'll all just help with everything' plan into owned parts with written handoffs, and watch the relief when everyone suddenly knows what's theirs.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can critique your seam map — 'where will these interfaces break?' is a good structural prompt — but it cannot pick your people; reliability, chemistry, and who shows up when it rains are facts about humans you've watched, not profiles a model can weigh. One team rule to set now, together: agree where AI is welcome in the build (each member's internal work, by the disclosed-tools rule) and where it isn't (nobody outsources their interface to a machine without telling the person on the other end — a generated handoff a teammate builds on is a trust debt between *people*).

You'll need: Seam map (owned parts / interfaces as X→Y contracts) + team roster with the honest reliability note

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] A team of 2-3 exists with complementary skills and a chosen project that needs all of them.
- [ ] A seam map exists with every interface written as a dated, formatted handoff contract.

2 One source of truth

~50 min

01 CONCEPT

Solo builders keep the project in their head; teams need it in a *place*. The disciplines that prevent ninety percent of team chaos: one shared workspace everyone actually uses (not three chats and someone's desktop), one source of truth per artifact — the current version lives in exactly one place, named so anyone can tell (v3-final-FINAL-real is a war crime), older versions kept but clearly retired, and decisions written down where they happened. Software teams solved this with version control; the *principles* — one truth, clear history, visible changes — transfer to any craft, and any team that skips them pays in merge disasters.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The event-site team's near-death experience: two members spent an evening improving the *same* page from different starting copies — four hours of work, unmergeable, one furious night. Their fix was boring and total: one shared folder as law, a naming rule (page-v2-ana-editing means hands off), a five-line decision log ('Wednesday: dropped the countdown widget, too buggy — all agreed'), and for the coder, actual version control. Chaos went to zero in a day. Every professional team on earth runs on some version of these rules, learned the same way: the hard way, once.

03 APPLY IT

Set up your team's infrastructure before real work starts: the one workspace, the naming convention, the source-of-truth rule per artifact type, the decision log, and version control if any part is code. Write it as a one-page team runbook (your reliability training knows this move) and get every member to actually work inside it for the first week.

04 REFLECT

Where does your team's project most resemble the two-people-one-page disaster waiting to happen? What does 'one source of truth' cost in convenience, and why is the cost worth it anyway?

05 GET FEEDBACK

After a week, audit each other: did everyone actually work in the workspace, follow the names, log the decisions? Every violation found kindly now is a merge disaster prevented later. Adjust any rule the team genuinely can't live with — rules nobody follows are worse than no rules.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach one-source-of-truth to any group drowning in 'which version is current?' — a family photo archive, a study-notes group. Set up their single place and naming rule in twenty minutes. It's the least glamorous gift you'll ever give and among the most used.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Infrastructure is machine-friendly territory: AI can draft naming conventions, explain version control basics for your stack, and template the decision log. The team-shaped caution: shared workspaces mean shared *content*, and nobody feeds a teammate's unfinished work, personal messages, or the team's private decisions into an AI tool without asking — the consent rules you learned for interviews apply inside teams too. What's shared with you is not yours to process; it's yours to protect.

You'll need: Team runbook (workspace / naming / truth rules / decision log) + week-one audit notes

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The infrastructure exists and all members worked inside it for a week.
- ☐ The decision log has real entries and the audit found (and fixed) at least one violation.

Unlocks after: Pick the team and split the seams

3 The work agreement and the weekly beat

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Friendly teams avoid writing things down — it feels like distrust. It's the opposite: the work agreement protects the friendship *from* the work. On one page: who owns what (from the seam map), what 'done' means per part, the deadlines each interface depends on, the weekly beat (a fixed 20-minute sync: what shipped, what's stuck, what changes), and — the clause that saves teams — how disagreements get decided when agreeing fails: whose call is it, per area? Decided calmly in week one, that clause is boring paperwork. Improvised mid-conflict in week five, it's the end of the band.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Every famous band that imploded, every startup founder-war, every group project that ended a friendship shares one autopsy finding: no agreement about decisions, money, or credit — until the dispute arrived and wrote one in anger. The event-site trio's agreement took twenty minutes: design calls are Ana's, technical calls are Jun's, content ties break toward Mei, and anything cross-cutting goes to a vote with the owner breaking ties. Week four's font war — which in the counterfactual world becomes The Font War — lasted ninety seconds: 'design call. Ana's.' Done. Still friends.

03 APPLY IT

Write and sign the team agreement: ownership, definitions of done, interface deadlines, the weekly beat's fixed time, and the decision clause per area. Then run the beat for two weeks of real building — twenty minutes, three questions, decisions logged. Real work now proceeds under the agreement.

04 REFLECT

Which part of the agreement felt awkward to propose to friends — and can you now articulate why the awkwardness is precisely the evidence it's needed? What happens to teams whose members are too polite to write things down?

05 GET FEEDBACK

After two weeks, review the agreement as a team: which clause has already earned its place, which needs amending, and has any disagreement been settled by the decision clause yet? Amend openly — an agreement that can't evolve gets abandoned instead.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Give the agreement template to another group forming around anything — a competition team, an event committee. Walk them through the decision clause especially, and tell them the band-war framing: this page is how you stay friends. It reframes paperwork as loyalty, which is what it is.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI drafts good agreement skeletons and can war-game them — 'what disputes does this team's agreement fail to cover?' is worth one run. But the clauses themselves are promises between specific humans, negotiated out loud: whose call design is, what done means, what happens when someone's week collapses — a model has no standing in any of it. Sign it with your names, not a template's. And log the beat's decisions by hand: the log is the team's memory, and teams, like people, must own their memory.

You'll need: Signed work agreement (ownership / done / deadlines / beat / decision clause) + two weeks of beat logs

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A signed agreement exists with a per-area decision clause.
- ☐ The weekly beat ran twice with logged decisions and real build progress under it.

Unlocks after: One source of truth

4 Review each other's work like professionals

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

The hardest team skill: telling a friend their part isn't good enough yet — and hearing it back. Professional review rules make it survivable: review the work against the *agreement's* definition of done, never against taste alone ('this fails the style sheet' beats 'I don't like it'); be specific and actionable (your field-critique training, now given as well as received); the maker decides how to fix, the reviewer decides whether it's fixed; and everything is reviewed before it crosses an interface — because catching a problem at the seam costs minutes, and catching it after integration costs the weekend. Software engineers review every line before merging. They're not being slow. They're being fast.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Jun's review of Ana's checkout page design was one line: 'looks great' — friendship-preserving, useless, and nearly disastrous: the design had no error state, discovered when a real user's payment failed into a blank screen. Their post-mortem produced the review rule they still quote: *'looks great' is not a review.* The next review — 'passes style sheet; missing: error state, loading state, what happens on empty cart' — stung for a minute, saved a weekend, and taught them both what respect between builders actually sounds like.

03 APPLY IT

Install review-before-integration: every part gets reviewed by another member against the definition of done before it crosses its interface. Run at least two review rounds each way during this fortnight's build. Log reviews in three lines: checked against what, found what, resolved how. Fold the best finds into the team's decision log.

04 REFLECT

Which was harder — giving the honest review or receiving it — and what did your field-critique quarter teach you that transfers? What's the difference between a review that respects the work and one that just respects the feelings?

05 GET FEEDBACK

As a team, audit your review log: did any review actually change anything? A log of all-passes means reviews are theatre — raise the bar together. And name the best catch of the fortnight out loud; teams that celebrate catches keep catching.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach 'looks great is not a review' to another collaborating group, with the checkout story. Give them the three-line review format and the maker-fixes/reviewer-verifies rule. If their next review finds something real, the culture transplanted.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

A strong pattern for teams: run AI as the *pre-reviewer* — each member machine-checks their own part against the definition of done before requesting human review, so teammates spend their attention on judgment, not typo-hunting. Two boundaries hold: the human review is the one that counts (a teammate approving your work is a promise to build on it — no model can make promises), and reviewing a teammate's work with AI happens with their knowledge, per the team's own rule from lesson one. Trust is the interface all the other interfaces run on.

You'll need: Review log (against-what / found / resolved) + review-before-integration rule in the runbook

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Every interface crossing this fortnight was preceded by a logged review.
- ☐ At least one review changed something real, and each member both gave and received two reviews.

Unlocks after: The work agreement and the weekly beat

5 Ship it, then hold the retrospective

~90 min

01 CONCEPT

Integration week: the parts meet, the seams show, and the team ships one real thing into the world — launch it with everything your pillars know about launching. Then the closing ritual every serious team runs and every amateur team skips: the retrospective. Around one table: what did the *team* make possible that none of us could have built alone? What did coordination cost, honestly — the hours in syncs, the compromises, the friction? What would we do differently, and — said out loud, by name — what did each person carry? Credit given precisely is the final interface, and the one people remember longest.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The event site shipped two days late (integration always takes longer — now they know) and handled four hundred visitors on event day without a blank screen, because of a one-line review. Their retrospective's ledger: possible-only-together — the design polish, the working code, and the content voice, simultaneously; the cost — roughly a fifth of their hours went to coordination itself ('the tax is real; the product is worth the tax'); by name — 'Jun's error states saved launch day. Ana's style sheet is why it looks like one site. Mei shipped the words while we argued about fonts.' Three builders walked out already planning the next thing — which is the only retrospective metric that really matters.

03 APPLY IT

Integrate, test end-to-end (your stress-test instincts apply — try to break the assembled thing before the world does), and ship to the project's real audience. Within a week, hold the retrospective with the four questions, written down: enabled / cost / change-next-time / credit-by-name. Each member takes their named contribution into their portfolio — with the team credited on every one.

04 REFLECT

Compare this shipped thing to your solo flagship work: what's genuinely different about what a team could reach? And the honest inverse — what did you miss about building alone? Both answers are true; builders spend careers choosing between them project by project.

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show the shipped project and the retrospective to an adult who has worked on real teams. Ask them: 'does this retrospective sound like teams you've been on?' Their stories back — the coordination taxes, the credit wars avoided or not — are a preview of every workplace you'll ever join.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Take the whole quarter's kit — seams and interfaces, one source of truth, the agreement, professional review, the retrospective — and help a new team through their first week of a real joint project. When their agreement gets signed and their first review finds something, you've reproduced the rarest thing in building: a team that works. That's the skill the world is shortest of, and now you carry it.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The retrospective must be the humans in the room — the costs were felt by people, the credit belongs to people, and saying it face to face is the entire point of the ritual. AI's one good seat: before the meeting, each member might privately ask 'what questions should a team retrospective ask that we might avoid?' — machines are useful against a team's shared blind spots, since teams, like individuals, protect their own comfort. But the answers, the credit, and the 'let's build another one' belong to the three of you. Some interfaces are sacred. This is one.

> **You'll need:** Integration test checklist + retrospective sheet (enabled / cost / change / credit-by-name)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The integrated project shipped to its real audience after an end-to-end break test.
- ☐ A written retrospective exists with all four questions answered, including credit by name.

Unlocks after: Review each other's work like professionals

CREATE WEALTH · Q1

From Hours to Assets

cw-15-16-q1 · supporting: Build

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 15–16, a teen who has run ventures can grasp the idea that separates wage-thinking from wealth-thinking: the difference between selling an hour (gone once sold) and building an asset (made once, sold or used many times). The abstraction is now fully available — they can reason about marginal cost, maintenance, and compounding — and their skills are finally good enough to package. The trap at this age is glamour: chasing 'passive income' fantasies from the internet instead of packaging the unglamorous thing they already provably do well.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, creating value means building **the first thing that earns or serves without your presence** — a study guide that sells while you're at school, a template used by strangers, a batch design produced without you touching each unit. The amount matters less than the category shift: the teen who has watched one real sale arrive unattended understands leverage from the inside, permanently.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The quarter's finish line is unmistakable and real: a sale or committed use of the asset that happens without the teen present — witnessed by a notification, not a conversation. Real money (or real adoption) arriving unattended is a qualitatively new experience with real stakes on both sides: the asset took real hours to build, and whether the world wants it is a question only the world can answer.

THE ARTIFACT

One make-once-sell-many asset, live: a packaged product built from the teen's proven skills (a guide, template pack, recorded mini-course, printable design, or batch-produced good) with a real shelf (marketplace listing, order form, or distribution point), its first unattended sales or uses logged, and an honest hours-in versus earnings-out audit.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A finished asset exists, packaged to a written finish bar, built from a skill the teen has real evidence for.
- The asset is on a real shelf where strangers or semi-strangers can get it without talking to the teen.
- At least one sale or committed use happened without the teen present, and it is logged.
- An honest audit exists: total hours invested, earnings or uses to date, and what weekly maintenance actually costs.

1 The hour you can only sell once

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

A service sells your hour; when the hour ends, so does the earning. An asset is different: you spend hours *once* building it, and each copy or use afterwards costs you almost nothing. Tutoring one student is a service; the revision guide you write from those sessions is an asset. Neither is superior everywhere — services teach you what people want; assets scale what you've learned. The wealth move at your stage: run services to *discover* the asset hiding inside them.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen tutor earned RM25 an hour, capped by her own timetable. She noticed she was drawing the same six diagrams for every confused student. Those diagrams, cleaned up into a 14-page 'the six pictures that make trigonometry click' guide, became an asset: 40 hours to make, then RM8 a copy, forever, with her timetable untouched. The service found the asset; the asset freed the hours.

03 APPLY IT

Audit your own service history — ventures, tutoring, helping, making. List every piece of repeatable value hiding in it: the questions you answer again and again, the template you remade five times, the thing you produce that others ask to copy. Write three candidate assets, each in one line: 'package X, for Y, who currently get it only by asking me.'

04 REFLECT

Which candidate is glamorous, and which is *proven* — already requested, already repeated? Why does the internet's 'passive income' advice point at glamour, and what does your own service history point at?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your three candidates to two people who've actually paid for or used your services. Ask: 'which of these would you have bought instead of, or as well as, asking me?' Their answer ranks the list better than any brainstorm.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Explain hours-versus-assets to a friend with a service hustle, using their own repeated work to find their hidden asset candidate. The moment they see the guide inside their tutoring — or the preset pack inside their editing — the idea has transferred.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The candidate list must come from your real service history — the repeated requests are the market's handwriting, and no model has seen your messages. Where AI helps: once you have candidates, 'what formats do assets like X usually take, and what do they sell for?' is honest reconnaissance. The trap to refuse: letting AI *invent* an asset idea unmoored from your evidence. An asset built on a model's guess is glamour with extra steps.

You'll need: Service-history audit sheet + three candidate one-liners

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Three asset candidates are written, each traced to repeated real requests or work.
- ☐ Two past users/customers ranked the candidates.

2 Validate before you build

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

The asset trap: spending eighty hours building before checking anyone wants it. The professional sequence runs backwards — validate first, build second. Three cheap validations, all under an hour each: the *conversation* (describe the asset to five people who fit the buyer; count who asks 'when can I get it?'), the *pre-order* (would anyone pay or sign up now, before it exists?), and the *smoke test* (a one-page description posted where buyers gather — measure real interest). Enthusiasm is polite; pre-orders are evidence.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Before making the trig guide, the tutor ran the sequence: described it to five maths-anxious classmates — three said 'I need that before finals' (signal); offered pre-orders at RM8 — two actually paid (strong signal, and RM16 of funding); posted the one-pager in the year-group chat — eleven 'interested' replies, which she'd learned to discount ('interested' is free) but logged anyway. Eighty hours of building, green-lit by three hours of checking. Her friend skipped this step for his own asset; his eighty hours are still unsold.

03 APPLY IT

Run all three validations on your top candidate inside two weeks: five buyer conversations (log exact words, not vibes), a real pre-order offer with a real price, and a one-page smoke test where your buyers gather. Set your evidence bar *before* you start — what result means build, what means back to the list — and honour it.

04 REFLECT

What's the difference in information between 'that's a great idea!' and a RM8 pre-order? Why do people say the first freely and do the second rarely — and which behaviour is your build decision resting on?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your validation log and your verdict to a fellow builder or adult: 'would you spend eighty hours on this evidence?' If you're bending the bar you set — arguing with your own rules — they'll catch it. That catch is the lesson.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the validate-first sequence to the friend whose asset candidate you found last lesson. Design their three checks with them, evidence bar first. Saving one friend eighty misdirected hours is this lesson's teach-back trophy.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can sharpen the instruments — tighten your one-pager, draft the pre-order pitch, suggest what to listen for in buyer conversations. It cannot be the instrument: a model's judgment of demand is a summary of yesterday's internet, not evidence about your buyers this month. The validation data — the exact words, the paid pre-orders, the reply count — comes from real humans through your real asks. Evidence bar written first, machine forbidden from moving it after.

You'll need: Validation log (conversations / pre-orders / smoke test) + pre-written evidence bar

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ All three validations ran with results logged against a pre-written evidence bar.
- ☐ A build / don't-build verdict is written and matches the bar.

Unlocks after: The hour you can only sell once

3 Build the asset to a finish bar

~120 min

01 CONCEPT

Now build — with the discipline your Build pillar trained: a written finish bar first ('done means…'), the smallest version that fully delivers the promise (v2 features go on the NOT list; assets especially attract endless polishing because they feel *permanent*), and production values matching what buyers expect at the price. An asset carries your name to people you'll never meet — it must survive without you there to explain it. Everything must be *in* the thing: instructions, context, quality.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The trig guide's finish bar, written before hour one: 'six diagrams redrawn cleanly, one worked example + one practice problem per diagram, printable PDF, a cover that doesn't look homemade, tested on two real students without me in the room.' That last clause did the most work — watching a student use the draft *silently* exposed every place the guide assumed she'd be there to explain. Assets are runbooks for knowledge: they work alone or they don't work.

03 APPLY IT

Write the finish bar and the NOT list, then build the asset inside your bet-blocks. Include the without-you test in the bar: two real target users consume the near-final version with you silent, and every stumble becomes a fix. Log build hours honestly — the audit lesson is waiting for the true number.

04 REFLECT

Where did the without-you test catch you assuming your own presence? What's the connection between this and your handoff-week training — what is an asset, in runbook terms?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Give the finished asset to one of your pre-order customers (they funded it; they go first). Ask for the buyer's-eye review: 'was it worth what you paid, and what nearly stopped it being?' Fix what's fixable before the shelf lesson opens it to strangers.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Show a fellow builder your finish bar, NOT list, and hour log, and teach the asset-specific trap: because assets feel permanent, perfectionism feels responsible — and becomes the reason most assets never ship. The finish bar is the antidote; help them write theirs.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Build with the tools the craft really uses, disclosed by the professional's rule you learned in your portfolio quarter: you can say exactly what the tools did, and the judgment calls are yours. The knowledge inside the asset carries a harder rule: it must be *yours to sell* — tested by you, true in your experience, not paraphrased from a model into a product. Buyers are paying for what you actually know. An asset of laundered AI content is a refund waiting to happen, wearing your name while it waits.

You'll need: Finish bar + NOT list + honest hour log + without-you test notes

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ The asset is finished to its pre-written bar, including the without-you test.
- ☐ Build hours are logged honestly, and a pre-order customer confirmed it was worth the price.

Unlocks after: Validate before you build

4 Put it on a shelf that isn't you

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

An asset sold only through your conversations is still a service wearing a costume. It needs a *shelf*: a place where someone can discover, decide, pay, and receive without you present — a marketplace listing, an order form pinned where buyers gather, a consignment spot at a real shop, a download link with payment attached. Shelf design is its own craft: the description sells honestly (your receipts-not-claims training), the price is set by value delivered (not hours spent — buyers don't care about your hours), and the delivery works every time, tested like the machine it is.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The trig guide's shelf: a simple order-form link pinned in three year-group chats plus ten printed copies on consignment at the school co-op shop (the co-op took RM1 a copy — her first distribution cost, noted for the audit). Pricing test: at RM8, buyers didn't blink — her Q2-margins training smelled underpricing, and the reprint went to RM10 with zero resistance. Value-priced, not hour-priced: the guide saved a student ten confused hours; RM10 was never the obstacle.

03 APPLY IT

Choose and build your shelf. Write the listing with receipts (who it's for, what it does, proof it works — your without-you testers' words, with permission). Set the price on value delivered, with a one-line justification. Then test the whole pipeline as a stranger would: discover, decide, pay, receive — every step, without your presence. Fix what breaks; the shelf is a delivery machine and gets machine standards.

04 REFLECT

What does your price say when you justify it by value instead of hours — and why is 'buyers don't care about your hours' both slightly insulting and completely liberating?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Have someone who's never seen the asset walk the shelf cold and narrate: what they'd expect, what they'd doubt, where they'd abandon. Every abandonment point on a shelf is invisible lost sales — patch them before launch.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help your asset-building friend design their shelf: listing with receipts, value-based price, the stranger-walk test. Teach the line that reframes the whole quarter: 'if you have to be in the room, it's not an asset yet.'

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Listing copy is claims-and-receipts territory — machine may polish, only reality may supply the receipts, and testimonial rules are absolute (real words, real permission). Pricing research is a fair AI errand ('what do comparable assets charge?') — treated as reference, overruled by what your validation and your buyers actually said. And test the delivery pipeline with your own hands: a model can review your shelf's design, but only a real walk-through finds the broken link at step three.

You'll need: Shelf checklist (listing with receipts / value-priced / stranger-walk test log)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A real shelf exists where discovery-to-delivery works without the teen present.
- ☐ The stranger-walk test ran and every abandonment point found was fixed.

Unlocks after: Build the asset to a finish bar

5 The first unattended sale — and the honest audit

~60 min

01 CONCEPT

Launch the shelf through your channels (a year of acquisition craft reports for duty), then wait for the notification that defines the quarter: a sale or download that happened *while you weren't there*. Celebrate it — category shifts deserve celebration — then audit it like an operator, because 'passive' is marketing, not accounting: total hours in, revenue out, the true per-week maintenance cost (answering questions, restocking, updating), and the honest projection — at current pace, when does the asset repay its hours, and what does it earn per maintenance-hour after that? Some assets audit brilliantly, some don't; both verdicts, honestly reached, complete the lesson.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Her notification came on a Tuesday, mid-class: RM10, order #14, from a student in the *other* stream she'd never met — the guide had been recommended sideways, her referral training working unattended too. The audit, run at month's end like a books-close: 43 hours in (build + shelf + launch), RM196 out, maintenance a real 30 minutes a week — payback around month four, then roughly RM20 per maintenance-hour after: four times her tutoring rate, uncapped by her timetable. Final line of the audit, worth the whole quarter: 'the guide earns while I sleep; the tutoring never did. Build the next asset.'

03 APPLY IT

Launch through your real channels and drumbeat. Log every sale/use with its source door. When the first unattended one arrives, mark it — then run the full audit at month's end: hours in, earnings out, weekly maintenance measured (not guessed), payback point, per-maintenance-hour rate. Close with the verdict in writing: build on this asset, build the next one, or fold the learning back into services — and why.

04 REFLECT

What did the unattended notification actually feel like — and why does that moment teach leverage better than any explanation ever could? If the audit disappointed: what did the eighty-ish hours buy that the revenue line doesn't show?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present the audit to your decision-maker or peer group exactly as you'd present closed books — because that's what it is. Take the hardest question; if the answer isn't in your logs, that's the number next quarter's asset tracks from day one.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Walk one person — your asset-friend, a sibling, a fellow seller — through the entire arc: service history, validation, finish bar, shelf, unattended sale, audit. When *their* first unattended notification arrives and they message you about it, the quarter has done the only thing curricula are for: it left the building.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The audit runs on your logged reality — hours from your log, sales from your shelf, maintenance from your clock — and by now the reflex is trained: no model fills a blank in your books. The verdict is a capital-allocation call, the first of many in your life: machine as sparring partner on the reasoning, never as the decider. And keep the notification screenshot. Years from now, whatever you build, that Tuesday was the moment the difference between working *for* money and building things that work *while you don't* stopped being a sentence and became a memory.

You'll need: Launch log (sales by door) + asset audit sheet (hours / earnings / maintenance / payback / verdict)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- [ ] At least one unattended sale or committed use is logged, with the launch run through real channels.
- [ ] A complete honest audit exists with payback math and a written verdict.

Unlocks after: Put it on a shelf that isn't you

CREATE WEALTH · Q2

Money That Works

cw-15-16-q2 · supporting: Live Well, Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 15–16, money gets real on both sides of the ledger: teens earn genuinely (ventures, assets, part-time work) and are targeted genuinely — in-app purchases, buy-now-pay-later, gambling-adjacent game mechanics, and algorithmic advertising tuned to their exact insecurities. The cognitive equipment for personal finance is fully present: they can project compound growth, reason about trade-offs across years, and design systems that outvote impulses. What no one tells them is the timing secret: habits and structures installed at sixteen, when amounts are small and stakes forgiving, are the ones that quietly run for life.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, wealth-thinking creates value when the teen's own money — really earned, really theirs — runs through **a system they designed on purpose**: tracked honestly, split deliberately, growing somewhere, defended against the traps aimed at them. The amounts are small; the architecture is permanent. A sixteen-year-old with a working money system and a written policy owns something most adults with salaries never build.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

This is the teen's own money — venture profits, asset sales, allowance, wages — under the teen's own designed control. The quarter's deal is pure autonomy: build the system, run it honestly for a month, and the money's management is genuinely yours, with the family's role shifting from gatekeeper to advisor. At sixteen, 'my money, my system, my policy — reviewed like an adult's' is worth more than any amount inside it.

THE ARTIFACT

A running personal money system: a 30-day honest tracking record, a deliberate account-and-jars structure with pay-yourself-first automation (or its manual ritual), a compounding projection built on the teen's real numbers, a trap-defence audit of their own devices and habits, and a signed one-page personal money policy.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- Thirty real days of spending and income are tracked with honest categories, and the teen can name their top three leaks.
- An account/jar structure exists and money actually moves through it, with saving happening before spending, automatically or by fixed ritual.
- A compounding projection exists using the teen's own numbers, and they can explain why starting years early beats contributing more later.
- A trap-defence audit was done on their own devices and habits, with at least two concrete defences installed.
- A signed one-page money policy exists covering split percentages, what savings are for, giving, and the rules the teen set for themselves.

Unlocks after: From Hours to Assets

1 Thirty days of truth

~40 min

01 CONCEPT

Nobody knows where their money goes; everybody is sure they do. The foundation of every money system is a boring, honest record: thirty days, every ringgit in and out, categorised simply (needs, wants, tools-of-your-craft, giving), nothing hidden — especially not the embarrassing categories, which are the informative ones. You ran this discipline on a venture in your books-closing quarter. Now the business being audited is you.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

A sixteen-year-old who 'basically spends nothing' tracked thirty days and met himself: RM67 in micro-transactions across three games ('it's only RM3' — eleven times), RM48 in after-school snacks, and a RM12 subscription he'd forgotten existed. RM127 a month, invisible, from someone who spends nothing. Not one purchase was a mistake by itself. The pattern was the mistake, and patterns only show up in records.

03 APPLY IT

Track every transaction for thirty days — app, notebook, whatever you'll actually sustain (your venture logging habits transfer directly). Categorise weekly, not at the end. At day thirty: total by category, find your top three leaks, and write one line each on what the leak buys you — because some leaks are worth it, and knowing which is the whole point.

04 REFLECT

Which category surprised you most against your self-image? What's the difference between spending you *chose* and spending that just… happened — and what fraction of your month was each?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your month's summary (totals, not every line) to a money-competent adult and ask what *their* thirty-day truth taught them when they first did it — most never have; watching them realise that is its own lesson. If they have: their leak stories will make yours feel normal, which matters.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Challenge a friend or sibling to their own thirty days, and check in weekly. When their invisible-money number lands, teach the reframe you learned: the record isn't there to shame the snacks; it's there to make the choosing conscious.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The record must be complete and yours — the embarrassing lines especially, because a track record that omits what you'd rather not see is your old friend selection bias, now running on your own wallet. Once thirty honest days exist, AI is a fine pattern-finder ('what do you notice in this spending?') and category-checker. It cannot know what a leak *buys you* — comfort, friendship, craft — and that judgment decides which leaks live or die. Machines optimise numbers; you're budgeting a life.

You'll need: 30-day tracking setup + category summary sheet (totals / top-3 leaks / what each buys)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Thirty complete days are tracked and categorised.
- ☐ The top three leaks are named with an honest line on what each buys.

2 Pay yourself first

~50 min

01 CONCEPT

The one money rule that outranks all others: savings happen *first*, not from what's left — because what's left is always zero; that's what left means. The mechanism is structure, not willpower: the moment money arrives, a fixed slice moves automatically (or by unbreakable ritual) into places with different jobs — spend, save-for-goals, long-term, give. Separate places matter psychologically: money mixed is money spent. You learned this building buffers into your venture; a buffer for your life works identically.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Two teens, same RM200 monthly income. One saves 'whatever's left' — after eight months: RM40, twice raided. The other moves RM50 the day money lands — split RM30 goals, RM15 long-term, RM5 give — then spends the RM150 guilt-free: after eight months, RM400 and zero raids, with *less* self-discipline used, not more. The willpower teen fights a battle every day; the structure teen fought once, when she designed the system. Structure always beats willpower, because structure only has to win once.

03 APPLY IT

Design your structure from your thirty-day truth: the places (real accounts where age allows, labelled jars or sub-balances where not), each place's job, and your percentages — split chosen by you, defensible to yourself. Then install pay-yourself-first: automatic transfer if your banking allows it, or a written ritual with a fixed trigger ('the day anything lands, before anything else'). Run the first cycle now, with real money.

04 REFLECT

What split did you choose and why those numbers? Where will your structure face its first raid attempt — and what makes raiding a labelled 'new-laptop fund' psychologically harder than raiding a pile?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Walk a parent or guardian through the structure — you'll likely need them for any real accounts anyway. Frame it as your system seeking an advisor, not permission: 'here's my design; what would you strengthen?' The register shift matters as much as the banking.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Set up a first pay-yourself-first split with a younger sibling or friend, tiny amounts included — RM2 of RM10 counts fully. Teach the sentence that carries the whole lesson: 'what's left is always zero, so pay the future first.'

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can explain account types available to minors in your country, compare mechanisms, and stress-test your split ('what does this design assume about my income's steadiness?') — honest research and design review. The percentages are values wearing numbers: how much future versus present versus others is precisely the kind of question you must never delegate, because the answer is a description of who you're deciding to be. Ask the machine about mechanisms. Ask yourself about meaning.

You'll need: Structure design (places / jobs / percentages) + first cycle executed with real money

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A place-and-percentage structure exists and the first real cycle ran through it.
- ☐ Pay-yourself-first is automated or installed as a written fixed ritual.

Unlocks after: Thirty days of truth

3 The absurd advantage of starting now

~45 min

01 CONCEPT

Compounding is growth on growth — and its arithmetic is genuinely absurd in one specific way: *time* beats *amount*, and it isn't close. Money growing at 7% doubles roughly every decade (the rule of 72: divide 72 by the rate). Which means the ringgit saved at sixteen doubles perhaps five more times than the ringgit saved at forty — the same coin, worth multiples more, purely for arriving early. Adults telling you this sound like a poster. Running *your own numbers* across your own decades is a different experience entirely — and you, unlike almost everyone, are hearing it while the advantage is still yours.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The classic twins: one invests RM100 monthly from 16 to 26 then stops forever (RM12,000 in); the other starts at 26 and invests RM100 monthly for *forty years* (RM48,000 in). At 66, at 7%: the early twin's decade beats the late twin's four decades. Four times the money in, and still behind — because the early money spent forty years doubling. Nobody believes it until they compute it themselves. So compute it yourself.

03 APPLY IT

Build your own projection: take your actual monthly save-rate from lesson two, project it at a modest growth rate to ages 20, 30, 50, and 66 — then run the twin scenario with your numbers (you-starting-now versus you-starting-at-26). Chart both curves. Then write the one-line conclusion in your own words, because the sentence you write is the one you'll keep.

04 REFLECT

At what age does your curve go from 'meh' to 'wait, what?' — and what does that long flat beginning explain about why most people quit saving young? What would you tell the version of you tempted to quit in the flat part?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Show your curves to an adult over forty and ask the honest question: 'knowing this arithmetic, what would you tell sixteen-year-old you?' The answers are nearly universal, slightly painful, and worth more than the chart. Write down what they say.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Run the twins computation live with a friend, their numbers, their screen. Don't lecture — just make them compute the crossover themselves and watch their face at the 'four times more in, still behind' moment. That face is the lesson landing. It only lands via arithmetic; that's why you make them drive.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The arithmetic is real math on real assumptions — AI can build the spreadsheet and explain the formulas, and verifying its numbers with the rule of 72 in your head is good practice in not outsourcing sense-checks. Two boundaries, one old, one new: the assumptions (your save-rate, a *modest* growth guess) stay yours and stay honest — optimistic rates make pretty lies; and if any tool or feed ever pitches you specific investments promising specific returns, your Don't-Fool-Yourself quarter is the immune system — who benefits, where's the missing data, and nobody guarantees growth. Compounding is patient. Everything promising to hurry it is selling something.

You'll need: Personal projection sheet (curves to 66 / twin scenario / one-line conclusion)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A projection with the teen's real numbers exists including the twin scenario crossover.
- ☐ A one-line conclusion is written in the teen's own words.

Unlocks after: Pay yourself first

4 Know the traps aimed at you

~50 min

01 CONCEPT

You are a targeted market. Billions are spent engineering your specific age group's money out of your pocket: micro-transactions priced below the guilt threshold, loot-box mechanics running casino psychology without casino rules, buy-now-pay-later that splits every price into painless-looking quarters, influencer ads wearing friendship's clothing, and lifestyle inflation — the quiet rule that spending expands to match income unless something stops it. The defence isn't vigilance (vigilance tires); it's *design*: audit your own devices and habits for installed traps, then re-engineer the environment so the default action is the one you chose. You de-crowned a founder once; now de-fang a phone.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

The RM67-in-micro-transactions teen ran his audit and found the machinery: stored payment details (one-tap purchases — friction removed by professionals), notifications tuned to pull him back at his weakest hours, and one game whose 'limited-time offer' timer was, he discovered on the third look, always limited, always available. His defences were structural, not heroic: payment details deleted (adding two minutes of friction — enough for the wanting to pass), purchase notifications off, and a personal rule written into his policy: 'anything over RM20 waits 48 hours; if I still want it, it was real.' Month one under the design: micro-spend RM9. The traps hadn't gotten weaker. The environment had gotten stronger.

03 APPLY IT

Run the trap audit on your own devices and month-one record: stored payments, subscription list (cancel the forgotten), notification permissions for anything that sells, the mechanics inside your top three apps and games (name the psychology being used on you — you know the vocabulary now), and any BNPL or credit-shaped offers you've seen. Install at least two structural defences and one written waiting-rule. Log what each defence is protecting against.

04 REFLECT

Which trap was working best on you — and notice it wasn't the one you'd have guessed before the audit. How does it change your feelings toward these apps to see the machinery priced and aimed? Not outrage, necessarily — but does 'it's just a game' survive the audit?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Compare audits with a friend who's done the same exercise (or walk them into doing it). Different traps catch different people — their catch teaches you a category you're blind to, and explaining your own catch out loud is the vaccine taking.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Teach the audit to your household — parents included; BNPL and subscription creep catch adults harder than teens. Run the family subscription hunt together and total the forgotten monthly cost. You'll likely pay for this curriculum's worth of value in one sitting, and the family treating you as the household's systems auditor is your autonomy lever, compounding.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can explain any mechanic you name — 'what psychology does a loot box use?' gets you the literature in plain language — and help you enumerate defence options. Two sharper notes for this decade: the recommendation feeds deciding what you see *are themselves the largest trap in the audit* — optimised for your attention, which is upstream of your money — so audit them too, with the missing-data question: who benefits from what I'm shown? And when AI tools themselves start carrying subscriptions, offers, and premium tiers aimed at you: same audit, same questions. No tool is exempt from the framework, including the ones helping you build it.

You'll need: Trap audit checklist (payments / subs / notifications / mechanics / credit) + installed defences log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A complete audit exists naming the mechanics found in the teen's own apps and habits.
- ☐ Two structural defences and one written waiting-rule are installed and logged.

Unlocks after: The absurd advantage of starting now

5 Write the policy and run the system

~50 min

01 CONCEPT

Everything converges onto one page: your personal money policy. The split percentages and their reasons; what each savings place is *for* and what justifies touching it; the giving line and why; the waiting-rules and trap-defences; and the review rhythm — monthly, fifteen minutes, against the policy (your drift-review discipline, pointed at money). Written policies beat intentions for the same reason work agreements beat friendliness and pre-mortems beat optimism: the decisions get made once, calmly, by the version of you that thinks in decades — and then the system runs, quietly outvoting the version of you standing in front of something shiny. Sign it. Run it. Review it. That page may be the highest-interest asset you'll ever create.

02 REAL EXAMPLE

Her one-page policy, month three: '40% spend / 35% goals / 15% long-term / 10% give. Goals jar is for the camera — touching it for anything else requires two weeks' wait and one adult's second opinion. Long-term is not mine until 25; it doesn't exist. Giving goes to the animal shelter quarterly, in person. Over-RM20 purchases wait 48 hours. Review: first Sunday monthly.' When a friend's concert-ticket panic came asking to borrow from the goals jar — *her own* panic, technically — the policy answered before the panic could: two weeks, second opinion. She skipped the concert, bought the camera in November, and photographed the next concert for pay. She quotes the policy's real author now: 'calm me decided; panicked me just had to obey.'

03 APPLY IT

Write your policy, one page, every element: splits with reasons, each place's purpose and touch-rules, giving, waiting-rules, defences, review rhythm. Sign it, date it, and post it where the money decisions happen. Then run the full system for one complete monthly cycle — income in, splits moving, policy consulted, review held — and log the cycle as proof of operation.

04 REFLECT

Reading your signed policy: which line will be hardest to obey, and which future moment will test it first? Across this whole curriculum — plans, agreements, runbooks, policies — what have you learned about the power of decisions written down by your calmest self?

05 GET FEEDBACK

Present the policy and your first cycle's log to your family advisor as a completed system: 'this is how my money runs now — annual review welcome.' Then ask the closing question of the quarter: 'what does my having this change about what you'd trust me with?' Log the answer. It's the autonomy you were playing for.

06 TEACH IT BACK — THE STEP THAT MAKES IT STICK

Help one person — friend, sibling, honestly even a parent — write their own one-page policy through the whole ladder: thirty days of truth, structure, projection, traps, policy. When theirs is signed and their first cycle runs, you haven't just taught a system. You've changed the trajectory of someone's decades, with one page. That's the wealth pillar's deepest lesson: the highest-return thing you'll ever build is capability — in yourself, and then in others.

AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The policy is the least delegable document in this entire curriculum: it's your values, addressed to your future weakness, signed by your present strength. AI's one honest role: after you've written it, the standing red-team pass — 'find the loopholes I've left myself.' Machines are excellent at finding loopholes; you were always going to find them too, at the worst possible moment. Better now. Then sign the closed version — by hand, on paper, the old way. Some documents deserve ink.

You'll need: Signed one-page money policy + first full-cycle log + monthly review slot in the calendar

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

- ☐ A signed, dated one-page policy exists covering splits, purposes, touch-rules, giving, waiting-rules, and review rhythm.
- ☐ One complete monthly cycle ran under the policy with its review held and logged.

Unlocks after: Know the traps aimed at you